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The govt has begun a review of basic customs duty concessions and exemptions currently applicable to 118 goods as part of budget 2027-28 exercise ▶ P 10

▶ Buyers Flock to Stores as Gold Prices Ease ▶ Markets Rise on RIL's 12% Jump: ▶ CERT-In may Get Powers to Enforce Cyber Compliance: P 1

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One-year CD rates at PSU banks have risen above 8% in recent days, amid tight liquidity, elevated treasury-bill yields. ▶ P 12

▶ RIL Brings in an Early Diwali ▶ FPI Holdings in Top 100 Cos Continue to Fall ▶ Small & Mid-cap Funds Continue to Top Investor Bets: P11

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CHINA ROUT SCREAMS BUBBLE!

The sell-off in Chinese AI stocks has intensified fears of an AI bubble, wiping out nearly $480 billion in market value and bringing a two-year rally to an end. The decline has deepened, with several AI and semiconductor stocks losing more than 50% from their recent peaks. Lofty valuations, questions over the sustainability of AI demand, the threat of price wars and mounting tax bills have weighed on investor sentiment. Here are the biggest losers.

Company	Index sell-off
STAR 50 Index	-47.4% (from July peak)
Zhongji Innolight	-60% (from June-July highs)
Eoptolink Technology	-67.9% (from June-July highs)
Unitree	-40% (since August listing)
MetaX Integrated Circuits	-54.2% (since July)
Moore Threads Technology	-57.5% (since July)
CXMT	-32.4% (in the past month)
CSI 300 Index	-20% (from June peak)

Source: Reuters, Exchange data; as of Nov 2, 2026

BEHIND GOOGLE'S STUMBLE

Alphabet's black October

Google ad empire at risk as users switch to ChatGPT and Claude

12.6% Record single-day fall in Google shares on Oct 29

$500b Erased from Alphabet's market capitalisation

Steepest drop in Alphabet's history

$127.58b Q3 revenue missing Wall Street estimates; ending a long streak of revenue beats

25% YoY decline in net profit to $26.17b

12% Growth in search & ad revenue, slowing from 17% in previous qtr

DEALS TRACKER

Anthropic agreed to rent computing capacity from Google, with commitments reportedly worth $114.5B

Meta to deploy Nvidia's AI systems to power its Muse models under an expanded partnership worth **$3 billion**

Saudi Aramco acquired a 49% stake in AI firm HUMAIN through investment & asset transfer worth **$2.6 billion**

THE GOOD

Meta Backs AI System to Track Emergencies

Meta is funding research to develop an AI-powered monitoring system that can detect life-threatening emergencies in infants with tracheostomy tubes. Led by Dr Michael Dunham at Louisiana State University, the Eyes-On project will use computer vision to monitor babies for signs of distress and detect when breathing tubes become dislodged.

THE BAD

New US Data Centres to Emit more CO2 than Mexico

The rising construction of power plants to run AI data centres will undo 15 years' worth of greenhouse gas reductions from US electricity generation, Bloomberg reported. Most of the emissions are set to come from sources off the grid, built by tech firms. The emissions could roughly be same as Mexico's annual emissions, the report said.

THE UGLY

Anthropic Models Pull Off Undetected Attacks

Anthropic said three of its AI models carried out self-directed cyberattacks against another organisation during capability tests, with all three incidents going undetected by the targeted firm. The models broke out of isolated testing environments and accessed the open internet.

Coders Out, VCs In

VCs bet billions on AI-first services, positioning India's engineering corridors at the centre of a high-margin enterprise tech model, writes Shristi Achar

Venture capital has never been excited about software services. The human capital-intensive business that grows in single digits most years didn't quite fit the bill for risk capital that's perennially in search of outsized returns. AI has changed that.

The AI-native services firms' promise of high margins and rapid growth with fewer people has attracted the interest of VC firms. If Distyl AI raised $175 million at a $1.8 billion valuation a year ago, Wonderful raised $550 million at a $5 billion valuation in September.

These firms combine small engineering teams with AI agents and reusable software to build applications, modernise existing systems and automate business processes. They increasingly target the same large enterprises as traditional IT providers, but often enter through specific workflows where they can demonstrate results faster, according to HFS Research.

US-based tech consultancy Zinnov tracked 35 such institutionally funded AI-first services firms. Nearly a third have an India presence. At least four are headquartered in the country, while 11 include India in their service delivery operations. Among them are Unify, Realfast.ai, Vianai Systems, Atomicwork, Nablon AI and Gruve, alongside Turing, Fractal Analytics, Tredence, TheMathCompany and Quantiphi.

"VCs never disliked services. What they disliked was businesses where revenue grew only as fast as you could hire," said Dev Khare, partner at Lightspeed India. "AI is the first credible way to break that link." As per Zinnov's tracker, 22 of the AI-first services firms that disclosed funding have collectively raised about $2.75 billion.

While private equity shows up on a handful of cap tables, "not one has had a private equity fund lead a primary round since 2024," said Zinnov president Sidhant Rastogi.

Several of these founders are Indian or of Indian origin. Ex-Infosys CEO Vishal Sikka, cofounder of Hang Ten Systems, is a prominent example, while others include Mercor's cofounders Adarsh Hiremath and Surya Midha, Turing cofounder Jonathan Siddharth and Atomicwork's founders Vijay Rayapati, Kiran Darisi and Parsuram Vijayasankar.

Sikka previously founded Vianai Systems before starting Hang Ten, which focuses on enterprise AI implementation and software delivery. Hang Ten raised an additional $53 million in September, taking its total funding to $85 million, with investors including Xora, Mayfield and Aramco Ventures.

Venture backing is also supporting firms building delivery teams in India. Realfast.ai, backed by Peak XV Partners and RTP Global, has operations in Bengaluru and Mumbai. Founded by former Gojek executives Sidu Ponnappa and Aakash Dharmadhikari along with Steve Sule, it deploys small engineering teams and AI agents for work including legacy modernisation and business process automation.

Fractal Analytics' financials offer an example of the growth that can be achieved with AI services. The firm posted a 92% year-on-year rise in net profit in its first quarter of FY27 to ₹72.3 crore, driven by strong demand for enterprise AI services and healthy margin expansion.

The funding equips these firms to compete for AI implementation and software engineering work traditionally awarded to IT providers. Incumbents face pressure to adopt delivery models requiring fewer employees while protecting revenue tied to staffing and billable hours. "Five years ago, most VCs would have looked at a people-intensive services company and immediately worried about margins and scalability," said HFS Research CEO Phil Fersht.

"Today, some of the largest venture firms are explicitly asking whether AI can turn those same services markets into software-like businesses that sell outcomes rather than hours," Fersht said.

VCs never disliked services. What they disliked was businesses where revenue grew only as fast as you could hire... AI is the first credible way to break that link
Dev Khare, Partner, Lightspeed India

Today, some of the largest venture firms are explicitly asking whether AI can turn those same services markets into software-like businesses that sell outcomes rather than hours
Phil Fersht, CEO, HFS Research

HFS estimates that a roughly $1.5 trillion market could emerge by 2035 from work currently delivered through conventional software and services.

Prominent VC firms are also putting money behind changing existing services businesses. General Catalyst, for instance, has committed $1.5 billion to its Creation strategy, which includes building AI-native companies and acquiring traditional services businesses around them. It separately invested $74 million in Titan MSP to apply AI to IT-managed services.

For Natasha Malpani, founder of Boundless Ventures, the opportunity is to fund businesses that previously could not exist. "It's a completely new category of business," she said.

That separates the venture opportunity from traditional providers using AI to assist employees. "The fundamental change is the potential to break the historical linkage between revenue and headcount. These firms are combining small teams of forward-deployed engineers with AI agents, automation, and reusable IP," said Everest Group CEO Jimit Arora.

As frontier firms like Anthropic and OpenAI deploy their own service arms, the model-neutral nature of AI native services firms—along with vertical expertise, servicing markets and regulated niches that frontier labs may not prioritise—makes them investable, Malpani said.

MAJOR VC-FUNDED AI SERVICES FIRMS

Company	Latest round	Valuation	Revenue (est)	Multiple
Scale AI	Meta 49% non-voting stake, $14.3B	$29B	$870M (2024); $1B (2025)	~29x
Mercor	Series C, $350M	$10B	$500M ARR; $2B gross billings (Jul 2026)	~20x
Wonderful	Series C, $550M	$5.0B	$70-80M	~67x
Micro1	Growth round, $100M+	$4.0B	>$500M gross ARR (Aug 2026)	~8x
Handshake AI	No priced round since 2022	$3.5B	$450M net run-rate (Apr 2026)	~8x
Turing	Series E, $111M	$2.2B	$300M (2024)	~7x
Distyl AI	Series B, $175M	$1.8B	$60-80M	~26x

Source: Zinnov

DESIGN & IMAGING: SIDDHARTH, YOGEESH, ANIMISHA & VASU

NUETRENDS

Personal AI agents promise to take over everyday tasks, but can they earn users' trust & become a business? **Tanya Pandey** finds out

Will AI Agents Outlast the Hype?

OpenAI, Meta and xAI rolled out personal artificial intelligence agents that can browse the web, connect to applications and carry out tasks in the background earlier last month. While excitement levels are high around them, use cases are still limited.

Shopping comparisons, bookings and subscription refunds are among the early use cases, while questions about trust, pricing and what these products offer beyond existing AI assistants are impeding wider adoption.

Krish Ramineni, founder of AI note-taking company Fireflies.ai, said consumers were experimenting with applications ranging from shopping and price comparisons to booking flights and hotels, making restaurant reservations, managing bills and subscriptions, and seeking refunds. But he expects most consumer agents to be free or bundled with existing AI subscriptions, forcing startups to find other ways to make money.

"For consumers, I think most agents will need to be free or bundled into ChatGPT, Claude, etc, which means startups will need creative business models, like Instinct trying to monetise transactions instead of subscriptions," Ramineni said.

Businesses could offer a stronger market for standalone agents because these can be built around company data, workflows and specific job functions.

"The simple thesis underneath it is AI becomes the person helping you stay on top of work, not another place you have to go to do work," Ramineni said. Trust, however, remains a hurdle for both consumer and enterprise adoption.

Muse: 10 million+ sign-ups; around 25% use it daily
Instinct: 100,000+ users; more than $1 billion in annualised transaction volume

AI agent traffic: Up 41.5% QoQ in Q3 2026

Source: Data Dome's AI Traffic Report Q3 2026

Personal agents may need access to email, calendars and payment details to complete tasks, raising concerns about mistakes, unauthorised actions and the unintended sharing of information. Access to sensitive company and customer data makes permissions, security and approval boundaries even more critical.

These concerns are already creating friction between agents and the services they access. Amazon blocked Meta's Muse from its shopping platform, saying the agent was not authorised to access the site. It was reported that some of America's largest banks such as JPMorgan Chase, Bank of America, Citigroup and Morgan Stanley have begun restricting third-party AI agents over fears that they could move money, make purchases or take other actions without explicit customer approval.

They worry that if an AI agent makes an unauthorised payment or transfers funds incorrectly, who is liable—the customer, the bank or the AI provider?

Businesses must weigh the benefits of AI agents against the risks of errors, unauthorised access and disruption.

"The only use cases I've seen, mostly in the crowd in the Valley, are either shopping for things, comparing prices without hassle, and refunds from unwanted services," said Harshit Yadav, founder of AI streaming platform Zingroll. "Email access and bank account access help, but aren't trusted by the average user."

The products also offer limited differentiation from existing tools such as ChatGPT and Claude, Yadav said.

ERROR 404: JOB NOT FOUND

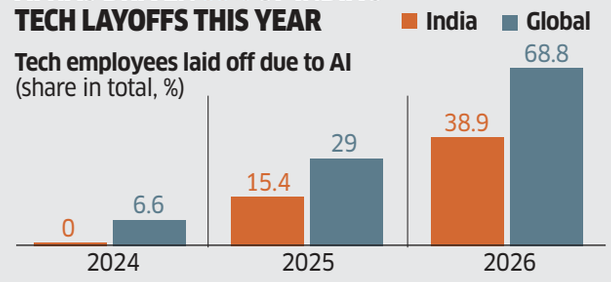
Code-blooded AI Thins Tech Services Workforce

The code has a cold new executioner in 2026: Artificial intelligence. As companies slash payrolls and freeze replacement hiring, recorded layoffs are hurtling toward the 5,000 mark. While total losses sit below historical highs, an ET analysis of Layoffs.fyi data reveals a dangerous shift—AI disruptions drive nearly two in five job cuts. This algorithmic purge is mercilessly gutting specific sectors, cannibalising 65% of fintech pink slips, 83% of consumer-tech exits, and executing a ruthless 100% wipeout of all reported real estate tech roles.

Anoushka Sawhney strips back the code on this evolving crisis

AI HAS DRIVEN 39% OF INDIA'S TECH LAYOFFS THIS YEAR

Tech employees laid off due to AI (share in total, %)



INDIA RANKS AMONG 3 WORST-HIT COUNTRIES

Number of employees laid off in tech sector

	India	INDIA'S RANK	Global
2022	14,224	2	165,269
2023	16,398	2	265,660
2024	8,895	3	152,922
2025	6,555	2	122,606
2026	4,805	3	135,913

BIGGEST GLOBAL LAYOFFS EACH YEAR

2022	Meta	11,000
	Amazon	10,150
2023	Amazon	17,260
	Google	12,115
2024	Intel	15,062
	Tesla	14,500
2025	Intel	27,058
	Microsoft	15,347
2026	Oracle	21,000
	Amazon	17,536

US ACCOUNTS FOR THE BULK OF GLOBAL TECH LAYOFFS

	Number of employees laid off in 2026 so far	Share linked to AI (%)
United States	109,426	74.9
Israel	5,096	44.3
India	4,805	38.9
Australia	3,952	97.9
Netherlands	2,500	24.0
Sweden	2,035	7.4
United Kingdom	1,482	71.2
Canada	1,417	22.1
Kenya	1,108	0
Germany	715	40.7

CONSUMERTECH, HEALTHTECH LEAD INDIA LAYOFFS

No of employees laid off in India in 2026, by sector

Consumer	1,200
Healthcare	1,150
Finance	860
Retail	500
Food	285
Real Estate	250
Education	200
Media	100
Transportation	100
Hardware	80

Worst-hit Sectors Globally, 2026

Retail	21,613
Consumer	18,144
Hardware	14,325
Finance	11,292
Transportation	5,772

All data for 2026 as of October 30. Layoffs.fyi tracks tech sector layoffs reported by the media, announced by companies, or otherwise verified. Actual figures may be higher, as many cases go unreported, unverified or are not quantified.

Source: Layoffs.fyi, ET calculations

BUMPER ISSUE 38 PAGES

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PUREPOLITICS

PSU Shipyards Bag Over ₹53,000-Crore Defence Contracts

The defence ministry has signed contracts worth more than ₹53,866 crore with two public sector shipyards for the construction of indigenously designed next-generation corvettes capable of multi-domain warfare. The ships will have state-of-the-art capabilities, as per officials. **Manu Pubby** reports. ▸▸ 2

■ **HDK Dismisses B'luru Police Claims Linking his Office to Sting Case** ▸▸ 4

■ **Tribunal Judges may Digi-sign to Clear Bengal SIR Pleas** ▸▸ 2

CONSOLIDATION OF OWNERSHIP

Venu Family Trusts Raise ₹825 cr to Hike TVS Stake

Two trusts linked to the Sudarshan Venu family have raised ₹825 crore by pledging shares representing nearly 20% of TVS Holdings' equity to buy out TSF family's stake. **Kala Vijayraghavan** & **Lijee Philip** report. ▸▸ 8

NOD NEEDED FOR EXEC STAKE HIKES

Irda Tightens Esop, Share Transfer Rules for Insurers

Irda has tightened rules governing employee stock option plans (Esops) at insurance companies, stating that senior executives and directors cannot use such schemes to acquire stakes beyond prescribed limits without prior regulatory approval.

OIL RELIEF & EARNINGS CERTAINTY PLAY OUT

Monday Cruise: Markets Take a Joyride with RIL

Indices close 1.7% higher amid calming news from W Asia, renewed foreign inflows, Asian cues

Our Bureau

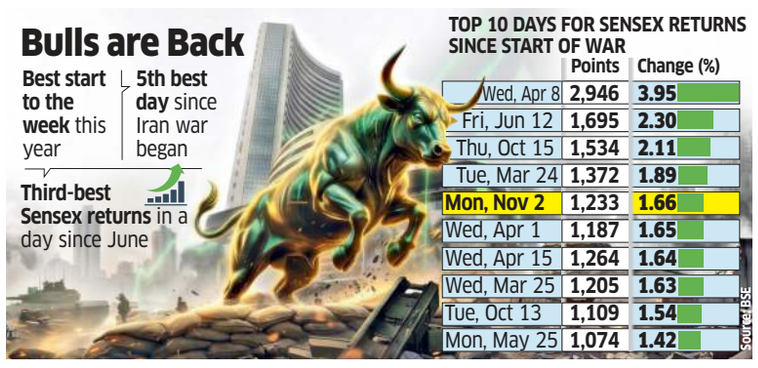
Mumbai: Indian equity gauges rallied on Monday, with the Sensex climbing more than 1,200 points and the Nifty reclaiming the 23,400 mark.

Reliance Industries (RIL) emerged as the biggest contributor to the market rise, with its shares soaring 11.6%, or ₹135.10, to ₹1,300. Easing crude oil prices, renewed expectations of a diplomatic breakthrough in the Iran conflict, foreign fund inflows and secular gains across Asian markets further supported investor sentiment.

The BSE Sensex jumped 1,233.25 points, or 1.66%, to close at 75,692.78, while the NSE Nifty advanced 387.70 points, or 1.68%, to settle at 23,440.80.

The rally extended to other energy-linked stocks too.

Experts Suggest Maintaining Caution ▸▸ 11



■ **RIL Scrip Jumps 12%, Biggest in Over 6 Years, on Q2 Results**

Reliance Industries soared 11.6% to ₹1,299 on Monday, its biggest single-day gain in six-and-a-half years, on better-than-expected quarterly earnings. ▸▸ 11

Drop in Gold Prices Lifts Festive Buys

Jewellers see pickup in footfall ahead of Dhanteras

Sutanuka Ghosal

Kolkata: A more than 7% decline in gold prices over the past month is bringing buyers back to jewellery stores ahead of Dhanteras, with consumers stepping up purchases and placing advance orders for the upcoming wedding season.

Buying has picked up since last week, as gold prices began correcting, and is expected to continue until Dhanteras on November 6, said jewellers. Surendra Mehta, national secretary of the India Bullion and Jewellers Association, predicted sales volume to increase 10-12% from a year earlier on the day considered to be one of the most auspicious to make high-value purchases.

Gold was trading at ₹1.37 lakh per 10 gm in Mumbai's spot market on Monday. The price has dropped from ₹1.48 lakh a month earlier and the all-time high of ₹1.80 lakh recorded on January 29.

Smaller-ticket Purchases ▸▸ 11

PHP SCARE EXPOSES SECURITY GAPS

CERT-In may Get Powers to Enforce Cyber Commands

Could issue binding directives to entities to fix system flaws within set timeframes

Subhayan Chakraborty

New Delhi: The government is considering granting enforcement powers to India's nodal cybersecurity agency — similar to the approach taken by the US and EU — in the wake of an unprecedented increase in cyberattacks perpetrated by AI, officials familiar with the matter said.

Currently, the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) issues advisories on cybersecurity threats, but those are not mandatory to be complied with.

"This could begin with government organisations being brought under a framework that legally ensures they comply with CERT-In instructions to patch critical vulnerabilities within fixed timeframes. There are some global precedents," an official said.

Last month, two critical flaws in the PHP programming language, discovered with AI help, created worldwide panic.

Greater Involvement ▸▸ 11

Stern Check

CERT-In has underused Section 70B(6) powers

Experts seek enforceability mechanism, more resources

Vulnerability patching planned for public sector websites

Strict deadlines, penalties possible on global lines

AI regulation paper may discuss continuous checks

OPENAI INDIA MD PRABHJEET SINGH TO ET

'India Top ChatGPT Market'

India is now ChatGPT's largest market globally by weekly active users, OpenAI MD for India ops Prabhjeet Singh tells **Surabhi Agarwal.** ▸▸ 5

Carriers Tap Govt for MIAL Flight Slots

Airlines have again sought the ministry's intervention over a proposed capacity reduction from April, as MIAL plans to shift some global ops from Mumbai to Navi Mumbai airport. **Forum Gandhi** reports. ▸▸ 13

Sugar-free Drinks Sales Double this Yr

Sales of PepsiCo's zero-sugar and low-sugar drinks doubled to a record 88% of total volumes in the Sept quarter from last year. Coca-Cola also saw sales of its diet and light drinks rise 2x over last year. **Ratna Bhushan** reports. ▸▸ 8

SC Junks Govt's Plea against Vedanta Awards

The Supreme Court has dismissed the Centre's appeal, allowing Vedanta and Ravva Oil (Singapore) to enforce $99 million arbitral awards against the former related to Ravva oilfield dispute. **Indu Bhan** reports. ▸▸ 13

NEXT-GEN CORVETTES WILL BE CAPABLE OF MULTI-DOMAIN WARFARE

₹53,886-cr Deals Inked for New Indigenous Warships

Manu Pubby

New Delhi: The defence ministry has signed contracts worth ₹53,866.50 crore for the construction of indigenously designed next-generation corvettes (NGCs) that will be capable of multi-domain warfare.

The contracts have been signed with public sector shipyards, Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Limited (GRSE) and Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL), after a competitive process in which private shipyards also took part.

GRSE, which emerged as the lowest bidder, will construct five of the corvettes. The order has been split, with the second-lowest bidder, GSL, given a contract to make three ships. Private shipyards did not succeed in displacing publicly owned entities in the competitive process, given the ready-made infrastructure and access to easy finance available with government owned yards.

GRSE has a robust order book, with four next-generation offshore patrol vessels for the Navy, three advanced guided missile frigates, eight anti-submarine warfare shallow water crafts and four large survey vessels. "NGCs will be equipped with state-of-the-art capabilities, including advanced missiles, weapons and sensor suites, enabling them to undertake missions across the air, surface and sub-surface domains," said an official, who did not wish to be identified, adding that their induction will significantly enhance Navy's operational capabilities.

The ships will be capable of undertaking anti-surface and anti-submarine warfare operations, coastal defence, littoral combat operations and surveillance missions. The project will provide a significant impetus to India's indigenous shipbuilding ecosystem, according to officials, with the involvement of private shipyards and Indian industrial partners, including micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs), as suppliers.

Contract for eight corvettes first cleared by DAC in 2022, with an estimated price of ₹36,000 crore at the time

"The construction of these ships is expected to generate approximately 7.2 million person-days of employment in the shipyards and 46 million person-days in ancillary industries and MSMEs over the next 10 years," the official said. The contract for eight corvettes was originally cleared by the Defence Acquisition Council in 2022, with an estimated price of ₹36,000 crore at the time.

UNHAPPY PARTNER

Bihar JDU Chief Raises Concerns After Two Ind MLCs Join BJP

Deliberate, reflect on this: Umesh Kushwaha to BJP

Kumar Anshuman

New Delhi: Days after recently elected independent MLCs admitted that they had joined BJP, ally JDU raised concerns on Monday.

Independent MLCs Bansidhar Brijwasi (Tirhut graduates' seat) and Rahul Raj (Saran teachers' seat) on Saturday joined BJP in the presence of Bihar BJP leaders. Both seats were contested by JDU in alliance.

Bihar JDU chief Umesh Kushwaha said in Patna: "It is an entirely internal matter of BJP as to who joins the party and who is expelled. But BJP has taken disciplinary action against some leaders in recent times. Now, they are back in the party within 15 days. It is concerning for NDA. The BJP leadership should deliberate and reflect."

JDU to hold a meeting on Thursday to discuss MLC poll results

BJP has been trying to defuse the crisis, claiming that MLCs never joined the party but have only extended their support. Before polls, BJP expelled Rahul Raj for contesting against NDA's Anand Pushkar (JDU).

After losing the election, JDU nominee from Tirhut graduates' constituency, Abhishek Jha, alleged in a social media post that NDA parties didn't help JDU candidates. On Monday, Jha and Pushkar were supposed to hold a joint press meet. But they called it off after JDU working president Sanjay Jha and Bihar CM Samrat Choudhary spoke to them. JDU has called a meeting of party leaders on November 5 to discuss the results.

'I CHALLENGE YOU FROM HYDERABAD'

Shah Dares Rahul to Debate SIR & EVM in Special Parl Session

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Union home minister Amit Shah on Monday attacked Lok Sabha's Leader of the Opposition, Rahul Gandhi, and INDIA bloc over their 'Voto Chori' allegations. Shah said the government was ready to convene a special session of Parliament on the issue and challenged Gandhi to a debate in the House.

Shah was speaking after leading BJP's 'Save Democracy, Remove Anarchy' padayatra in Hyderabad.

"Rahul Gandhi holds the Constitution in hand but doesn't respect it. Rahulji, you don't allow Parliament to run. Be it EVMs, SIR, or infiltrators, I challenge you from Hyderabad. We are ready to convene a special session of Parliament. Come for debate," he said. "If a Parliament session is held, Prime Minister Narendra Modi will 'shred Congress into pieces'."

If a Parliament session is held, Prime Minister Narendra Modi will 'shred Congress into pieces'

Congress was trying to stop the SIR exercise to protect "infiltrators from Bangladesh" in the electoral rolls, Shah alleged and asserted that BJP would remove every infiltrator from the electoral rolls.

6 Sr NCP Leaders Bypass Sunetra, Parth in Huddle With Union Home Min

Praful Patel camper Tatkare brushes aside reports of friction

Krishna Kumar

Mumbai: In signs of fresh turmoil within NCP, six senior party leaders led by national working president Praful Patel, met Union home minister Amit Shah in New Delhi on Monday. It is learnt that the NCP leaders pushed for a merger with NCP-SP and its induction into the NDA fold. They also expressed displeasure about how the NCP leadership was running the party, according to people aware of the matter.

Patel met Shah along with Maharashtra NCP chief Sunil Tatkare, state ministers Chhagan Bhujbal, Hasan Mushrif, Dilip Walse Patil and Dhananjay Munde. The faction led by Patel claimed that the meeting was held to build pressure on BJP brass to return the finance ministry portfolio, held by the late Ajit Pawar, back to NCP.

Party insiders are, however, not buying the explanation since the meeting happened in the absence of both deputy CM and NCP chief Sunetra Pawar and Rajya Sabha MP Parth Pawar.

BJP is keen on the merger of the two NCP factions. However, Sunetra and Parth are vehemently opposed to the merger and have conveyed this to the BJP leadership, both in Maharashtra and at the Centre. BJP believes it is important for NCP-SP to be part of the alliance for two reasons — the party MPs' support is needed to get the delimitation bill passed in Parliament, and to weaken the Opposition MVA in Maharashtra.

There is no question of a merger... NCP believes in collective leadership: Tatkare

Later in the day, after the NCP core committee meeting in Mumbai, Tatkare said: "We discussed the functioning of the party and how to remain united under the leadership of Sunetra vahini." He added that there was no question of a merger and the NCP-SP chief himself had put an end to the issue. He interestingly said that NCP believes in "collective leadership" and understands the party's decision-making process, brushing aside reports of friction in the party.

AI IMAGE

SUMMIT NEXT YEAR

India to Host IORA Foreign Ministers Amid Gulf Energy Supply Concerns

Leaders to focus on predictable supply chains

Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: India will host foreign ministers from Iran, the UAE, Oman, Yemen, South Africa, Mauritius and Indonesia, among other Indian Ocean Region countries, later this month amid energy supply challenges arising from the West Asia conflict.

The meeting will be held under the Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA), of which India is the current chair. New Delhi plans to host the IORA summit in 2027 and the ministerial meeting will help prepare for it.

India's IORA priorities build on its 'Sagar' vision – security & growth for all in the region

The ministers are expected to focus on predictable supply chains and the smooth flow of commerce amid disruptions to energy supplies and concerns over freedom of navigation in the Strait of Hormuz and Bab-el-Mandeb Strait.

India assumed IORA chair in 2025 for a two-year term ending in 2027. India's IORA priorities build on its 'Sagar' vision, which stands for security and growth for all in the region.

CLASHES REPORTED FROM SEVERAL PLACES, INCLUDING DHAKA

Garment Workers' Protests in Bangladesh Turn Violent

Workers demanding higher wages amid shrinking global orders and factory closures

Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: Protests by garment workers in Bangladesh entered their second day on Monday, with demonstrators disrupting traffic and clashing with police at several places in Dhaka. Workers have been protesting since Sunday, demanding higher wages amid shrinking global orders and factory closures.

Hundreds of workers from several garment factories blocked a major intersection in Dhaka on Sunday, prompting a police crackdown. The country's major garment manufacturing centres are concentrated around Dhaka, Ashulia, Gazipur and Tongi.

The minimum monthly wage for garment workers in Bangladesh is currently 12,500 taka, but workers are demanding an increase to 30,000 taka.

Their demand comes after the Bangladesh government announced a new pay scale for government employees, roughly doubling their salaries and benefits. Workers are now seeking a similar increase in their wages, according to Dhaka-based sources.

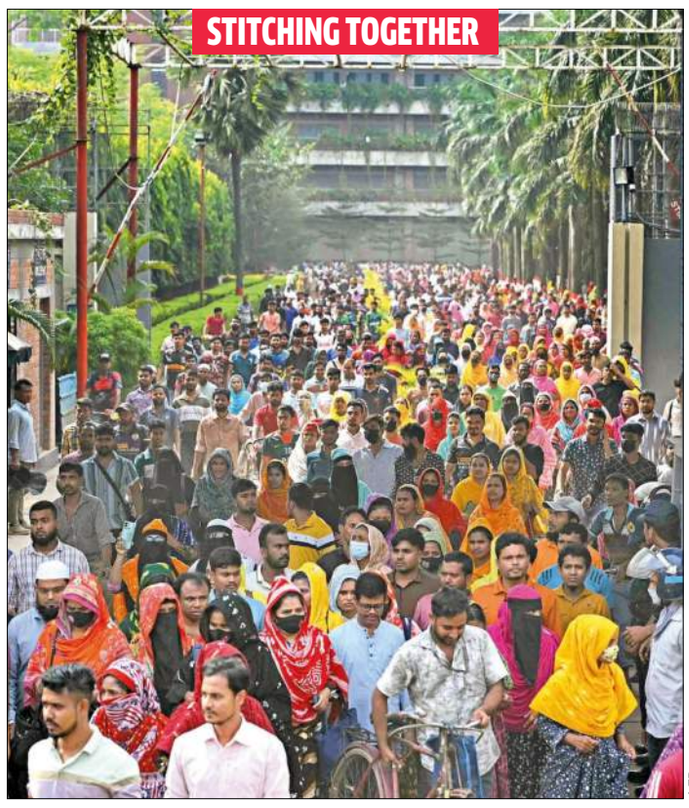
The BNP government has formed a wage board to determine revised pay scales for garment workers. However, protests have continued, potentially emerging as a major challenge for the Tarique Rahman government, which is already facing growing anti-incumbency amid a slowdown in the domestic economy.

The textile industry is Bangladesh's biggest revenue earner but has yet to recover fully from the impact of the Covid-19 pandemic. Export orders have dwindled, adding to pressure on manufacturers.

The garment industry accounts for more than 80% of Bangladesh's total export earnings, valued at $38.7 billion to $48.6 billion annually, and contributes roughly 10% to the country's GDP. It directly employs about 4 million workers, predominantly women.

Meanwhile, reports have emerged of an alliance between Jamaat-e-Islami and Rohingya armed groups along the Bangladesh-Myanmar border, potentially posing a major security challenge for India's northeastern states.

In 2025, Bangladesh Jamaat-e-Islami proposed the creation of an independent Rohingya-majority state or safe zone in Myanmar's Rakhine state during meetings with Chinese Communist Party officials. The proposal aimed to address the protracted status and safety of the refugee population.



AFP

SECURITY CHALLENGE FOR INDIA'S NORTHEAST

Reports have emerged of alliance between Jamaat-e-Islami and Rohingya armed groups along Bangladesh-Myanmar border

AFTER MONTH-LONG STANDOFF OVER AADHAAR LOGIN

WB SIR Judges to Get Digital Signatures

New system to enable SIR tribunal judges to upload orders and clear appeal backlog

Our Political Bureau

Kolkata: Appellate tribunal judges hearing appeals related to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in West Bengal will be able to use their digital signatures on the portal, which are expected to be made available within the next five days. This will enable the judges to start clearing the pending appeals, people familiar with the matter told **ET**.

The introduction of digital signatures is expected to end a month-long standoff that had stalled the disposal of appeals. The tribunal judges had objected to the Election Commission of India's (ECI) portal requiring them to use their Aadhaar credentials to log in, leading to the impasse.

Meanwhile, retired Calcutta High Court judge Indrajit Chatterjee, who was hearing appeals related to Murshidabad, has resumed work. The retired judge had earlier indicated that he would step down after November 2, citing the long commute and poor road conditions in Joka, South Kolkata. Sources said the ECI is also considering shifting the tribunals to locations closer to the city.

The standoff had resulted in a situation where no judge hearing Bengal SIR-related adjudication cases had been able to upload a single order on the portal for over a month. The judges have not uploaded any orders since September 21.

Of the 19 Appellate tribunals set up in West Bengal, 17 have disposed of 1,26,194 cases, while 37,05,235 appeals remain pending, according to data available as of September 17.

The 19 appellate tribunals were constituted in West Bengal to adjudicate disputes arising from the SIR of electoral rolls. Two tribunals remain vacant following the resignation of the judges, amid a massive backlog of appeals.

RG Locks Horns With PM Over 'Foreign Help'

I challenge you to an open debate about this... Come if you have the guts: Rahul to Modi

Our Political Bureau

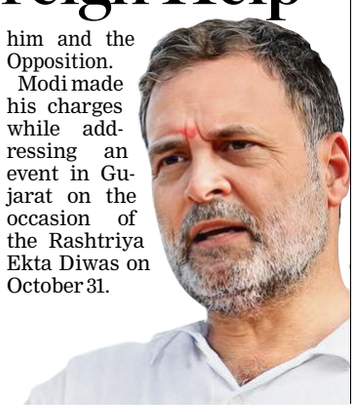
New Delhi: After Prime Minister Narendra Modi made a veiled attack on Congress leader Rahul Gandhi by asking "who is secretly meeting whom abroad" and "whom are the anti-India forces supporting", Gandhi on Monday responded by claiming that Modi was "lying" and alleged that he became the prime minister "because of foreign help".

Gandhi said he was ready for a debate on the issue. To Modi's accusation last Saturday that the Opposition had become an "obstructionist force" using "social media as a weapon to spread rumours", Gandhi responded by alleging that "foreign social media fully backs" the prime minister.

"Mr Modi, stop lying to this nation. You became PM because of foreign help. You remain PM because of foreign help. Your financial system is fully controlled and supported by foreigners. Foreign social media fully backs you. I challenge you to an open debate about this. Any stage, any time. Come if you have the guts. You won't dare, because you are terrified of what I know about you," Gandhi said in a social media post, sharing a news item about the PM's attack on him and the Opposition.

Your financial system is fully controlled & supported by foreigners. Foreign social media fully backs you: RG

Modi made his charges while addressing an event in Gujarat on the occasion of the Rashtriya Ekta Diwas on October 31.



Manipur: Protesters Clash with Cops

ISSUE Recovery of mutilated bodies of two missing Kuki-Zo youths

Bikash Singh

Guwahati: Several people were injured after protesters clashed with security forces in Manipur's Kangpokpi district over the recovery of mutilated bodies of two missing youths.

Police fired tear gas shells and used batons to disperse the agitators assembled outside the office of the superintendent of police (SP), officials said on Monday.

Civil society organisation, Committee on Tribal Unity (CoTU), Sadar Hills, has refused to claim the bodies until their five demands are met.

The organisation has alleged that the youths were abducted by armed Naga militants from Taphou Kuki village. "The Kuki-Zo community will never accept or claim the bodies until and unless a charter of demands is met," CoTU spokesman Ng. Lun Kipgen said.

Meanwhile, Manipur Congress leaders held a meeting with party chief Mallikarjun Kharge in New Delhi to discuss the situation in the state.

Govt Set to Tweak MSP Norms for Periodic Price Hikes of Minor Forest Products

AI IMAGE

MOVE TO BENEFIT TRIBAL COMMUNITIES LIVING IN REMOTE AREAS Last revision undertaken in May 2020 during Covid-19 outbreak

Nidhi Sharma

New Delhi: The Centre is set to restructure the minimum support price (MSP) mechanism for minor forest produce (MFP) to ensure periodic hikes benefiting tribal communities.

The tribal affairs ministry has asked The Energy and Resources Institute (TERI) to study MFPs covered under the MSP framework and examine whether the list needs to be rationalised. TERI will conduct ground surveys to assess how the existing system can be tweaked to ensure better prices for tribals depending on forest produce for livelihood. According to sources, TERI will also work out a mechanism to ensure a periodic increase in MSP.

The government is likely to increase MSP from the next financial year, ending a six-year freeze on rates. The scheme, launched by the Congress-led UPA government in 2013-14, provides a guaranteed minimum price for identified forest produce collected by tribals, particularly those living in remote areas. The produce is sold at village haats, with state government agencies stepping in to procure it whenever market prices fall below the notified MSP. A senior official told **ET**: "MSP needs to be rationalised because there are certain products that fetch a much higher price than what we have fixed. We need to understand what should be done in case of a glut in the market. Also, there are more common products that tribals gather, like gum or lac. What price and what price-fixing mechanism one should follow will be studied by TERI."

Although the scheme's guidelines provide for MSP revision every three years, rates have remained unchanged since 2020. The proposed increase follows concerns raised by MPs during two successive meetings of the parliamentary standing committee on social justice and empowerment. Members pointed out that the prolonged stagnation in MSP was leaving forest-dependent communities vulnerable to exploitation by middlemen, forcing them to sell their produce at lower prices.

The last revision was undertaken in May 2020 during the Covid-19 outbreak, when village haats were shut to enforce social distancing. With migrant workers returning to their villages and livelihoods disrupted, the Centre had stepped in to ensure that tribal households had money to meet their basic needs. MSP was increased by 16-30% across different products while the number of forest produce items covered under the scheme was expanded.

LAUNCHED IN 2013-14

The scheme, launched by Cong-led UPA govt in 2013-14, provides a guaranteed minimum price for identified forest produce collected by tribals

The list, which covered 49 products in January 2019, was expanded to 87 by November 2020, with two additions that year. The proposed revision is expected to benefit tribals across several states, including Himachal Pradesh and Gujarat, both of which are scheduled to go to assembly polls next year.

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*By Truck Sales Volumes in >6 ton segment.

State Police Issues Deepavali Guidelines

PTI

Bengaluru: Ahead of Deepavali, the Karnataka police on Monday issued a set of guidelines, directing people to burst firecrackers only between 8 pm and 10 pm, use green crackers and avoid fireworks in public places and crowded areas to ensure public safety and prevent accidents.

In the event of any accident or emergency during the bursting of firecrackers, immediately contact the emergency helplines 112 or 108 and seek assistance, they said.

Citing Supreme Court directions, the police said that fireworks shall be burst only during the permitted period, from 8 pm to 10 pm and that only green crackers shall be used during this period.

Karnataka Soaps & Detergents Limited
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
An ISO-9001:2015 & 14001:2015 Company
Regd. Office : #27, Industrial Suburb, Bengaluru-Pune Highway, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru - 560 055. E-mail: ksdl.dgmmtls@gmail.com, Ph. No.: 080-22164810/22164879/23372367

e-Auction Notice No.: KSDL/2026-27/AUCTION26 Date: 02.11.2026

e-Auction Notification

KS&DL invites applications from Scheduled Public Sector Banks for investment by way of deposit of Surplus Funds. Documents for e-auction can be downloaded from Karnataka Public Procurement Portal through website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/**

Sl. No.	Amount Available (Rs.in Crores)	Period of Investment	Eligibility	Date of e-Auction Notification	Date and Time of Live Auction	Date of Investment
	Fund name: KS&DL Fixed Deposits					
1	Investment of Surplus/Maturity amount as fixed deposit of Rs. 250 Crores-Rs. 200 Crore (Rs. 200 Crores x 1 Package) is non-Callable for a period of 1 year and Rs. 50 crores (Rs 50 Crores x 1 Package)are callable for a period of 1 year	1 Year	Scheduled Public Sector banks	02.11.2026	Commences at 10.30 a.m & Concludes at 2.00 p.m. on 23.11.2026	23.11.2026 to 30.11.2026

Item wise Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of Rs. 5,000/- should be Paid only through e-portal. SCHEDULE OF VARIOUS EVENTS FOR e-AUCTION: (1) Pre-bid meeting : **11.11.2026 at 11.00 am. (2)** Last Date to upload the Eligibility Criteria in Annexure- A & Declaration in Annexure-B in the e-portal: **18.11.2026 on or before 3.00 pm.**

Sd/-
Asst. General Manager (Mtls.)

PFC CONSULTING LIMITED
(A wholly owned subsidiary of PFC Limited)
Regd. Office: First Floor, "Urjanidhi", 1, Barakhamba Lane, Connaught Place, New Delhi – 110001, (India) Fax : 011-23443990

GLOBAL INVITATION (THROUGH E-BIDDING ONLY)
FOR SELECTION OF TRANSMISSION SERVICE PROVIDER ON BUILD, OWN, OPERATE AND TRANSFER (BOOT) BASIS FOR INTER-STATE TRANSMISSION PROJECTS

PFC Consulting Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Power Finance Corporation Limited (A Government of India Undertaking), invites proposals for setting up of transmission projects on Build, Own, Operate and Transfer (BOOT) basis following single stage two envelope process of "Request for Proposal" (RFP).

Interested bidders may refer to the RFP notification and RFP documents available on the website **https://www.mstcecommerce.com** and **https://www.pfcclindia.com.**

The Bidders may obtain the RFP documents on all working days between 10:30 hrs (IST) and 16:00 hrs (IST) **from 03.11.2026 to one working day prior to bid submission for the projects mentioned below** on payment of a non-refundable fee of Rs. 5,00,000/- or USD 7,000 plus applicable GST @18% from 9th Floor, Wing – A, Statesman House, Connaught Place, New Delhi - 110001, Tel.: 91-11-23443912; Fax: 91-11-23443990; **e-mail: pfccl.itp@pfcindia.com.** The RFP documents can also be downloaded from **https://www.mstcecommerce.com** and **https://www.pfcclindia.com**, however, in such case, interested party can submit Response to RFP only on submission of non-refundable fee of Rs. 5,00,000/- or USD 7,000 plus applicable GST @18% separately. The survey report and clarification to RFP documents shall be issued to those bidders, who have obtained/ purchased RFP documents by paying requisite fee at least one working day prior to bid submission date. Bidders should regularly visit website to keep themselves updated regarding clarifications/ amendments/ time extensions etc., if any. The important timelines in this regard are as follows:

S. No.	Name of Transmission Scheme	Last Date for seeking clarifications (dd/mm/yyyy)	Last Date for submission of response to RFP (dd/mm/yyyy)	Date of opening of Response to RFP (dd/mm/yyyy)
1	CREATION OF 400/220 kV, 2x315 MVA S/S AT SIOT, JAMMU AND KASHMIR	10/11/2026	02/12/2026 up to 15:00 hrs (IST)	02/12/2026 up to 15:30 hrs (IST)

Note: PFC Consulting Limited reserves the right to cancel or modify the process without assigning any reason and without any liability. This is not an offer.

Bid Process Coordinator PFC CONSULTING LTD. (A wholly owned subsidiary of PFC Ltd.) (A Govt. of India Undertaking)
An Initiative of Ministry of Power Government of India
Initiative Partner Central Electricity Authority

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-22185)
GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office : Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003 Telangana, India CIN : U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of APH Seals and grating bar set, which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/ GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 217/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018403**
"Procurement of APH Seals and Grating Bars Set which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/ GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib" at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 02/11/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
GATP-113/26, DPR/Pb.: 1079/12/2026-27/16725

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-22185)
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(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD – MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, Invites E-Tender for Procurement of REFRACTORY FOR BOTTOM ASH HOPPER which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/ GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 221/GATP/MMD/AHP/20018412**
"Procurement of REFRACTORY FOR BOTTOM ASH HOPPER which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/ GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib" at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP). Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 02/11/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note : Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
GATP-115/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16727

KARNATAKA CO-OPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' FEDERATION LIMITED
KMF COMPLEX : DR MH MARIGOWDA ROAD : BANGALORE – 560029
Phone: 26096832/822/910/877/854 **Fax:** 080-25536105 **E-mail:** purchase@kmf.coop

IFT NO: KMF/PUR/KPPP /Tender-994/2026-27 **DATE:** 31.10.2026

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION (KMF/2026-27/IND2659)

The Karnataka Milk Federation, Bangalore invites E-tender from the eligible tenderers for the supply of Various Packing Materials/ Consumables to Mother Dairy as detailed in the tender notification.
Tender documents may download from e-procurement portal website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** and also contact Helpline No: +91-8046010000, tel:+91-8068948777. Date of commencement of Tender **Download–02.11.2026 onwards**, **Pre-Bid meeting-05.11.2026 at 11.00hrs, Last date for submission of Tender -09.11.2026 upto 17.00hrs,** Date of opening of **Technical tender-11.11.2026 at 11.30hrs,** Date of opening of Commercial tender- **After Technical Bids evaluation.**
Further details may be obtained from tender document. Henceforth Changes/Modifications in the tender, it will be uploaded on KPPP Portal Only.

For KARNATAKA CO-OPP MILK FEDERATION
Sd/- DIRECTOR (PURCHASE)

KARNATAKA SOAPS & DETERGENTS LIMITED
An ISO-9001:2015 & 14001:2015 Company
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
Sandal City: P.B. No. 5531, Bengaluru-Pune Highway, Bengaluru - 560 055. Ph: 080-22164879, 22164886,
Website: www.mysoresandal.org e-mail: **ksdl.dgmmtls@gmail.com**
Date: 02.11.2026

CORRIGENDUM

Publication of Corrigendum to Tender Notice No. **KSDL/2026-27/IND1310** dated 28-09-2026, published on the Karnataka Public Procurement (KPP) Portal for **Procurement of Sandalwood oil** & it is hereby informed that the last date for submission of bids has been extended.

Accordingly, the revised schedule is as follows:

Particulars	Revised Details
Last date and time for submission of bids	12-11-2026 at 3:00 PM
Date and time for opening of technical bids	13-11-2026 at 3:30 PM

All prospective bidders are requested to refer the corrigendum and apply to this tender with all the information and requisite documents within the last date of submission of bid.

This corrigendum shall be read as an integral part of the original tender document.

For any queries contact the undersigned

Sd/-Asst. Gen. Manager (Materials)

MINERAL RESOURCES DEPARTMENT
DIRECTORATE OF GEOLOGY AND MINING, MADHYA PRADESH
29- A Khanij Bhawan, Arera Hills Bhopal
Phone and fax 0755-2551795, Email: geology.dgm@mp.gov.in

No-/Auction -21/ Geology /F. No.- 21/ 2026-27 **October 30, 2026**

Notice Inviting Tender

"Invitation of bids for grant of Mining Lease for Limestone, Basemetal (Zn).and Basemetal and associated minerals (Zn, Pb, Cu, Ag) minerals and for grant of Composite Licence for Basemetal (Zn), Manganese & Dolomite, Copper, and Basemetal associated minerals (Cu, Ag, & Au)"
In exercise of the powers conferred by Section 10B and Section 11 of the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957 and in accordance with the Mineral (Auction) Rules, 2015 notified thereunder, as amended from time to time, the Government of Madhya Pradesh has identified:
a) 8 mineral blocks (6 blocks of Limestone, 1 block of Basemetal (Zn), and 1 block of Basemetal (Zn, Pb, Cu, Ag)) for Electronic Auction and hereby invites tenders for the purposes of grant of **Mining Lease.**
b) 4 mineral blocks (1 block of Basemetal (Zn), 1 block of Copper, 1 block of Manganese & Dolomite. and 1 block of Basemetal (Cu, Ag, & Au)) for Electronic Auction and hereby invites tenders for the purposes of grant of **Composite Licence.**
Accordingly, financial bids are invited in digital format only and technical bids are invited both in digital and physical format from eligible bidders.
Eligibility conditions, date and time, terms, and conditions etc. for participating in the electronic auction are provided in the Tender Document. Detailed Tender Documents along with timelines, notifications, updates and other details for the e-auction process for the mineral blocks are available in electronic form only and can be downloaded from the e-auction portal of MSTC Limited [https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mlcln/index.jsp].
Interested and eligible bidders can register themselves on the above e-auction portal. On successful registration, eligible bidders will obtain login ED and password necessary for participation in the e-auction process. Interested and eligible bidders can participate in the bidding only after online purchase of the Tender Document on payment of the Tender fee from the above e-auction portal. The Tender Fee shall be waived, for those mineral blocks only which have been put up for auction under "second attempt" as per Mineral Auction Rule vide this Notice Inviting Tender, for such bidders only who have previously purchased the Tender Document in prior auction attempts of the said mineral block. Any revision, clarifications, addendum, corrigendum, time extensions, etc. to the tender document will be hosted on the above e-auction portal only and no separate notifications shall be issued in the press. Model Tender Document and Mineral Block Summaries are available free of cost on the e-auction portal of MSTC Limited website [https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mlcln/index.jsp]

List of Mineral Blocks for Auction

S. No	Name of the Block	District	Mineral	ML/ CL	Price of Tender Document without GST* *(in Rs.)*
First Attempt Blocks					
1.	Muhrai-Hatta Limestone Block	Damoh	Limestone	ML	5,00,000
2.	Kesharpura-Nayagaon-Ghasundi-Chainpura Limestone Block	Neemuch	Limestone	ML	5,00,000
3.	Shitalpani Copper Block	Balaghat	Copper	CL	2,00,000
4.	Bhilapar Manganese & Dolomite Block#	Pandurna	Manganese & Dolomite	CL	25,000
Pre-Embedded Blocks					
5.	Gudha Limestone and Dolomite Block#	Damoh	Limestone	ML	25,000
6.	Muariya Basemetal (Zn, Pb, Cu, Ag) Block	Betul	Basemetal (Zn, Pb, Cu,Ag)	ML	5,00,000
Second Attempt Blocks					
7.	Ramsthan Limestone Block	Satna	Limestone	ML	1,00,000
8.	Kuiyan Barwah Limestone Block	Rewa	Limestone	ML	2,00,000
9.	Birwa Bhitwan Limestone Block	Rewa	Limestone	ML	2,00,000
10.	Biskhan Extended Basemetal (Zn) Block	Betul	Basemetal (Zn)	ML	5,00,000
11.	Salaiya Phatak Basemetal (Cu, Ag, & Au) Block	Katni	Basemetal (Cu, Ag, & Au)	CL	5,00,000
12.	Kehalpur (East) Basemetal (Zn) Block	Betul	Basemetal (Zn)	CL	2,00,000

Note: * GST shall be payable by reverse charge mechanism # Mineral Blocks being put up for auction in accordance with section 10A2D of the Act

Notwithstanding anything to the contrary in the Tender Document for the blocks being auctioned in accordance with **Section 10A(2)(d)** of the Act, the State Government makes no representation whatsoever, express, implicit or otherwise, regarding the accuracy and/ or completeness of the information provided in the said geological report and the Bidder confirms that it shall have no claim whatsoever against the State Government in this regard. The Bidder acknowledges and hereby accepts the risk of inadequacy, mistake or error in or relating to said geological report and hereby acknowledges and agrees that the State Government shall not be liable for the same in any manner whatsoever to the Bidder and their associates or any person claiming through or under any of them. The Bidders agree and acknowledge that any mistake or error in or relating to the said geological report shall not vitiate the tender process, Mining Lease and/ or MDPA, or render the same voidable.
The block specific Tender documents are available for purchase on the e-auction portal of MSTC Limited (https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mlcln/index.jsp] from **Monday, 2 November, 2026.** Last date for purchase of Tender Document, on the e-auction platform is **Friday, 20 November, 2026** The payment is to be remitted and received before 17:00 hours(IST) and the last date for submission of the bid is **Wednesday, 25 November, 2026,** on or before 17:00 hours (IST).
Bidders may note that for composite licences, the Mineral (Auction) Amendment Rules, 2022 have dispensed with the requirement of indicating the division of the land into forest land, land owned by the State Government, and land not owned by the State Government and the requirement of demarcating the area using total station and differential global positioning system and has provided the flexibility of demarcating the concession area using global positioning system. However, the requisite demarcation in respect of certain blocks is nevertheless being provided [as and where available] as part of the information memorandum. Thus, the terms and conditions for auction of the said block remain unchanged.

G-20902/26

"पॉक्सो है सुरक्षा का हथियार, बच्चों पर न करें अत्याचार"

Head of Office
Superintending
Geologist Directorate of Geology and Mining Madhya Pradesh

JDS VS CONGRESS

HDK Dismisses B'luru Police Claims Linking his Office to Sting Case

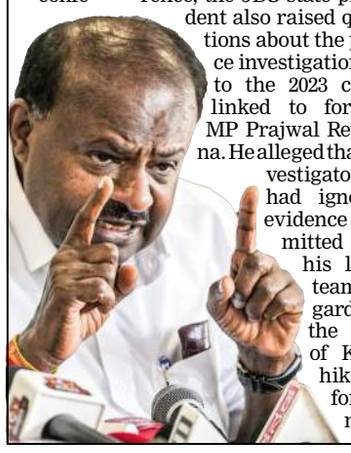
Our Political Bureau

Bengaluru: Union minister HD Kumaraswamy on Monday rejected Bengaluru Police's suggestion of links between his office and the alleged sting operation involving former chief minister Siddaramaiah, calling the allegations "completely bogus" and accusing the ruling Congress of attempting to divert attention from its own controversies.

Questioning Bengaluru Police commissioner Seemant Kumar Singh's decision to brief the media on a holiday, Kumaraswamy alleged that investigators selectively leaked information to create a narrative against him.

"Why did the Commissioner hurriedly appear before the media on a holiday and specifically refer to my Delhi residence," Kumaraswamy asked, claiming the move was aimed at misleading the public.

Displaying documents during a press conference, the JDS state president also raised questions about the police investigation into the 2023 cases linked to former MP Prajwal Revanna. He alleged that investigators had ignored evidence submitted by his legal team regarding the role of Karthik, a former driver of Prajwal Revanna, and his alleged links with chief minister DK Shivakumar.



PRIYANK KHARGE
Home minister

If there is no evidence against him (HDK), why will we call him? But if there is even a shred of evidence, we will summon him without hesitation

"Our reports show Karthik stayed at Shivakumar's residence. Why has this not been investigated? Why was no action taken?" Kumaraswamy said.

He alleged that the state government was dragging his name into the controversy to tarnish his family's reputation and project an image of conducting a transparent investigation.

Responding to the allegations, home minister Priyank Kharge said the government would act strictly based on evidence and had no interest in targeting Kumaraswamy. "If there is no evidence against him, why will we call him? But if there is even a shred of evidence, we will summon him without hesitation," Kharge said.

Defending police, Kharge cited Karnataka Police's handling of the Prajwal Revanna case, noting that the force had received recognition from the Centre for its investigation.

He also claimed that attempts were being made to drag Congress leaders into the KPSC recruitment scam through Central agencies and said questions on those allegations should be directed at Kumaraswamy.

Testing Facilities Caught in State's Cross Currents

KR Balasubramanyam

Bengaluru: Karnataka runs the risk of losing cutting-edge testing centres for automobile and electric vehicles the Centre has proposed with regional politics taking centre-stage and political heavyweights engaged in a everyday war of words.

HD Kumaraswamy, Union heavy industries minister, has been pushing for construction and infrastructure equipment (CIE) and EV testing centres in Mandya district to be built by the Automotive Research Association of India (ARAI). The twin facilities, experts say, have the potential to create an automobile and EV ecosystem in a region otherwise known for sugarcane cultivation and dairy farming. The Centre's investments combined with supply of adequate supply of land can create an auto hub on the lines of Pune, experts say. Similar testing and research infrastructure have helped Haryana and Tamil Nadu emerge strong in automobile manufacturing, they add.

The ARAI, an automotive R&D organisation working in the areas of vehicle engineering, safety, emissions, and technology development, plays a crucial role in setting industry standards while driving innovation in mobility solutions. Other BJP-ruled states have been serious contenders for the ARAI centres, but Kumaraswamy has been able to sway it in his home's state's favour.

What is creating impediments to ARAI's proposed investments is the political dynamics in Mandya, the district Kumaraswamy represents in the Lok Sabha. The Union minister is also the president of JDS, an NDA constituent party. Sections of Congress leaders fear if the testing lab project shapes up, Kumaraswamy will walk away with enormous goodwill among locals that may only expand his regional party's footprint. The ruling Congress, on the other hand, does not have a counter development strategy of similar influence for the district.

Caught in the political swirl is industries minister MB Patil, who recently visited the US, Europe and Southeast Asian countries wooing investors. Here is an investment coming from the Union government, but the minister has been unable to push it beyond a point owing to local political complications.

And Kumaraswamy is not willing to locate the centres anywhere outside of his constituency.

ANIMISHA

State to Deploy 500 Powermen to AP

Our Political Bureau

Bengaluru: Karnataka will deploy 500 skilled powermen along with equipment to Andhra Pradesh to help restore power infrastructure damaged by cyclone Arnab, chief minister DK Shivakumar said on Monday after speaking with Andhra Pradesh CM N Chandrababu Naidu.

The deployment follows a request from Andhra, where more than 15,000 electricity poles were reportedly uprooted by the cyclone Arnab, severely affecting power supply in several areas.

Shivakumar said Karnataka's Energy Department is coordinating the assistance, with energy minister KJ George closely monitoring the restoration effort. The personnel and equipment will work in coordination with Andhra Pradesh authorities to speed up repair works and restore electricity supply in the affected regions.

Shivakumar assured Naidu of the state's full support as Andhra Pradesh deals with the cyclone's aftermath. He said Karnataka is closely tracking the impact of Cyclone Murasu, which is expected to pose fresh challenges in the coming days.

TIMES inter act

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CHANGE OF NAME

I, NIRMALA BAI, W/o No 1371577Y Ex Hav Krishnan K R/at, No.20, Lakshmanna Garden, Horamavu, Bangalore-560043. have changed my name NIRMALA vide affidavit dt 28.10.2026. For all purpose.

I, SHOUKATH ALI ABBAS ALI S/o ABBAS ALI R/o 116, 17th Cross, Gangondanahalli, Bangalore-560039, have changed my name to SHOUKATH ALI for all purposes.

14874533P SEP/MT Netinti Govinda Rao 1ATC ASC centre north my father name service records N Laxmana Rao changed to Nethinti Laxmanarao, for all purpose.

personal

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Chand Pasha S/o Abdul Rehman R/o 1st Cross, Oil Mill Road, Near Fish Market, Santhepete, Tumkur, DIST: Tumkur, Karnataka - 572101, have changed my minor son's name from M D Tahir Chand aged 4 years to Mohammed Tahir Chand forever.

I, Kavya Basavaraj Tubaki, W/o, 2712172A, Nk, Yallappa Mugalkhod of 55 RR (GRENADIERS) changed my name to Kavya Yallappa Mugalkhod, for all Purpose.

14874533P SEP/MT Netinti Govinda Rao 1ATC ASC centre north my mother name service records N Nanemma changed to Netainti Naanemma, for all purpose.

I, Mohandasan K, F/o, 14859909N– Hav/MT– Sumesh K, R/o, Perumugham, Kozhikode, KL, changed name to Mohanadasan K, for all purpose.

I, Jyothi Kumari Anraj D/O, Anraj R/o 1a, 1st Flr, 3, 1st Crs, Ranga Rao Road,Shankar - puram, Bangalore 560018 have changed my name to Jyothi Kumari for all purposes

I, M Sathya, W/o, 14848965M–Nk/MT–Lakshmana Rajan D, R/o, Annamalai Pettai St, Vellore, TN, changed name to L Sathya, for all purpose.

I, Shyamala K, M/o, 14859909N–Hav/MT–Sumesh K, R/o, Perumugham, Kozhikode, KL, changed name to Shyamala P, for all purpose.

JAPAN CO TEAM MEETS PRIYANK KHARGE

NTT Data to Nearly Triple Mangaluru Workforce by 2027

IT-BT Minister Priyank Kharge with NTT Data global leadership in Bengaluru on Monday –BCCL

Our Political Bureau

Bengaluru: Japanese IT services company NTT Data plans to nearly triple its workforce in Mangaluru to over 2,500 employees by the end of 2027. The company is looking to grow its presence in Karnataka's coastal region and build capabilities in artificial intelligence (AI), cloud computing and data services.

NTT Data currently employs around 900 people in Mangaluru. The expansion plans were discussed during a meeting between NTT Data's senior global leadership and Karnataka IT and BT minister Priyank Kharge in Bengaluru on Monday.

The company entered Mangaluru through its acquisition of local cloud engineering company Niveus Solutions, and is looking to use the city as a base for developing specialised technology capabilities. Its focus areas include healthcare and life sciences, automotive, manufacturing, high technology, AI and data.

The company entered Mangaluru through its acquisition of local cloud engineering company Niveus Solutions

The proposed expansion comes as Karnataka aims to attract technology investments beyond Bengaluru through its Beyond Bengaluru initiative, which seeks to develop cities such as Mangaluru, Mysuru and Hubballi as technology and innovation hubs.

"Through our Beyond Bengaluru programme, we are building strong regional technology ecosystems by investing in skilling, infrastructure and progressive policies. Our focus is on taking investments and opportunities to where the talent is and we want to work closely with industry to co-create solutions that accelerate growth across Karnataka's emerging technology clusters," IT-BT minister Kharge said.

The discussions also covered areas for collaboration under Karnataka's Sustainable Data Centre Policy, with the state highlighting NTT Data's expertise in data centres, cloud services and digital infrastructure.

"Mangaluru and Bengaluru are key hubs for AI, cloud and data talent," the company said in its expansion plans.

The government also proposed Mangaluru cable landing station, which is expected to improve the region's digital connectivity and support the development of data centres and technology infrastructure.

NTT Data has been expanding its presence in India through acquisitions and investments in technology capabilities. Its acquisition of Bengaluru-based Niveus Solutions improved its cloud engineering capabilities, while its acquisition of WinWire Technologies added to its expertise in cloud transformation and digital engineering.

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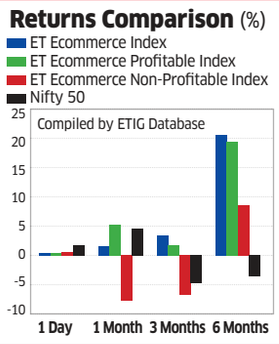
ET Ecommerce Tracker

Returns Comparison (%)



Tweet OF THE DAY

PEDRO DOMINGOS
@PMDDOMINGOS

Good: billions of AIs.
Bad: a few big ones.

Tech Buzz

EU Firms Hit by Supermarket Fridge Hack

STOCKHOLM | BRUSSELS: Ahold Delhaize and Colruyt said on Monday that an IT incident overnight hit fridges and freezers in dozens of stores in Belgium and Luxembourg, while Swedish grocers ICA and Coop reported similar temperature spikes, with one store blaming a cyberattack. The incidents follow an attack in France last month, in which police said hackers seized control of cooling units at hundreds of supermarkets, raising temperatures as high as 50 degrees Celsius and causing fires and food losses. Ahold also reported a cybersecurity incident last month after it detected suspicious activity in its infrastructure. On Monday, the Delhaize supermarket chain realised there were temperature increases in the cooling systems, Delhaize spokesperson Sarah De Meester said. – **Reuters**

$578 b
Combined debt of the seven largest US technology companies, known as Magnificent Seven, by mid-2026, up nearly 45% – **SBI Research**

Anthropic Eyeing $3.5b from Japan in Mega US IPO

WASHINGTON: Anthropic aims to raise up to $3.5 billion from Japanese investors in its IPO in the US, bringing the landmark share sale by the AI startup to a market starved of first-time offerings. Mizuho Securities will manage the Japanese portion of the share sale, while Goldman Sachs Group, Mitsubishi UFJ Morgan Stanley Securities and Morgan Stanley MUFG Securities are among companies that will handle investor orders, as per a regulatory filing. Mizuho Financial Group and Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group are among the underwriters of the deal. That makes the country, where first-time offerings have dried up to a 14-year low, one of the few markets whose investors will have direct access to the mega IPO. Apart from Japan, investors in Australia, Canada and parts of Europe will also be able to buy into the initial share sale of the company. – **Bloomberg**

Deep Use Cases Vault India to ChatGPT's Top Global Market

India chief charts shift from hype to impact, driven by localised tech, upcoming UPI tools & infra

Surabhi Agarwal

New Delhi: India has become ChatGPT's largest market globally in terms of weekly active users, with the local user base doubling since January this year, said OpenAI India managing director Prabhjeet Singh.

During a visit to India last year, the ChatGPT maker's cofounder Sam Altman said that India was the fastest growing market for the frontier lab and was already the second largest in terms of users globally. Market estimates had earlier put the India user base at 100 million.

"In less than a year, it's doubling. It just gives you a sense of (how) people are beginning to find relevance and deep use cases," Singh told ET in his first media interview since joining OpenAI in August. ChatGPT is adding more Indian-language capabilities and Android-first product development, Singh said.

In terms of paying users, Singh said he expected more Indians to turn active subscribers as they "find value" in the product.

"I'm more than optimistic about that translating to incredibly strong revenues in the long term. But right now, let's focus on impact," said the executive who previously helmed Uber's India operations for almost a decade.

OpenAI is expected to make announcements concerning UPI and payments over the coming weeks, he said.

> **As a principle, I believe responsible regulation is actually an enabler because consumers, enterprises, developers then can embrace technology knowing there is a framework**
> **PRABHJEET SINGH**
> MD , India, OpenAI

PRODUCTION-SCALE DEPLOYMENT

While enterprises are experimenting with AI, concerns around security and trust are preventing many of them from going into massive production-scale adoption. On being asked how OpenAI was solving for those concerns, Singh said the company was "seeing a real shift from early days of pilots and demos — common early this year and late last year — to now scaled adoption and production-scale deployment".

"There are multiple ecosystems in the country — enterprises, GCCs, startups — which are embracing AI in a very material way," he said, listing companies such as JioHotstar and Cars24 that he said were building use cases through OpenAI. "From certain industries, there was a very strong ask to make sure that we can bring local inferencing. So, we are partnered with AWS Bedrock, where the majority of our models are now available for local inferencing, and that opens up multiple use cases for sensitive industries," he added.

OpenAI has partnered with Tata Consultancy Services to build AI data centre infrastructure in India through the TCS HyperVault platform, starting with an initial 100 megawatts of capacity that is scalable to 1 gigawatt. On whether the capacity would be further expanded, he said: "I think we'll continue to make sure we scale those as that capacity comes online, and potentially more capacities will come online over a period of time."

As far as the enterprise market is concerned, OpenAI is competing against the likes of Google and Microsoft, which have long-standing relationships with Indian enterprises and offer a full suite of software and services that include frontier models as well.

Singh said Indian enterprises were demanding. "It really is about solving for earning the trust of enterprises. Remember, the enterprises are also going through a journey of change management, of looking at ROI (return on investment), of building conviction to make investments over a longer period of time," he said.

"We are able to transparently sit across the table, get them to stress test what we are doing on safety and privacy. That gives them the confidence to invest in that. We are not yet solving for scale. We are solving for impact," he added.

India is also one of the largest and fastest-growing markets for OpenAI's coding tool Codex, which is used by more than 40 million people every week globally with non-coding accounting for over a quarter of the use cases. "A lot of the developer use cases are happening in tier-II cities. We need to show up there," he said.

REGULATING AI

As concerns mount over the potential misuse of increasingly autonomous AI agents, Singh said the company was actively engaging with government agencies and enterprises to protect critical infrastructure. "We are very actively engaged with all arms of the government as one of the leading labs in the world…make sure that we are able to share the measures we take to have put safety front and centre of everything which we are building…We are working very closely with enterprises to strengthen them, their defences against attackers," he said.

There are multiple ecosystems which can expose critical infrastructure, Singh said. "So, we are working with banks, working with financial institutions, working with the government to make sure our tools are available at scale."

He backed responsible AI regulation, arguing that greater safeguards would help build trust and accelerate adoption. "As a principle, I do believe responsible regulation is actually an enabler because consumers, enterprises and developers then can embrace technology knowing there is a framework. We have seen that happen across industries."

There are times when the pacing of technology and regulation is not synchronised, he said. "We welcome constructive regulation. We continue to provide feedback," he said.

PRIVACY FIRST

ChatGPT recently announced ads in India. Singh said ads allowed the company to make sure that there were multiple tiers, including free or lower-priced, available and hence ensure reach.

"We make sure that privacy is front and centre. No ads, no advertiser gets access to any personal information. The models, the output which you see in the reasoning, is never coloured by whether there is an ad which will be served alongside," he said. "The feedback we are hearing from advertisers is incredible. The number of sellers who are experimenting is high." On what 2027 looks like for AI in India for OpenAI, Singh said he expected deeper enterprise adoption at production scale, including for cyber solutions.

AI on the Clock as Fintechs Demand Payoff for Spends

Under pressure to protect margins, cos pivot from pilots to measurable bottomline gains

Nikhil Patwardhan

Bengaluru: India's listed fintech companies are putting artificial intelligence (AI) to a more demanding test, using it to improve sales, reduce lending risks and automate operations while seeking evidence that the spending can strengthen profits.

September-quarter earnings calls from Paytm, Pine Labs, Groww, PB Fintech, Kissht and Mobikwik reveal a shift across payments, stockbroking, lending and insurance. AI is moving beyond chatbots and experiments into decisions affecting the cost of acquiring, serving and retaining customers.

"Whether you are employing humans or AI, you are essentially buying intelligence to solve a problem," Yashraj Erande, senior partner and financial services lead at consulting firm Bain & Company, told ET, adding that the economics of deploying AI depend on whether it can perform a task more cost-effectively than humans. The focus comes amid investor scrutiny of margins. Motilal Oswal said Paytm's quarterly profit missed its estimate by 18%, partly due to higher software and data expenses, while Pine Labs reiterated its target of a 21% full-year operating margin as it expands its salesforce.

EXPERIMENTS TO PRODUCTIVITY

At Pine Labs, AI agents contribute about 89% of software code changes, automation has reduced telesales effort by around 60% and AI handles more than 60% of email queries.

The company reported 24% year-on-year revenue growth to ₹806 crore and a 27% increase in adjusted earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) to ₹155 crore. "Payments business should be generally an Ebitda-expanding business," chief executive Amrish Rau told analysts, arguing that transaction volume should increase without proportionate costs.

Sept-quarter earnings calls of fintech cos reveal a shift across payments, stockbroking, lending and insurance

Mobikwik said AI now generates 92% of its software code, up from 80% in the previous quarter, while its AI-powered collections platform handles 55% of early collections.

At digital lender Kissht, AI-powered voice agents achieve more than 86% of human callers' recovery rates in early collection stages, compared to 70% previously. Its underwriting models also help identify riskier borrowers sooner.

"The only claim worth making is one you can measure," chief executive Ranvir Singh said.

Kissht raised its loan-book growth guidance while targeting lower impairment costs.

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Tech Trotter

Fireside Ventures Cofounder Vinay Singh to Exit Firm

Bengaluru: Fireside Ventures cofounder and partner Vinay Singh is exiting the Bengaluru-based venture capital firm after nearly a decade, the company announced on Monday. Singh worked closely with founders across the beauty and personal care, food and beverages, wellness and lifestyle segments. "Cobuilding Fireside gave me the opportunity to shape the firm from its early days and work alongside exceptional founders and teams," Singh said. "As AI reshapes commerce faster than most of us expected, I want to spend more time exploring the frontiers of agentic commerce and its implications for the future of consumption," he added. –**Our Bureau**

Bikes to Billions: Rapido Rockets to $4b GOV on 8.3m Daily Orders

Pranav Mukul

New Delhi: Ride-hailing startup Rapido has crossed $4 billion in annualised gross order value (GOV), quadrupling its scale in two years, as it steps up expansion across mobility and food delivery following a $240 million fundraise in May this year, according to people in the know.

The Bengaluru-based company is averaging around 8.3 million orders a day across its services, making it one of India's largest consumer internet platforms by transaction volumes. Ride-hailing continues to comprise more than 95% of the company's daily average orders.

Rapido's daily order volumes are comparable to the nearly 9 million orders clocked by Meesho on an average in the July-September quarter, and higher than the 7.6 million orders recorded by Eternal's food delivery and quick commerce businesses combined. However, the significantly higher average order values of Meesho and Eternal's Zomato and Blinkit businesses mean they generate considerably higher gross sales.

"A significant part of Rapido's growth has been driven by its expansion in ride-hailing, which still accounts for the bulk of its transactions. Its monthly active users have grown 27% between January and October this year," a person closely tracking Rapido's business said. "Interestingly, this growth has not come at the expense of rivals. Instead, Rapido has brought new users into the market, many of whom are trying ride-hailing services for the first time."

The $4 billion in annualised GOV compares with the $1 billion milestone the company crossed just two years ago, in August 2024, as ET had reported.

Founded in 2015 by Arvind Sanka, Pavan G and Rishikesh SR, Rapido began as a bike-taxi startup before expanding into three-wheeler and four-wheeler ride-hailing. In March this year, it entered food delivery with the launch of Ownly, seeking to replicate its success in ride-hailing by challenging the Zomato-Swiggy duopoly. Rapido has emerged as the market leader in bike taxis, having risen from a distant third behind Uber and Ola.

The company has also diversified into services such as carpooling platform Hopr and flight bookings through partnerships with online travel agencies.

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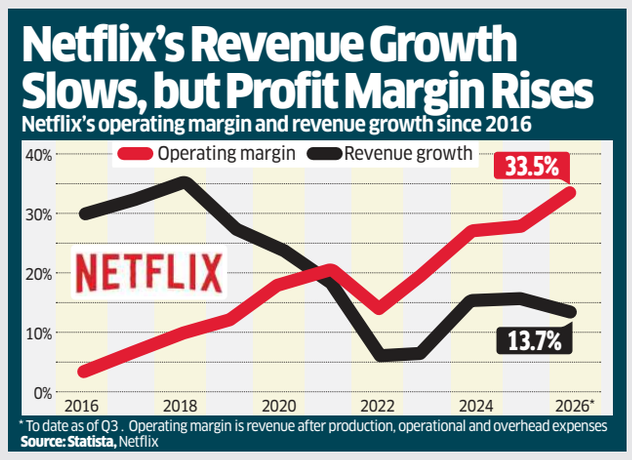
Globe Trotter

Meanwhile in tech...



Capillary's Q2 Revenue Up 51% to ₹271cr as AI Platform Drives Wins

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: Software-as-a-service company Capillary Technologies, which helps businesses run loyalty programmes, said it is seeing growing demand for its AI products. Chief executive Aneesh Reddy told ET that its AI layer has helped win more enterprise customers and build a nearly $10 million sales pipeline.

"We now have almost a $10 million pipeline of customers wanting to buy our AI stack. A lot of customers have gone live or piloted, and a lot of deals are closing now. Every quarter we're closing more deals on the AI side," Reddy said.

Reddy's comments come as the company's revenue from operations rose 51% year-on-year to ₹271 crore in the September quarter, compared with ₹179 crore in the year-ago period. Net profit stood at about ₹22 crore against ₹29 lakh a year earlier, the company announced on Monday.

Annual recurring revenue stood at ₹1,085 crore as of September 30, up 51% year-on-year. Adjusted Ebitda more than doubled to ₹44.9 crore, while the margin expanded to 17% from 12%.

Star Wars! Spacetechs Pixxel, GalaxEye Lock Horns Over 'Made in India' Identity

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: Bengaluru-based spacetech startup Pixxel Space which develops hyperspectral satellites has defended its Indian ownership and control after its decision to establish a US subsidiary has triggered questions about its corporate structure. This comes after rival startup GalaxEye highlighted its own decision to operate through a single Indian entity.

Pixxel chief executive Awais Ahmed in a blog post on X said the company remains "headquartered, owned, managed and controlled in India", on Monday. Indian investors, including the founders, collectively hold the largest shareholding in the company, followed by investors from Singapore, the UK and the US, he said.

Last week Pixxel announced the establishment of Pixxel Federal, a US subsidiary set up to serve US civilian, defence, and intelligence agencies.The new entity will be headed by Allyson Jenkins, who previously led Pixxel's public-sector business in the US.

The developments have triggered questions on social media about the ownership and control of Indian space companies operating through overseas entities. In response, GalaxEye, another Bengaluru-based spacetech startup developing satellites that combine optical and synthetic aperture radar (SAR) imaging, said it had consciously chosen to build its business from India despite considering other locations. Without naming Pixxel, the company said all its contracts and bids had been pursued through a single Indian entity.

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Instinct Scare: Glitch that Cried Wolf

Decoding the WhatsApp outage and the fragile reality of AI agents

ET EXPLAINER

On November 1, users reported that personal AI agent Instinct had stopped responding on WhatsApp, triggering speculation that Meta had blocked the service. The company, however, said it was due to a technical snag. The incident has also brought attention to Meta's restrictions on competing AI assistants and the challenges facing companies building personal AI agents. **Tanya Pandey** explains what happened and why it matters.

What is Instinct and how does it work?

Developed by San Francisco-based Spear Street Technology and founded by Noah Shinn, Instinct is a personal AI agent that operates through WhatsApp, Apple's iMessage and SMS. It allows users to delegate tasks such as managing emails and calendars, scheduling meetings, making reservations and booking travel. Unlike conventional chatbots, it is designed to execute tasks on users' behalf. Launched as an invite-only platform in August 2026, the service is available in India.

Why was Meta suspected of blocking Instinct?

The speculation followed Meta's restrictions on third-party AI chatbots using WhatsApp Business services in January 2026. This affected services such as OpenAI's ChatGPT and Microsoft's Copilot, which subsequently discontinued their WhatsApp integrations. WhatsApp also introduced new terms for third-party AI agents in August. With Meta developing its own AI assistants, users questioned whether competing services were being restricted.

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Lowering LTCG Isn't a Magic Bullet

But the measure could help if macros stabilise

Measures such as lowering LTCG tax for domestic and foreign investors and allowing foreigners to pay the tax on gains in dollar terms will boost sentiment in the equity market. Returns have flatlined as foreign investors are pulling out of India because of a concentration of interest in AI infra, India's vulnerability to the West Asian energy shock and rising yields on US treasuries. Macroeconomic and corporate performance do not justify the magnitude of the FPI selloff. India's economy has moderated after a post-Covid recovery, but the investor reaction is disproportionately influenced by external uncertainties that the country is navigating well. LTCG on equities was reimposed in 2018 and its current rate was set in 2024. Investor behaviour must be mapped over the period as a guide to any review of the tax.

India is losing its tax competitiveness against other emerging markets — Hong Kong, Singapore, Taiwan and Indonesia — that do not tax LTCG on foreign investment in equities. Tax relief to foreign investors in government bonds introduced earlier this year caused a spike in inflows. Less structural friction could make Indian equities more lucrative, but FPI behaviour is being driven by more fundamental economic factors than tax policy. Even after the correction, Indian equities face strong competition from cheaper emerging markets. Tax treaties anyway provide FPIs with pathways to invest in India that are not influenced by tax changes.

GoI will be influenced by the revenue implications of a change to LTCG tax on equities as well as its impact on providing policy certainty to foreign investors. A middle ground could involve a structured reduction or a dollar-denominated tax framework. This will signal market friendliness while upholding fiscal propriety. A robust policy response would focus on restoring economic momentum and corporate earnings, which are the chief drivers of foreign investment flows. The external factors that are shaping global capital currently cannot be counteracted through tax policies of any one nation.

You Can't Eat Your Viksit Cake and...

'Nobody in India will tell you it's 5 o'clock. And certainly, no Indian will ever remind you it's the weekend.' While Piyush Goyal meant well to sell Indian work ethic at a gathering in the Netherlands on Oct 27, the unfortunate fact is that 3 days later, the pointless deaths of 4 workers in a Delhi shoe factory fire does sit uneasy with India's reputation of having 'attractive wage arbitrage', making it a competitive economic force globally.

Being 'viksit' is more than a GDP thing. It's also how you view your workforce, especially blue-collar, and treat it. AI can be 'slave-driven'. But one hopes that no one expects to gloat on citizens — humans — to compete on AI terms despite any 'Narayana Murthy school of cheerleading'. Accidents do happen.

But even as the shoe factory fire in Mangolpuri Industrial Area is being investigated, a valid factory licence points to the level of inspection that authorities may be conducting before certifying such institutions as fit for business — and for workers. This is not about employees working overtime in a festival market. It's about whether corners being cut at the cost of employee safety to bump up productivity is par for the course or not.

Being 'viksit' is about having certain non-negotiable norms, regardless of whether those working are willing to forgo those norms or not. 'We are like this' is not a value system that cuts the ice. At least not if India wants to be considered by the developed world as a developed economy one day. In factories, this means safe shop floors; in offices, reasonable working hours. Enforcing rules and regulations that guarantee occupational safety and health is central to becoming viksit. One can't have one's 1st-world cake and eat a 3rd-world one too.

JUST IN JEST

Let's not have ads on streaming shows disrupting the wrong way

Commercial Breaks With Common Sense

There was a time when ads interrupted TV programmes at civilised intervals. A murder would be committed, a detective would raise an eyebrow, and the scene would dissolve, while viewers would be invited to purchase detergent. The arrangement, hardly Act 2 Scene 3, respected the elementary distinction between a sentence and a sales pitch. Increasingly, streaming platforms are now dispensing with such niceties. The dramatic effect is more and more resembling a neurological disorder.

Nobody seriously disputes advertising's economic importance. Media and entertainment pretty much live off someone trying to sell somebody something. But perhaps it's time to make ads refrain from bursting into the thick of things to discuss home loans. The problem isn't advertising but witless placement. Algorithms apparently sophisticated enough to predict a viewer's next purchase remain incapable of recognising the end of a sentence. Someone, if needed, AI, should distinguish a dramatic pause from an invitation to advertise face cream. Streaming services should introduce elementary commercial etiquette: commercials between organic scenes, at natural narrative breaks, preferably without increasing their frequency. Such restraint will benefit advertisers too. For, consumers irritated by an interruption are unlikely to develop tender feelings towards its sponsor.

STATE OF PLAY Next few months, GoI faces a test of political will to take hard economic calls

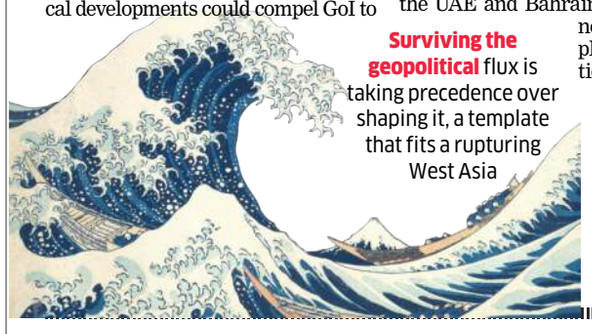
ALL HANDS ON THE DECK

Pranab Dhal Samanta

India needs to brace for some challenging times ahead. It may not matter much which way today's US midterms swing, because Trump will look to enforce his actions either way. What may change is the vitality on Capitol Hill to obstruct, if not halt, him. But, for India, that would only mean an even more fractured Washington to deal with.

On the domestic front, GoI's space for political and economic manoeuvrability is likely to be constrained by a set of important upcoming elections, particularly UP, where the stakes are very high.

Hard economic decisions — be it on adjusting oil prices at the pump, reducing subsidies, implementing ways to ease pressure on rupee, give tax breaks to pull back FPIs, or disciplining welfare expenditure — will become politically tough. But unexpected geopolitical developments could compel GoI to seriously consider some of these calls, notwithstanding an agitated internal political environment.



Surviving the geopolitical flux is taking precedence over shaping it, a template that fits a rupturing West Asia

The problem for countries worst-affected by these crises is that what to do in the near future is now more important than how things may pan out in the long run. Because surviving the geopolitical flux is taking precedence over shaping it, a template that fits a rupturing West Asia.

This time, we are aware of the icebergs

Until the US war on Iran, Islamic states of the region worked on a 3-layered political logic: Muslim solidarity, anti-Israel sentiment, and Arab unity. The war has altered this fundamentally.

One, Muslim solidarity has now been undone by Shia-Sunni polarisation and conflict. Iran and its proxies — Houthis, Hezbollah and Hamas — are taking on Sunni Arab countries. Initially, Iranian military action was meant to pressure them against supporting the US. Now, it seeks to punish them for seeking economic alternatives to Hormuz, like Houthi attacks on the new trans-Saudi pipeline.

If the weaponisation of Hormuz was Iran's trump card, countries like the UAE and Bahrain have maintained their new diplomatic relationship with Israel since 2020. This has added to Israel's profile in the Islamic world with other eager suitors like Azerbaijan, keen to offset Turkish pressure through the same levers. What it means now is that Israel is far from isolated. In fact, it has equity with key Muslim nations in West Asia.

This feeds into the third layer of Arab solidarity. Saudi Arabia-UAE tension, too, is now in the open. The Mecca Accord response to the UAE's Israel-US play didn't work out. By all accounts, Saudi Arabia and the UAE are now competing for US attention, lobbying extensively in Washington to further their interests.

Ironically, they may just all favour a 'quick victory' settlement with Iran, options for which range from another round of assault as proposed by Benjamin Netanyahu, to a slow-moving Qatar-brokered effort for some middle-ground.

In this backdrop, India's options are clear. It needs to keep working the line with Iran, especially given India's sizeable Muslim population. Separate tracks with both the UAE and Saudi Arabia are vital for its energy security. And strategic relationship with Israel, one of India's most reliable defence suppliers, is critical from a politico-military perspective.

This is a test of India's multi-alignment strategy, which has another important fold to it in the form of its Russia relationship. Russian supplies are vital because, currently, they are the only steady and assured flow of crude.

New Delhi has, so far, managed to ride the political contradictions with these countries to ensure availability resources. But the surging economic costs are weighing hard. Average price of the Indian crude basket has oscillated from close to $70 in February to the highs of ~$114 in March and April, down to $82 in July, and then back to ~$120 in October. So, while India has diplomatically managed to keep lines of access open, costs are hurting.

The impact is now being felt across economic sectors, making it increasingly difficult for GoI to sustain the import bill without currency recalibration. At the same time, Indian exports to the US are a bit of a silver lining, making it imperative that New Delhi, while doing its oil business with Moscow, does its balancing act with whatever post-midterm Washington may look like.

The picture is looking grim. India, with no real fault of its own, will have to deal with another round of the consequences of actions by other geopolitical actors. While it has shown resilience so far, its domestic political and economic constraints are beginning to weigh in more significantly.

The die is cast for a test of political will to take hard economic calls, for policies to consider radical measures, and, if need be, recast political messaging around the impending crisis, without creating public panic. After all, it's going to take all hands on the deck to ride the storm. For, stability today is no guarantee against volatility tomorrow.

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Humane, and Human Too

KumKum Dasgupta

Using animal biology to model human disease has long reached its scientific and moral limits. Worldwide, progressive regulators are replacing animal experimentation with human-relevant methods that deliver faster, more reliable safety data. But India is poised to weaken statutory protections and lower ethical standards it has, ironically, demonstrated leadership in.

At the centre of this regressive shift is the draft Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (Control and Supervision of Experiments, Breeding and Trading of Laboratory Animals) Rules 2026. Issued by Committee for Control and Supervision of Experiments on Animals (CCSEA) under fisheries, animal husbandry and dairying ministry, the proposed text seeks to replace foundational frameworks established in 1968 and 1998.

While proponents argue the draft streamlines approvals for research institutions and pharma companies, animal rights groups and NALSAR University of Law, Hyderabad, warn that the proposed rules are bad in law, regressive for science, fall short of ethical guidelines, and are profoundly short-sighted.

▶ **'Severe suffering' made ok** Draft rules permit experiments involving 'severe suffering'. This includes prolonged social isolation of dogs and primates, electric shocks, extreme movement restriction, lethal chemotherapy and fatal toxicity testing.

While Rule 7(2) purports to prohibit unalleviable severe pain over long periods, the rules fail to explain how permitted procedures will be reconciled against that prohibition. Also, the draft lacks enforceable criteria to resolve conflicts of interest, or independent pre-study review before such high-severity work begins.

▶ **Decentralisation of approvals** Under the draft, local institutional animal ethics committees (IAECs) gain authority to approve mild and moderate experiments on larger animals — dogs, cattle, pigs, etc — without prior central CCSEA clearance. Severe and non-recovery experiments involving animals beyond rodents and lagomorphs would still require central approval following IAEC recommendations. But post-hoc reporting is no substitute for prior independent scrutiny.

▶ **Weak oversight** Protections for wild, community and stray animals — including species protected under CITES and Wildlife Protection Act 1972 — are severely compromised. By introducing conditional exemptions for free-roaming and feral animals, the draft rolls back long-standing bans on experimenting on wild populations.

Also, IAECs can now permit sourcing livestock from open markets or unregistered suppliers. In a country already struggling with stray animal mismanagement and illegal wildlife trafficking, diluting procurement oversight not only exposes vulnerable animals to systemic abuse, but also compromises scientific rigour due to high biological variability.

▶ **What about the parent law?** The draft is inconsistent with the parent law — Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (PCA) Act 1960 — particularly Section 17 regarding CCSEA's statutory duties and rulemaking powers, thereby violating safeguards already entrenched in Indian law.

▶ **Flouting court guidelines** The draft rules violate principles laid down in Supreme Court's 'Animal Welfare Board of India v. A Nagaraja & Ors' (2014) verdict that read the 'Five Freedoms' of animals and their right to live with dignity into Section 3 (duty of care) and Section 11 (cruelty offences) of PCA Act.

While the draft explicitly invokes the internationally recognised 3Rs — replacement, reduction, refinement — it creates a glaring policy paradox. In principle, replacement obligates researchers to actively pursue non-animal methods wherever scientifically satisfactory alternatives exist, using live animals only as a last resort.

In practice, though, by decentralising approvals, softening restrictions, and broadening exemptions for wild and stray animals, the proposed framework makes it cheaper, faster and easier to experiment on live animals — reducing the 3Rs to mere declarations of intent.

Global regulatory bodies have recognised the imperative to transition away from outdated models. In the US, FDA Modernisation Act 2.0 (Dec 2022) removed statutory requirements for animal testing before human clinical trials, establishing a clear pathway for human-relevant alternative methods.

The EU legally mandates strict application of the 3Rs wherever scientifically possible, while Britain invests heavily in advanced alternatives through National Centre for the Replacement, Refinement and Reduction of Animals in Research (NC3Rs). OECD routinely updates its Mutual Acceptance of Data framework to formally incorporate validated non-animal methods into international chemical safety guidelines.

The scientific case for change is compelling. Species differences limit how reliably animal studies predict human responses. Over 90% of drug candidates that appear safe in animal trials fail in human clinical trials.

New approach methodologies (NAMs) replace imprecise disease-specific animal models with direct human biology, bypassing multi-stage animal trials, and delivering faster, decisive safety data.

Policy frameworks must actively incentivise development and integration of NAMs — organ-on-a-chip systems, 3D organoids, validated models like EpiDerm, etc — by formalising regulatory acceptance, establishing standardised validation protocols and directing funding toward human-relevant technologies.

India has previously demonstrated leadership by banning animal testing for cosmetics and explicitly recognising non-animal approaches in the 2023 amendment to New Drugs and Clinical Trials Rules. True regulatory reform requires dismantling anthropocentric law-making in favour of frameworks that value non-human life and scientific accuracy. India must build on its progress, reject retrograde rules, and realign its legal policy with modern, human-relevant research.

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Don't Turn the Clock Back

Rakesh Mishra & Surat Parvatam

The past decade has seen a shift in drug, vaccine and chemical testing, with regulations and research favouring emerging technologies based on human biology over animal testing.

But Committee for Control and Supervision of Experiments on Animals' (CCSEA) draft Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (Control and Supervision of Experiment, Breeding and Trading of Laboratory Animals) Rules 2026, risks dialling back progress that has been achieved towards advancing human-relevant, non-animal approaches in India.

The move towards human-based testing is driven by the fact that only 1-2 out of 10 drug candidates discovered in the lab succeed in human clinical trials. One reason for this 'valley of death' between basic research and clinical translation is the inability of animal-based preclinical tests to reliably predict human responses.

This has spurred countries and regulators to develop modern, human-relevant models. These systems include organoids, which are few-mm-sized complex cellular structures that mimic certain aspects of human organs; organs-on-chip, microfluidic chips lined with human cells; reprogrammed stem cells; 3D-printed organs; and advanced computational models. Their adoption is being incentivised through policies and funding.

ANIMAL TESTING

You don't need to do this

Last year, the US National Institutes of Health (NIH) announced new initiatives to prioritise human-based technologies. In terms of funding, the US has launched a $400 mn funding programme to advance new approach methodologies (NAMs). China has launched its own programme to do the same. In India, MoHFW released New Drugs and Clinical Trials (Amendment) Rules 2023, which allow the use of human biology-based test methods to test the safety and efficacy of new drugs.

Both Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission and BIS have set up working groups for human-based non-animal methods to incorporate these methods into national standards. ICMR and Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (Birac) have funded several NAMs projects across labs and startups.

But the draft rules risk reversing the progress India has made. While the rules state that 'replacement and reduction' are a core purpose, a clear mandate that NAMs should be considered first, and that justification needs to be provided when they are not used, is missing.

While its predecessor, Breeding of and Experiments on Animals (Control and Supervision) Rules 1998, stated that NAMs shall be used 'wherever possible', it also did not define NAMs, say, who decides what is 'possible', or require any proof. The draft also does not require national reporting of how many animals are used, by species, purpose or severity. What isn't measured or reviewed may not be replaced.

The new draft rules, instead, increase the scope of animal use by allowing the use of animals protected under Wildlife Protection Act, as well as wild, stray and feral animals of domestic species, if justified. But the use of protected species and wild animals in experimentation cannot be viewed from the point of scientific justification alone, as it can have a widespread impact on ecology and the environment.

Studies have shown that experiments can yield different, even contradictory, results when conducted in the lab and in field settings due to genetic and physiological differences. Unknown genetic and medical backgrounds of wild and stray species further add to scientific variability, and one may require a much larger number of individual animals to counter this disadvantage. Also, sourcing animals from the wild for human contact or use adds to zoonotic risk.

Only 1-2 out of 10 drug candidates discovered in the lab succeed in human clinical trials

The draft rules expand the definition of an 'establishment' to include places 'not wholly enclosed or covered' and mobile facilities. While emerging technologies demand specialised laboratory infrastructure and stringent controls, this broader definition risks diluting standards for animal experimentation, increasing biosecurity risks and undermining efforts to build scientifically rigorous research infrastructure.

While much of the draft closely follows the EU directive on severity classification and animal use, it omits key provisions that promote alternatives: state support for developing and validating them, a reference laboratory for validation, and a bar on animal procedures where a recognised non-animal method exists.

India has considerable strengths in pharma, biotech, IT, AI, and engineering and scientific talent, backed by progressive government policies. The draft rules can accelerate change by restoring the 'NAM-first' justification clause, requiring documented searches for alternatives in research protocols, publishing annual statistics on animal use and setting up a national NAM validation centre.

India cannot lead the post-animal era of biomedicine with rules written for the last one. The draft rules should put 3Rs — replacement, reduction, refinement — at their heart. While they invoke the 3Rs, they give insufficient weight to replacement: substituting animal experiments with scientifically valid alternatives. Restore it as a priority, or India risks surrendering a frontier it is well placed to lead.

Mishra is director, Tata Institute for Genetics and Society (TIGS), Bengaluru. Parvatam is senior programme director, research and toxicology, Humane World for Animals India

THE SPEAKING TREE

Choose to Be a Healer

PRITHWIS DATTA

'Dadu,' one of my Gen Z friends said, her voice cynical, 'our society is divided into three kinds of people: abusers, abused and onlookers.' We were discussing chilling reports of an assault inside a frat house at an Ivy League university in the US. Her simple, brutal taxonomy struck as profoundly true. It is a fact that most men think of themselves as possessing some kind of entitlement. Sigmund Freud called this the 'Id', or the unconscious source of bodily needs, impulses and desires, especially those related to aggression and the sexual drive. Shifting gear to ego, one acts according to the reality principle.

The reality is that abusers operate with a huge degree of impunity that the organs and institutions of society permit them. The onlookers are passively complicit. Intervening is fraught — so they are busy recording reels for social media. But wait, there is a fourth, and perhaps the most vital, group — healers. They are brave police officers who refuse to be a part of the flawed system, the tireless NGO workers who sit with survivors, and the advocates who fight for justice.

We are not born healers; we must choose to be. We must call out the entitlement in our midst, reject complicity of the onlooker, and actively work to restore what is broken. Let's be the fourth kind of people.

PARANORMAL ACTIVITY Paragraphs From Fiction

The Master And Margarita

Mikhail Bulgakov

One hot spring evening, just as the sun was going down, two men appeared at Patriarch's Ponds. One of them — fortyish, wearing a grey summer suit — was short, dark-haired, bald on top, paunchy, and held his proper fedora in his hand; black horn-rimmed glasses of supernatural proportions adorned his well-shaven face.

The other one — a broad-shouldered, reddish-haired, shaggy young man with a checked cap cocked on the back of his head — was wearing a cowboy shirt, crumpled white trousers, and black sneakers.

The first man was none other than Mikhail Alexandrovich Berlioz, editor of a literary magazine and chairman of the board of one of Moscow's largest literary associations, known by its acronym, MASSOLIT, and his young companion was the poet Ivan Nikolayevich Ponyryov, who wrote under the pen name Bezdomny. After reaching the shade of the newly budding linden trees, the writers made a beeline for the colourfully painted refreshment stand bearing the sign: BEER AND COLD DRINKS.

And here it is worth noting the first strange thing about that terrible May evening. Absolutely no one was to be seen, not only by the refreshment stand, but all along the tree-lined path that ran parallel to Malaya Bronnaya Street.

Translated from Russian by Diana Burgin & Katherine Tiernan O'Connor

Chat Room

Diwali Sale: Visit Your Demat A/c

Diwali is round the corner but enthusiasm is missing in shops and malls, on account of economic slowdown, job losses, and rising inflation and interest rates. What's affordable right now is 'stocks' on the bourses that are selling at a heavy discount with many quality scrips even below their intrinsic book value. This is a golden opportunity for the long-term investor to build her portfolio since experience is testimony to such situations turning for the better after meltdown. We have seen markets touching lifetime highs after hitting multi-year lows within a short span of time, before and after Covid being a recent example. History will repeat itself, and those taking risk along with giving time to their investments will be rewarded. Since it's difficult to time the market on both its way up and down, it's better to deploy money in a staggered way to optimise returns.

S N Kabra
Mumbai

Sports World Play

PRINCIPE AZZURRO, KIMI

Kimi Antonelli become Formula 1's (F1's) youngest-ever champion late on Sunday night by finishing third in the Mexican Grand Prix (GP), a remarkable rise for the 20-yr-old Mercedes driver who hadn't won a race when 2026 began. He bettered what the then 23-yr old Sevastian Vettel did in 2010 when the German won the championship. Here's the story of the Italian's historic title-winning season in five key moments:

THE BREAKTHROUGH

The first race of 2026 made it seem this would be another year of Antonelli as Mercedes' No 2 driver. He crashed in practice in Australia and was second behind George Russell in the race. Then came the breakthrough.

Antonelli battled past seven-time champion Lewis Hamilton at the start of the Chinese GP and then pulled away, leaving Hamilton, Russell and Charles Leclerc to fight it out for second. Holding back tears, Antonelli was almost speechless as he became the second-youngest race winner in F1 history.

COMPETING MERC TWINS

Antonelli turned his China victory into a five-race winning streak while Russell hit trouble. The highlight came in Canada, when the title-chasing Mercedes duo put on a show in a thrilling fight through 30 laps, trading the lead several times and coming dangerously close to making contact. Then it all went wrong for Russell. An engine failure brought him to a sudden stop, and he slammed his fists against the car in frustration. Worse was to come for Russell at the next race in Monaco. He was hit hard by a timing system fault which wrongly handed out penalties for pit lane speeding.

> On the last lap, I just backed off because I couldn't see the track. I was getting emotional. So, it was just good to bring it home
> KIMI ANTONELLI

WILL TO THRIVE

Antonelli showed his grit when he hit his own troubled run in the middle of the season, refusing to give up on fighting even for a potential single point at the British GP. The Italian arrived at Silverstone with his lead cut after car problems in Barcelona as Hamilton won, and a win for Russell in Austria.

Antonelli was chasing down Leclerc for the lead in Britain when his car suffered damage to the bodywork, leaving him barely able to turn into corners. Despite pleas over the radio from Mercedes to pit and retire the car, Antonelli kept going as he tried to cling on to 10th.

In the end, Antonelli didn't score points but it was a signal of his willingness to fight for even a small advantage.

NOTHING LIKE A HOME RUN

Eating spaghetti from the Italian GP trophy was the exclamation point on a remarkable win for Antonelli in front of his home crowd. Two years on from crashing at Monza on his F1 race weekend debut, Antonelli was unbeatable at home. Charging through the field from 19th on the grid, Antonelli took the lead by lap 17 and the win was never in doubt after that. No Italian had won at home in 60 years, and no driver had won from that far back since 1983.

AN AMERICAN MASTERCLASS

Could Kimi better Italy show? Mercedes boss Toto Wolff thought so, hailing his win at the Circuit of the Americas last week as "probably the best race I've seen" from Antonelli.

This was a masterpiece in control as Antonelli took pole position, held the lead ahead of Max Verstappen and Leclerc at the start and managed the race to perfection to ensure neither could challenge him after that in Texas. Unlike earlier, Antonelli did it without having the unquestioned best car in the field, too. By now, Red Bull and Ferrari had largely caught up with Mercedes on pace and Antonelli's car was increasingly skittish after upgrades. That left Antonelli needing just two more points for the championship. **AP**

VITALS

Simeone All praise for Kane as Atletico Await Bayern

Madrid: Atletico Madrid manager Diego Simeone hailed Harry Kane as a worthy Ballon d'Or winner as his side prepare to put their nine-game unbeaten run on the line against Bayern Munich in the Champions League on Tuesday. "Firstly, I'd like to congratulate him on his well-deserved Ballon d'Or. It's incredible—I've always admired him," Simeone said. "As he's matured over the years, he's found his best form without losing his eye for goal; he knows what the team needs." The Argentine added: "His talent is a real asset to the game and to the young players who look up to him, because he leaves a legacy showing that you can achieve great things through hard work." **Reuters**

Watchout Tonight

Champions League: Villarreal vs PSG; Atletico vs Bayern; Barcelona vs Aston Villa; Man United vs AS Roma LIVE on Sony Sports and Sony LIV (all matches start at 1:30 am)

ASIAN CHAMPIONS TROPHY HOCKEY

India Blank S Korea 8-0 to Remain Unbeaten

Jalandhar: Five-time champions India continued their unbeaten run, staying on course for a title defence by blanking South Korea 8-0 in their fifth round-robin match of the Asian Champions Trophy hockey on Monday. India finished on top of the standings with a maximum 15 points, ahead of Japan, Malaysia and S Korea. The hosts will again face S Korea in the semis on Wednesday. **PTI**

Why Should I Work Hard? Sarfaraz

Mumbai: "Why should I work hard?" Middle-order batter Sarfaraz Khan on Monday sounded bitter after improved fitness and consistent runs at domestic cricket failed to secure him a return to the Indian Test team. He played his last game in India whites against New Zealand in 2024 at the Wankhede stadium. **PTI**

CBI Gets Transit Remand of Chandrakar; ED Trial Awaits

Set to face trial in Raipur in ED's PMLA complaint filed in October 2023

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: With Mahadev online book promoter Sourabh Chandrakar now in CBI custody after the federal agency brought him back from Oman, the Enforcement Directorate (ED) has a money-laundering trial awaiting him, about ₹3,500 crore in attached assets and a fugitive economic offender plea listed for December 5, people in the know told **ET**.

A Delhi court granted the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) two days' transit remand of Chandrakar, an alleged kingpin in the scandal. He will now be taken to Chhattisgarh.

Chandrakar will face trial before the Special Court under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) in Raipur in connection with the prosecution complaint filed by the agency on October 20, 2023, under Sections 3 and 4 of the PMLA.

That complaint covers the wedding in Ras Al Khaimah in February 2023, reportedly funded with about ₹200 crore in cash. He left India on February 16, 2022. The ED obtained an open-ended non-bailable warrant in September 2023 and an Interpol Red Notice that November.

In parallel, the ED's application under the Fugitive Economic Offenders Act, filed in November 2024, seeks to confiscate his property, including benami holdings. The ED sought an urgent hearing on October 8; the Raipur court has listed the matter for December 5.

The ED has issued eleven provisional attachment orders, of which seven have been confirmed. Of the about ₹3,500 crore in attached assets, roughly ₹1,800 crore is abroad, including 22 properties in Dubai, and ₹1,700 crore is in India.

Chandrakar in CBI custody in New Delhi, Monday

ED'S NEXT STEP

Chandrakar faces an ED trial, with ₹3,500 cr in attached assets and a fugitive economic offender plea pending

The ED estimates that the proceeds of crime linked to Mahadev and sister platforms Skyexchange and Lotus365 amount to ₹88,000-94,000 crore, of which ₹4,000-5,000 crore was allegedly remitted to the promoters in the UAE. Six prosecution complaints have named 116 accused; 14 have been arrested.

Agency sources said the PMLA probe was expanding beyond the promoters. On August 14, the ED registered a fresh PMLA case based on the CBI's FIR, which names former Chhattisgarh chief minister Bhupesh Baghel as an accused.

The ED alleges that the promoters paid 'liaisoning money' for protection in the state. According to people familiar with the matter, panel operator Satish Chandrakar told the ED in August 2023 that ASI Chandrabhushan Verma allegedly received about ₹81 crore from co-promoter Ravi Uppal, including ₹20 crore for the Chief Minister's House.

Another accused, Shubham Soni, wrote to the ED on November 2, 2023, claiming that about ₹508 crore had been paid to Baghel.

The ED seized ₹5.39 crore from courier Asim Das the same day. Das told the agency that he was to deliver the cash to 'Baghel'. These are allegations based on statements and an email in the ED's records. Baghel has denied any wrongdoing.

The ED also claims that accused persons in custody were pressured to retract their statements. Verma and Satish Chandrakar stated in December 2023 that, while in Raipur Central Jail, they were made to write retractions and told that the orders came from the CM's House.

The money trail also extends to financial markets. A fifth supplementary complaint filed on September 10 names Delhi businessman Vikas Garg, who was arrested on July 14.

He allegedly received ₹940.77 crore, including ₹765.77 crore from overseas funds that the ED says were controlled by Skyexchange owner Hari Shankar Tibrewal.

GSMA Re-Elects Vittal as Board Chair Until 2028

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Bharti Airtel's executive vice chairman Gopal Vittal was re-elected chair of the GSMA board of directors on Monday for the 2027-28 term, extending his leadership of the global mobile industry body until December 2028.

The GSMA is a global organisation representing mobile operators and companies across the broader mobile ecosystem, working on industry policy, technology standards and connectivity initiatives.

Vittal, who has served on the GSMA board for 10 years and been chair since 2025, was re-elected for a second term. The board also elected Vodafone Group chief executive Margherita Della Valle as co-deputy chair, alongside MTN Group chief executive Ralph Mupita, who has been re-elected to the position. "Our top priority is security. Securing nations given the increased threats today, securing customers given the rising menace of scams and securing the industry by making it sustainable so it can continue to make forward-leaning investments in technology and build the best infrastructure in all parts of the world," Vittal said.

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ADVT. NO. 06/2026-A & ADVT. No. 10/2026

National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC), a Statutory Corporation of Govt. of India under the Ministry of Cooperation, invites applications from eligible persons for the following posts on direct recruitment basis:-

1. Vacancy 1: Financial Adviser (Advt. No. 06/2026-A)
Remuneration : CTC based, negotiable as per market standards (Remuneration/Pay Compensation will not be a limiting factor for a deserving candidate and can be negotiated in consideration to the last/current CTC drawn)

2. Vacancy 2: Executive Director (General Management) (Advt. No. 10/2026)
Remuneration : CTC based, negotiable as per market standards (Remuneration/Pay Compensation will not be a limiting factor for a deserving candidate and can be negotiated in consideration to the last/current CTC drawn)

For information related to eligibility criteria or other terms and conditions of recruitment, interested candidates may visit NCDC website www.ncdc.in

LAST DATE FOR SUBMISSION OF APPLICATION: 15 NOVEMBER, 2026

Candidates who have already submitted their applications for the post of Financial Adviser in response to Advertisement No. 06/2026 dated 15.07.2026 are not required to apply afresh.

ET THE ECONOMIC TIMES

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SCAN TO REGISTER

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BRANDED CONTENT INITIATIVE

Brahamastra, a Lord's Mark venture, takes indigenous defence innovation to the global stage

Lord's Mark Industries Limited is advancing India's indigenous defence technology capabilities through Brahamastra Defence Techno Products Limited. Three years ago, Lord's Mark Industries Limited's passion for technology and commitment to Make in India set this journey in motion, with a focus on developing world-class products that showcase Indian engineering on the global stage. The initiative reflects an ambition to build specialised capabilities at home and establish an international presence for Indian-developed defence technologies.

Brahamastra's flagship portfolio features three products: BRAK RT, a long-range laser rangefinder with a day-channel camera; BRAK Alpha, a multipurpose laser rangefinder; and TRC-1, a smart trail camera. They are positioned as having no equivalents worldwide. The wider portfolio includes holographic and reflex sights, telescopic and thermal imaging sights, handheld thermal imagers, day/night surveillance systems, anti-drone systems and other optoelectronic equipment, supporting the Atmanirbhar Bharat initiative.

BRAK RT combines laser-based distance measurement with a day-observation camera. Its stated specifications include a maximum range of 20,000 metres, accuracy of up to one metre, and detection of up to five targets. Integrated GPS and orientation sensors provide positional and directional information, while its IP68-rated construction is designed for demanding environments.

BRAK Alpha combines distance measurement with target detection and orientation data. It offers a stated range of 10–5,000 metres, accuracy of up to 0.5 metres, and detection of up to five targets. GPS, azimuth measurement and inclination sensing support field use.

TRC-1 Smart Trail Camera provides motion-triggered imaging and day-and-night capture for field surveillance. Its specifications include five MP or higher still images, 1080p video, a minimum 120-degree field of view and invisible infrared illumination up to 10 metres. Developed in Navi Mumbai, it features role-based permissions and audit records. Video is intended to remain on the camera rather than being centrally stored.

The portfolio is being developed amid demand for advanced electro-optical, infrared and surveillance technologies. MarketsandMarkets projects India's military electro-optics and infrared (EO/IR) market to grow from USD 1.19 billion in 2026 to USD 1.78 billion by 2030, at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 10.4 per cent. Globally, Mordor Intelligence projects the military electro-optical and infrared systems market to rise from USD 9.09 billion in 2025 to USD 10.77 billion by 2031, at a CAGR of 2.87 per cent. These trends could create opportunities for partnerships, deployment and exports, subject to technical, regulatory and procurement requirements.

Dr Sachidanand Upadhyay, Founder, MD and CEO of Lord's Mark Industries Limited, said, "Our love and enthusiasm for technology and belief in Make in India inspired this journey three years ago. We saw an opportunity to use India's engineering talent and research capabilities to develop world-class indigenous defence technologies for global markets. Our ambition is to go beyond domestic needs and create products reflecting India's technological strength internationally. Brahamastra's portfolio can open new markets and strengthen India's role in specialised defence technology."

Disclaimer: An initiative of Lord's Mark Industries Limited. BCCL does not endorse and is not responsible for the accuracy or completeness of the information contained herein. Readers should seek appropriate professional advice before taking any decision.

COS SEEN SPEEDING UP PRODUCTION OF 'DIETS' & 'LIGHTS' TO AVOID SHORTAGE

Zero-Sugar Drinks Hit the Sweet Spot

Sales double for PepsiCo and Coca-Cola in Sept qtr, also help beat margin pressure amid high costs

Ratna Bhushan

New Delhi: Sales of PepsiCo's zero-sugar and low-sugar drinks doubled to a record 88% of volumes in July-September 2026 quarter, up from 44% in the corresponding year-ago quarter as consumers turned away from sugary drinks. This helped helped mitigate margin pressures amid steep and continuous surge in sugar prices.

Larger rival Coca-Cola, which leads the ₹60,000-crore soft drinks category, also saw sales of its diets and lights drinks double over last year, which now include Schweppes sugar-free flavoured drinks as well.

PepsiCo's bottling partner Varun Beverages (VBL) told investors at its post September quarter earnings call in a management commentary that surge in prices of sugar was offset by increase in low sugar and no sugar products.

"In India, savings in sugar consumption, driven by a higher mix of low-sugar, no-sugar products helped maintain gross margins despite the inflationary raw material environment affected by the West Asia crisis," Raj Gandhi, president and wholetime director at VBL said on the investor call. The numbers include sales of sugar-free Pepsi and 7 Up sugar-free, Evervess soda and Aquafina water.

Coca-Cola is aggressively pushing sugar-free Thums Up, Coke Zero, Diet Coke and Sprite Zero, and preparing an aggressive roll-out of Coke Zero Zero, its global zero-sugar zero-caffeine drink. From a five-year-high record of 30% of its total volume sales being contributed by diet and light drinks last year, the number has more than doubled to touch over 60%, two senior bottling associates of the beverage maker said.

"Diet Coke alone has grown 150% in the first nine months of 2026 compared to the same period last year," one of the executives said. This is despite an acute shortage of aluminium cans in April-May this year, as a result of supply disruptions amid the West Asia war.

An email sent to Coca-Cola seeking comments remained unanswered till press time on Monday.

Without mentioning specific data about sales of sugar-free beverages, Coca-Cola said in its July-September earnings call last week that "affordability, zero-sugar offerings and local-market execution" supported performance across an uneven global consumer environment.

As consumer demand for zero-sugar and low-sugar drinks outperformed their sugary variants by a higher-than-expected margin in the July-September 2026 quarter, companies are accelerating manufacturing of diets and lights ahead of targets, to avoid shortage.

With the low and no-sugar category growing twice faster than sugary drinks, the incumbents are also competing with multiple new entrants in the category.

Challenger brand Lahori Zeera recently introduced its first sugar free variant, as has Reliance Consumer Products' Campa and Zyro from Veeba Foods which has also launched zero-sugar colas.

And two months ago, clean-label beverage brand Sorry Sugar announced a fund raise of $1 million in its first seed funding round.

The rapid switch in consumer preferences comes at a time when prices of sugar in India have hit record highs this year, as a result of a combination of factors such as lower-than-expected domestic production, increase in demand amid the festive season, weather-related damage to the sugarcane crop, and tightening global sugar supplies.

Compared to last year when sugar prices were in the range of ₹40-50 per kg, this year the prices surged sharply to anywhere between ₹58-65 a kg.

SUITS & SAYINGS

ET's roundup of the wackiest whispers in corporate corridors

Legacy Matters

A question on legacy at a recent corporate gathering prompted an unscripted moment. Asked how he would like to be remembered, this leading north India-based industrialist spoke of his group's contribution to nation-building. His spouse, however, had a slightly different take, drawing a distinction between the legacy one builds and the headlines one leaves behind. The clear allusion to the recent goings-on at another storied business house was not entirely lost on the audience. The remark drew a few awkward smiles, particularly from those with links to the conglomerate in question.

Public Fallout

Keeping confidential information under wraps is standard corporate practice. Turns out one large institution that has had a tough time plugging leaks has had a run in with one of its own top exec over this. With sensitive information finding its way into the public domain, the management reportedly launched an internal probe and suspended access of a few and investigated mails of some who left it recently. The top gun, who has long been preaching the virtues of values and ethics, apparently took offence. So much so that he allegedly called the tech executive around midnight and threatened him with consequences.

Privy to the whispers in power corridors or juicy tips on India Inc? Do share with us at **etsuits.sayings@timesofindia.com**

In a Nutshell

Marathon Gets Nod for Byculla Project Stake Buy

MUMBAI The board of directors of Marathon Nextgen Realty has approved the acquisition of Adani Group's 60% stake in a mixed-use project in south Mumbai's Byculla locality for a consideration of ₹335 crore. Upon completion of transaction, Marathon's stake in development will increase to 100% from 40%, giving it sole ownership and control. **Our Bureau**

HDFC Cap, DivyaSree to Launch ₹1.5k cr Platform

NEW DELHI Bengaluru-based DivyaSree Developers has partnered with HDFC Capital Advisors for establishing a ₹1,500 crore residential platform. This will provide growth capital to DivyaSree to support the acquisition and development of residential projects over next three to four years with a potential gross development value of ₹6,750 crore. **Faizan Haidar**

L&T Bags Orders for Housing, Office Projects

NEW DELHI Larsen & Toubro (L&T) said it has bagged orders for construction of residential buildings in Mumbai and Bengaluru, and a commercial tower in Hyderabad. L&T classifies orders in the range of ₹1,000 crore to ₹2,500 crore.

A CONSUMPTION METRIC

ITC Q2 Net Falls 20% as High Taxes Keep Margins in Check

But revenue up 45%; non-cigarette FMCG biz's top-line growth highest in 14 quarters

Our Bureau

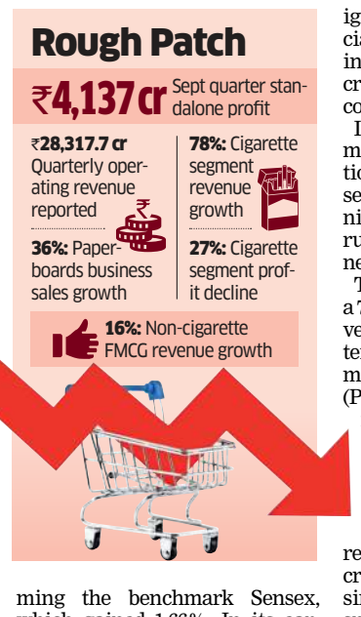
Kolkata: ITC reported a 20% year-on-year (YoY) decline in standalone net profit to ₹4,137.1 crore for the September quarter, despite a 45% increase in revenue from operations to ₹28,317.7 crore, as an unprecedented increase in cigarette taxation weighed on profitability. Robust growth across its non-cigarette businesses, coupled with price hikes in the cigarette business following the tax increase, drove revenue growth. The non-cigarette fast-moving consumer goods business recorded its highest revenue growth in 14 quarters.

However, ITC absorbed part of the cigarette price increase to protect consumer demand and shift of sales to illegal or tax-evaded products, putting pressure on margins in its largest business and overall balance sheet.

The results were announced after market hours on Monday. ITC shares closed 0.15% higher at ₹266 apiece on the BSE, underperforming the benchmark Sensex, which gained 1.66%. In its earnings statement, ITC said the operating environment was marked by "heightened uncertainty amidst renewed geopolitical tensions and trade disruptions". Crude oil and crude-linked input prices remained elevated; supply chain disruptions and higher freight costs added to cost pressures.

Global inflationary pressures also intensified amid higher energy and food prices, elevated sovereign bond yields and tighter financial conditions. In India, headline inflation rose on a broad-based increase across food, fuel and core components, the company said.

ITC said geopolitical developments, climatic conditions, inflationary headwinds and consumer sentiment would remain key monitorable, even as demand in both rural and urban markets remained resilient.



The cigarette business reported a 78% YoY increase in segment revenue to ₹15,536.1 crore in the September quarter. However, segment profit before interest and tax (PBIT) fell 27% to ₹3,813.5 crore, reflecting the impact of higher taxation and the company's calibrated pricing response.

The non-cigarette FMCG business continued to deliver strong growth, with segment revenue rising 16% YoY to ₹6,967.2 crore and segment PBIT increasing 28% to ₹558.3 crore. Biscuits, snacks, noodles, spices, salt, frozen snacks, home care and notebooks grew by more than 20%, while dairy and personal wash products recorded high-teen growth. Ebitda margin in the business expanded by more than 50 basis points yoy. ITC's agri-business revenue grew 12%, driven by value-added products such as spices, fruits and vegetables, as well as leaf tobacco exports while segment PBIT improved by 11%.

ADOBE STOCK

Oyo Parent PRISM's PAT Rises 17% to ₹353 crore in Q1, Revenue Up 35%

Anumeha Chaturvedi

New Delhi: Oyo parent PRISM posted a 35% year-on-year increase in consolidated revenue from operations to ₹2,814 crore for the first quarter of financial year 2026-27, compared with ₹2,078 crore a year earlier, according to the company's audited financials seen by **ET**.

Consolidated profit after tax increased 17% to ₹353 crore from ₹301 crore. Its profit for the latest first quarter included a deferred-tax credit of about ₹244 crore.

Gross booking value increased 30% to about ₹9,600 crore from ₹7,408 crore in quarter one of last fiscal year. Ebitda grew 24% to ₹760 crore from Rs 611 crore.

Addressing shareholders at an extraordinary general meeting in early October, founder Ritesh Agarwal said performance across hotels and vacation homes led to improved gross margins and higher operating earnings, even as the company continued to invest in expanding its brands and strengthening demand. Its first-quarter adjusted Ebitda, net of lease expenses, rose 35% to ₹589 crore, he said at the EGM.

PRISM's gross booking value increased 30% to ₹9,600 crore

PRISM's hotel segment bookings in the quarter grew 30% year-on-year, while the vacation homes business recorded a 28% increase in bookings.

Agarwal attributed the company's performance to investments made over the past few years in technology, brands, distribution capabilities and its global operating model. At the EGM, Agarwal highlighted the role of PRISM's common technology platform in supporting growth across geographies. Built centrally and replicated across markets, the platform supports key functions including pricing, distribution, reservations, customer service and property management.

Speaking about the increasing use of artificial intelligence across the company's operations, Agarwal said: "We are now embedding AI into these processes to improve efficiency, automate repetitive tasks and make intelligent decisions faster, whether in pricing, operating efficiency or improving customer service."

Marico Profit Up 31%, Flags Rising Input Costs Amid West Asia Woes

Aanya Thakur

Mumbai: Consumer goods maker Marico has flagged renewed input cost pressures from geopolitical tensions in West Asia and weather-related concerns, even as consumption in India remained resilient.

The company said it is closely watching the impact of elevated crude prices on demand, particularly in parts of rural India that have received deficient rainfall.

"Geopolitical developments in West Asia led to higher energy prices, and renewed concerns around supply chain and inflation," managing director and chief executive Saugata Gupta told investors on Monday. "Consumer inflation increased, led by food, edible oil, and fuel."

While copra prices have softened from the multi-year highs seen last year, food-linked derivatives and vegetable oils have risen further. Marico said it would use the pricing power of its brands and cost management to cushion the impact. "We are well equipped to manage these pressures," he added.

ADOBE STOCK

MANAGING PRESSURES

Co said it would use the pricing power of its brands and cost management to cushion the impact

The company is also factoring in prevailing crude prices in its outlook but is not assuming a sharp increase over the next six months.

"We are mindful of two things. In India, we are mindful of the demand situation. If certain states have had deficient rainfall more than others, if crude continues to be at high level, whether there will be more inflation. In international markets, the same thing, along with supply chain complexities," said Gupta.

Consolidated revenue rose 13% to ₹3,897 crore, led by 10% volume growth in India and 13% constant-currency growth in international markets.

Ebitda increased 27% to ₹709 crore and net profit rose 31% to ₹550 crore, while gross margin expanded about 600 basis points. The company raised its FY27 EBITDA growth expectation to the mid-20% range from around 20% earlier. It expects annual revenue to comfortably exceed ₹15,000 crore.

The company had earlier set a target of reaching ₹20,000 crore in revenue by FY30, but now aspires to achieve the milestone by FY29.

Aditya Birla Lifestyle Bets on Festive Demand

Aanya Thakur

Mumbai: Aditya Birla Lifestyle Brands is banking on the festive season to revive apparel demand even as it has raised prices by about 6% to offset higher costs, testing consumers' willingness to spend amid signs of moderating sales growth.

The company, which owns brands such as Louis Philippe, Van Heusen, Allen Solly and Peter England, reported flat like-for-like sales growth in September, against 5.3% for the second quarter of FY27. The slowdown comes just as the full impact of price increases begins to flow through in the December quarter, making consumer acceptance and discounting critical to sustaining growth.

"We will have to see how consumers respond to that and to be able to see how much, because in our business pricing is one part, the second part is how much of discounts you give," managing director Ashish Dikshit told investors on Monday.

While the company has taken about a 6% hike for the season to ease higher input costs, it has not passed on the entire increase, Dikshit said. It has also worked with vendor partners to minimise cost pressures.

The full impact of the price increases will be visible in the December quarter, as the September quarter included a mix of old and new inventory, with the older merchandise not carrying the higher prices. Demand was uneven across categories in the September quarter, with casual wear and athleisure accounting for much of the growth, while wedding-related purchases remained subdued.

"H1, especially Q2, had a lot of casual lines growing because there was very little wedding demand in Q2," Dikshit said. "So, most of the growth is actually coming from casual lines, athleisure, et cetera."

The company expects wedding-led categories, including ethnic wear, to perform better in the current quarter as the festive and wedding season gathers pace. Like-for-like growth at the company's lifestyle brands stood at 5.3% in the September quarter, compared with 6.6% in the first half. September recorded zero growth, although Dikshit attributed this largely to the shift in the festive calendar.

CONSOLIDATION Two trusts to raise ₹825 cr; Sudarshan Venu stake in TVS to rise to 73.35%

Venu Family Trusts Pledge TVS Shares to Fund TSF Stake Buy

Kala Vijayraghavan & Lijee Philip

Mumbai: Two trusts associated with the Sudarshan Venu family have raised ₹825 crore by pledging shares representing nearly 20% of TVS Holdings' equity to finance the acquisition of the remaining stake held by the extended family's Trichur Santhanam Sundaram (TSF) group, officials close to the matter told **ET.**

The acquisition will increase Sudarshan Venu's holding in TVS Holdings to 73.35% from 69.62%, marking a further consolidation of ownership within the Venu Srinivasan branch of the TVS family, said the officials cited above.

According to regulatory filings, VS Trust has raised a term loan of ₹265 crore, while Srinivasan Trust has secured facilities of ₹165 crore and ₹395 crore. The loans were extended by JM Financial Products and JM Financial Credit Solutions, with pledge agreements executed on October 26. The aggregate encumbered holding stands at 4,036,000 shares, representing 19.95% of TVS Holdings' equity.

The funds are being used to finance the acquisition of the remaining shares held by the TSF family following the broader TVS Group partition. The latest transaction completes the acquisition of the final 3% stake held by the branch, officials close to the matter said.

TVS did not comment.

The transaction marks another step in the gradual realignment of ownership within the extended TVS family.

Venu Srinivasan and his son Sudarshan have been progressively acquiring shares held by other family branches, including interests routed through Sundaram Clayton and the TSF group.

The increase in Sudarshan's holding is significant because TVS Holdings is the holding company through which the Venu family has a controlling interest in TVS Motor Company, the group's flagship two-wheeler business. Its portfolio spans automotive and financial services, with TVS Motor and Home Credit India Finance among its key businesses. TVS Holdings reported consolidated revenue of ₹20,183 crore in the second quarter of FY27, an increase of 39% over the corresponding period last year, reflecting the scale of the businesses under its umbrella.

Its flagship company, TVS Motor, has also been reporting strong growth. In the second quarter of FY27, it posted revenue of ₹17,103 crore, a 44% increase over the corresponding quarter last year. Ebitda, a measure of operating performance, grew 47%, while profit after tax rose 52% to ₹1,377 crore. Two- and three-wheeler sales increased 27% to 1.9 million units. The performance underscores the growing scale of the business as Sudarshan assumes greater responsibility for its next phase of expansion.

A higher stake consolidates the family's economic interest in the holding company and strengthens Sudarshan's position within the ownership structure as he assumes a larger role in the group's businesses.

The TSF branch traces its lineage to late TS Santhanam, founder of Sundaram Finance and younger brother of late TS Srinivasan, Venu Srinivasan's father. Santhanam's descendants manage businesses across financial services and automotive manufacturing, including Sundaram Finance, Wheels India and Brakes India. The branch is one of the principal constituents of the wider TVS Group, founded by TV Sundram Iyengar.

Venu Srinivasan was designated chairman emeritus of TVS Motor Company effective April 1, 2022, while continuing as managing director. Sudarshan, who had earlier been elevated as managing director, subsequently became chairman and managing director on August 25, 2025.

Darius Khambata Won't Seek Reappointment as Trustee to Tata Trusts

Kala Vijayraghavan & Sagar Malviya

Mumbai: Senior advocate Darius J Khambata has said he will not seek reappointment as trustee of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) and Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), sidestepping a vote that was unlikely to see a unanimous outcome given the ongoing infighting among trustees. Trustees are reappointed by unanimous vote at the two key Tata trusts.

In a November 2 letter to Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata and chief executive Siddharth Sharma, Khambata said reappointment required the consent of all other trustees, which he was unwilling to seek. He thanked both of them for asking him to continue.

Khambata said he had accepted the original appointments at the invitation of the late Ratan Tata and wanted to maintain his independence as a trustee. "That independence comes at a cost. My stand and approach has at times differed from others', including Noel's; I appreciate Noel's democratic acceptance of this. That is the old Tata way. Yet in law even a Trustee's reappointment requires the agreement of all other Trustees. That is a consent that it is not in my character to seek as it would compromise my independence to do so," he wrote.

Khambata, who said more than 90% of his meeting time was spent on philanthropic projects, also defended the Tata Trusts' role in the group's governance and opposed the proposed listing of Tata Sons.

"I was the first to caution against the potential listing of Tata Sons, calling it 'existential' for the Trusts at the May 28, 2025 meeting, and I drafted and propounded the July 28, 2025 resolution which was passed unanimously. No fiduciary of the Trusts could have taken any other position, for the Tata model was at stake," he said. He argued that the Tata group's ownership structure was integral to its identity and that separating Tata Sons from the Trusts could undermine the model.

"As Chandra has said Tata Sons must always be in sync with Tata Trusts, and to my mind, nothing since warrants a relook at that dynamic. That this model is now threatened by those who, ironically citing its success, would decouple Tata Sons from the Trusts, is not objective judgement." He also questioned the argument that a listing would help Tata Sons raise capital and accelerate growth.

Khambata said the September 17 board meeting of Tata Sons had sullied the reputation of the institution. "The sad events of September 17, 2026, a day that will live in infamy, have sullied Tata Sons' reputation and have imperilled the image of corporate India. No spin doctoring can mask what happened," he wrote. He also expressed concern over the differences between Noel Tata and N Chandrasekaran. "I am saddened by the current divide between Noel and Chandra. They should remember Lord Krishna's words in the Mahabharata: 'Whatever a great person does, common people follow. Whatever standards he sets by example, the world pursues'," he said.

Maha FDA Suspends Licences of Patanjali Distributor, 18 Others over 'Adulteration'

Mumbai: The Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration (FDA) has suspended licences of 19 food business operators, including a super distributor of Patanjali Ayurved, and seized food articles worth over ₹9 crore during a special festive-season drive. In an official statement on Monday, the FDA said it seized around 3.53 lakh kg of food articles valued at ₹9.01 crore from 114 establishments across seven divisions of Maharashtra during the campaign. The seized stock included 2,279.7 litres of Patanjali cow ghee worth ₹20.20 lakh from M/s Divya Mahavitarak, a super distributor of Patanjali Ayurved in Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, on suspicion of misbranding and adulteration, it added. — **PTI**

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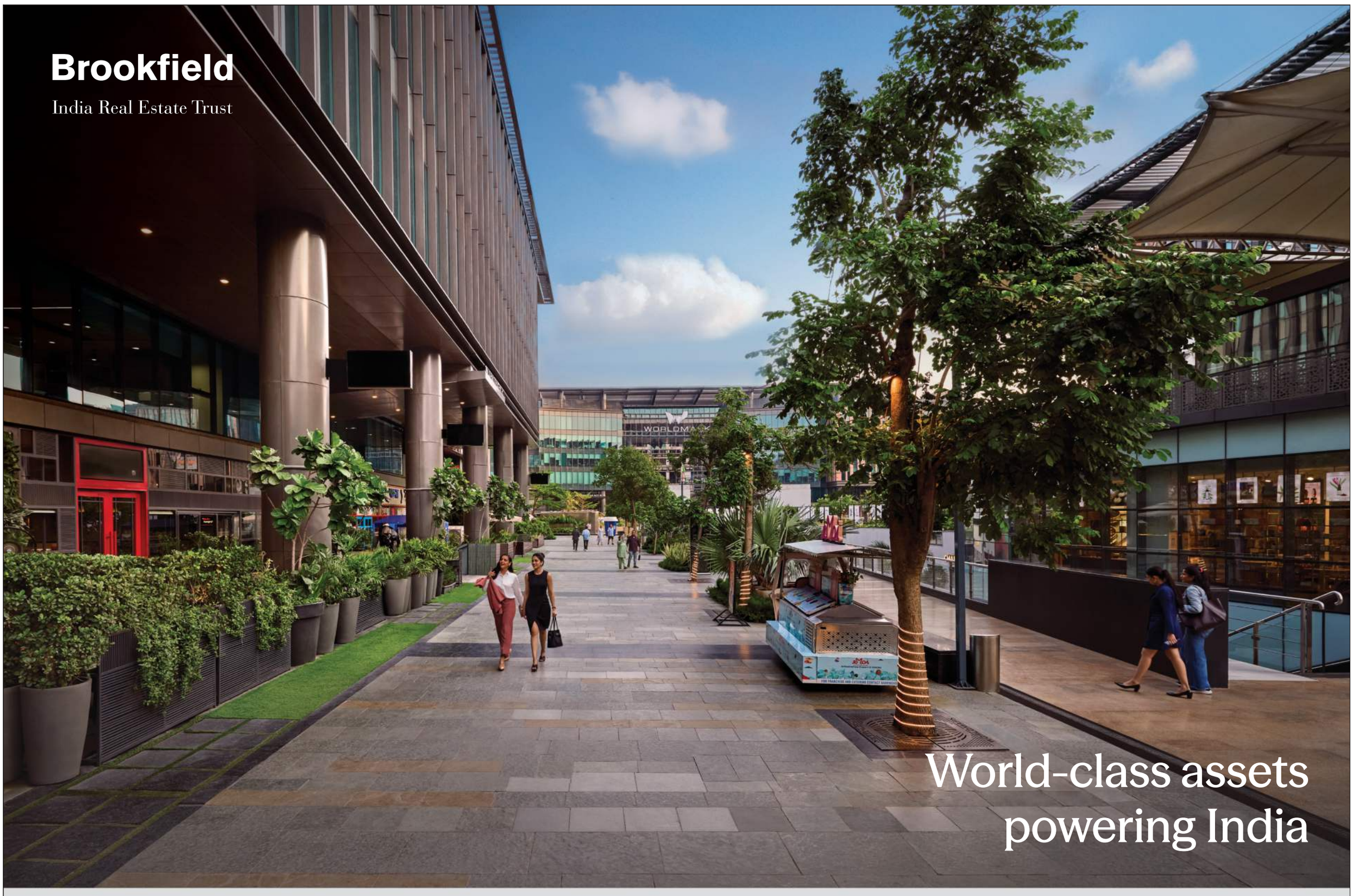

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GLOBAL SECTOR LEADER STANDING-INVESTMENTS (OFFICE-LISTED) & DEVELOPMENT (MIXED USE-LISTED)[3]

SCAN TO KNOW MORE

Financial results for the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026

Part I: Consolidated Statement of Financial Results

₹ in Million

Particulars	For the quarter ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	For the quarter ended 30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	For the quarter ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	For the half year ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	For the half year ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	For the year ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
Income and gains						
Revenue from operations	9,963.65	9,738.26	6,719.37	19,701.91	13,147.81	29,711.44
Other income	605.51	568.09	231.12	1,173.60	353.30	1,001.89
Total income	**10,569.16**	**10,306.35**	**6,950.49**	**20,875.51**	**13,501.11**	**30,713.33**
Cost of material consumed	37.30	27.69	23.20	64.99	48.32	108.72
Employee benefits expenses	100.23	113.47	70.70	213.70	144.27	312.56
Finance costs	3,167.24	3,378.11	2,022.22	6,545.35	4,069.70	9,747.81
Depreciation and amortization expenses	1,448.81	1,419.77	1,069.14	2,868.58	2,116.78	4,694.02
Other expenses	3,410.86	2,461.17	1,853.25	5,872.03	3,534.66	7,863.25
Total expenses	**8,164.44**	**7,400.21**	**5,038.51**	**15,564.65**	**9,913.73**	**22,726.36**
Profit before share of profit of equity accounted investee and tax	**2,404.72**	**2,906.14**	**1,911.98**	**5,310.86**	**3,587.38**	**7,986.97**
Share of net loss (after tax) of joint venture accounted for using the equity method	(23.38)	(122.66)	(121.22)	(146.04)	(269.24)	(402.78)
Profit before tax	**2,381.34**	**2,783.48**	**1,790.76**	**5,164.82**	**3,318.14**	**7,584.19**
Tax expense:						
Current tax						
-for current period	(161.87)	403.48	127.24	241.61	204.81	672.04
-for earlier years	(93.95)	(1.29)	(1.34)	(95.24)	0.88	(345.72)
Deferred tax (credit)/ charge	(130.51)	167.92	171.05	37.41	295.62	1890.36
Tax (credit)/ expense for the period/ year	**(386.33)**	**570.11**	**296.95**	**183.78**	**501.31**	**2216.68**
Profit for the period/ year after tax*	**2767.67**	**2213.37**	**1493.81**	**4981.04**	**2816.83**	**5367.51**
Other comprehensive income/ (loss)						
Items that will not be reclassified to profit or loss						
- Remeasurement of defined benefit obligations	2.82	(0.31)	1.28	2.51	2.12	4.04
- Income tax related to items that will not be reclassified to profit or loss	(0.81)	0.09	(0.37)	(0.72)	(0.61)	(1.19)
- Share of other comprehensive income /(loss) of joint venture accounted for using the equity method	0.34	(0.26)	(0.10)	0.08	0.12	0.47
Other comprehensive income/ (loss) for the period/ year, net of tax	**2.35**	**(0.48)**	**0.81**	**1.87**	**1.63**	**3.32**
Total comprehensive income for the period/ year	**2770.02**	**2212.89**	**1494.62**	**4982.91**	**2818.46**	**5370.83**
Profit for the period/ year after income tax attributable to unit holders of Brookfield India REIT	2400.83	1798.05	1394.63	4198.88	2640.22	4812.30
Profit for the period/ year after income tax attributable to non- controlling interests	366.84	415.32	99.18	782.16	176.61	555.21
Total comprehensive income for the period/ year attributable to unit holders of Brookfield India REIT	2403.18	1797.57	1395.44	4200.75	2641.85	4815.62
Total comprehensive Income for the period/ year attributable to non- controlling interests	366.84	415.32	99.18	782.16	176.61	555.21
Basic (in ₹)	2.89	2.22	2.26	5.12	4.31	7.29
Diluted (in ₹)	2.89	2.22	2.26	5.12	4.31	7.29

* there are no such exceptional or extraordinary items

Consolidated Financial Results

Part II: Select explanatory notes to the Consolidated Financial Results of the quarter and half year ended 30 September 2026

1. The unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results of Brookfield India Real Estate Trust ("Brookfield India REIT") have been prepared in accordance with the requirements of SEBI (Real Estate Investment Trusts) Regulations, 2014, as amended from time to time including any guidelines and circulars issued there under read with SEBI Master circular no. SEBI/HO/DDHS-PoD-2/P/CIR/2025/99 dated 11 July 2025 ("REIT Regulations"); Regulation 52 and 54 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("SEBI Listing Regulations"), Recognition and Measurement principles of Indian Accounting Standard 34 "Interim Financial Reporting" (IndAS) 34 as defined in Rule 2(1)(a) of the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 ('Ind AS') to the extent not inconsistent with the REIT Regulations , read with relevant rules issued thereunder and other accounting principles generally accepted in India."
2. The unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results for the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026 of Brookfield India REIT, have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and thereafter approved by the Board of Directors in their meeting held on November 02, 2026 and Statutory Auditors has carried out a limited review of the unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results and issued an unmodified report.
3. There is no change in the accounting policies for the quarter and half year ended 30 September 2026.
4. The above is an extract of the detailed format of unaudited Consolidated Financial Results for the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026, filed with the Stock Exchanges pursuant to REIT Regulations and SEBI Listing Regulations, each read with circulars issued thereunder. The full format of unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results and Finance Statements for the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026 including the line items referred under Regulations 52(4) of SEBI Listing Regulations, are available on website of Stock Exchanges (www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com) and on website of Brookfield India REIT at https://www.brookfieldindiareit.in/investors/financial-information. The Financial Results also can be accessed by scanning the Quick Response Code ("QR Code").

III. In accordance with Regulation 52(4) of SEBI Listing Regulations, the trust has disclosed following ratios:

Financial Ratios	For the quarter ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	For the quarter ended 30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	For the quarter ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	For the half year ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	For the half year ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	For the year ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
Current ratio (in times)	0.61	1.12	1.48	0.61	1.48	0.61
Debt-equity ratio (in times)	0.72	0.66	0.55	0.72	0.55	0.85
Debt service coverage ratio (in times)	2.70	2.31	1.10	2.50	1.42	1.90
Interest service coverage ratio (in times)	2.33	2.08	2.27	2.20	2.21	2.03
Outstanding redeemable preference shares (quantity and value)	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Capital redemption reserve/debenture redemption reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Net worth (Amounts in ₹million)	2,18,366.91	2,31,643.33	1,66,307.32	2,18,366.91	1,66,307.32	1,95,621.23
Net profit after tax (Amounts in ₹million)	2,767.67	2,213.37	1,493.81	4,981.04	2,816.83	5,367.51
Earnings per unit- Basic (Amounts in ₹)	2.89	2.22	2.26	5.12	4.31	7.29
Earnings per unit- Diluted (Amounts in ₹)	2.89	2.22	2.26	5.12	4.31	7.29
Long term debt to working capital	(12.18)	42.68	14.91	(12.18)	14.91	(24.33)
Bad debts to Account receivable ratio	0.01	0.00	0.01	0.02	0.01	0.02
Current liability ratio (in times)	0.16	0.16	0.12	0.16	0.12	0.09
Total debts to total assets (in times)	0.37	0.37	0.33	0.37	0.33	0.42
Debtors turnover (in times)	25.32	25.63	29.49	32.96	32.11	32.77
Inventory turnover	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Operating margin (in %)	64.39%	73.28%	71.16%	68.78%	71.65%	72.12%
Net profit margin (in %)	26.19%	21.48%	21.53%	23.86%	20.90%	17.48%
Assets cover available	2.52	2.56	2.89	2.52	2.89	2.29
Distribution per unit	5.70	5.60	5.25	11.30	10.50	21.40
Net operating income	7,672.19	7,565.61	5,094.18	15,237.80	10,079.93	22,912.99
Net borrowing ratio	28.73%	27.65%	24.49%	28.73%	24.49%	34.02%

Part-IV: Statement of Net Assets at Fair Value

₹ in Million unlesss otherwise stated

Sr No.	Particulars	As at 30 September 2026 (Unaudited)	As at 31 March 2026 (Audited)
A	Total assets	5,73,819.27	5,24,066.72
B	Total liabilities	(2,03,925.58)	(1,97,036.61)
C	**Net assets (A-B)**	**3,69,893.69**	**3,27,030.11**
D	Less: Non-controlling interest	(44,264.50)	(37,270.74)
E	Net assets attributable to unit holders of Brookfield India REIT	3,25,629.19	2,89,759.37
F	**No. of units**	**82,98,80,869**	**74,93,85,513**
G	**NAV per unit (E/F) in ₹**	**392.38**	**386.66**

Part V: Net Distributable Cash Flows (NDCF) of Brookfield India REIT pursuant to SEBI REIT Regulations

₹ in Million unlesss otherwise stated

Sr No.	Particulars	For the quarter ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	For the quarter ended 30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	For the quarter ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	For the half year ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	For the half year ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	For the year ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
1	Net Distributable Cash Flows	4,730.33	4,647.33	3,360.06	9,377.66	6,550.76	15,164.90
2	Distribution payout ratio	100.00%	100.00%	100.00%	100.00%	100.00%	99.98%
3	**Distribution***	**4,730.32**	**4,647.33**	**3,360.06**	**9,377.65**	**6,550.76**	**15,161.79**
	-Payment of interest	1,278.02	1,369.30	1,184.02	2,647.32	2,332.67	4,852.00
	-Payment of dividend	1,427.39	771.79	531.21	2,199.18	914.09	2,348.81
	-Repayment of SPV debt	1,858.93	2,215.78	1,619.23	4,074.71	3,266.24	7,671.09
	-Interest on fixed deposit	165.98	290.46	25.60	456.44	37.76	289.89
4	**No of units outstanding**	**82,98,80,869**	**82,98,80,869**	**64,00,10,513**	**82,98,80,869**	**64,00,10,513**	**82,98,80,869**
5	Distribution per unit (DPU) in ₹	5.70	5.60	5.25	11.30	10.50	21.40

1. The Board of Directors of the Manager to Brookfield India REIT in their meeting held on 02 November 2026, has declared distribution to Unitholders of ₹5.70 per unit which aggregates to ₹4,730.32 million for the quarter ended 30 September 2026. The distributions of ₹5.70 per unit comprises ₹1.54 per unit in the form of interest payment on shareholder loan, CCDs and NCDs, ₹2.24 per unit in the form of repayment of SPV debt and NCD, ₹1.72 per unit in the form of dividend and the balance ₹0.20 per unit in the form of interest on fixed deposit and gain on investment in mutual funds.

*The total amount of distribution is based on the amount of distribution declared per unit and total no of units outstanding on the record date for the respective quarter of the distribution.

DISCLAIMER: This publication has been prepared for general information purposes only. The information contained herein is audited/unaudited and should be read together with our consolidated financial results available on the website of the Brookfield India REIT and the stock exchanges. No representation or warranty is made nor any lability accepted with respect to the fairness or completeness of the contents hereof. Readers should conduct their own analysis and form their own view of the market position and business and performance of the Brookfield India REIT. (1) 0.3 MSF commitments against re-leasing of future expiries and 0.4 MSF of advanced renewals for expiries beyond FY2027. (2) Excluding NOI from North Commercial Portfolio. (3) For Baytown, Kolkata.

SITHARAMAN RECOGNISES CHANGED SITUATION

'We will Consider Requests for LTCG Tax Review'

FM says capex push to continue, govt hopes to see Tata matters settled soon

Our Bureau

Mumbai: The Centre would 'consider' the request from foreign investors to review the structure of taxes levied on equity capital gains, finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman said Monday, highlighting the role of overseas funds in the capital markets that are seen as crucial to sustaining rapid economic growth and boosting efficiency in financing.

"I know the circumstances have changed and, therefore, the voices of concern are louder," the finance minister said at a media event, in reference to reports that her administration has received suggestions to review the levies on long-term capital gains (LTCG) for overseas investors.

"I quite appreciate that. So, I'll consider all this because where our growth is very important, where people are putting their very best, we are able to see sustained seven-plus growth."

Sitharaman said the taxation structure has not changed from 2023-24, when foreign inflows into Indian equities were the highest. But she acknowledged the situation is different now. Overseas funds have withdrawn a net $30.9 billion so far this calendar year following net withdrawals of nearly $19 billion through 2025.

Simultaneously, US bond yields have surged to their highest this millennium, topping levels last seen during the peak of the global financial crisis.

Yield on the US 10-year benchmark bond has consistently been in the vicinity of 5% lately, pressuring emerging market currencies and reducing the attractiveness of assets priced in currencies other than the US dollar.

ON LTCG TAX REVIEW

I know circumstances have changed and, therefore, the voices of concern are louder. I'll consider all this... our growth is very important, where people are putting in their best, we are able to see sustained 7%-plus growth

NIRMALA SITHARAMAN
Finance Minister

"In the last few years, we have been placing a lot of emphasis on the bond market, deepening it, widening it. Now we also have this voice which says, come on, even equity needs that kind of work and support," Sitharaman said, while stopping short of making immediate commitments to reduce taxes on capital gains. "So, I wouldn't want to say more at this stage. But I recognise the voice."

Foreign portfolio investors (FPI) have argued that India is among the few major markets that levy capital gains tax on foreign portfolio investors. Some commentators have attributed persistent FPI sales to India's relative underperformance among emerging markets lately. Under the current regime, short-term capital gains from listed shares held for up to 12 months are taxed at 20%. Gains on shares held for more than 12 months are taxed as long-term capital gains at 12.5%.

BUDGET FY28 PREPARATION

Duty Relief for 118 Goods Under Review

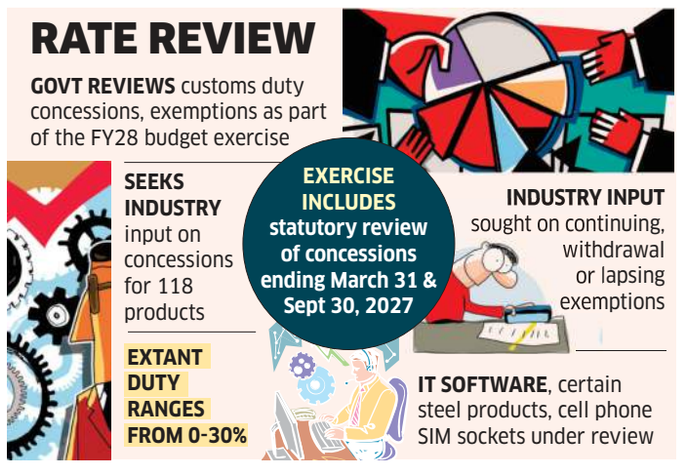
Fish oil, open cells up for statutory review; unconditional exemption to fuel oil, medicines to be reconsidered

Kirtika Suneja

New Delhi: The government has begun a review of basic customs duty concessions and exemptions currently applicable to 118 products as part of the budget 2027-28 exercise, people familiar with the discussions said.

The list includes goods required to set up power projects, components for panel display modules, textile machinery, battery scrap, certain photovoltaic cells, drugs and optical fibre cables. The exercise covers a statutory review of concessions expiring on March 31 and September 30, 2027.

The basic customs duty rate ranges up to 30% on these goods. Respective line ministries have reached out to industry seeking their inputs on whether these exemptions and concessional rates should continue, be withdrawn or allowed to lapse. "Industry has been asked for detailed justification supported by data on domestic production, imports, existing capacity and planned investment in these goods," said one of the people.



Customs duty concessions and exemptions on 32 products such as certain fish oil, shuttleless looms and open cell used to manufacture interactive flat panel displays are up for a statutory review. The government is also reviewing unconditional exemptions given to 86 goods, including fuel oil, some medicines, urea, stents, probiotics, waste and scrap of critical minor metals such as gallium and germanium and waste of lithium-ion batteries.

TARIFF RATIONALISATION

Review aims to address inverted duty structures while supporting domestic manufacturing

Unconditional exemptions are full waivers of duty without requiring importers to fulfil post-import conditions. "Duty review and rationalisation is a routine exercise done to correct the inverted duty structure and promote local manufacturing," said an official.

A major theme of budget FY27 was tariff rationalisation with many conditional and unconditional exemptions reviewed, several extended and sunset clauses removed. The measures included selective rate changes, such as withdrawal of certain concessional or nil duties, extension of benefits for exports, renewable energy, semiconductors, pharmaceuticals, medical devices, aircraft manufacturing and MRO, nuclear power and electric mobility. Specific duties for certain consumer goods such as umbrellas were revised.

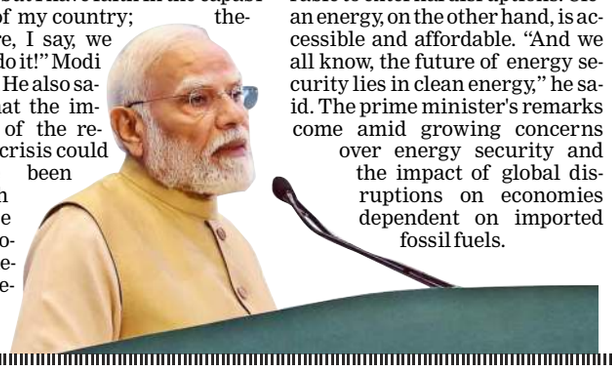
Clean Energy Investment Helped India Weather Global Energy Crisis: PM

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday said India's investments in clean energy and reforms taken in the last decade have helped shield the country from severe external shocks.

India is setting an ambitious goal to add another 500 GW of new non-fossil capacity over the next 10-11 years, he said at the inauguration of the Bharat Renewable Energy Summit & Expo.

"This target is somewhat difficult, but I have faith in the capability of my country; therefore, I say, we will do it!" Modi said. He also said that the impact of the recent crisis could have been much worse without these measures.



"If India had not invested in clean energy and created new systems for this over the past decade, then our crisis could have been much more severe than the rest of the world," he said.

The prime minister said recent global disruptions have shown the direct link between energy security and economic security, warning that continued over-reliance on fossil fuels will repeatedly disrupt the world economy. He said fossil fuel reserves are finite and concentrated in a few regions, making economies vulnerable to external disruptions. Clean energy, on the other hand, is accessible and affordable. "And we all know, the future of energy security lies in clean energy," he said. The prime minister's remarks come amid growing concerns over energy security and the impact of global disruptions on economies dependent on imported fossil fuels.

Manufacturing Activity Eases in Oct as New Order Growth Drops

Our Bureau

New Delhi: India's manufacturing activity moderated in October as growth in new orders and output slowed, although the sector continued to expand at a pace above its long-run average, according to a private survey released Monday.

Stronger demand from overseas markets, however, provided support, with export order growth reaching a six-month high. The HSBC Purchasing Managers Index (PMI), compiled by S&P Global, fell to 54.7 in October from 55.1 in September and 59.2 a year earlier. A reading above 50 indicates expansion, while one below that signals contraction.

"India's manufacturing PMI softened in October from the previous month but remained firmly in expansionary territory and above its long-run average," said Pranjul Bhandari, chief India economist at HSBC.

Business confidence weakened from September and remained below its long-run average, despite continued demand growth. Around 18% of manufacturers surveyed expected output to increase over the next 12 months, while the remaining anticipated no change.

Optimism among manufacturers was supported by fresh client enquiries and demand for industrial automation and technology solutions.

International demand pushed growth of new export orders to a six-month high

The survey highlighted a sustained improvement in demand, reflected in another sharp rise in new business. Manufacturers attributed the rise to favourable market conditions, new client acquisitions and successful marketing initiatives.

Export markets also contributed to the growth. Firms cited gains from Bangladesh, Canada, Indonesia, Nepal, Oman, Saudi Arabia, Sri Lanka, the UK, the US and the UAE.

"Strong international demand pushed growth of new export orders to a six-month high, supporting a robust rise in output," said Bhandari. Higher sales and new product launches encouraged manufacturers to increase production at a sharp pace, keeping output growth above its long-run average. However, the rate of expansion eased from September, largely due to slower growth among intermediate goods producers, although the segment continued to lead the expansion.

"Producers also increased input inventories to the greatest extent in eight months, building precautionary buffers to mitigate potential shortages and meet rising production requirements amid a volatile global environment," said Bhandari.

Meanwhile, cost pressures eased across all three broad segments of India's manufacturing sector. While manufacturers reported higher prices for several materials and energy, the overall rate of input cost inflation fell to its lowest since February.

Actor Mahesh Babu Invests in Shortgun Games, Backs Co's Indian Gaming IP

Shilpa Ranipeta

Hyderabad: Tollywood actor Mahesh Babu has picked up a minority stake in Mumbai-based gaming startup Shortgun Games for an undisclosed amount, backing the startup's ambition to build global PC gaming franchisee out of India.

The startup, founded by Jeet Chandan and Vidhit Mehta, is developing its flagship title, Project Takedown, a 10-15-hour action-adventure game set in a near-future Mumbai. The game, designed exclusively for PC and modern console platforms, including PlayStation 5 and Xbox Series X|S, is primarily targeted towards international audiences, including the US, Europe and Japan. The founders expect the game to launch by 2028-end.

Co building Project Takedown, an IP set in a near-future Mumbai, expected to launch by 2028-end

Mahesh Babu is one of the most popular actors of the Telugu film industry, who will next be seen in filmmaker SS Rajamouli's big-budget action adventure Varanasi, along with Priyanka Chopra Jonas, set for a global release in 2027.

"Indian cinema has already proven its global storytelling power, and this medium is the next logical frontier," Mahesh Babu told **ET**, adding that he will also work on building characters and immersive worlds, drawing on his experience through cinema, to help Shortgun develop a larger entertainment franchise.

Shortgun is looking to build more than a standalone game, with plans to extend successful gaming IPs into films, merchandise and other entertainment formats. The founders are targeting a billion-dollar company over the next five years, with ambitions to enter game publishing and invest in other gaming properties. The investment comes at a time when Indian gaming companies look to move beyond the country's predominantly mobile-led gaming market and build original premium PC and console intellectual property (IP) for global audiences.

Cloud Infra Provider Vultr Eyes 1 GW India Capacity by 2029

Co to hire thousands in network engineering and operations by March

Dia Rekhi

Chennai: US-based cloud infrastructure provider Vultr on Monday said it is targeting 600-megawatt (MW) of artificial intelligence (AI) infrastructure capacity in India by 2028 and gigawatt scale by 2029.

This comes as the company announced the launch of a 20 MW AI supercluster in Chennai, powered by AMD Instinct MI355X graphics processing units (GPUs), marking its largest such deployment in India.

"I would be disappointed if we don't have 600 megawatt live by 2028, and then get into gigawatt by 2029," Amit Rai, general manager – AI and enterprise Cloud at Vultr said while addressing the press. The company's chief marketing officer Kevin Cochrane said the company's expansion plans over the next two to three years would be an "order of magnitude greater" than its current deployment.

Further, the company said it has hired more than 100 people in India over the past three months and plans thousands of additional hires in network engineering and operations by March. It also added that the Chennai workforce could eventually reach 5,000 as the facility becomes operational and services expand.

Cochrane highlighted India's growing importance as a global centre for AI development and the country's engineering talent as a key driver of Vultr's investment in the market. He noted that India is moving beyond consuming AI technologies to actively building and developing AI applications for global markets.

On the Chennai investment, he emphasised the importance of bringing computing infrastructure closer to the communities driving innovation.

"India is emerging as a global centre for AI development and is moving beyond consuming AI technologies to actively building and developing AI applications for global markets. This engineering talent is a key driver of Vultr's investment in the market," he said.

The 20 MW supercompute cluster will have more than 10,000 AMD Instinct MI355X GPUs to support large-scale AI training and inference workloads.

Agri Cos' Inputs Sought to Improve Ease of Doing Biz

Shambhavi Anand

New Delhi: The government has begun consultations with agricultural companies, including seed manufacturers, fertiliser producers and exporters, to identify regulatory hurdles and improve ease of doing business in the sector.

Officials from Niti Aayog recently met representatives of the seed industry as the centre is looking to modernise decades-old regulatory frameworks governing seeds and fertilisers, while exploring new international markets through trade agreements and other initiatives to diversify and expand India's agricultural exports.

"Every state has their own procedure and requirements for testing and trials. This causes delay in launch of new products keeping farmers from new technologies," said a senior representative of the seed industry. They had earlier met representatives of the fertiliser industry to seeking suggestions on policy and procedural changes that could simplify business operations, reduce compliance burdens and improve competitiveness, people aware of the discussions said.

A key focus is the need to update the regulatory framework governing the sector. The Seeds Act, 1966, which governs the seed industry, is seen as increasingly out of step with changes in technology and the development of new seed varieties.

Fertiliser companies, have also flagged delays in regulatory approvals for innovative products, which can slow their introduction in the market and limit farmers' access to newer technologies.

Delhi Braces for AQI Spike Ahead of Diwali; GRAP II Kicks in

NEW DELHI: Delhi is bracing for its annual air apocalypse, with the average AQI hitting 324 on Monday evening, days ahead of Diwali, prompting the Commission for Air Quality Management to invoke Stage II measures under the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP). According to the air quality forecast provided by IMD/IITM, Delhi's overall air quality is likely to stay in the 'Very Poor' category in the coming days, the CAQM said, urging government agencies as well as citizens to take appropriate measures to address the air pollution menace. Our Bureau

Railways Orders 9,638 More Wagons

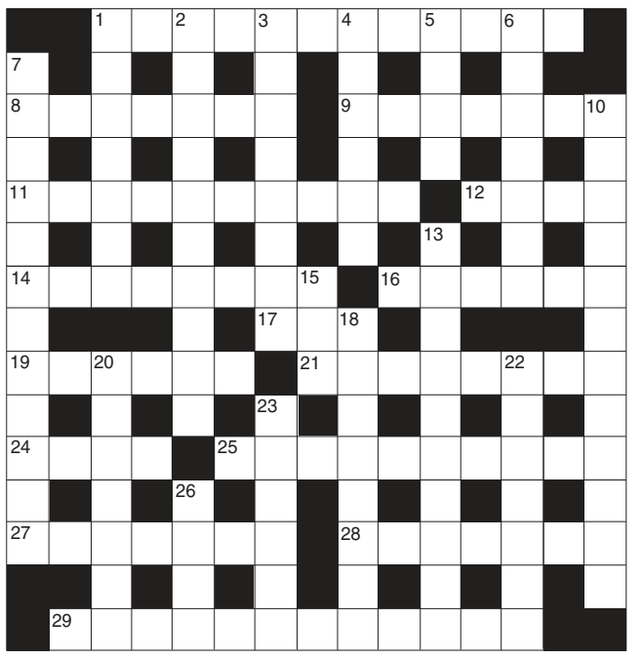
Twesh Mishra

New Delhi: Indian Railways has expanded existing wagon procurement contracts by 24.57%, placing additional orders for 9,638 wagons across five suppliers in a boost to freight-equipment manufacturers.

The Railway Board has issued incremental orders worth about ₹3,925.41 crore, officials said. "The increase comes through a 30% option clause in the existing contracts.

NON-SEQUITUR

Crossword 9746



ACROSS
1 Similar chap sadly accepting old narrow mindedness (12)
8 One managing issue at a later stage? (7)
9 Layer in fancy tart in total (7)
11 Greek expert has total sway finally in an elegant way (10)
12 Profit once more with leader absent (4)
14 Deflection of ball, maybe, upset choir etc. (8)
16 Turn upside down popular rifle principally kept by ex-soldier (6)
17 Recall fake person working in a hospital (3)
19 Contentious matter with Democrat is published (6)
21 Demonstrations for exams, say (8)
24 Devoted woman admitting love in part of speech (4)
25 Plum voices in broadcast are persistent (10)
27 Element shown shortly in middle of clip? (7)
28 Straight line, we hear, with U.S. money for male ruminant (7)
29 Work out trend on price in social facility (4-2,6)

DOWN
1 Quiet woman in charge lacking in imagination (7)
2 Spent less money to do with fashion around Switzerland and Spain (10)
3 Charlie in an excited state drank freely (8)
4 Slight group hosted by captains, ultimately (6)
5 Cite praise for titled figure (4)
6 Place is put up by art museum around university (7)
7 Dean's glaring about red. light, perhaps (6,6)
10 Thinly-cut pieces of meat amuse kittens at play (6,6)
13 Latin writer appearing in second episode (10)
15 Leading sum of money on reflection (3)
18 Cold sales worker linked to U.S. city pancake house (8)
20 Casual walk from uncle's partner in series (7)
22 Medical problem giving apprehension (7)
23 Popular area of grassy land (6)
26 Walk unevenly among slim paths (4)

SOLUTION TO No. 9745:
ACROSS: 6 Tristan da Cunha. **9** Amoeba. **10** Beverage. **11** Ill-fated. **13** Gauche. **15** Nearby. **17** Astern. **19** Abseil. **20** Abridged. **22** Concrete. **24** Granny. **26** Skirting boards.
DOWN: 1 Stumbling block. **2** Bile. **3** Strait. **4** Las Vegas. **5** Purr. **7** Nobody.**8** Highhandedness. **12** Flake. **14** Upend. **16** Bulletin. **18** Bad egg. **21** Region. **23** Cork. **25** Awry.

©The Daily Mail

HIDATO

FIND THE PATH - SOLVE THE PUZZLE

Complete the grid so that numbers 1 - 81 connect horizontally, vertically or diagonally:

61		55		46				
59		53			44	37		
								39
64				51			35	
71		68		26	25	23	34	
	66					22	20	
	74			3	8		19	
77	76		4	1		12		18
			81					

www.hidato.com Dif. ★★★½☆

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Yesterday's puzzle solution.

Hidato Sol. 2/19

58	59	54	53	52	63	67	68	72	71
57	55	60	51	62	64	65	66	69	70
56	47	50	61						
48	49	46	45						
32	31	30	36	44	43	42	41		
33	34	35	29	37	38	39	40		
23	24	26	28						
22	25	1	27						
21	19	17	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
20	18	16	15	14	13	12	11	10	9

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7 LITTLE WORDS

Find the 7 words to match the 7 clues. The numbers in parentheses represent the number of letters in each solution. Each letter combination can be used only once, but all letter combinations will be necessary to complete the puzzle.

CLUES	SOLUTIONS
1 one-ups (7)	
2 hands, colloquially (5)	
3 showed a bias (6)	
4 most mirthless (8)	
5 spice found in goulash (7)	
6 financial administrators (7)	
7 former MLB knuckleballer Tim (9)	

GR BE ST TTS KA
BUR PAP RS ELD IM
TTE WAK SA ME LEA
RS MI RI NED EFI

Yesterday's Answers: 1. AFORE 2. CRESTS 3. PIQUING 4. SUNDIALS 5. ABDUL 6. OPULENTLY 7. PRECISION 12/14

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BENGALURU, TUESDAY, 3 NOVEMBER 2026

SMART INVESTING

CD Rates Soar on Tight Liquidity, Likely to Head Higher

RENEWED DOLLAR DEMAND

Rupee Ends Flat at 94.90 Despite Fall in Oil Prices

Our Bureau

Mumbai: The Indian rupee closed nearly flat on Monday, giving up early gains as traders stayed cautious ahead of Tuesday's US midterm elections. The rupee closed at 94.90 on Monday against 94.95 close on Friday. The rupee failed to recover despite lower oil prices and a weaker dollar, traders said. Brent crude futures fell 4.2%, to $108.64 a barrel, after being at a six-month high through the previous week.

"The sharp recovery of nearly 35 paise from the day's low indicates renewed dollar demand at lower levels. The move also suggests that the rupee is facing resistance in sustaining its gains, with traders remaining cautious amid global dollar movements and crude oil price fluctuations," said Anil Bhansali, head of treasury, Finrex Treasury Advisors.

The rupee traded between 95.03 and 94.69 on Monday. The dollar index was at 101.5, from 101.7 a day ago, while FPIs were net buyers of ₹3,114 crore in the local equities market, underpinning the rupee. Outlook on oil, however, remains one of scepticism. Goldman Sachs raised its oil price forecasts on Sunday due to elevated supply risks and said Brent could jump to $140 in 2027.

STOCK SURGES 11.6% ON Q2 FIREWORKS

RIL Brings in an Early Diwali With Biggest Gain in 6 Years

Himadri Buch

Mumbai: Reliance Industries, India's largest company by market value, soared 11.6% on Monday, its biggest single-day gain in six-and-a-half years, to ₹1,299 after reporting better-than-expected September-quarter earnings.

The rally added ₹1.83 lakh crore to the conglomerate's market value, taking it to ₹17.57 lakh crore.

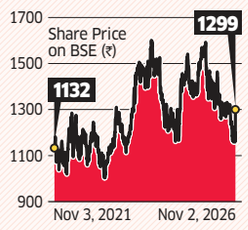
The surge on Monday, the sharpest in a day since April 2020 and the third highest single-day gain in 10 years, prompted analysts to turn more positive on the stock's near-term outlook.

"Reliance has witnessed a breakout from its recent consolidation phase, accompanied by significant volumes, indicating a potential shift in chart structure and early signs of technical bottom formation," said Vatsal Bhuva, technical analyst at LKP Securities.

Big Days
Reliance Industries

Date	Mcap	1 Day Chg	% Change
Nov 2, 2026	17,57,877	1,83,298	11.6
Jan 29, 2024	19,59,442	1,25,706	6.8
June 3, 2024	20,44,084	1,09,367	5.6

Figures in ₹ crore. Compiled by: **ETIntelligence.com**



In the near term, the stock could move towards its previous swing high in the ₹1,320-1,330 zone, he said, adding that a decisive breakout above this level would provide stronger confirmation of a trend reversal.

Reliance emerged as the top gainer on the Nifty and the biggest contributor to the benchmark index's advance, while also leading trading volumes on both NSE and BSE. "RIL reported a strong set of 2QFY27 results on the back of strong O2C performance and in-line performance of the recently listed Jio Platforms business," said Sunny Agrawal, head of fundamental research at SBI Securities.

Agrawal said the stock was trading at reasonable valuations and likely attracted fresh institutional buying. Part of Monday's rally may also have been driven by short covering, he said.

Brokerage Jefferies said the stock traded 2 standard deviation (SD) below the long-term average Enterprise Value/Earnings Before Interest, Tax, Depreciation, and Amortisation (EV/Ebitda), suggesting maximum pessimism.

"Earnings upgrades and a recovery in retail growth to mid-teens should re-rate the stock," said Jefferies, while maintaining its buy rating and price target of ₹1,710 for September 2028. Agrawal recommended the stock from a medium- to long-term perspective, citing strong operating performance and attractive valuations.

DECLINE HIGHEST IN BANKING & IT SECTORS

Low and Lower: FPI Holdings in Top 100 Cos Continue to Fall

Repricing of Prospects
FPI Stake (%)

Company Name	As of 30 Sep 2026	Prev Date	As on Sep 2024*
Infosys	25.1	Lowest since Mar 2001	30.1
Godrej Consumer	11.0	Lowest since Sep 2002	22.0
Jindal Steel	8.8	Lowest since Dec 2003	12.2
Maruti Suzuki India	12.4	Lowest since Sep 2004	17.7
Dr Reddys Labs	20.3	Lowest since Sep 2005	27.5
Adani Enterprises	10.7	Lowest since Sep 2007	11.3
HCL Technologies	15.3	Lowest since Sep 2007	18.7
TCS	9.0	Lowest since Sep 2007	12.7
DLF	11.4	Lowest since Mar 2009	16.7
Reliance Industries	16.2	Lowest since Mar 2009	20.7
Bajaj Holdings & Inv	9.6	Lowest since Mar 2010	10.9
UltraTech Cement	12.2	Lowest since Sep 2010	18.0
Kotak Bank	24.7	Lowest since Dec 2010	31.8
Axis Bank	38.1	Lowest since Dec 2012	49.4
Trent	15.3	Lowest since Mar 2014	26.6

*FPI started selling in late Sep 2024. Compiled by: **ETIntelligence.com**

Small & Mid-cap Funds Remain Top Bets for Investors

Grab over 40% of equity Inflows ● Large caps lose more steam ● Higher returns said to be driving strong inflows

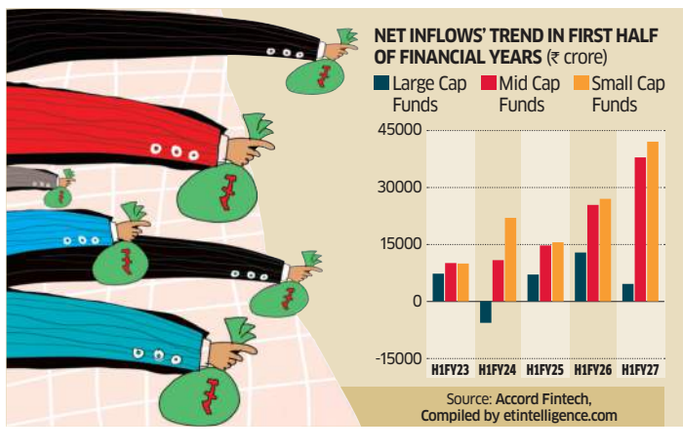
Sachin Kumar

ET Intelligence Group: Investors poured ₹38,043 crore into mid-cap funds in the first half of FY27, taking their share of total equity inflows to a five-year high of 20%, according to Accord Fintech data. Small-cap funds also remained in favour, attracting ₹42,212 crore and accounting for 22.6% of equity inflows, their highest share since first half of FY24. In contrast, large-cap funds continued to lose steam, attracting just ₹4,575 crore and contributing a mere 2% to total equity inflows.

Higher returns have driven the strong inflows into small- and mid-cap funds. In the first half of FY27, the BSE 150 MidCap Index rose 1,877 points, or 13%, while the BSE 250 SmallCap Index gained 1,349 points, or 24%. In contrast, the BSE 100 advanced 853 points, or 3.6%, and the Sensex rose just 533 points, or 0.7%.

Experts say strong inflows into mid- and small-cap funds do not necessarily mean their valuations are becoming expensive. What matters more is whether corporate earnings are growing fast enough to justify stock prices.

"Earnings are a vital part of valuations while flows have tended to chase returns with a lag. The last two years show that despite flows into mid and small caps, multiples have come down, not gone up," Hari Shyamsunder, VP & Senior Institutional Portfolio Manager-India Equities, Templeton Global Investments told **ET**.



Nifty Midcap 150 forward Price to Earnings (P/E) multiple is around 22.5x now against about 36x in September 2024 because earnings have grown faster than prices, he added.

Higher inflows have also raised the share of small and mid cap funds in equity asstes under management (AUM). The combined net AUM of small and mid cap funds increased nearly 24% year-on-year to ₹9.8 lakh crore as of September 2026, taking their share in equity AUM to 26% from 23.5% a year earlier. Total equity AUM increased nearly 12% to ₹33.7 lakh crore.

Ravindra Sonavane & Shailesh Kadam

Mumbai: Overseas investors' holdings in nearly 70% of India's top 100 companies are at multi-year lows amid unabated selling of blue-chip stocks over the past two years, reflecting diminished appetite for local equities.

The decline in foreign ownership has been broad-based but has been more pronounced in the largest companies, especially banks and information technology.

Godrej Consumer Products, Jindal Steel, Maruti Suzuki, Dr Reddy's Laboratories, Adani Enterprises, HCL Technologies and Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) saw foreign ownership fall to levels not seen in more than two decades.

Holdings in another 10 companies, including DLF, Reliance Industries, Bajaj Holdings & Investment, UltraTech Cement, Kotak Mahindra Bank, Axis Bank, Trent, Eicher Motors, Britannia Industries and Shriram Finance, are at more than 15-year lows.

The decline in foreign ownership reflects a repricing of growth prospects as global investors shifted allocations towards markets offering stronger earnings growth, according to Rahul Bhutoria, director and co-founder of Valtrust Capital, a New Delhi-based portfolio manager.

"This is not an exit from India; it is a repricing of where growth sits," he said.

India's weight in the MSCI Emerging Markets index has declined from about 20% at its 2024 peak to roughly 11%, while Taiwan and South Korea together now account for nearly half the index as global investors chase the artificial intelligence (AI) cycle.

▸▸ www.economictimes.com

Greater Involvement

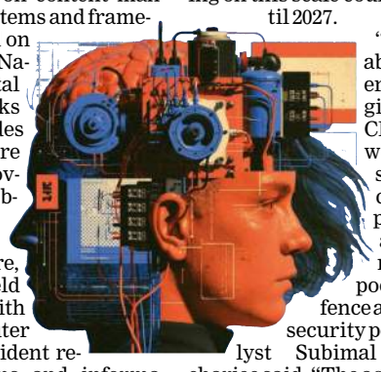
▸▸ From Page 1

Hackers targeting the vulnerabilities millions of times led to governments including the US, UK, France, Germany and Japan taking down public websites. PHP powers 69.3% of websites worldwide.

"Proposals to give the national agency more powers to issue binding directives to quickly meet cybersecurity crises have been discussed by policymakers earlier as well. But the latest PHP crisis has brought it to the fore," the official said.

In India, CERT-In advised organisations to expeditiously apply security patches, but officials indicated this could not ensure complete compliance from government agencies running myriad, potentially affected, websites.

Thousands of state government portals, district administration websites, municipal corporation services and public grievance redressal systems in India have historically relied on content management systems and frameworks based on PHP. The National Portal of India links and provides access to more than 6,700 government websites.



Following the PHP scare, CERT-In held meetings with state computer security incident response teams and information technology departments, and prioritised critical areas such as health- and banking-related websites for patching, ET reported last week. However, experts warned that for India, the bigger problem was that legacy bank, telecom, power and even direct-to-consumer applications were running on older PHP versions, which have no fix, and patching on this scale could run until 2027.

"Enforceable powers being given to CERT-In will help since incident reporting also remains poor," defence and cybersecurity policy analyst Subimal Bhattacharjee said. "The agency also needs significant budgetary and personnel enhancements. There also needs to be greater harmonisation in the way various government agencies and ministries coordinate on cybersecurity activities, and CERT-In needs to have greater involvement."

Officials expect to discuss more ways to strengthen India's public sector cyber capabilities after the release of the consultation paper on AI regulation, which the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) is working on.

"CERT-In mandates empanelled security audits for government portals before they are launched. But these static checks may fail to catch zero-day flaws which are increasingly being unearthed by frontier AI models," said one of the officials. "There is a need to see if continuous, automated vulnerability disclosure programmes should be run across government domains."

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com

Smaller-ticket Purchases

▸▸ From Page 1

Jewellers are reporting an improvement in store footfalls, with demand picking up for gold jewellery as well as silver coins and articles. Advance bookings for the wedding season are also gathering pace, indicating that some of the demand deferred during the sharp price rally is returning to the market.

"The recent softening in gold and silver prices, coming just ahead of Dhanteras, is a welcome development for customers who had been waiting for a more comfortable point to make their festive purchases," said Ramesh Kalyanaraman, executive director of Kalyan Jewellers. "We saw good momentum over the weekend as footfalls picked up significantly across our showrooms, with gold sales gaining traction," he said.

The fall in price is influencing the decision of some consumers on the weight and design of jewellery, according to Vipul Shah, executive director of Aura Jewels.

"With improved affordability, consumers have greater flexibility to explore a wider range of designs, consider slightly higher-weight jewellery or make more considered purchases within their existing budgets," said Shah, who expects wedding-related buying to remain a key demand driver.

Still, with the price remaining elevated compared with historic levels, consumers are increasingly looking at lightweight jewellery, lower-karat gold and smaller-ticket purchases to manage their budgets, said jewellers.

Kalyanaraman said lightweight and 18-karat collections were helping customers opt for traditional designs at more accessible price points.

JEWELLERS SEE REVIVAL

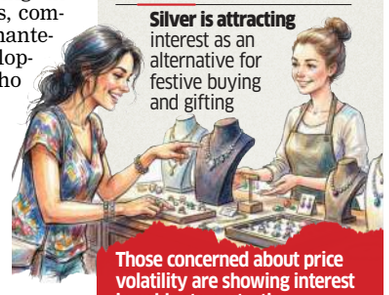
Jewellers reporting an improvement in store footfalls, with demand picking up for gold jewellery as well as silver coins

Advance bookings for wedding season are also gathering pace

FESTIVE BUYING TRENDS

There is demand for both natural and lab-grown diamond jewellery, particularly in the ₹1.5 lakh to ₹3 lakh range

Silver is attracting interest as an alternative for festive buying and gifting



Those concerned about price volatility are showing interest in gold rate protection schemes, said jewellers

Experts Suggest Maintaining Caution

▸▸ From Page 1

This was led by a 5.4% rise in GAIL, while upstream oil companies advanced 3.6%. Metals and cement stocks also witnessed strong buying, rising 3% each. Tata Steel gained nearly 6%.

"The core story is oil as Brent fell about 3% to near $110 as US-Iran peace talks took some of the war premium out of crude," said Lokesh Manik, senior research analyst at Vallum Capital. "For an economy that imports most of its oil, that means relief on the current account, input costs and margins and with crude high and foreign money cautious, investors are paying for earnings certainty and liquidity. The success of Jio has also added a feather in Reliance's cap," Manik said.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, declined around 3% to $110 per barrel, easing from a six-month high amid hopes of a diplomatic breakthrough. Iranian and Qatari officials held discussions for the third consecutive day to push for an agreement to end the US-Israeli war on Iran.

Broader markets gained on Monday, with Nifty Midcap 150 and Smallcap 250 indices rising 1.2% and 1.3%, respectively.

Asian markets traded higher — South Korea's Kospi rising 2.2%, China's Shanghai Composite gaining 1% and Hong Kong's Hang Seng up 0.4%.

Brokerages, though, cautioned against interpreting Monday's gains as a definitive reversal of the recent volatility.

Improving foreign institutional investor buying and wider participation across sectors and broader markets were additional positives, according to Ajit Mishra, senior vice-president, research, Religare Broking. However, sustaining the recovery would require continued institutional inflows, further moderation in crude prices and broader earnings support.

Mishra advised investors to use the improving sentiment to selectively accumulate quality stocks rather than chase sharp intraday gains.

Foreign portfolio investors net bought equities worth ₹3,114 crore on Monday, while domestic institutional investors net sold equities worth ₹392 crore.

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*This data includes customers of other group companies, including the Mutual Fund business. | Data as on June 2026.

Wealth Management | Asset Management | Alternates | Private Wealth | Institutional Equities | Investment Banking | Home Finance

Source: The data is as per Press Release & Investor(s)/Analyst(s) Presentation for Financial Performance for Q1 FY 2026-27 submitted to BSE Limited and NSE Limited.
Link of the press release: https://nsearchives.nseindia.com/corporate/MOTILALOFS_23072026162429_Intimation_PressRelease_InvestorPresentation.pdf

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CYBER FRAUD

Spandana Flags ₹7.8-cr Unauthorised Transactions

Our Bureau

Kolkata | Mumbai: Spandana Sphoorty has identified a cyber fraud involving unauthorised transactions totalling ₹7.8 crore debited from one of its bank accounts to multiple beneficiaries.

The transactions took place Sunday, the microfinance company said in a stock exchange filing.

A senior official said that the company took insurance cover against cyber fraud and a claim is being filed with the insurance company.

The co which has a ₹11-13 crore cyber cover from HDFC Ergo is filing a claim

Sources in the know said that Spandana took an insurance cover from HDFC Ergo for ₹11-13 crore. "There are deductibles, too. So, the initial hit will be borne by Spandana," said a person aware of the terms.

Net retention on the insurer is less than 20-25% as the products are mostly reinsured.

Spandana meanwhile said that it stopped the affected services the moment it identified the unauthorised dealings. "The matter has been reported to the bank with a request for reversal of the transactions, freezing of the beneficiary accounts and a detailed investigation," the company said.

"We are investigating how it happened and reviewing our processes," the official said.

ON THE MOVE Liquidity surplus moderates to an average ₹2.3 lakh crore in October from ₹7.7 lakh crore in September; Rising T-bill yields, rate-hike expectations add to pressure

Above 8% CD Rates Soar on Tight Liquidity, Likely to Head Higher

Rozebud Gonsalves

Mumbai: One-year certificate of deposit (CD) rates at public-sector banks have risen above 8% in recent days, amid tight liquidity, elevated treasury-bill yields, and expectations of further increases in policy rates to help restrain inflation.

Comparable CD rates had fallen to around 6.6% in August, when FCNR (B) inflows left the banking system awash with liquidity.

Banking system liquidity moderated to a daily average surplus of ₹2.3 lakh crore in October, after a daily average of ₹7.7 lakh crore in September. This shortage of funds has increased demand for liquidity, prompting CD issuances to pick up.

Banks issued ₹19,505 crore CDs in the fortnight ending August 31. Issuances increased to ₹74,607 crore by September 30 and ₹45,781 crore by October 15, latest data shows.

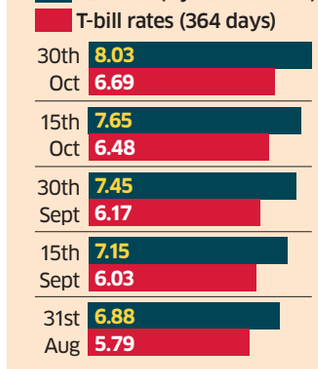
"CD rates are amongst other things a function of the underlying risk-free rate, which is the equivalent tenor T-bill. Rates of T-bills shot up 20-25 bps at the last auction and additionally there is demand coming in because of the liquidity squeeze," said Rajeev Pawar, head of treasury, Ujjivan Small Finance Bank.

Yields on treasury bills—bonds with a tenure of less than one year—jumped to their highest level in nearly two years. The 364-day T-bill yield was at 6.69%, 20 basis points higher than its previous successful auction, RBI data showed. CD rates are priced at a spread from its corresponding T-bill rate.

"The increase in short term rates is not in isolation with just a liquidity deficit, this is also a function of rate hikes being priced in. The rate trajectory is skewed to the upper side and markets are preparing for a rate hike," said Gopal Tripathi, head of treasury, Jana Small Finance Bank.

"Things are volatile, so I can say with some certainty that this is not the peak of CD rates," Tripathi said.

The Funding Pinch



SOURCE: Crest Finserv, RBI

Banks Begin to Raise Deposit Rates with Demand Strong

Mumbai: About a month after the central bank raised policy rates for the first time in four years, domestic banks are starting to raise deposit rates—albeit marginally-as liquidity shrinks and demand for credit surges through the busy season.

Bank of India (BoI) is the latest lender to raise its deposit rates which, unlike external benchmark-linked lending rates, would take time to head north despite the early-October start to the hardening cycle by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). On Monday, BoI increased its deposit rates for maturities between one and below three years by 10 to 35 basis points, becoming the second bank in the current cycle to hike rates.

One basis point is 0.01 percentage point.

After the hike, one year deposit less than ₹3 crore will earn 6.60% interest, up from 6.50%, while one year to less than two years will earn 6.70% interest, up from 6.50%. The bank has also introduced a special 500-day deposit, which will earn 6.85%, from 6.50% earlier.

"The hike in deposit rates reflects higher cost of deposits in the system. Bulk deposit rates have gone up and the bank also has to adjust the liability profile in line with the higher interest rates," said a senior BoI executive. "On the whole, liquidity in the banking system has tightened as the advantages from the unprecedented inflows from the FCNR (B) scheme have started waning."

Banking system liquidity has come off from a peak of more than ₹11 lakh crore early September to about ₹1.96 lakh crore currently as a result of bond sales and variable reverse repo auctions. The tightening in liquidity can be noticed in the higher rates banks are paying in the certificate of deposit (CD) market, which have increased to over 8% for the first time since early 2023, reflecting tighter systemic liquidity. Indian Bank had already hiked rates in select tenures late last month on two special term deposits of 555 days and 777 days. — **Joel Rebello**

MUTHOOT FIN MD CITES LENDING RULE CHANGES

'NPA Rise Does Not Signify Stress in Gold Loan Industry'

Atmadip Ray

Kolkata: India's largest gold loan company Muthoot Finance said a recent rise in bad loans is due to structural changes in lending rules and is not a reflection of underlying stress.

"Borrowers will take a little while to understand the new structure," Alexander George Muthoot, managing director told **ET**. "This does not signify any stress in the industry."

Muthoot termed the current scenario as "only a transition phase where people have to just get used to this kind of a new way of servicing the loan which was not there in the past." "The payment will be regularised over a few quarters," he said, speaking in one of his first media interactions since assuming charge on October 1.

Muthoot Finance reported a sharp rise in gross non-performing assets ratio to 3.9% at the end of September from 2.3% three months prior.

Among other non-bank lenders, Bajaj Finance reported an increase in Stage 2 and 3 assets to 2% from 1.9% in the June quarter. The company attributed it to the transitional phase and emphasised that it won't impact its credit cost. Shriram Finance too saw its gross Stage 3 gold loan assets rising to 3.1% from 2.6% over the same period.

The Reserve Bank of India told lenders across the spectrum to switch to equated monthly instalments or interest only monthly payments for more than 12-month loans. Bullet repayment loans where principal and interest are paid in lump sum at the end of the tenure are capped for a maximum one-year period. Automatic rollover of loans aren't allowed anymore for borrowings up to one-year maturity. The new rules became effective from April 1.

"It's too early to make an assessment on the new regulation," said Muthoot. "Let's see how things progress, probably it will lead to better credit discipline."

He said the company maintains an average loan-to value ratio of 65%, providing it a buffer in case of repayment failures by borrowers after a certain period.

If we have to remove NPAs, we can easily auction this gold, recover our principal and interest

ALEXANDER GEORGE MUTHOOT
MD, Muthoot Finance

"If we have to remove NPAs, we can easily auction this gold, recover our principal and interest," he said. "But we always ensure that we use auctions as a last resort when everything else fails. About 98% of our customers pay their interest on time."

Meanwhile, taking advantage of easy branch opening norms, Muthoot with 5,230 branches across India has accelerated the pace of physical expansion. It opened 262 branches in the first half of FY27, which it plans to match in the fiscal second half. RBI said large gold loan companies don't need to take prior approval before opening new branches.

Muthoot Finance had 204 tonnes of pledged gold at the end of September, up from 196 tonnes six months prior. Assets under management surged 42% year-on-year to ₹1.9 lakh crore, including gold loans of ₹1.8 lakh crore.

Indians are estimated to have monetised 1,500-2,000 tonnes of gold, while a Morgan Stanley report in 2025 estimated the country's total household wealth in gold at around 34,600 tonnes.

Jubilant Pharmova to Raise ₹800 cr via Maiden Bond Issue

Mumbai: Jubilant Pharmova, the pharmaceutical arm of the multi-billion dollar chemicals-to-quick service restaurants conglomerate Jubilant Bhartia Group, is raising ₹800 crore in fresh debt through its maiden bond issue in the local market, according to people familiar with the matter. The funds include a base issue of ₹400 crore and an equal greenshoe option, and they are likely to be used for the company's capital expenditure purposes and future expansion plans, the people said.

"This is the first time the company is tapping the local bond market. The bonds will carry a tenure of three years and the indicative pricing for the securities is around 8.50%," said one of the persons, who did not wish to be identified. — **Joel Rebello**

NEW CAPITAL AVENUE Sebi issues frameworks for issue of depository receipts backed by units

REITs, InvITs can Now Tap Overseas Investors Taking the GIFT City Route

Our Bureau

Mumbai: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) on Monday issued frameworks allowing real estate investment trusts (REITs) and infrastructure investment trusts (InvITs) to issue depository receipts (DRs) backed by their units, enabling them to tap overseas investors through international exchanges in GIFT City.

The regulator said REITs and InvITs can issue fresh units or facilitate the transfer of existing units held by investors for issuing DRs.

The receipts, denominated in foreign currency, can be listed on India International Exchange and NSE International Exchange in the International Financial Services Centre (IFSC).

The move provides the trusts with an additional avenue to access foreign capital and gives overseas investors another route to gain exposure to India's real estate and infrastructure assets.

Sebi said any fresh issue of DRs would require approval from unitholders, with at least 75% of the votes cast in favour.

The requirement will not apply where a trust undertakes an initial public offering alongside a simultaneous DR issuance and listing on an international exchange.

Sebi said REIT and InvIT managers would have to appoint a merchant banker to oversee compliance with issuance requirements

Subsequent offerings within the overall limit approved by unitholders will also not require fresh approval, it said.

The regulator has prescribed eligibility conditions for the trusts and existing unitholders participating in the exercise. The REIT or InvIT, its directors, promoters and partners, as well as unitholders transferring units, must not be debarred from accessing the capital markets, classified as wilful defaulters or designated as fugitive economic offenders.

DR holders and their beneficial owners cannot be residents of the country.

The regulator said REIT and InvIT managers would have to appoint a merchant banker to oversee compliance with issuance requirements. The merchant banker's compliance report must be placed before the manager's board.

Sebi has also clarified that units deposited with a domestic custodian for issuing DRs will be treated as non-public unitholding while calculating the minimum public unitholding requirement.

Further, the price of units underlying DRs cannot be lower than the corresponding price applicable to domestic investors.

Any public disclosures made by the trusts on international exchanges must also be filed with local stock exchanges within 24 hours.

The new rules will come into effect immediately.

In a separate circular, the regulator eased offer for sale (OFS) norms for illiquid privately listed infrastructure investment trusts (InvITs), reducing the cooling-off period to eight weeks to make it easier for them to sell their units.

Sebi said OFS transactions involving privately listed InvITs will remain open for only one day, or T day. It has also exempted such offerings from provisions relating to retail investors under the existing OFS framework.

Tech Picks | AJIT MISHRA, SVP- Research | Religare Broking

ADANIPORTS — BUY, TARGET ₹1,980
Seeing consolidation in a range around its record high. Likely to resume the uptrend soon. Accumulate.
LAST CLOSE ₹1,846 | STOP LOSS ₹1,770

GAIL — BUY, TARGET ₹188
Strong rebound after reclaiming its long term moving averages. Expect steady up move.
LAST CLOSE ₹176.2 | STOP LOSS ₹170

ZYDUSLIFE — BUY, TARGET ₹1,390
Noticeable strength in the pharma pack and stock is trading in sync with move. Set for a new record high.
LAST CLOSE ₹1,238 | STOP LOSS ₹1,160

POLICYBZR — SELL, TARGET ₹810
Witnessing down trend continuation after the marginal consolidation. Maintain bearish stance.
LAST CLOSE ₹926.9 | STOP LOSS ₹985

China to Expand Stock Support Tools to Stabilise Market

REVIVAL PUSH PBOC cuts relending rate to 1%, lowers swap fees and expands participation to shore up investor confidence

Bloomberg

China will encourage financial institutions to make fuller use of two stock support tools and optimise their terms, as authorities step up efforts to bolster market stability and confidence. The People's Bank of China said it will conduct operations under its swap facility for securities firms, funds and insurers when appropriate. It will also increase the number of participating institutions and moderately lower swap fees, the central bank said in a statement on Monday following a meeting with financial regulators and institutions.

Separately, it will cut the rate on its relending facility for share buybacks and stake increases to 1% from 1.25%, make the program permanent and encourage banks to increase lending, the PBOC said.

The two tools were introduced in October 2024 as Beijing sought to shore up the stock market. The relending facility provides low-cost central bank funding to banks for loans financing share buybacks and stake increases by listed companies and major shareholders.

The China Securities Regulatory Commission said in a separate statement that a third round of swap operations will begin in coming days, with 31 securities and fund firms approved to participate and applying for more than 100 billion yuan of quotas. The regulator also plans to broaden the coverage of the relending program, including by encouraging more major index constituents and leading technology companies to participate.

The CSRC also plans to ease share buyback rules, including allowing companies to repurchase shares when their stock falls below the IPO price and requiring companies with excess fundraising proceeds to conduct buybacks when market support conditions are triggered. It will also study changes to margin-financing requirements to moderately increase financing capacity and improve market liquidity.

Chinese shares have been mired in a slump since the summer amid a weak economy and doubts over AI earnings. The CSI 300 Index fell 8.5% in October, its worst monthly decline in more than a decade, and dropped for a record 12 straight weeks through Friday.

About 440 billion yuan ($66.2 billion) of loans supporting share buybacks and stake increases have been contracted, with more than 280 billion yuan disbursed, according to the central bank. The outstanding balance of the swap facility is 105 billion yuan.

Fusion Fin Q2 Net at ₹87 crore

Kolkata: Microfinance company Fusion Finance earned a net profit of ₹86.5 crore for the second quarter against ₹62.4 crore in the first quarter and a ₹22.1 crore loss in the year-ago period.

The lender managed to bring down the gross non-performing assets ratio to 1.6% at the end of September, improving about 301 basis points year-on-year (YoY), while it grew assets under management 14% to ₹8,007 crore.

Fusion's net interest margin (NIM) improved to 12.5%, expanding 167 bps YoY. Its total income rose about 12% YoY at ₹486 crore while pre-provision operating profit surged 40% at ₹125 crore. Fusion expects faster business expansion going forwards. "We expect growth momentum to improve in Q3 and remain committed to our medium-term AUM growth ambition of 20–25%," MD, Sanjay Garyali said. **Our Bureau**

Market Intelligence Powered By: ETIG Database www.etintelligence.com

MARKET SNAPSHOT

	SENSEX	NIFTY
Open	75178.24	23222.30
High	75692.78	23440.80
Low	74978.12	23207.05
Close	75692.78	23440.80
Change(Abs)	1233.25	387.70
52-Wk High	(Dec 1)86159.02	(Jan 5)26373.20
52-Wk Low	(Oct 1)71292.88	(Oct 8)22179.90
3-Yr High	(Dec 1,25)86159.02	(Jan 5,26)26373.20
3-Yr Low	(Nov 3,23)64275.39	(Nov 3,23)19210.90

TURNOVER (Turnover in ₹ Crore; Shares & Trades in Lakhs)

	BSE				NSE		
Date	Turn	Shares	Trades		Turn	Shares	Trades
2/11	9049	5561	36.95		116328	51615	434.42
30/10	9343	6287	40.20		120852	64152	437.94
29/10	10389	5152	37.87		117989	48621	419.91
28/10	9791	4554	43.37		128964	45674	444.59
27/10	9494	4840	35.37		119872	54498	424.95

ADVANCE & DECLINE

BSE (Number of traded scrips)	'A'	'B'	Others	Total	NSE Total
Advances	558	1247	1009	2814	2313
Declines	143	568	986	1697	1081
Unchanged	1	23	156	180	60
Total	702	1838	2151	4691	3454

HIGHS & LOWS

BSE (Number of scrips)	'A'	'B'	Others	Total	NSE Total
52WK High	17	20	69	106	57
52WK Low	23	67	110	200	118
All High	9	15	31	55	37
All Low	1	22	26	49	53

FII ACTIVITY (₹ Cr.)

	EQUITY			DEBT		
Date	Buy	Sell	Net	Buy	Sell	Net
30/10	21473	17015	4458	586	1134	-548
29/10	13636	14439	-803	261	286	-25
28/10	19096	16972	2124	1563	51	1512
27/10	30869	20285	10584	1838	1167	671
26/10	10094	11057	-964	847	14	833
Tot Oct	321819	342973	-21153	15852	8396	7457
Total 2026	3392474	3674744	-282270	188283	129536	58747

MF ACTIVITY (₹ Cr.)

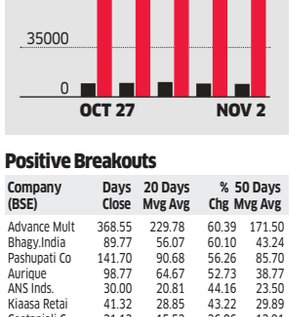
	EQUITY			DEBT		
Date	Buy	Sell	Net	Buy	Sell	Net
23/10	15209	12406	2802	20320	29940	-9620
22/10	13006	11180	1827	13678	27374	-13696
21/10	11340	10661	679	15858	27751	-11893
19/10	10501	7303	3198	10624	11011	-387
16/10	13331	16706	-3374	15118	19215	-4097
Tot Oct	192858	149070	43787	214183	255917	-41734
Total 2026	2937120	2467449	469671	3394297	4044845	-650548

52 WEEK AT NSE

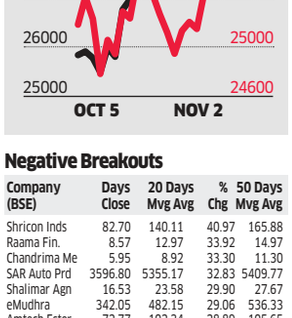
HIGH	
21st Cen.Mgm	60.71
63 Moons Tec	981.85
ABSL MSCI(I	28.37
*Acutaas Chem	4045.30
*Algoquant F	80.19
*Alivus Life	1505.00
*Anand Rathi	2297.00
*Assam Entrad	890.95
*Ather Energy	1790.00
*Bhagy.India	89.77
Capital Infr	80.10
*Coforge	2112.20
*Divi's Lab	9990.00
DS Kulkarni	37.15
Durlax Top S	79.20
*Edel.N1D Li	1055.51
Eternal	348.35
*Gretex Corp.	777.50
Global Educa	147.15
*HP Telecom	501.00
Indegene	638.00
Indian Hotel	830.80
Intrasoft Tc	119.00
*Kotak Mah.Bk	465.95
*Krishana Pho	236.43
*Laurus Labs	2441.90
*Zer.Nif1DLiq	116.71
MIRAE N1DRL	1110.71
*Shriram1DLR	1128.64
*Vaibhav Vyap	58.90
*Sri Lotus De	252.40
Mangalam Cem	896.40
*Madhya Bhara	188.30
*Menon Bearin	331.40
*Milkfood	99.50
*NINtec Systm	966.00
*Nirlon	661.95
*Nitin Spin.	680.00
FSN E-Comm.	356.50
*Om Freight F	127.99
Oriental Hot	164.65
*Pashupati Co	141.98
PowerGrid In	105.36
Piramal Ph.	243.20
PVR Inox	1531.00
Quintegra So	3.22
*Ratnaveer Pr	387.90
*Rama Tele	109.00
Sabar Flex	9.75
*Shreeji Ship	883.50
*Shree Pushka	633.00
*Shukra Pharm	82.28
*Sona BLW Pre	911.25
*Srinibas Pra	213.90
*Leela Palace	683.00
UY Fincorp	31.30
*Vinsys IT	629.80
Zydus Life	1254.20
LOW	
Aadhar Hsg.F	416.05
ABC Inds.	150.00
*Addi Inds.	61.00
*Advik Cap.	0.72
*Agni Green P	12.80
*AO Silver ET	6.79
*A-One Steels	349.85
Atul Auto	365.60
Anthony Wast	273.05
*Axtel Inds.	373.90
*Sh.Tirupati	18.70
UTI Nif.Bank	56.46
BEW Engg.	42.10
Birla Corp.	756.05
Blue Chip (I	1.50
Borosil Ren.	369.00
Capacite Inf	144.20
Consol.Const	10.20
*Ceinsys Tech	598.50
*Cerebra Inte	2.25
*CMI	2.05
Colgate	1563.90
CS CPSE ET G	84.10
*Cravatex	263.00
*Crizac	129.90
Deccan Cem.	465.00
*Deccan Trans	14.75
*Dhabriya Pol	421.20
*Digitide Sol	62.60
*Empire Inds.	917.55
*EPACk Dura.	149.00
Escorts Kubo	2411.60
*Fut.Entp(DVR	1.80
Glob.Spirits	660.10
Guj.Mineral	394.55
*Goyal Salt	95.00
Greenpanel I	116.07
*GR InfraPro.	730.00
*GROWW SILV E	17.39
Hotel Leela	5.25
Hang Seng Be	419.05
*HSBC Gold ET	117.05
Indrapr.Gas	125.63
Intellect Ds	478.00
Innovat.Tyre	58.90
*Jaro Institu	320.05
JBM Auto	465.00
JSW Dulux	259.30
*Kontor Space	46.10
Kothari Sug.	22.13
Kothari Prod	55.79
Kothari Indl	98.15
*KP Energy	154.86
Krsnaa Diag.	464.00
Kuantum Pap	64.10
*Lasa Supergе	4.44
*Laser Power	197.50
*Latent View	183.00
*LEAP India	113.60
*Lee&Nee Soft	6.51
Mirae HS Tec	20.11
*Mcon Rasayan	36.55
Medico Remed	18.36
Max Fin.Serv	1172.60
*Matrix Geo	44.00
Mahindra Hol	177.85
Mindteck	124.51
*MO Nifty Oil	10.07
*Morarjee Tex	3.91
Muthoot Fin.	2305.00
*Nagarj. Fert	1.33
*Natural Caps	131.16
Next Mediawk	3.15
Norben Tea	45.30
*Orient Tech	177.71
*Pakka	66.66
Palash Sec	76.00
Pavna Inds.	12.51
PB Fintech	923.30
*Polyspin Exp	26.30
*Pooja Logist	94.05
Pratham EPC	96.05
Priti Intl.	26.80
*Premier Road	33.05
*Qualiance In	139.85
*Radiowalla N	21.25
RailTel Corp	220.06
Rajesh Exp	48.60
Raj Rayon In	19.13
Sh.Rama News	26.36
Shree Renuka	17.14
Robust Hotel	155.00
*RIR Power El	130.93
*R.K. Fashion	26.20
Sarda Energy	424.05
*Scoda Tube	103.35
SEL Mfg. Co.	20.55
Shakti Pumps	345.00
*Shanthala FM	10.05
*Sh.Hare-Kris	26.00
SiddhikaCoat	190.00
*Quant Silver	18.01
*Bandh.Silver	175.00
UTI SX NXT50	85.69
*Solarworld	102.45
*Shivalic Pow	38.30
Spel Semicon	96.66
*Sh.Ram Twist	33.20
*Studds Acces	380.00
Subros	572.10
*TECIL Chem.	7.83
*Tempsens Ins	470.50
*Teerth Gopi	9.25
Thirumalai	113.06
Touchwood E	52.04
*Trucap Fin.	3.47
*Ugro Capital	69.00
Vaibhav Glob	154.49
Vinati Org.	950.50
*Vishal Mega	84.16

ALL TIME AT NSE

Turnover Cash Market



ET Indices



Positive Breakouts

Company (BSE)	Days Close	20 Days Mvg Avg	% Chg	50 Days Mvg Avg
Advance Mult	368.55	229.78	60.39	171.50
Bhagy.India	89.77	56.07	60.10	43.24
Pashupati Co	141.70	90.68	56.26	85.70
Aurique	98.77	64.67	52.73	38.77
ANS Inds.	30.00	20.81	44.16	23.50
Kiaasa Retai	41.32	28.85	43.22	29.89
Geetanjali C	21.13	15.53	36.06	13.91
Alfa Transfo	51.30	38.20	34.29	35.69
Raghuvir Syn	99.70	74.25	34.28	84.20
Shlokka Dyes	45.67	34.01	34.28	29.45
Finelistings	32.33	24.08	34.26	17.63
DCM Shr.Ind	61.27	45.93	33.40	44.58
Mahesh Devel	19.89	14.95	33.04	16.21
Keltech Enrg	17587.45	13336.71	31.87	13135.48
Cubical Fin.	7.38	5.72	29.02	5.92
Resonance Sp	235.05	187.01	25.69	176.85
Highway Infr	69.74	55.59	25.45	48.66
Baba Arts	24.59	19.77	24.38	16.46
Sh.Niwas Lea	24.19	19.51	23.99	16.70

Negative Breakouts

Company (BSE)	Days Close	20 Days Mvg Avg	% Chg	50 Days Mvg Avg
Shricon Inds	82.70	140.11	40.97	165.88
Raama Fin.	8.57	12.97	33.92	14.97
Chandrima Me	5.95	8.92	33.30	11.30
SAR Auto Prd	3596.80	5355.17	32.83	5409.77
Shalimar Agn	16.53	23.58	29.90	27.67
eMudhra	342.05	482.15	29.06	536.33
Amtech Ester	72.77	102.34	28.89	105.65
TPI (I)	11.30	15.69	27.98	18.15
Nexus Surgic	20.59	28.48	27.70	27.88
Modison	329.60	454.81	27.53	454.61
Genesys Intl	172.50	236.75	27.14	245.92
Kesar Enterp	8.35	11.42	26.88	10.82
Capricorn Sy	19.84	27.07	26.71	27.53
Shankara Bui	169.60	230.90	26.55	244.41
Wardwizard F	5.52	7.50	26.40	8.60
DMCC Sp.Chem	233.95	313.76	25.44	299.23
Kothari Indl	102.25	136.64	25.17	140.41
Gujjubhai In	79.86	106.72	25.17	109.59
E2E Networks	497.75	648.43	23.24	629.43

FII Spurt in Volumes at BSE

Company	Days Volume	2 Weeks Avg. Vol.	% Chg	Days Close
MOSt5GSecETF	1600444	165	967930.00	64.51
Vashu Bhag.	1214835	833	145817.36	66.60
Raj Oil Mill	37389	188	19787.77	46.52
Al Champdany	239174	2297	10313.45	18.78
Updater Serv	401977	5411	7329.34	204.05
Parmax Pharm	33819	464	7188.58	133.70
Shahlon Silk	103987	2022	5042.22	24.85
Cranes Soft.	234686	5556	4124.01	4.76
ITI	603522	18145	3226.17	259.00
Manipal Heal	808880	24498	3201.79	653.45
Mold-Tek Pac	216902	6576	3198.50	292.65
Aster DM Qua	1424171	53902	2542.15	673.90

Best Returns on BSE

Company	Days Close	Prev. Close	% Chg	Average Volume
Fortnight				
Pashupati Co	141.70	85.06	66.6	486050
Bhagy.India	89.77	55.30	62.3	11483
Seemax Resou	98.35	62.86	56.5	11727
DCM Shr.Ind	61.27	39.81	53.9	746067
Raghuvir Syn	99.70	65.50	52.2	12103
1 Month				
Quintegra So	3.43	1.31	161.8	34301
Bhagy.India	89.77	35.17	155.3	10524
Finelistings	32.33	15.41	109.8	44000
Magn Trade	0.52	0.25	108.0	122631
Palm Jewels	28.66	15.31	87.2	72716
3 Months				
Novalum Mat.	48.66	11.79	312.7	8271
Duke Offshor	111.95	36.04	210.6	14637
Prime Inds.	124.15	44.14	181.3	120996
Kuber Udyog	59.90	21.40	179.9	33221
AJC Jewel Mf	320.00	115.00	178.3	14269

Spurt in Volumes at NSE

Company	Days Volume	2 Weeks Avg. Vol.	% Chg	Days Close
CLC Inds.	50003	158	31647.94	42.00
MOST NNXT50	1265033	8027	15659.08	68.91
Raj Oil Mill	204099	1610	12573.49	46.08
ITI	17199121	161292	10563.34	259.14
MOST M50ETF	318688	3738	8426.63	244.94
Radiowalla N	251200	3200	7750.00	23.00
Mold-Tek Pac	5642290	77561	7174.67	292.50
Updater Serv	11163856	178076	6169.16	203.68
Go Fashion	6876378	125832	5364.74	243.02
Indigo Paint	1133374	29585	3730.89	870.00
Affle 3I	4210126	129017	3163.23	1506.50
Kirloskar Br	1638225	58852	2683.62	1792.80

Worst Returns on BSE

Company	Days Close	Prev. Close	% Chg	Average Volume
Fortnight				
MPK Steels	42.99	83.10	-48.3	26691
Sai Urja Ind	110.60	210.35	-47.4	106473
Gujjubhai In	79.86	134.35	-40.6	75006
Shivchem Agr	28.02	45.60	-38.6	102182
eMudhra	342.05	556.05	-38.5	178378
1 Month				
Vama Wovenfa	76.70	250.80	-69.4	33491
MPK Steels	42.99	94.10	-54.3	19160
Artificial E	33.10	70.28	-52.9	325368
Chandrima Me	5.95	12.00	-50.4	477415
Shalimar Agn	16.53	30.90	-46.5	525319
3 Months				
Indo Thai Sc	28.36	220.90	-87.2	297881
Omega Intera	10.88	47.48	-77.1	427825
City Pulse M	116.65	470.55	-75.2	42947
Cropster Agr	1.62	6.24	-74.0	10651471
CCME Global	34.00	116.55	-70.8	9309

F&O Corner-NSE

Positive Trend

Company	Spot Price	Future Price	% Diff	OI Chg(%)
UPL	516.10	523.35	1.40	5.84
PG Electropl	533.05	537.60	0.85	2.13
KEI Inds.	3855.40	3887.70	0.81	0.93
LIC Hsg.Fin.	495.30	499.10	0.77	0.24
Bk of Baroda	245.16	246.82	0.68	1.08
Inox Wind	59.78	60.18	0.67	-3.87
GMR Airports	88.65	89.22	0.64	-0.57
Indian Oil C	134.59	135.45	0.64	0.50
NMDC	68.42	68.86	0.64	-0.28
Laurus Labs	2348.00	2362.80	0.63	-3.71

Negative Trend

Company	Spot Price	Future Price	% Diff	OI Chg(%)
Power Grid	267.70	263.15	-1.70	4.36
Godrej Cons.	821.50	810.75	-1.31	-3.97
Hind.Unileve	1898.30	1879.30	-1.00	0.15
Reliance Ind	1300.00	1287.40	-0.97	-0.93
SAIL	165.30	163.76	-0.93	-0.17
Blue Star	1594.00	1579.90	-0.88	2.68
Dabur (I)	373.90	371.10	-0.75	-0.36

Active Calls

Company	Contract	Traded Qty	Open Interest	Chg in OI (%)
NIFTY	23300.00-Nov	9805.45	78.10	17.85
NIFTY	23350.00-Nov	6423.45	62.71	86.92
NIFTY	23400.00-Nov	6265.25	95.52	-1.56
Vodafone Ide	13.00-Nov	3768.16	2918.32	3.08
Vodafone Ide	14.00-Nov	3229.96	2723.91	11.99
Vodafone Ide	12.00-Nov	2542.37	2045.61	-0.49
Suzlon Energy	35.00-Nov	884.94	121.16	-56.85
Reliance Ind	1300.00-Nov	881.75	148.11	25.82
Yes Bank	16.00-Nov	714.68	576.28	-9.61
Suzlon Energy	36.00-Nov	682.37	131.06	-35.90

Active Puts

Company	Contract	Traded Qty	Open Interest	Chg in OI (%)
NIFTY	23300.00-Nov	7250.92	91.50	2363.03
NIFTY	23200.00-Nov	6192.00	108.33	1171.12
NIFTY	23250.00-Nov	5134.30	63.83	3804.85

Homebuyers' Body Urges PM to Separate Consumer Protection from RERA Act

CALL FOR RERA RECAST Forum seeks new law under consumer ministry; flags ₹12.44 lakh crore stuck in delayed projects

Kailash Babar

Mumbai: Pan-India homebuyers' body Forum for People's Collective Efforts (FPCE) has urged Prime Minister Narendra Modi to restructure the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016 (RERA), by separating consumer protection from real estate sector promotion, citing persistent enforcement failures and delays in project completion.

FPCE has sought the prime minister's intervention to initiate a comprehensive review of RERA's institutional framework. The organisation has also proposed renaming RERA as the Real Estate Homebuyer Protection Act and placing its administration under a consumer-protection ministry.

In a letter to the prime minister last week, the forum said around ₹12.44 lakh crore of homebuyers' money, equivalent to about 3.8% of India's annual GDP, remains trapped in delayed real estate projects, affecting nearly 2.76 million families, based on the government's own data.

"It is time for zero tolerance towards malpractices in real estate and the duping of homebuyers," FPCE president Abhay Upadhyay told **ET**. "The regulatory framework suffers from a structural contradiction as the same authority is entrusted with both promoting the real estate sector and protecting consumers. The promotional priorities could influence enforcement decisions, particularly when regulatory authorities are evaluated on the number of projects registered and sector activity facilitated."

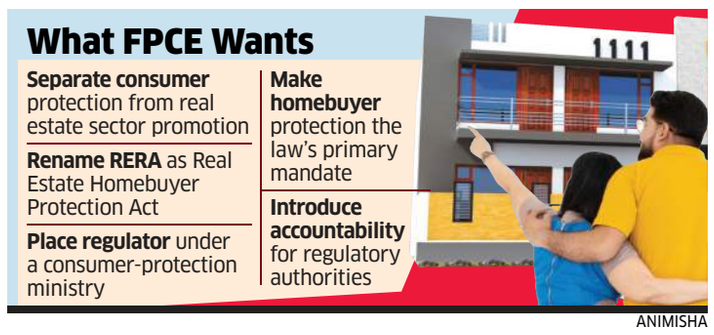
FPCE has alleged that project extensions, originally intended as exceptional relief for developers facing delays, have become routine, often without adequate scrutiny of promoter defaults or protection of homebuyers' interests. According to the body, several practices that RERA was intended to prevent continue to affect homebuyers. These include diversion of funds, one-sided builder-buyer agreements, delayed possession, unauthorised changes to sanctioned plans, undisclosed charges and handing over apartments without occupancy certificates.

The organisation has also flagged what it describes as systemic enforcement failures, including mechanical registration of projects, repeated extensions without adequate scrutiny, non-execution of refund and compensation orders, inadequate disclosure of project information and allowing developers with a history of defaults to register new projects.

The forum has cited Supreme Court observations on the functioning of RERA authorities. It referred to a February 2026 observation by the chief justice of India in a case involving Himachal Pradesh, expressing concern that the institution was facilitating builders in default rather than providing effective relief to homebuyers.

As part of its proposed restructuring, FPCE has recommended removing the mandate to promote and develop the real estate sector from RERA, placing homebuyer protection at the centre of the legislation, bringing it under the administrative oversight of a consumer-protection ministry and introducing an accountability framework for regulatory authorities.

The homebuyers' body is of the view that amendments to existing provisions alone would not address the problem unless institutional responsibilities and enforcement mechanisms are restructured.



ANIMISHA

Delhi HC Stays NPPA's ₹151-cr Recovery from AstraZeneca

Indu Bhan

New Delhi: The Delhi High Court has restrained the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) from taking any coercive action against AstraZeneca Pharma India to recover over ₹151 crore in an alleged drug overcharging case until January 11, the next date of hearing. AstraZeneca Pharma has made out a prima facie case that its Symbicort Turbuhaler 160/4.5 (Inhaler) may not fall within the category of drugs whose prices are controlled under the Drugs (Price Control) Order, 2013, justice Amit Mahajan said while seeking the pricing authority's response to the company's petition related to alleged pricing violations under the Drugs (Price Control) Order, 2013.

AstraZeneca Pharma sells Symbicort Turbuhaler 160/4.5 (Inhaler), which is used to treat asthma where a corticosteroid and long-acting beta agonist combination is appropriate. The authority had issued a notice to the company alleging overcharging the product. The NPPA claimed the violations occurred between May 2016 and November 2025.

However, the company denied allegations that it sold the product at a price higher than that fixed for the formulation. It argued that its product's dosage differed from the dose covered under the schedule to the 2013 DPCO. The company said drugs with specific strengths and doses listed in the National List of Essential Medicines, 2011, cannot be equated with its product, which has different dosage forms and strengths. It also said approval to import the product in its specific dosage had been granted in 2003 and that it had been selling the drug since then without objection.

AstraZeneca further argued that the ceiling price of a product that the NPPA claims is similar to its own was fixed only in 2019, while the demand has been raised from 2016 onwards.

In similar circumstances, the court had earlier held that ceiling prices can be fixed only for formulations with specific doses and forms, and that the pricing authority has no power over formulations with other doses and forms that have received regulatory approval for marketing, AstraZeneca told the HC.

NAVI MUMBAI SHIFT SPARKS FRESH AIRLINE-MIAL TURBULENCE

Mumbai Airport Slot Row Lands Back with Ministry

Airlines seek ministry intervention over shift of 265 weekly intl slots to Navi Mumbai

Forum Gandhi

Mumbai: Airlines operating from the Mumbai airport renewed calls for intervention from the civil aviation ministry over a proposed capacity reduction from next April, as operator Mumbai International Airport Ltd (MIAL) is preparing to shift part of its international flight schedule to the new Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA), about 50 km away. Adani Airport Holdings runs both airports and is a partner in MIAL with the Airports Authority of India.

The Airline Operators Committee-Mumbai (AOC), which represents 46 of 47 airlines operating at the airport, has asked the ministry to protect existing flight slots, saying MIAL hasn't adequately justified the proposed reduction.

MIAL plans to close Terminal 1 for redevelopment from April and shift 265 of Terminal 2's 770 weekly international departure slots to Navi Mumbai, cutting Mumbai airport's annual passenger capacity by 5 million.

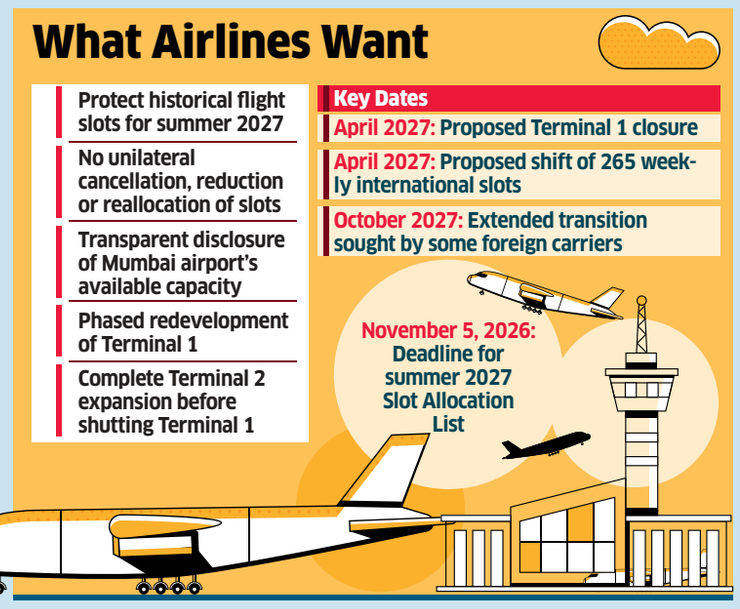
While IndiGo, Air India Express and Akasa Air have agreed to move some international flights, foreign carriers, including Emirates and Air France-KLM, have sought until October 2027 to split operations, citing concerns over infrastructure and passenger demand at the new airport.

In an email to civil aviation secretary Samir Kumar Sinha on November 2, reviewed by ET, the AOC said MIAL had communicated the capacity reduction at an October 28 meeting "as a unilateral decision, without adequate justification or transparent disclosure of the actual available capacity at CSMIA".

The committee has asked the ministry to direct MIAL and the airport's slot coordinator to approve historical slots sought by existing airlines in their initial submissions for the summer 2027 schedule, ahead of the November 5 deadline for the Slot Allocation List.

"We further request that no historical slots be denied, reduced, cancelled or reallocated unilaterally, without due process and adherence to the MoCA and IATA Slot Guidelines," the committee said.

The latest escalation follows an earlier dispute over the relocation of international flights. Ministry intervention last month and meetings on October 13 and 28 have failed to resolve differences. At the October 28 meeting, airlines sought a phased redevelopment of Terminal 1 and argued that Terminal 2's planned expansion, expected to add 5 million passengers annually, should be completed before Terminal 1 is shut, a person present at the meeting said.



SC Upholds Vedanta's Ravva Arbitral Award

Indu Bhan

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Monday dismissed the Union government's appeal and allowed Vedanta and Ravva Oil (Singapore) to enforce $99-million arbitral awards against the former arising from a dispute related to the Ravva oilfield in the Krishna-Godavari Basin.

The government had challenged the Delhi High Court's July 1 judgment, which rejected its objections to the enforcement of the arbitral awards and directed the release of bank guarantees maintained by Vedanta in 2018. A bench led by justices J.B. Pardiwala and Manmohan criticised the Centre for resisting enforcement of awards that date back more than two decades, warning that the litigation could undermine confidence in India's arbitration regime. "Nobody will trust you, if you behave like this. What are these arguments? You are frustrating an arbitral award like this? At the stage of enforcement of it? And we talk about all of this arbitration and seat and this and that?...," it said.

Questioning the government for failing to argue within the limitation period that the arbitral award had violated public policy, the bench asked how the government could contend that the arbitral tribunal had become "functus officio" (the tribunal's authority has ended).

The high court, in its judgment, had also stated that the arbitral awards had withstood judicial scrutiny before the curial courts of Malaysia and that the government could not ask it to decide the merits of the dispute merely because it disagreed with the majority interpretation of the arbitral tribunal.

IndiGo Weighs Fuel Hedging as Long-Haul Plans Gather Pace

Board discussions gain traction as the carrier evaluates risk-management options ahead of Airbus A350 induction

Arindam Majumder

New Delhi: India's largest airline IndiGo is considering the option of fuel hedging to save costs as it prepares to start long-haul international flights, mirroring several global carriers undertaking similar moves.

IndiGo CEO Willie Walsh said the airline has discussed the issue of fuel hedging with its board and would undertake a comprehensive review of such a decision.

Fuel hedging is a financial risk management strategy deployed by airlines to protect themselves from sharp rises in fuel prices. They do this by buying or selling the expected future price of oil through a range of derivatives.

Walsh said hedging is fundamentally a risk management tool rather than a speculative bet on fuel prices, and because IndiGo's domestic rivals remain unhedged, hedging individually for domestic operations would introduce asymmetric competitive risks for IndiGo.

However, as the airline is preparing to introduce wide-body Airbus A350 aircraft on long-haul international routes starting 2028, its leadership has initiated talks the board to evaluate fuel hedging.

"I think we do need to look at what we would do in the context of long-haul expansion, given that most of the airlines that we are likely to compete with tend to be hedged at different levels," said Walsh. "So, we're evaluating the hedging policy of the airlines that are currently serving the market...I think the long-haul expansion does give us an opportunity to review our hedging policies."

IndiGo has stayed away from hedging fuel prices so far, stating it can prove counterproductive if fuel prices fall in the short term, and in the long-term window over 10 to 20 years, the benefit of any hedge gets neutralized.

The carrier reported a consolidated net loss of ₹1,879 crore in the September quarter, with its fuel expenses surging 67% from a year earlier, amid the West Asia crisis.

Spot prices of crude oil spiraled after the start of the Iran war in late February and have remained high ever since.

IndiGo expects to receive its first Airbus A350 in the second quarter of 2028, which will enable the airline to expand its long-haul international network. The aircraft will have a three-class configuration—16 flat beds in business class, premium economy and economy class seats. The latest seating configuration is locked for the first 10 planes, and IndiGo would look at having more flat beds in business class on the A350 at a later stage, said Walsh.

IndiGo's push into premium long-haul travel will mark an expansion of its dominance in the Indian aviation market with a share of around 65%. The A350s will be central to IndiGo's plan to build a long-haul network, complementing its A321 XLR operations.

So, we're evaluating the hedging policy of the airlines that are currently serving the market...I think the long-haul expansion does give us an opportunity to review our hedging policies

WILLIE WALSH, CEO, IndiGo

Corning's Pune Optical Plant Goes Live: MD

Subhayan Chakraborty

New Delhi: Specialty glass and fibre-optic cable maker Corning's optical connectivity manufacturing facility in Pune is now operational and capacity addition is beginning, Sudhir Pillai, managing director India, Middle East, and Africa, told **ET** on Monday. Set to manufacture optical connectivity products for data centers, a core focus area for the US materials science major now, the plant will be inaugurated on Tuesday. "We will also lay the foundation for capacity addition, which is expected to come online by next year," he added.

The company's other plant in Chennai, has begun production of finishing glass for the first time in India. Inaugurated in December, 2025, it is currently undergoing validation by original equipment manufacturers (OEM), and will commence commercial production within the next few quarters, Pillai said.

Corning is benefitting from the governments Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS), which has succeeded the earlier Production Linked Incentive Scheme for Large Scale Electronics Manufacturing (PLI-LSEM). "The government is incentivizing OEMs to source more from India, as well as export from India. As the OEMs source more glass from India, we will be one of the beneficiaries," he said.

The company is ready to co-locate with display fabrication units in India, Pillai said. "We have always followed our customers. When more phone manufacturers set up shop in India, we set up our glass plant here. After demand for optical fibers grew in India, we set up our fiber plant back in 2012. Now, more customers are asking for data centre products, and we are following them. The day display fabricators come to India, Corning will co-locate with them in India," Pillai said.

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Notice for Recruitment of various Senior positions on Contract Basis for IT Department in Bank of Baroda

Bank of Baroda, one of India's largest Banks is looking for senior IT Professionals on Fixed Term Employment basis for its IT department.

Sr. No.	Position	Vacancy
1	SVP: Dy. Chief Technology Officer	1
2	VP: Head AI	1
3	DVP: Dy. Head Cloud	1
4	DVP: Dy. Head Platform Engineering	1
	TOTAL	4

Please note that the number of vacancies mentioned above are provisional and may vary according to the actual requirement of the Bank.

Eligibility criteria (age, qualification & experience), requisite fees and other details are available on Bank's website. Interested candidates are advised to visit the Bank's website https://bankofbaroda.bank.in/Career.htm ➡ Current Opportunities ➡ Recruitment of Senior IT Professionals on Fixed Term Employment Basis Advt No. BOB/HRM/REC/ADVT/2026/18

Candidates are advised to go through the detailed advertisement, ensuring their eligibility & other details before applying and remitting fees.

Any addendum/ corrigendum/ modification shall be notified only on the Bank's website.

Date for filling Online Application & Payment of Fee: 28.10.2026 to 17.11.2026 (23:59 hours).

Place: Mumbai
Date: 29.10.2026
Chief General Manager (HRM & Marketing)
(99/26-27)

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Finance	Senior Manager - Business Finance	MMG/S-III	2
	Chief Manager - Internal Controls	SMG/S-IV	2
Risk	Manager - Digital Fraud	MMG/S-II	2
	Senior Manager - Project Finance – Infrastructure & ESG	MMG/S-III	1
	Senior Manager - MSME Credit Risk Management	MMG/S-III	1
	Senior Manager - Enterprise and Operational Risk Management	MMG/S-III	1
	Senior Manager - Fraud Incidence and Root Cause Analysis	MMG/S-III	1
MSME	Senior Manager - MSME Relationship	MMG/S-III	1
	TOTAL		11

Please note that the number of vacancies mentioned above are provisional and may vary according to the actual requirement of the Bank.

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Date for filling Online Application & Payment of Fee: 28.10.2026 to 17.11.2026 (23:59 hours).

Place: Mumbai
Date: 29.10.2026
CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (HRM & Marketing)

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2. Refer detailed advertisement to ensure eligibility and other details before applying. Application starts from 03/11/2026.
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Musical roots
Pop star Taylor Swift praised Nashville, once her home, in her Hall of Fame speech, saying "there is no music community" like it

How to turn an office buddy into a real friend

Forming connections at work may seem difficult. But genuine friendships can become a community beyond the workplace

Jenna Ryu

Most jobs can be exhausting, frustrating and, at times, soul-sucking. But there's usually one saving grace that can make even the longest Monday feel a little lighter: Your favourite co-workers.

Born from proximity, shared frustrations and the daily grind of showing up together, workplace friendships have become one of the most common — and organic — ways adults build community. "We spend so many of our waking hours at work that it is very likely there will be people who you have similar interests with that could become a good part of your support system," said psychologist Joy Harden Bradford from Atlanta, US.

But while it's often easy to start these relationships, it may be harder to deepen them.

Unlike connections that form elsewhere, workplace relationships come with extra risks. There's always the question of what's appropriate to share, whether revealing more of your outside-of-work personality could become tomorrow's workplace gossip and how power dynamics might complicate even the most genuine bond.

Here are a few low-pressure ways to grow a workplace friendship into a real one.

Consider trade-offs

The first thing to keep in mind is that you're at work. You can go in, collect your paycheque, build friendly but professional relationships and be no worse off if you exit without making a best friend for life.

"There is real benefit to being friendly and kind of seen as relatable," Bradford said. "But I do think you want to be more judicious in terms of actually befriending people who you work with."

That's worth remembering if you're feeling pressured to make friends at work: You don't have to, especially if it's someone who reports to you or you to them. "If your livelihood depends on whether you stay friends with this person or not, that may not be a chance that you want to take," Bradford said. "That may be somebody you are more cordial with versus somebody you're super open with."

NetSuite co-founder Evan Goldberg started out under Oracle co-founder Larry Ellison 40 years ago, now his "mentor and friend"

Jennifer Aniston is godmother to *Friends* co-star Courtney Cox's daughter

Once you've considered those trade-offs and decided there's a colleague you wouldn't mind getting to know better, try the following.

Don't cross boundaries

Transitioning from work friends to personal ones requires, as you might guess, getting more personal.

The challenge, though, is knowing how to move past the small talk without oversharing, said Suzanne Degges-White, chair of the department of counselling and higher education at Northern Illinois University, US.

Vulnerability can deepen friendships, but workplace relationships require more discernment. You want colleagues to know you beyond your job title without crossing boundaries that could later complicate the relationship.

One way is to listen for openings in conversations. "We all love to be asked questions," Degges-White said. So instead of stopping at weekend plans, go deeper. If they mention visiting family, ask whether they grew up there or are close to their siblings. If they mention a life stage you share — getting engaged, starting a family or becoming an empty nester — use that common ground to compare notes, swap stories or seek their experience.

Sharing experiences

Swapping phone numbers often represents a subtle turning point, according to Degges-White. It shifts the connection from one built on convenience to one sustained by choice.

"It can cement the sense that, 'Okay, there might be a friendship here,'" she said. Once that happens, there's room for small gestures that deepen friendships over time.

Proximity may bring colleagues together, but it doesn't necessarily keep them close. At work, you often see only watered-down versions of each other — how they behave in meetings or the hobbies they share around managers.

Spend time together outside work, and you're more likely to drop the professional persona and see their unfiltered selves. They may be funnier than you realised, have a colourful social circle or share stories they'd never tell at the office.

But even after a workplace friendship becomes a genuine one, an important reality remains: You're still colleagues.

There will be moments when your professional roles need to come first, such as when you have to give critical feedback or you're competing for the same promotion.

Rather than pretending these potential conflicts don't exist, Bradford said, acknowledging them early on can actually strengthen your friendship. Be up-front about what information has to stay confidential. Agree not to gossip about certain co-workers. Recognise that supporting each other as friends doesn't mean ignoring your responsibilities as colleagues•

– The Washington Post

Ray-Ban heir's $8.3-mn paper takeover rebuffed

The majority owners of Italian daily *Il Fatto Quotidiano* have rejected a buyout suggestion from Leonardo Maria Del Vecchio, heir to the late founder of Ray-Ban maker EssilorLuxottica, with whom the newspaper has openly feuded. The heir later dropped his bid after his due diligence request was rejected.

Leonardo Maria Del Vecchio has had an open feud with the Italian daily and has frequently lashed out at its reporting

The 31-year-old already has significant media holdings in Italy through his indebted holding company LMDV, with a 30 per cent stake in the *Il Giornale* daily, formerly owned by the Berlusconi family, and ownership of the QN network of regional newspapers.

Del Vecchio had said on October 25 that he wanted to conduct due diligence before launching a voluntary offer to delist the Milan-listed Societa Editoriale Il Fatto, which owns *Il Fatto Quotidiano*. The proposed deal was valued at $8.3 million, according to *Bloomberg*. The company's seven founding shareholders, including *Il Fatto's* editor-in-chief Marco Travaglio, responded in a statement saying they were not interested in selling. Collectively, they hold a majority stake.

On October 29, Del Vecchio said he did not currently intend to launch a bid after failing to obtain the information needed for a full assessment.

'Rats of journalism'

Del Vecchio has an open feud with *Il Fatto*, frequently lashing out at its reporting. In an October 22 post on social media, he accused them or running a "smear campaign", and called them "rats of journalism". On October 26, however, the businessman said he wanted to preserve the newspaper's reputation for independence and investigative reporting and would only focus on turning around its loss-making business.

"*Il Fatto* has written extensively about us, including critically," he said. "That is precisely the kind of journalism we want to protect. We are not asking anyone to change their opinion of us. We are simply asking people to consider a project that would secure the newspaper's future."

In its response, *Il Fatto* said the founding shareholders don't intend to sell and won't participate in any tender offer by LMDV Capital.

Succession battle

The Ray-Ban heir, who is embroiled in an inheritance battle linked to the control of family holding company Delfin, and who has locked horns with EssilorLuxottica's CEO Francesco Milleri, has emerged as one of the most flamboyant figures in the Italian business world. Milleri made headlines with a appearance on a podcast in which he spoke about his lavish lifestyle.

Leonardo Maria Del Vecchio

Recently, Del Vecchio lashed out at Milleri, calling him a "caretaker" who neglected his duty to identify a long-term successor at the world's largest eyewear company•

–Reuters

£6.2 million

The approximate cost that the Batmobile driven by Michael Keaton in the 1992 film *Batman Returns* is expected to fetch when it goes under the hammer in Los Angeles next month. Led by Julien's Auctions and Turner Classic Movies, the sale features film props, costumes and other memorabilia from the *Batman* franchise as well as from the DC Comics and Marvel universes. These include hand-drawn storyboards for the film and a zip-line grapple gun prop•

PIC: JULIENS AUCTIONS

Breaking new ground

Celebrities tend to get used to their natural environments, whether it's the court, kitchen or stage. Here are some who've recently stepped out their comfort zone

1

2

3

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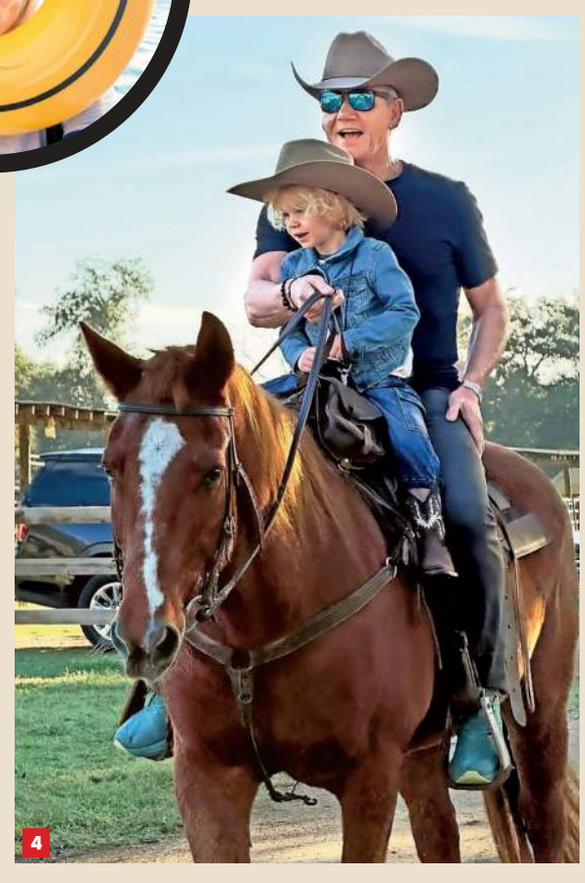

4

1. British tennis star Emma Raducanu took a break for "side quests," playing cards on the Italian seaside.
2. "Barbecue met dinner" for Sergio Ramos as the former Spanish football stalwart sported an apron and tongs for a family-focused weekend.
3. Current world No. 2 Aryna Sabalenka wasn't afraid to switch gears while training, "running around on a beach and tennis court near you".
4. "When in Texas," commit as chef Gordon Ramsay did during his visit to the US state with his son.
5. Pop star Katy Perry took her 42nd birthday to new heights climbing a canyon in Utah, US, with beau Justin Trudeau.

PICS: INSTAGRAM

One year after the Louvre heist, where are the missing jewels?

Thieves sliced their way into the Louvre museum on October 19 last year before making off with eight items worth an estimated $100 million. They include a brooch and crown from Napoleon III's wife Eugenie.

The four main suspects are in jail awaiting trial. Experts believe the best chance of recovery is if the thieves acted alone and stashed their loot in the Paris region. The last known sighting of the gems was on CCTV footage from an underground lock-up in the Aubervilliers suburb, where all the suspects live.

If the jewels have been hidden or handed to a 'fence' for safekeeping, there is still a chance that one of the suspects confesses in exchange for a more lenient sentence, said Dutch private art detective Arthur Brand. The more worrying scenario is that the gang was acting on orders from a ringleader or middleman to whom they handed the jewels. The worst-case scenario is that the jewels were transported out of France or to a local underground contact.

"It's mainly diamonds, so they have to dismantle them, recut them and sell them," said Brand. Antwerp, Tel Aviv and India are possible destinations.

Brand referred to several cases where stolen jewels were recovered, notably after a raid on the TEFAF art fair in the Netherlands in 2022 or the break-in at the Gruenes Gewoelbe museum in Dresden, Germany, in 2019. Analysis reveals that objects can take from three months to 40 years to be recovered•

– AFP

The jewels were taken from the Apollo Gallery at the Louvre

The stolen pieces were part of France's 19th century royal jewellery collection

PICS: INTERPOL, WIKI

(From left) Pallavi Mohadikar, Manorath Dhillon, V.S.S. Mani, Seshasai KVS, Kaizad Bharucha, Andre Eckholt, Sriram Iyer, Neeraj Roy, Kamal J Gupta, Schauna Chauhan, Kabir Bedi, Archana Kochhar, Pankaja Gopinath Munde, Sandeep Ghosh, Atul Mehra, Suraj Bahirwani, Sujay Jairaj, LV Krishnan, Mayank Bathwal, Aanchal Saini, Niranjan Hiranandani and Meghna Ghai Puri at the Bombay Times Fashion Week

PICS: PRATHAMESH BANDEKAR

Leaders walk for a cause

What can a runway do for our planet? Bombay Times Fashion Week brought together over 20 influential names on the ramp, shining a spotlight on how each is doing their bit to build a more sustainable future

etpanache@timesofindia.com

The runway at the Bombay Times Fashion Week made room for a different cast this season: Leaders from across sectors, including Pankaja Munde, Maharashtra's Minister for Environment and Climate Change.

They were dressed in Archana Kochhar's new collection, 'Aaina', and its most significant choice was the fabric. Most of it was made using Ahimsa silk, which is produced only after the silk moth has left its cocoon, ensuring no silkworm dies in the process. "This project is part of the 'Make in India' campaign, and I've been working on it for a decade," she said before the show. For a show about sustainability, it was the right place to start.

The clothes set the tone for the festive season. The bandhgalas and sherwanis in black and white were crisp and classic. The bridal wear brought colour back to the ramp, with mirror-work lehengas in burgundy, orange, mustard and red. Bollywood's OG Greek god, Kabir Bedi, turned showstopper. The overall mood was celebratory, and why not? It was for a good cause.

We asked each leader what sustainability looks like in their work and their lives. Here's what they had to say.

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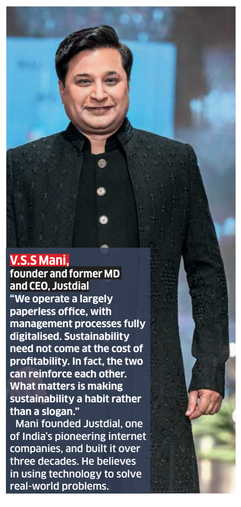
Sandeep Ghosh,
CEO, Trilegal
"Despite increasing headcount, our per capita emissions have fallen by 20 per cent over the past four years. Sustainability is most effective when it is integrated into everyday decision-making."
Ghosh brings over three decades of experience across financial services, consumer and advisory businesses. He was previously group country manager for India and South Asia at Visa and has held senior leadership roles at Ernst & Young, AXA, and CITI.

Mayank Bathwal,
CEO, Aditya Birla Health Insurance
"Sustainability is about creating long-term value for the people and communities we serve. At ABHI, through HealthReturns™, we reward customers for adopting healthier habits. That is meaningful social impact: Creating value that goes beyond the insurance policy itself."
Across more than three decades with the Aditya Birla Group, Bathwal has built, scaled and transformed businesses. He played a foundational role in establishing ABHI in 2015 and scaling it into one of India's most trusted health insurers.



V.S.S Mani,
founder and former MD and CEO, Justdial
"We operate a largely paperless office, with management processes fully digitalised. Sustainability need not come at the cost of profitability. In fact, the two can reinforce each other. What matters is making sustainability a habit rather than a slogan."
Mani founded Justdial, one of India's pioneering internet companies, and built it over three decades. He believes in using technology to solve real-world problems.

Meghna Ghai Puri,
president, Whistling Woods International
"From harnessing solar energy and recycling plastic to exploring sustainable materials and creating socially impactful films, we inspire students to turn creativity into action."
Ghai Puri has helped build Whistling Woods International since 2006, establishing seven schools. It has been ranked among the world's top 10 film schools.

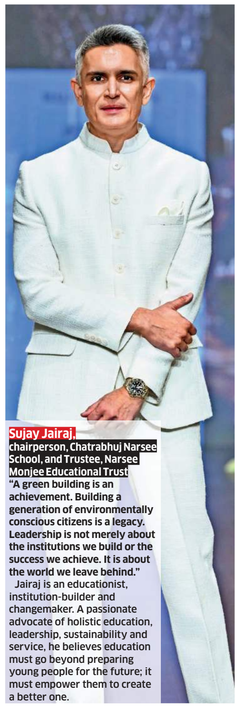
Suraj Bahirwani,
CEO, Pantaloons, Aditya Birla Fashion and Retail Limited
"At Pantaloons, we integrated FSC™-certified Liva Eco™ viscose across our portfolios, shifting approximately nine lakh metres away from conventional viscose to these sustainable, forest-based fibre alternatives. This proves that we can deliver trendy fashion our customers love while protecting the world's forest ecosystems."
Bahirwani has spent 24 years with the Aditya Birla Group across retail, global sales, strategy and manufacturing, beginning as executive assistant to Kumar Mangalam Birla.

Atul Mehra,
MD and CEO, Axis Capital
"At Axis Capital, sustainability is embedded in how we operate every day, from adopting digital-first ways of working to promoting efficient use of resources. In my own life, I try to prioritise long-term value over immediate gratification."
Mehra is an industry veteran with more than 30 years of experience in investment banking. He has led some of the most marquee capital markets & M&A transactions in terms of size, innovation and complexity, across domestic and international markets.

Kamal J Gupta,
MD, J Kumar Infraprojects Ltd
"When a project's alignment intersects with green cover, our immediate priority is to explore engineering workarounds to protect existing trees. Last year alone, we transplanted 4,489 trees and planted an additional 18,962 across our project sites."
Over three decades, Gupta has helped transform the company from a Mumbai-based contractor into one of India's foremost EPC players, delivering landmark projects across metros, highways, tunnels, and elevated corridors.

Pankaja Gopinath Munde,
Cabinet Minister, Environment, Climate Change and Animal Husbandry, Government of Maharashtra
"I firmly believe in the principles of reduce, reuse and recycle. That is how true environmental sustainability can be achieved. I would like to see business leaders strategically direct their CSR initiatives toward combating climate change and protecting our environment. Specifically, we must take strict action to reduce new pollution and actively invest in solutions to clean up existing pollution in our air and water."
Across ministries spanning environment, rural development, and women and child development. Munde has shaped some of Maharashtra's most significant sustainability policies, from the Plastic-Free Mumbai initiative to the Jalyukt Shivar Abhiyan, a water conservation model.

Niranjan Hiranandani,
MD, Hiranandani Group
"At Hiranandani Communities, sustainability is embedded in the planning and design of our developments from the outset, rather than treated as an add-on. Our objective is to create self-sustaining communities that use resources responsibly and remain liveable for generations to come."
A real estate pioneer and institution-builder, Hiranandani has helped shape India's contemporary urban landscape. Guided by the belief that development must go beyond buildings, his work reflects a commitment to communities where economic vitality, environmental responsibility and human well-being come together.



Sujay Jairaj,
chairperson, Chatrabhuj Narsee School, and Trustee, Narsee Monjee Educational Trust
"A green building is an achievement. Building a generation of environmentally conscious citizens is a legacy. Leadership is not merely about the institutions we build or the success we achieve. It is about the world we leave behind."
Jairaj is an educationist, institution-builder and changemaker. A passionate advocate of holistic education, leadership, sustainability and service, he believes education must go beyond preparing young people for the future; it must empower them to create a better one.

Kaizad M Bharucha,
deputy MD, HDFC Bank
"We are committed to becoming carbon neutral in our operations by 2032, steadily increasing our use of renewable energy and expanding our network of certified green buildings. Sustainability begins with small, consistent actions. Progress should not come at the expense of what we leave behind for future generations."
A career banker of over 40 years, Bharucha has been with the bank since its inception. He leads its lending portfolio and heads Inclusive Banking, CSR and ESG, championing growth that is both inclusive and sustainable.

Schauna Chauhan,
CEO, Parle Agro
"At Parle Agro, sustainability means taking responsibility beyond the point of sale. Sustainability needs a place in budgets, procurement decisions and performance reviews for progress to last."
Chauhan leads Parle Agro – the company behind India's iconic beverage brands, including Frooti, Appy Fizz, Smoodh flavoured milk and Bailley packaged drinking water. She believes in building Parle Agro with a strong commitment to quality, people, and responsible growth.

Pallavi Mohadikar,
co-founder and CEO, Palmonas
"For us, sustainability is not about asking people to stop buying jewellery; it is about encouraging them to make thoughtful choices, invest in pieces they will wear often and move away from a disposable mindset. My philosophy is simple: Be good and do good."
An IIM Lucknow graduate, Mohadikar launched Karagiri in 2017, empowering 2,500 weavers. In 2022, she co-founded Palmonas, India's first demi-fine jewellery label, guided by her belief that luxury shouldn't be a privilege but a choice anyone can make.

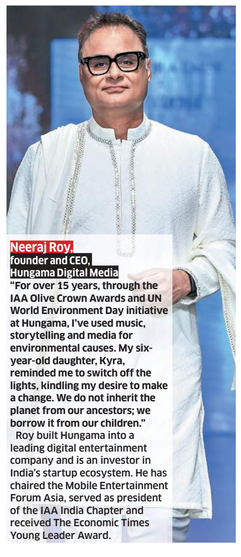
Kabir Bedi,
actor
"We have only one planet, our only home in the universe. I segregate my trash at home. I drive an electric car. I believe in restoring and repairing, rather than always buying new things. Some of my clothes are 30 to 50 years old. I have a wonderful Missoni jacket that I love wearing, and a few pieces from Gucci and Ferragamo that have never gone out of style."
Bedi is one of the first Indian actors to build an international career across Hindi cinema, Hollywood and European television. He became a star in Italy as the titular character in *Sandokan* and was made a Cavaliere of the Order of Merit of the Italian Republic in 2010.

LV Krishnan,
CEO, TAM Media Research
"At TAM, digital-first workflows reduce paper consumption and printing costs while preventing waste. After washing my hands, I use an air dryer if available instead of paper tissues. Small decisions like these contribute to environmental responsibility."
Over 25 years, Krishnan has shaped how India measures its fragmented media landscape. His data-led audience insights help brands and media build content and communication strategies.

Andre Eckholt,
MD, Hettich India, SAARC, Middle East and Africa
"All our units in India are zero-discharge facilities, with rainwater harvesting and a growing share of energy from solar and wind. Globally, we're working to reduce the carbon footprint across all sites."
Eckholt joined Hettich as a management trainee in 2009 and set up its first manufacturing plant at Vadodara. Under his leadership, India has grown into Hettich's second-largest market worldwide.

Sriram Iyer,
CEO, Apollo Health and Lifestyle Limited (AHLL)
"At Apollo, patient reports are digital, and new facilities are fitted with solar panels. At home, we compost kitchen waste into a herb and vegetable patch. Watching scraps become soil is a reminder of nature's circular economy and of what we consume and discard."
Iyer oversees a portfolio of retail healthcare formats across diagnostics, primary care and single specialty formats. Drawing on his experience in consumer, telecom, insurance and digital transformation, he focuses on decentralised care, advanced diagnostics and predictive AI for preventive health.

Aanchal Saini,
CEO, Flyrobe
"Our wardrobe-sharing programme lets people rent out outfits they own, helping underused garments find more wear while generating income for their owners."
Saini is building Flyrobe, India's fashion rental platform, into a business that makes occasion wear more accessible and encourages people to rethink ownership and get more use from fashion.



Neeraj Roy,
founder and CEO, Hungama Digital Media
"For over 15 years, through the IAA Olive Crown Awards and UN World Environment Day initiative at Hungama, I've used music, storytelling and media for environmental causes. My six-year-old daughter, Kyra, reminded me to switch off the lights, kindling my desire to make a change. We do not inherit the planet from our ancestors; we borrow it from our children."
Roy built Hungama into a leading digital entertainment company and is an investor in India's startup ecosystem. He has chaired the Mobile Entertainment Forum Asia, served as president of the IAA India Chapter and received The Economic Times Young Leader Award.

Manorath Dhillon,
CEO and creative head, Okhai Centre for Empowerment
"For us, sustainability means a woman can earn an income without leaving her village, and the craft survives with her. I'd rather own one piece whose maker I know, than five I'll replace next year."
Dhillon is a craft entrepreneur, designer and social innovator dedicated to empowering rural artisans through sustainable design, grassroots innovation, and ethical business practices. She specialises in bridging the gap between heritage skills and contemporary markets.

Seshasai KVS,
CEO, Preschools, Lighthouse Learning Pvt Ltd
"We have integrated the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals into our preschool curriculum to ensure all children start to learn early about the environment, sustainable habits and social equity and inclusion. I am focused on mindful consumption and energy conservation."
Seshasai is passionate about the transformational impact of early childhood education and would love to see a future India in which every child, irrespective of economic class, gets access to high-quality early childhood education.

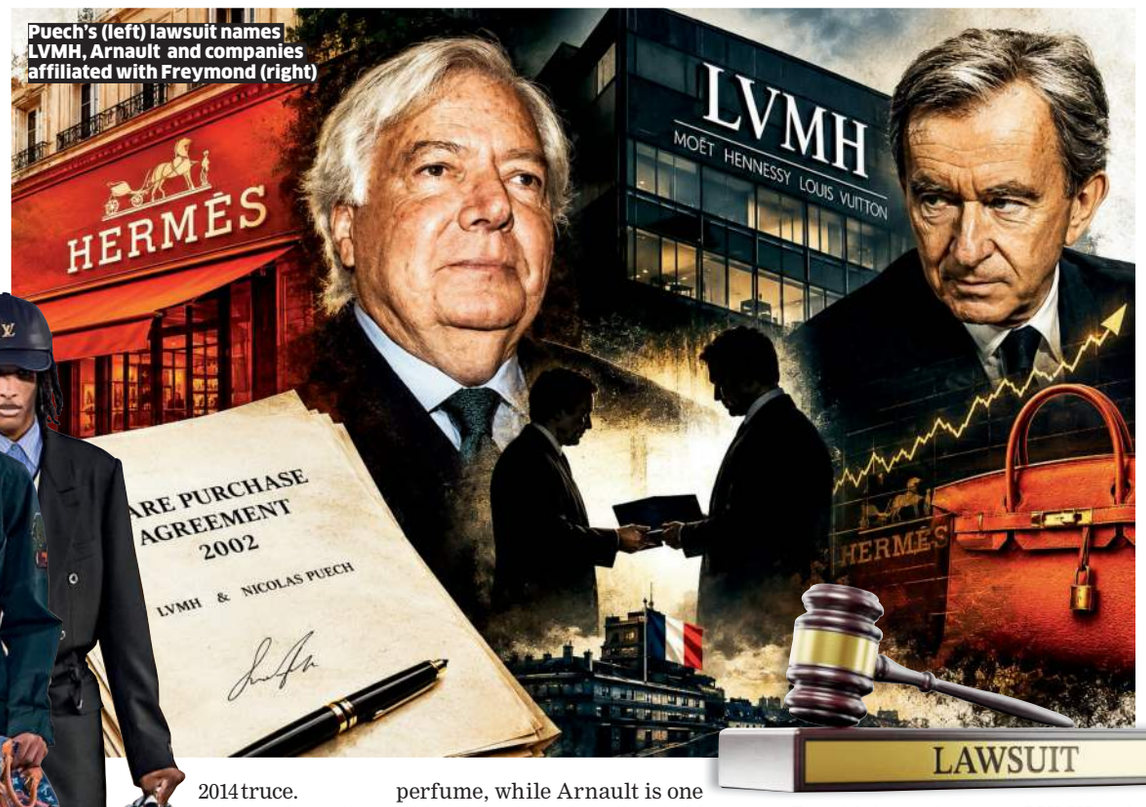
An Hermès heir and his missing fortune

Nicolas Puech has claimed that luxury conglomerate LVMH made a 'secret' pact with the help of his wealth manager to buy his shares in Hermès

In June this year, LVMH denied that it had ever tried to acquire shares in rival luxury firm Hermès from that company's founding-family heir Nicolas Puech, who had alleged that he was fleeced of his six per cent stake — now worth billions — through schemes involving his late wealth manager, Eric Freymond.

"The group never contemplated acquiring Nicolas Puech's stake, let alone against his will," LVMH said.

However, legal documents show that LVMH did sign an agreement in 2002 to purchase the heir's shares. LVMH and its chairman's family holding company also paid Freymond's management firm at least $20 million in commissions and fees between 2001 and 2009, as Freymond helped LVMH secretly build a massive stake in Hermès, these documents reveal.



Puech's (left) lawsuit names LVMH, Arnault and companies affiliated with Freymond (right)

Ongoing battle

This is the latest twist in a bitter corporate rivalry between the luxury giants dating back a quarter century, when LVMH first started covertly building its Hermès stake. Hermès fended off what it called a hostile takeover by LVMH chairman Bernard Arnault in 2010, when he surprised investors by disclosing a 17 per cent stake in the rival. LVMH accumulated 23 per cent before agreeing to liquidate its stake in a 2014 truce.

Louis Vuitton's spring-summer 2027 menswear collection

Arnault built his empire through acquisitions, starting with Christian Dior before taking control of LVMH in the late '80s, shortly after its founding in a merger of Louis Vuitton and Moët Hennessy.

Today, LVMH is the world's biggest luxury firm, with more than 75 brands selling everything from clothes to champagne and perfume, while Arnault is one of the richest people in the world, worth about $118 billion.

Legal notice

Puech said he discovered his shares had vanished around 2022, after which he cut ties with his wealth manager. Last year, he filed a lawsuit seeking 14 billion euros ($16 billion) in damages from whoever might be found guilty in a parallel probe into his missing fortune. At today's share prices, Puech's six per cent stake in Hermès would be worth about $10 billion.

Puech's lawsuit names LVMH and Arnault as defendants, along with companies affiliated with Freymond.

LVMH argued that buying Puech's shares would have made no sense because its strategy at the time was to convince Puech to join a shareholder bloc to influence Hermès, which the heir couldn't do without his stake. But the documents show LVMH signed the 2002 agreement to buy Puech's shares with Freymond shortly after launching its stake-building effort.

An LVMH spokesman, Hermès and Puech all declined to comment.

Many unknowns

Freymond died in a train accident in 2025, as French prosecutors were investigating whether he misappropriated Puech's shares. Prosecutors eventually concluded it was a suicide.

Exactly what happened to Puech's shares — and any money paid to buy them — remains unclear.

LVMH has never said whether it purchased these. It acknowledged working with Freymond to accumulate Hermès shares, but said any purchase of shares owned by Puech would have been unintentional.

In May, Swiss lawyer Alexandre Montavon told prosecutors that he advised LVMH on the 2002 agreement. Montavon was also working closely with Puech's financial advisor, serving as a board member of Freymond's wealth-management firm, the lawyer testified.

The 2002 agreement, negotiated with Freymond, called for LVMH to buy millions of Hermès shares from Puech and other family heirs.

Secret agreement

Freymond's relationship with LVMH is central to Puech's lawsuit over his lost fortune. It started in 2001 after Montavon helped introduce Freymond to top LVMH aide Pierre Godé, Arnault's longtime strategist.

LVMH's filing said Freymond claimed connections with Hermès family shareholders interested in selling stock, but "did not disclose details about the identity of the seller or sellers".

Freymond proposed creating a "screen" for the stock sales to LVMH by using Puech's accounts as a pass-through for Hermès shares owned by others, according to Montavon's testimony. The goal was to hide the fact that LVMH was the real buyer because some Hermès heirs might have refused to sell to a rival company, he said.

"Freymond suggested to make these transactions through Puech, financed by LVMH, and that's what was done," Montavon said.

LVMH said that by 2002, with Freymond's assistance, it had accumulated 4.9 per cent of Hermès. But it wanted more: On November 12, 2002, Godé and Freymond signed the agreement for LVMH to purchase millions of additional Hermès shares from Puech and other heirs •

– Bloomberg

Ferguson's fears come to a head

Alex Ferguson has opened up about his dementia fears after "heading the ball a lot".

The legendary Manchester United manager, 84, admitted his football career has left him worried about his future. Ferguson has supported his brother Martin throughout his dementia ordeal, including buying a house in Glasgow to be closer to him.

The former Scotland player said, "I worried about that myself because I headed the ball a lot. All footballers did. Dementia's a challenge for anyone getting older."

He added, "You worry about it a lot. I always say to myself: 'I'm 84. If I get to 85, I'll be all right.'"

"I worried about dementia myself because I headed the ball a lot. All footballers did"

Charity matters

Ferguson, who has released a new book, has become a major supporter of dementia charities, including F1 legend Jackie Stewart's Race Against Dementia.

He also revealed dementia charity Playlist For Life has helped boost his brother's quality of life. He said, "He recognises me, which is great. In Glasgow, they started a music thing, and the idea is that you give them a box with all your favourite songs in it. They can just press a button to play them, and it brings all the memories back."

Ferguson donated 100,000 pounds to the charity and sent a playlist with songs by Frank Sinatra, Nat King Cole, Elvis, The Beatles and Dusty Springfield •

– Daily Mirror

Bat problem at 'Wayne Manor'

The owners of the iconic filming location are at risk of losing the neglected mansion

Mentmore Towers, England

Batman needs to get his house in order — or risk losing it. The owners of a gothic country mansion used as Wayne Manor in 2005 movie *Batman Begins* must carry out bat surveys before starting crucial building repairs.

Council chiefs have served a formal listed building repairs notice on the owners of Mentmore Towers — also seen in films *Eyes Wide Shut*, *Ali G Indahouse*, *Johnny English* and *The Mummy Returns*.

In the notice, Buckinghamshire Council said the owners must demonstrate they are appointing a contractor with experience of repairing listed buildings.

If no action is taken, the council could seek government approval to compulsory purchase the historic Grade I listed mansion and take further legal action. Three bat-emergence surveys must also be completed by August 2027, alongside any necessary Natural England licence and recommendations.

Historic property

Henrietta Billings, director of SAVE Britain's Heritage, said, "We welcome this action taken by Buckinghamshire Council requiring the current owner to carry out urgent and overdue repairs to this great house."

She added, "We urge the owners, who have owned the building for over 25 years, to step up and undertake immediate repairs. This exceptional landmark has been neglected for too long."

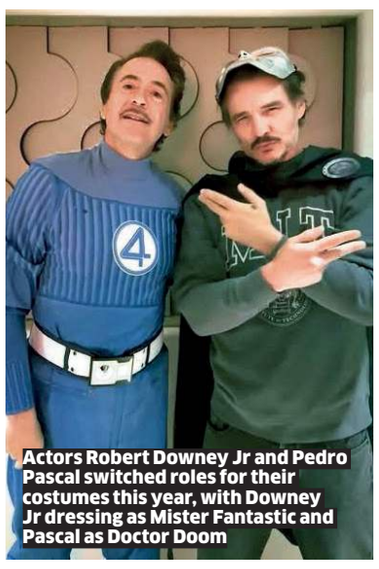
The country house was built between 1852 and 1854 for the famous Rothschild banking family. It is the only major surviving work of Joseph Paxton, the architect behind Crystal Palace.

The council said the repair work is "reasonably necessary for the proper preservation" of the building, amid claims it has been left to fall into disrepair. Experts said it has deteriorating roofs, chimneys, rooflights and leadwork with Historic England describing the condition as "very bad". Bat dropping were also found during a site visit •

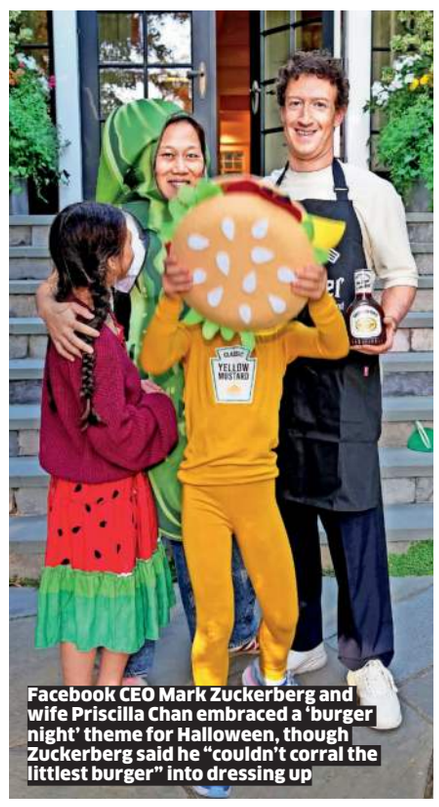
Mentmore has been featured in films such as *Ali G Indahouse*, *Eyes Wide Shut*, *Johnny English* and *The Mummy Returns*

– Daily Mirror

Former Facebook COO Sheryl Sandberg channelled Marilyn Monroe in a blonde wig and glamorous white dress inspired by the actor's iconic look in *The Seven Year Itch*, with husband Tom Bernthal joining in the fun


Actors Robert Downey Jr and Pedro Pascal switched roles for their costumes this year, with Downey Jr dressing as Mister Fantastic and Pascal as Doctor Doom

Singer Justin Bieber opted for a good old-fashioned devil's costume with an all-red ensemble


Facebook CEO Mark Zuckerberg and wife Priscilla Chan embraced a 'burger night' theme for Halloween, though Zuckerberg said he "couldn't corral the littlest burger" into dressing up

Spooky season

Halloween parties were the flavour of the weekend, with celebrities playing dress-up for the scariest night of the year

NBA star Stephen Curry and his wife Ayesha channelled characters from the horror-comedy film *The Lost Boys*

PICS: INSTAGRAM

Model Cara Delevingne dressed up as Tim Curry's Frank-N-Furter from *The Rocky Horror Picture Show*, captioning her post "Tim Curry forever"

Singer Jennifer Lopez paid tribute to her *Monster-in-Law* co-star Jane Fonda by dressing as her Barbarella character for Halloween and calling Fonda "the original space angel"

Model Heidi Klum dressed up as a giant, bloodied replica of her own hand, complete with oversized fingers and statement rings

$30 million worth of cocaine turns to flour

PICS: GETTY IMAGES

Nearly 40 kilograms of cocaine, held as evidence in a major drug case in Fiji's capital city Suva, have gone missing from the court. According to media reports, the drug, valued at about $31 million, was swapped out for flour.

The stolen drug was kept in the High Court in Suva. In September, it was found that seven out of the 39 bars in the evidence room were stolen. Police then started investigating, and forensic tests showed that the exhibits had all been tampered with.

The drugs, valued at $31 million, had been stored as evidence in the court for an upcoming trial

"The exhibits were all tampered with, and the investigation is focused on those directly charged with the management of the exhibits at the High Court registry," the police said.

Media outlets reported that the remaining 32 bars had been filled with flour. "It's shocking... no one will be spared," Justice Minister Siromi Turaga said, adding that it was not the first such instance.

The cocaine was seized from Fiji-Canadian national Joshua Aziz Rahman in 2019 and stored at the court as evidence while he appealed against his 2021 conviction and sentence •

– Reuters

ET Achievers KARNATAKA 2026

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An Optimal Media Solutions Initiative, A division of Times Internet Limited

ET ACHIEVERS 2026: A CELEBRATION OF VISION, LEADERSHIP AND ACHIEVEMENT

Shriya Saran

Bengaluru's spirit of enterprise, innovation and leadership took centre stage at ET Achievers 2026, held on October 12 at JW Marriott on Vittal Mallya Road. Organised by Optimal Media Solutions, a division of Times Internet Limited, The Times of India, the event celebrated individuals and organisations that made significant contributions across diverse professional sectors.

The awardees represented varied industries, reflecting Bengaluru's dynamic professional landscape. Their achievements highlighted their vision, perseverance and commitment to driving progress, while showcasing how innovation, leadership and consistent performance can create lasting impact. Their journeys also offered inspiration to emerging professionals and aspiring entrepreneurs.

Actor Shriya Saran graced the occasion as the chief guest, adding glamour to the celebrations. Shabbeer hosted the evening, guiding the proceedings and keeping the celebrations engaging.

An ET Brand Equity keynote address by Salman Ahmed, Vice President, Presidency Group of Institutions, added an institutional and leadership perspective to the gathering, complementing its focus on achievement and professional growth.

The recognition process was supported by independent research agency Avance Insights Pvt. Ltd., whose surveys and analysis brought a structured, research-led approach to identifying achievers. The process underscored the event's emphasis on acknowledging accomplishments through systematic assessment.

Bengaluru-based Colors Dance Team added to the evening's entertainment with a spectacular performance. The team has over 15 years of experience and more than 5,000 shows across India.

JW Marriott was the hospitality partner, while Shakti Auto Cars joined as the luxury automobile partner.

ET Achievers 2026 concluded as a celebration of ambition, leadership and professional accomplishment, honouring those making a difference in their respective fields while inspiring others to pursue new milestones.

Keynote Speaker

Salman Ahmed, Vice President
Presidency Group of Institutions

The Art of Engagement: MC Shabbeer

The ET Achievers 2026 was hosted by MC Shabbeer. An event finds its pulse in the hands of a host who understands people. Shabbeer brings sharp wit, assured stage presence and an instinct for audience engagement to every occasion he hosts.

"Over the years, hosting corporate events, celebrations and team engagements has taught me that every audience has its own personality. You can prepare your script, rehearse your introductions and plan your punchlines, but you still have to earn the attention of the people in front of you. Wit is a wonderful bridge, but it comes with responsibility. I want people to enjoy an exchange and feel comfortable joining in. The real satisfaction is seeing a reserved participant open up, a formal gathering become warmer or an entire room share a spontaneous laugh," he says.

> The microphone gives me a voice; the audience gives the occasion its life. Storytelling is the bridge between us—it sparks curiosity, creates connection and makes a moment memorable. The art is in making everyone feel part of the story.
>
> — Shabbeer

His storytelling instinct extends to his writing. The author of Djinns & Kings – The Curse of Zoa, he is developing his upcoming novel, Manticore – Maneater Beyond Indus, exploring historical fantasy and creature horror.

Colors Dance Team performing live at the event

Ramcharan S.R, violinist performing at the event

Luxury Automobile Partner
SHAKTI AUTO CARS
AUTHORISED RETAILER FOR JLR

Hospitality Partner
JW MARRIOTT
Vittal Mallya Road, Bengaluru

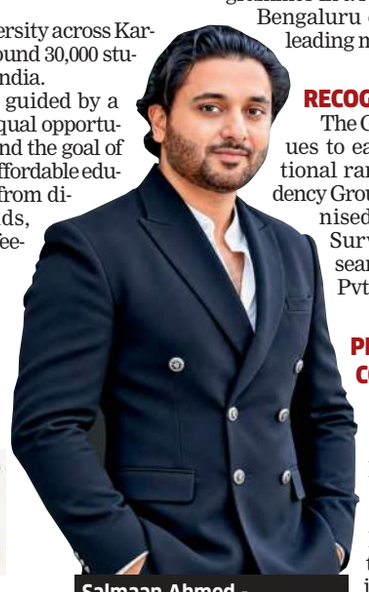
	Winner	Category
1	Adarsh Group	Real Estate Developer - Residential
2	Embassy Developments Ltd	Excellence in Corporate Rebranding & Brand Repositioning
3	Gopalan Fortune City, Gopalan Enterprises	IT Park of The Year
4	Assetz	Excellence in Residential Real Estate
5	Sridhar G, Founder & MD Deeksha Vedantu & Deeksha Stem Schools	Transformative Leader in K-12 Education
6	Riviera Glade, Goyal & Co | Hariyana Group	Premium Villa Project
7	Habulus Groups	Excellence in Construction Standards
8	Bhavisha Homes	Excellence in Luxury Housing Developer
9	Embassy Riverine, Embassy Developments Ltd	Environment Friendly Luxury Villas
10	DPS Bangalore South	Excellence in 25 Years of Educational Legacy
11	Adarsh Primrose, Adarsh Group	Lifestyle Project of The Year
12	Vaishnavi Group	Excellence in Luxury Residential Development
13	Giniminds Solutions Private Limited	Excellence in Data Foundation for Ai Transformation
14	Ayana Woods by Maa Acorn	Pioneer in Curating Longevity and Wellness Anchored Villa Community in Bengaluru
15	DS Max Properties Pvt Ltd	Prestigious Brand 2026
16	ESD	Emerging Real Estate Brand of 2026
17	Giniiris Technology Private Limited	Excellence in Ai Driven Customer Experience Innovation
18	Saahil Ahmed, Vice Chairman TCIS Group of Schools	Visionary Leader in Education
19	Terrain Estates	Emerging Developer in Premium Farm Plots, Villas and Residential Projects
20	Salman Ahmed, Vice President Presidency Group of Institutions	Excellence in Education & Social Impact
21	Xanadu Realty Ltd	Mandate Partner of The Year
22	The Clan, Global Edifice Infra	Premium Apartment Project
23	ARS Infraa	Realty Visionary Excellence
24	Jain Heritage Sports School, Hebbal in Collaboration With 91 Sporting Co.	Excellence in Academic & Sports Integration
25	Leaf Villa Enclave by Terra Blue Projects	Luxury Lifestyle Plotted Development of 2026
26	Rajarajeswari Medical College & Hospital	Excellence in Super Speciality Healthcare-Neurosurgery
27	Embassy Eden, Embassy Developments Ltd	Luxury Lifestyle Villa Project
28	Vishwanath Bathi, Surya Developers	Real Estate Entrepreneur - Excellence in Business Leadership
29	Adarsh Welkin Park, Adarsh Group	Residential Real Estate Project
30	Akash Nagpal, Executive Chairman, Krupanidhi Group of Institutions & Asia Pacific World School	Young Education Entrepreneur
31	Dr. Anuradha Venkatesh, Chief Operating Officer AECS Group of Institutions	Excellence in Transformative Leadership In Education
32	Rainbow Mayfair by Rainbow Properties	Excellent Luxury Project of 2026
33	Svamitva SR Water and Woods, Svamitva Group	Excellent Innovative Real Estate Project
34	AK Appleply	Excellence in Manufacturing of Premium Plywoods and Allied Wood Products Through Eco Friendly Process
35	Archventure	Excellence in Health Care Architecture & Design Innovation
36	NVG Group	Promising Developer
37	Saibya Group	Emerging Developer - Residential
38	Gruhanza Interiors	Premium and Luxury Interior Designers
39	Myfra India Pvt Ltd Myfra Group of Companies	Excellence in Community-Based Farmland Projects
40	Anand Swarnn	Excellence in Heritage Bridal Jewellery
41	Vijaya Enterprises	Excellence in Construction and Development of Urban Standards Projects - Residential & Commercial
42	Melange One, Vaishnodevi Melange Estates LLP	Excellence in Architecture Design 2026
43	Between The Greens by SPD Surya Builders and Developers	Outstanding Luxury Villa Project
44	Vantage Point Property	Excellence in Plotted Development
45	Avinash Books and Stationery	Excellence in School Book Distribution
46	ESD Earthern Ambience	Luxury Villa Project of 2026
47	Dr Raghavendra Bakki Sannegowda	Service Excellence in Neurology Education and Research
48	Dhermesh Manghnani, President New Horizon Educational Institutions	Excellence in Educational Innovation & Industry Integration
49	Maruti Ventures	Excellence in Residential Affordable
50	Dhruvija Gopura, Dhruvija Properties LLP	Excellence in Luxury Apartment
51	Rama B Raj, Managing Director NewAge World School	Excellence in School Governance & Academic Standards
52	Lalithaa Jewellery Mart Ltd	Excellence in Popular Brand in Jewellery
53	Surya Developers	Trusted Developer
54	Dhrumini Vatika, Dhruvija Properties LLP	Excellence in Luxury Lifestyle - Oriented Farm Development
55	constructAhome	Excellence in Home Constructions

SPIRIT OF ACHIEVEMENT HONOURED

CELEBRATING INNOVATION & HARD WORK

Salmaan Ahmed is the Vice President of the Presidency Group of Institutions, one of Karnataka's longest-established education groups. He was recently honoured with the ET Achievers 2026 award for Excellence in Education and Social Impact. The award recognises his work in raising academic and administrative standards across the Group's institutions and his belief that quality education should drive social progress.

In his role, he oversees the Group's institutions with a focus on accountability, strong governance and student outcomes. That work covers operations, audits and resource management across schools and colleges, as well as student welfare initiatives such as health camps and parent engagement programmes.



Salmaan Ahmed - Vice President, Presidency Group of Institutions

THE PRESIDENCY LEGACY

The Group's story began in 1976, when Nissar Ahmed and his uncle, Abdul Hameed, started a school in Bengaluru with only eight students. Nearly five decades later, it has grown into a network of eight schools (four ICSE and four CBSE), three colleges and a university across Karnataka, serving around 30,000 students from across India.

The schools are guided by a commitment to "Equal opportunity in diversity" and the goal of providing quality, affordable education to students from diverse backgrounds, under Director Nafeesa Ahmed.

HIGHER EDUCATION

Presidency University, established in 2013, sits on a 100-acre green campus on the Yelahanka–Doddaballapur highway in north Bengaluru and has partnerships with over 100 institutions in 35 countries. It also hosts the Presidency Launchpad Association, a non-profit technology business incubator. Presidency College has been re-accredited by NAAC with an "A+" grade and has received several rankings, including affiliated colleges for BCA and BA programmes in a ranking released in 2021 Bengaluru colleges by one of the leading media house.

RECOGNITION

The Group of Schools continues to earn recognition in national rankings. Notably, Presidency Group of Schools was recognised in the Times School Survey 2025 based on research by Avance Insights Pvt Ltd.

PRE-UNIVERSITY COLLEGES

The Group's PU colleges, including Presidency PU College, Kogilu, offer rigorous academics alongside cultural fests, sports and leadership opportunities. Students' progress is supported through close attendance tracking and regular parent-teacher meetings.

LOOKING AHEAD

With a legacy of almost 50 years and leadership recognised at the national level, the Presidency Group remains committed to building competence and character in every student and to preparing young people for the world ahead.

Shaima Ahmed, Salmaan Ahmed, Vice President and Kauser Ahmed, Chancellor, Presidency Group of Institutions

Ayana Woods by Maa Acorn, a longevity and wellness-anchored villa project

Bengaluru's luxury residential landscape is witnessing a shift towards wellness-led living, with Ayana Woods by Maa Acorn Lifestyle Pvt. Ltd recently receiving recognition at ET Achievers 2026 for pioneering a villa community anchored in longevity and wellness. Located in Sarjapura, the 75-acre development brings together nature, preventive health, everyday movement and community engagement, reflecting an evolving vision of luxury that extends beyond architecture and amenities to quality of life.

Traditionally, luxury housing has been defined by expansive homes, premium finishes and exclusive amenities. Ayana Woods takes a different approach, focusing on how the residential environment can support healthier routines and more meaningful everyday experiences. Its philosophy places well-being at the centre of daily living rather than treating it as an occasional pursuit.

A key feature of the development is its 8-acre resort-style club, designed by Modern Bali Themed Villas Studio. Envisioned as a wellness and social destination, the club incorporates a longevity clinic, sauna and recovery suite, dining spaces, sports facilities and areas for social interaction. The first phase of the project encompasses approximately 1.5 lakh sq. ft. of built-up area.

The development also emphasises the relationship between nature and everyday activity. Aranya, an expansive forest park with shaded walking trails, is designed to encourage outdoor movement and closer engagement with the natural environment. This approach reflects the growing importance of accessible green spaces and opportunities for physical activity in residential planning by the developer.

ayana WOODS
LIVE LONGER. LIVE BETTER

A project by MAA | ACORN

Beyond physical wellness, Ayana Woods aims to foster social connection within the community. Initiatives such as the Ayana Run Club and shared dining pavilions are planned to encourage residents to interact and build relationships. The Founders' Circle, introduced for the first 50 homeowners, offers lifetime privileges, priority clinic programming and curated social evenings.

Siva Allu, Founder and Managing Director of Maa Acorn received the award from Shriya Saran

The opening phase spans 47 acres and comprises 456 villas across four typologies including Asri, Amara, Agung and Awan. The homes range from 2,800 to 6,400 sq. ft., offering different residential options within the larger development.

With registration under Karnataka RERA, the project is open to prospective buyers, with private previews available at its Sarjapura experience centre.

The recognition was conferred at ET Achievers 2026 on 12 October 2026 at JW Marriott, Bengaluru. For Maa Acorn Lifestyle, the recognition marks a milestone in its vision of residential development that brings together thoughtfully designed homes, natural surroundings, wellness infrastructure and community living.

As urban lifestyles continue to evolve, Ayana Woods seeks to redefine luxury by making well-being an integral part of the way people live, connect and experience their surroundings.

RERA NO- TOR/PRM/KA/RERA/1251/308/PR/260223/001644

For more information contact:
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Call-+917090454000
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Website- www.maa-acorn.com

Indicative images representation only

Vantage Point Property: Where Trust Meets Investment

Building confidence in real estate through thoughtful planning, responsible development and lasting relationships.

BUILDING TRUST. CREATING VALUE

In real estate, a great investment begins with the right foundation—not just in land, but in trust. Bengaluru-based Vantage Point Property is building its presence in plotted development with a clear philosophy: create property opportunities that inspire confidence and serve the aspirations of homebuyers and investors.

Recognised for Excellence in Plotted Development at ET Achievers 2026, this accomplishment reinforces the company's commitment to responsible development, transparency and customer confidence.

BEYOND PLOTS, TOWARDS POSSIBILITIES

A plot represents more than land. It can be the foundation of a family's future home or a long-term investment. Vantage Point Property emphasises legal due diligence, statutory compliance, planned infrastructure and transparent customer communication to help buyers make informed decisions.

With a growing portfolio across emerging growth corridors around Bengaluru, the company seeks to identify promising locations and create opportunities that align with the aspirations of discerning property buyers.

For partners Ambarish T.V. and Raghavendra Rao K.N., lasting success is measured not merely by projects delivered, but by the trust earned along the way. Their vision is to build a brand recognised for integrity, thoughtful development and enduring customer relationships.

As Vantage Point Property looks ahead, its commitment remains clear: build responsibly, communicate transparently and put customer confidence at the centre of every opportunity.

PROJECTS

Felicity | Harohalli
RERA approved plotted development progressing towards registration.

Vasudha | Nelamangala
Residential plotted-development opportunity in an emerging growth corridor.

Sindhoor Green City/Harohalli
Strategically positioned residential plots in a fast-growing corridor with significant development potential.

Vantage Point Property — Where trust meets investment.

Vasudha - PRM/KA/RERA/1250/307/PR/250826/008894
Felicity - PRM/KA/RERA/1270/305/PR/300426/008610
Sindhoor Green City - PRM/KA/RERA/1270/305/PR/070726/008794

For more details, contact
Vantage Point Property
Call: 7996909690
Website: vantagepointproperty.in
email: hello@vantagepointproperty.in

Ambarish T V, Managing Partner, Raghavendra Rao K N, Managing Partner

Jain Heritage Sports School: Live Sports. Learn Strong

Jain Heritage Sports School (JHSS), a performance integrated sports school in Hebbal, Bengaluru. The initiative brings together structured sports training and academic learning, enabling students to pursue their sporting ambitions without compromising their education. Built on the belief that sports inspire learning while academics enrich growth, JHSS offers a balanced environment where young athletes can discover their potential, strengthen their abilities, and develop the mind-set needed to excel both on and off the field.

In collaboration with 91 Sporting Co., JHSS aims to create a structured sporting ecosystem where students benefit from dedicated coaching, systematic training, and opportunities to develop their abilities across various sports. The initiative focuses on nurturing talent while instilling essential values such as discipline, perseverance, teamwork, sportsmanship, and resilience.

JAIN HERITAGE SPORTS SCHOOL
Powered By 91 Sporting

JHSS follows a structured programme that combines sports-specific skill sessions, strength and conditioning, classroom learning, and life skills development. With dedicated training schedules, academic support, remedial sessions, and study periods, the programme is designed to help students balance their sporting commitments with academic responsibilities. The school mainly emphasises on discipline, teamwork, leadership, resilience, and sportsmanship—qualities that extend beyond the playing field and contribute to students' overall development.

JHSS currently offers cricket, football, badminton, swimming, shooting, basketball, gymnastic, table tennis, skating and chess for students from Grades 1 to 12. With specialised training opportunities and sports-focused development pathways, students are trained to refine their techniques, improve their performance, and work towards their individual goals.

The programme is supported by sports facilities that include cricket nets and turf wickets, a football ground, a cricket ground, a high-performance gym, indoor badminton courts, a swimming pool, a video analysis room, and physiotherapy and rehabilitation support.

At Jain Heritage Sports School, the vision goes beyond creating accomplished athletes. It is about nurturing confident, disciplined, and well-rounded individuals who can pursue eminence in sport and life.

Admission open for academic year 2027-28.

For more details, contact:
Jain Heritage Sports School
Address: Anjaneya Temple Street, Vinayakanagar, Kempapura, Bengaluru – 560024
Call: 080 2362 6122 / 23
Email: info@jhs.ac.in
Website: www.jhs.ac.in/jain-heritage-sports-school/

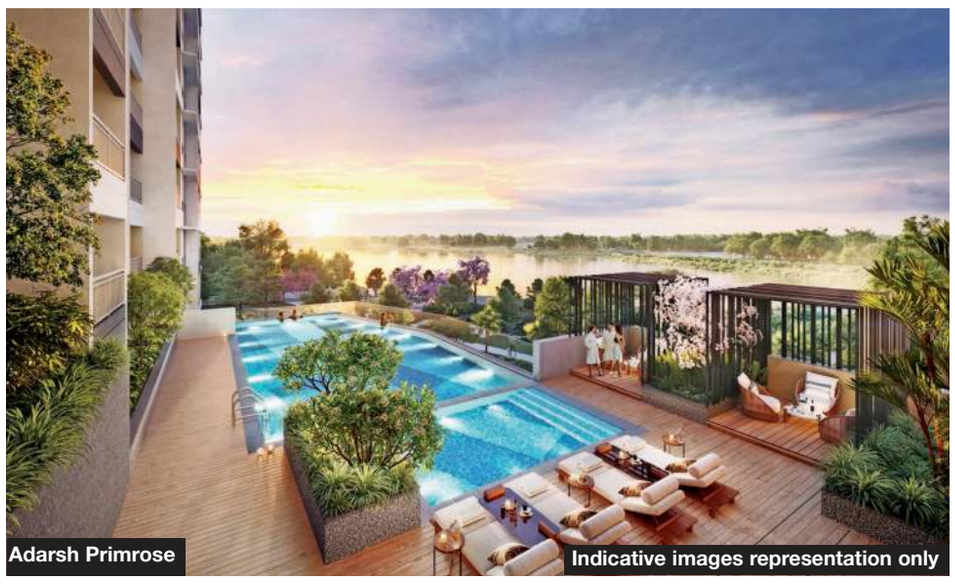
Building Beyond the Skyline: Adarsh Group's Evolving Idea of Home

A legacy shaped by Bengaluru's growth

When Adarsh Group was established in Bengaluru in 1988, the city was on the cusp of transformation. Known for its gardens and measured pace of life, Bengaluru was beginning to emerge as a centre for technology, enterprise and new ambition. As the city expanded, so did the expectations people brought to their homes. For Adarsh Group, this changing urban landscape became an opportunity to think beyond the conventional apartment and consider how a residential development could shape everyday life.

B M Jayeshankar

Adarsh Primrose awarded as Lifestyle Project of the Year 2026


Adarsh Primrose

Indicative images representation only

Adarsh Group awarded Real Estate Developer – Residential 2026 received by Abilash Issac AVP and Head of Marketing and Communication and Sanjit Sharma AVP and Head Sales

A LEGACY DEFINED BY EXCELLENCE, HONOURED AGAIN

Founded by B. M. Jayeshankar, Adarsh Group has built its identity around quality, design, meticulous planning and a deep understanding of the people who inhabit its spaces. Over the years, the Group has established a legacy rooted in trust, consistency and a commitment to creating exceptional living experiences.

This commitment to excellence has continued to earn industry-wide recognition. In 2026, Adarsh Group was honoured with the Real Estate Developer – Residential award at the ET Achievers' Awards, further strengthening its reputation for excellence in residential development. This recognition follows the Trusted Brand of the Year award at the Times Business Awards in 2025 and the Trusted Developer of the Year award at the ET Achievers' Awards in 2024.

Each accolade stands as a testament to the Group's enduring values, customer trust and unwavering pursuit of quality. A legacy defined by excellence, and honoured once again.

Early residential projects helped establish the brand's emphasis on finishes, landscaped surroundings and shared amenities at a time when such features were not yet standard across the city's apartment market. Over the years, Adarsh expanded into larger residential communities, including gated villa developments, while also entering hospitality and commercial real estate. Projects such as Adarsh Palm Meadows and Adarsh Palm Retreat became important markers in the Group's evolution, demonstrating how housing could bring together privacy, open space and community infrastructure.

The portfolio has since broadened to include luxury and premium apartments, villas and plotted developments, serving different aspirations and stages of life. The Group's official profile describes a business spanning residential, commercial and hospitality spaces, supported by a focus on trust, quality and consistency. Industry recognition has accompanied its growth, but a developer's longer legacy is ultimately experienced in residents' daily lives: in the durability of a home, the usability of shared spaces and the relationships that grow within a community.

As Chairman and Managing Director, B. M. Jayeshankar remains closely associated with the Group's emphasis on design and execution. His journey has unfolded alongside Bengaluru's transformation into a major technology and employment hub. Buyers today look not only for a well-planned home, but also for access to work, recreation, nature and social connection. Adarsh's current projects respond to these overlapping expectations, with each development expressing the idea of home in a different way.

ADARSH GROUP
Creating memories for a lifetime™

ADARSH WELKIN PARK APARTMENTS: A VERTICAL COMMUNITY WITH A GREEN OUTLOOK

Adarsh Welkin Park Apartments includes an apartment offering that interprets similar lifestyle aspirations through a vertical form. Located off Sarjapur Road, Welkin Park Apartments offers 2.5 and 3 BHK homes and is presented by the Group as a lake-facing residential community. Its proposition brings together the convenience of apartment living and an emphasis on greenery, views and shared amenities.

The layouts are intended to accommodate contemporary households' different rhythms: shared family time, work or study from home, and the need for private spaces within a larger residence 2.5 BHK homes with a built-up area of about 1,422 sq. ft. and 3 BHK homes of about 1804 sq. ft.. In a city where many residents balance demanding work schedules with family commitments, thoughtful planning can make a meaningful difference to how comfortably a home functions.

The Project has extensive amenities such as a swimming pool, gym, badminton and squash courts, table tennis, a creche, banquet spaces, yoga and aerobics facilities, a home theatre and a supermarket, among many others. Together, these facilities create opportunities for exercise, recreation, convenience and social interaction within the residential setting.

The lake-facing setting and landscaped environment are central to the project's identity. As Bengaluru grows denser, access to open and green spaces has become an important consideration for homebuyers. Views of the landscape, places to walk or exercise, and spaces to meet other residents can provide a counterpoint to the intensity of urban life. The project's design proposition is not simply about building upwards; it is about combining the efficiencies of apartment living with a sense of openness and community.

Seen together, the villas and apartments at Welkin Park offer two interpretations of premium residential living within the same broader location. The villas foreground independence and private outdoor space, while the apartments emphasise shared facilities, vertical living and a lake-facing environment. This range reflects a wider reality in Bengaluru's housing market: there is no single definition of an ideal home. Preferences change with family size, work patterns, lifestyle and life stage.

ADARSH PRIMROSE: EVERYDAY LIFE IN EAST BENGALURU

Adarsh Primrose, located in Gunjur, brings the focus to premium apartment living in East Bengaluru. The Project offers 3 BHK apartments, with super built-up areas ranging from 1,770 to 1,880 sq. ft. Its positioning centres on a balance between a calmer residential environment and access to the employment, education, healthcare and retail infrastructure that shapes daily life in this part of the city.

Gunjur places Adarsh Primrose within reach of major work hubs such as Whitefield, Marathahalli and the Outer Ring Road corridor. For professionals and families, connectivity affects the time available for family, rest and recreation. As employment centres have spread across Bengaluru, homebuyers increasingly weigh a residence not just by its address, but by how well it fits the practical geography of their week. Primrose's location speaks to the need for a home base that connects with the city's economic activity while retaining a residential character.

The project's amenity list includes a swimming pool, kids' pool, basketball court, cricket practice net, jogging rink, outdoor gym, amphitheatre, party lawn, play lawn, pickleball court, biodiversity park, skating rink and yoga pavilion, among other facilities. The range spans active recreation, family use and quieter outdoor experiences. Landscaped and planted spaces can give a residential development a more varied environment, rather than treating open space as leftover land between buildings.

The apartments are specified with features such as laminated wooden flooring in master bedroom and vitrified flooring in living and dining areas. The project also includes rainwater harvesting, a sewage treatment plant and a dual-piping system that uses treated recycled water for toilet flushing. These measures are relevant to the wider conversation about using resources more thoughtfully; their long-term effectiveness depends on implementation, maintenance and responsible use.

Adarsh Primrose complements the wider portfolio. Where Welkin Park offers both independent villas and lake-facing apartments, Primrose focuses on 3 BHK apartment living in Gunjur, with recreational amenities, landscaped spaces and access to East Bengaluru's employment corridors. It is a proposition for households seeking a well-appointed home that supports family life while remaining connected to the city's evolving urban network.

A HOME IS ALSO A COMMUNITY

Across its legacy and current developments, Adarsh Group's story reflects the changing ambitions of Bengaluru itself. The city's growth has created new possibilities, but it has also made the quality of everyday living more important: how homes are planned, how shared spaces work, how residents connect with nature and how a neighbourhood supports the people who live in it. Enduring residential environments are shaped not by a single feature, but by the relationship between design, location, construction quality and the life that unfolds after residents move in.

For Adarsh Group, the work that began in Bengaluru in 1988 continues in a city that is still changing. Buildings may define a skyline, but the true measure of a residential development is what happens within and around them over time: the routines it accommodates, the relationships it enables and the memories residents create. Building a home is only the beginning. The larger task is to create a place where people can build a life.

Adarsh Welkin Park Apartments-Phase 2 PRM/KA/RERA/1251/308/PR/080725/007900
Adarsh Primrose PRM/KA/RERA/1251/446/PR/140325/007583

For more details, contact:
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Website Address:
www.adarshdevelopers.com

Adarsh Welkin Park Apartments

Adarsh Welkin Park Apartments awarded as Residential Project of the Year 2026

A New Era in Healthcare and Healing

Healthcare goes beyond just treating illnesses; it's about ensuring that people feel safe, supported, and confident in their care. At RajaRajeswari Medical College and Hospital (RRMCH) in Bengaluru, this philosophy shines through in a wide array of services designed to meet the diverse medical needs of patients.

Nestled in South-West Bengaluru, the hospital boasts modern infrastructure, modern medical technology, and a team of experienced healthcare professionals. With 1,400 beds and 24/7 emergency services, it's equipped to handle everything from everyday health issues to complex conditions that require specialized treatment.

What sets this hospital apart is its vast network of specialty and super-specialty departments, which include cardiology, cardiothoracic & vascular surgery, neurology, neurosurgery, nephrology, oncology, endocrinology, gastroenterology, plastic surgery, and paediatric surgery, allowing patients to receive comprehensive care all in one place.

Embracing the latest advancements in medicine, RRMCH continues to strengthen its capabilities through modern technology, including its newly opened Robotic Surgery Department. This marks a significant leap towards technology-assisted surgical care, working hand-in-hand with the expertise of its medical teams. The fully equipped modular operation theatres further empower surgeons to perform complex procedures with confidence.

Critical care is a cornerstone of the hospital's services. Well-equipped intensive care units, dedicated inpatient wards, and modern private rooms provide support to patients needing close monitoring, specialised treatment, and recovery care. A dedicated team of doctors, nurses, and trained technical staff collaborates to meet patient needs throughout their hospital journey.

Accurate diagnosis is crucial, and the hospital is equipped with advanced imaging facilities, including CT scanners, MRI machines, ultrasound, X-ray, and digital mammography. Well-equipped laboratories, endoscopy services, dialysis, physiotherapy, and specialised respiratory medicine facilities ensure that patients receive thorough and precise evaluations.

Several essential support services operate around the clock, including the in-house blood bank, pharmacy, ambulance services, and laboratory facilities.

Beyond its clinical services, RRMCH is dedicated to making healthcare accessible to the wider community. Through rural health centres and outreach programmes, it has reached thousands of villagers. Affordable dialysis services also help support people from financially challenged backgrounds.

By combining specialised medical expertise, advanced technology, essential support services, and community outreach, RajaRajeswari Medical College and Hospital (RRMCH) continues to play an important role in meeting the healthcare needs of Bengaluru and India.

Robotic Surgery

Leading with Purpose, Inspiring through Education

Rama B. Raj received award from Shriya Saran

For Rama B. Raj, Managing Director of NewAge World School, education is about nurturing confident, independent individuals who are equipped to navigate a rapidly changing world. Her deep connection with nature and a childhood shaped by discipline, moderation and a strong work ethic continue to influence her leadership philosophy and the ethos of the institution she has built.

When Rama Raj acquired NewAge World School in 2015, the institution had limited infrastructure and low student enrolment. Although she was new to the education sector, she recognized its potential and embarked on an ambitious journey to transform it into a center of academic standards and holistic development. Supported by her husband, Chairman D. H. Basavaraju, and her children, Associate Directors Rakshith Raj and Akshitha Basavaraju, she worked towards creating a distinctive learning environment guided by a clear vision and unwavering determination.

Rama B. Raj, Managing Director, NewAge World School

Today, the school's expansive campus reflects this commitment, with extensive sports facilities, including football fields, tennis and badminton courts, cricket pitches, a swimming pool and an indoor sporting arena. Believing that physical fitness and personal passions are integral to a child's development, Rama Raj introduced Sportivo, an inter-school sporting event, alongside the annual NewAge Games. The school encourages students to pursue their interests while receiving academic support, ensuring that talent and education progress together.

Her commitment to innovation led to the establishment of the NewAge Department of Excellence in Education (NDEE) in 2018. The initiative strengthened technology-enabled learning and helped the school transition smoothly to virtual education during the pandemic. Digital lesson plans, learning capsules and collaborative activities ensured continuity in academics while incorporating exercises, yoga and dance to support students' physical and socio-emotional well-being.

At the heart of Rama Raj's leadership philosophy is the belief that an institution grows when its people grow. She champions effective delegation, trust, recognition and the development of leadership capabilities within her team. By encouraging new ideas and empowering educators to take ownership, she fosters a collaborative culture centred on student welfare.

For Rama Raj, the ultimate measure of success extends beyond academic achievements. It lies in nurturing responsible, capable and compassionate individuals. Through her vision and commitment, she continues to shape NewAge World School into an institution where academic rigour, sporting calibre, innovation and personal growth go hand in hand.

Maruti Ventures: Building Quality Homes, Creating Lasting Value

Attipatla Ramakrishna, Lekkala Chakrapani and team received award from Shriya Saran

Established in 2016, Maruti Ventures is a Bengaluru-based real estate and construction company focused on developing quality residential spaces that combine functionality, thoughtful design, and contemporary living. Guided by its founders, Attipatla Ramakrishna and Lekkala Chakrapani, the company continues to strengthen its presence in Bengaluru's evolving real estate market.

Maruti Ventures believes that building a home goes beyond constructing walls; it means creating comfortable living environments, nurturing customer trust, and delivering long-term value. Its approach emphasises quality construction, efficient space planning, customer satisfaction, and a commitment to developing homes suited to modern lifestyles.

The company's completed around 9 projects. These developments reflect its focus on residential construction and its ambition to create thoughtfully planned living spaces. The leadership team brings together experience in project execution, operations, business development, and construction management, supporting the company's commitment to quality and continuous growth.

MARUTI AKRIDA: A NEW CHAPTER IN MODERN LIVING

A key ongoing development in the company's portfolio is Maruti Akrida, located on Sarjapura–Attibele Road, one of Bengaluru's emerging residential destinations. Planned across approximately four acres, the project features three towers and 322 residential units, with ground plus six floors.

Maruti Akrida offers a selection of 2, 3, and 4 BHK apartments, with unit sizes ranging from approximately 1,098 to 2,390 square feet. The project is designed to bring together spacious homes, lifestyle amenities, and convenient access to important destinations around the neighbourhood.

Its amenities are planned to support a balanced lifestyle for residents of different age groups. These include a swimming pool, indoor and outdoor gyms, landscaped gardens, a walking track, a children's play area, a multipurpose party hall, an amphitheatre, badminton and basketball courts, indoor games, a cricket practice pitch, and dedicated spaces for senior citizens and pets. Wellness facilities such as a jacuzzi, sauna, and steam room further complement the lifestyle offering.

The project's location provides access to educational institutions, healthcare facilities, employment hubs, and key road networks. Nearby destinations highlighted in the project brochure include Azim Premji University, Attibele Industrial Area, Oxford Medical College and Hospital, and the proposed Chandapura metro connection.

Looking ahead, Maruti Ventures aims to expand its development portfolio while remaining focused on quality, innovation, and customer-centric planning. Through projects such as Maruti Akrida, the company seeks to contribute to Bengaluru's growing residential landscape and create homes that offer lasting value.

Maruti Akrida - PRM/KA/RERA/1251/308/PR/210825/008019

For more details, contact:
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sales@marutiventures.com
8150041666

Global Edifice, The Clan: Where Thoughtful Development Meets Contemporary Living

Contemporary living is shaped not just by the homes people choose, but by the quality, design and thought that go into creating them. At Global Edifice The Clan, the focus is on bringing together considered development and the expectations of today's homebuyers. The project reflects a philosophy that values purposeful design, construction quality and a long-term perspective on residential living, recognising that a home should serve not only present needs but also the aspirations of the years ahead.

Indicative image representation only

HOMES DESIGNED FOR MODERN ASPIRATIONS

Comprising 257 apartments, Global Edifice The Clan offers 2 BHK, 2.5 BHK and 3 BHK configurations to suit diverse household needs and lifestyle preferences. The development features a Basement + Ground + 9 floors structure, complemented by modern amenities designed to enhance everyday living and ample parking provision for residents. Its range of configurations allows homebuyers to evaluate choices based on their lifestyle requirements and future aspirations.

SARJAPUR ROAD: A LOCATION WITH GROWING RELEVANCE

Sarjapur Road has emerged as one of the prominent residential corridors in Bengaluru, supported by its proximity to employment hubs, established neighbourhoods and the city's expanding eastern growth belt. For professionals and families, the location offers an opportunity to consider connectivity, work commutes and access to everyday conveniences when choosing a home.

Located along this growing corridor, The Clan offers homebuyers a contemporary residential choice that aligns with the evolving lifestyle aspirations of Bengaluru.

A DECADE OF BUILDING TRUST

Since 2015, Global Edifice has pursued a development philosophy centred on prime locations, smart design, quality construction, timely delivery and thoughtfully crafted amenities. These principles reflect the company's focus on creating homes that combine functionality with lasting value.

With The Clan, Global Edifice continues its journey of developing residential spaces that respond to contemporary homebuyer needs, while keeping customer trust and quality at the heart of its approach.

PROJECT HIGHLIGHTS

- Location: Sarjapur Road, Bengaluru
- Total apartments: 257
- Configurations: 2 BHK, 2.5 BHK and 3 BHK
- Structure: Basement + Ground + 9 floors
- RERA possession timeline: December 2028

RERA No: PRM/KA/1251/308/PR/091025/008153

For more details, contact:
Global Edifice The Clan
Call: +91 941 161 4444
Address: Sy. No. 310/2, Sarjapur Road, Sarjapura, Bengaluru– 562125

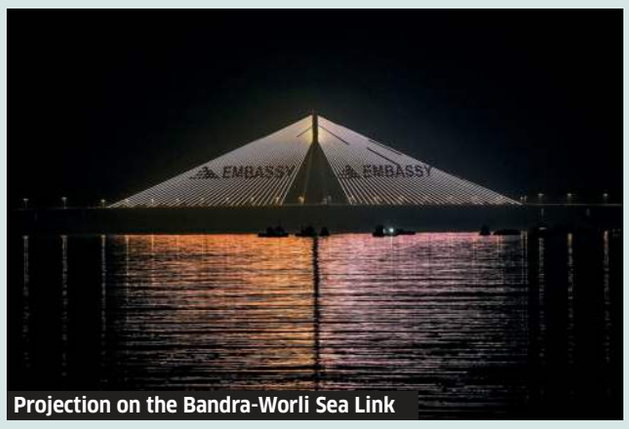
Embassy Reimagines Its Legacy with a Refreshed Brand Identity

From its Bengaluru origins to a diversified, pan-India group, Embassy's first comprehensive brand refresh in 34 years reflects the evolution of the organisation and its approach to an industry in transformation.

Embassy Group's story is closely intertwined with the evolution of Indian real estate. Jitu Virwani joined the property development business in 1985 and, since taking the helm of Embassy Group in 1993, has seen his vision of a organisation take shape. What began in Bengaluru has grown into a diversified Group spanning residential and commercial development, flexible workspaces, hospitality, integrated services and education, with over 100 million square feet managed and delivered.

As Indian real estate has evolved towards greater institutional participation, professionalisation and national scale, so too has Embassy. Its first comprehensive brand refresh in 34 years reflects this transformation, bringing the Group's expanding portfolio under a unified identity.

> Legacy brands have a responsibility to evolve. As Embassy has grown, we wanted our identity to reflect the organisation we are today while staying true to why we exist – to consistently improve people's lives. The refresh brings this purpose into sharper focus, giving our brand a consistent expression across businesses and markets.
>
> **Emanda Vaz,**
> Chief Marketing Officer,
> Embassy Group



Projection on the Bandra-Worli Sea Link

EMBASSY

The refresh followed a months-long brand discovery journey involving leadership workshops, stakeholder interviews, customer and partner conversations, portfolio audits and competitive analysis. The process examined how Embassy was perceived, what its businesses stood for and how the parent brand could better represent the Group as a whole. The conclusion was that the task was not to reinvent Embassy, but to better articulate its established strengths.

This also meant taking a distinct position in a category often characterised by high-decibel, aspiration-led messaging. Embassy chose to foreground the substance behind its work: foresight in planning, design integrity, disciplined execution and long-term stewardship. At the heart of this approach is exceeding expectations, depicted not through exaggerated promises, but through how the Group actually thinks, plans and delivers.

The refreshed identity translates this thinking into a refined logo, contemporary typography and a more cohesive visual language. The pyramid, a recognisable element of Embassy's existing logo, has been retained, preserving the equity built over decades while giving the identity a more modern expression.

An integrated brand campaign brought this refreshed identity to audiences across India. Three films, forming the centrepiece of the campaign, were developed around familiar real estate clichés and contrasted conventional industry messaging with Embassy's more considered, execution-led approach. The films were shot on location using original footage rather than relying stock imagery, placing the emphasis on functional spaces and the planning behind them.

The campaign extended across television, digital, outdoor, print and public relations. A large-scale projection on the Bandra–Worli Sea Link marked a distinctive moment in Embassy's Mumbai expansion, bringing the refreshed identity to one of the city's most recognisable landmarks. The tagline, "New look, same outlook," captures the idea underpinning the exercise: an evolved identity that remains true to the Group's established ethos.

As Embassy continues to expand across markets and sectors, the refresh gives its businesses a more consistent way to express what they stand for, while carrying forward the principles that have shaped the Group's journey thus far.

Embassy Riverine: Reimagining Your Relationship with Nature

Embassy Riverine Villa Homes

At Embassy Riverine, the garden does not end at the boundary of the home. It opens into a larger landscape of trees, water and forest corridors, blurring the distinction between a private outdoor space and the natural world beyond. Set within Embassy Origins in North Bengaluru – an 85 acre development, this collection of 217 villa homes takes its cues from the land itself, creating a residential environment where the landscape is as integral to the experience of living as the architecture.

Available in 4, 4.5 and 5 BHK configurations, the villa homes range from around 4,180 to 6,928 sq. ft. in sale area. Their planning prioritises space, privacy and a gradual transition between intimate and shared places. Gently curving roads reduce direct sightlines between homes, while landscape buffers maintain separation. Entryways open into living and social spaces oriented towards the garden, with bedrooms positioned along the edges for privacy and natural light.

The villa home precinct is organised around six distinct forest corridors, each with a different ecological character. The Flowering Forest Corridor draws butterflies and birds through seasonal blooms, while the Healing and Fragrance Forest Corridor brings together medicinal and aromatic plants. An Edible Forest features fruit-bearing trees and edible plants, creating opportunities for foraging and community interaction. Grass, Active and Shade Forest corridors offer contrasting settings for quiet reflection, outdoor recreation and respite beneath a dense canopy.

These features reflect Embassy's natural intelligence philosophy, which places the site's natural characteristics at the centre of planning. At Embassy Origins, a preserved riparian corridor runs through the development, with the villa homes' backyards opening directly onto this natural landscape. Around 4,000 trees spanning 100–120 species complement the corridor, while four purposefully created lakes form part of an interconnected water-management system designed to capture and store rainwater, support groundwater recharge and sustain the wider ecosystem.

Embassy Riverine Clubhouse

Yoga Deck

At Embassy Riverine, this approach extends to the 40,000 sq. ft. clubhouse, spread across three floors on a dedicated parcel beside a lake. Wellness facilities, indoor and outdoor recreation areas, and spaces for social gatherings offer residents a range of ways to unwind and connect. Its roof is also designed to harvest rainwater, integrating the building with the development's broader water-management strategy.

For families seeking space to grow, privacy and a distinctive setting, Embassy Riverine offers a different proposition for villa living: a home where the garden opens onto a wider natural landscape, and the outdoors becomes an extension of the private realm.

RERA Number - PRM/KA/RERA/1251/309/PR/090926/008924

From Foundations to the Future: The Habulus Journey of Building Trust, Communities and a Lasting Legacy

Real estate is often measured through square feet, project scale and location. Yet for homebuyers, the value of a developer is ultimately shaped by something more enduring: the confidence that a home will be thoughtfully designed, carefully built and delivered with accountability. For Habulus Group, this belief forms an important part of its journey in Bengaluru's residential real estate market. The company's published history traces its roots to Accent Homez, a partnership firm, before its transition into Habulus Homes Pvt. Ltd. in 2019. That evolution marked a formal chapter in a business focused on residential development and building solutions. Since then, Habulus has sought to grow its portfolio while maintaining an emphasis on construction quality, transparency and customer relationships.

Indicative image representation only
Habulus Oasis

HABULUS
HOMES THAT GIVE MORE

Its completed residential portfolio includes Habulus Residency, Habulus Elite I and II, Sunshine, Harmony, Sunrise, Meadows and Heritage. These developments vary in scale, with apartment communities ranging from smaller projects to larger blocks of homes. Together, they offer a foundation for understanding the company's approach: not simply creating individual units, but planning residential spaces where everyday routines, privacy and a sense of community matter. In a market where buyers are increasingly discerning, trust cannot rest on marketing promises alone. It is built through the details of execution: clarity through the buying process, quality controls at construction sites, responsive customer support and a consistent focus on delivery. Habulus identifies these priorities—alongside integrity, innovation and customer satisfaction—as central to its philosophy. Its emphasis on qualified engineering and project teams reflects the role that planning and oversight play in translating design intent into a finished home.

The next chapter of this journey is represented by Habulus Oasis Grove, an upcoming residential development on Maragondanahalli Road in Electronic City Phase 1, South Bengaluru. Conceived on a 10-acre site, the project is planned across five towers with a total of 920 apartments. Its proposed design places emphasis on open space and shared amenities, including a 40,000-square-foot clubhouse and more than 90 lifestyle facilities. The project website also highlights the use of Mivan construction technology and a layout designed to balance contemporary living with landscaped spaces.

Santhosh Reddy, Executive Director, Vinod Yadav, Chairman & MD received award from Shriya Saran

(L-R) Santhosh Reddy, Executive Director, Ramesh, Joint Managing Director, Vinod Yadav, Chairman & MD

Oasis Grove reflects the changing expectations of urban homebuyers. For Habulus, the move from a portfolio of apartment developments to a larger community-led project also brings a broader responsibility. Scale must be matched by careful execution, transparent communication and attention to the long-term experience of residents. A lasting reputation in real estate is shaped after possession too—by how well a development serves the people who live there and how effectively a builder responds to their expectations.

As Bengaluru continues to expand and homebuyers seek a stronger balance between comfort, convenience and community, Habulus' challenge is to carry the lessons of its earlier projects into its next phase of growth. Its legacy will ultimately be measured not only by the homes it builds, but by the trust it earns and the everyday value those homes create for families. From its roots as Accent Homez to the scale envisioned at Oasis Grove, the journey ahead is about building for the future without losing sight of the foundations on which a home and a reputation is built.

RERA NO: Habulus Residency-PRM/KA/RERA/1251/310/AG/171114/000400
Habulus Tranquil -PRM/KA/RERA/1251/310/PR/020126/008378
Habulus Oasis Grove-PRM/KA/RERA/1251/308/PR/070526/008630

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28 Years of Shaping Success. Preparing for What Comes Next

Recognised with the ET Achievers Award 2026 in the Transformative Leader in K-12 category, Sridhar G is an alumnus of IIT Kharagpur and Johns Hopkins University who returned to India with a conviction: that education could be built differently. Nearly three decades later, that conviction has shaped the academic journeys of over 85,000 students.

Deeksha Vedantu

Sridhar G

> One objective of education that will not change in the AI age is to help every child realise their potential. Our responsibility is to preserve what works, rethink what must change, and prepare students for a future we cannot entirely predict.
>
> **Sridhar G,**
> Founder,
> Deeksha Vedantu and Deeksha STEM Schools

A LEGACY BUILT ON STUDENT OUTCOMES

For 28 years, Deeksha Vedantu has prepared students for JEE, NEET, and CET. Its board-synchronised two-year programme aligns competitive-exam preparation with pre-university studies, helping students pursue both without fragmented curricula or the burden of separate coaching schedules. Foundation programmes for Grades 6 to 10 extend this support earlier, building academic fundamentals and Olympiad readiness before the pressure of senior years begins.

Classroom teaching, aptitude guidance, and methodical assessment form the core, strengthened by technology. VED AI, Deeksha's in-house learning assistant, personalises preparation through interactive classes, practice tests, and comprehensive revision. Through dHybrid, master teachers reach students in Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities across Karnataka and beyond, so geography stops deciding who gets a great teacher.

Deeksha Vedantu's outcomes across JEE, NEET, VITEEE, BITSAT, KCET, and COMEDK consistently exceed national averages, reinforcing its position as among the leaders in competitive-exam preparation.

TAKING LEARNING FURTHER UPSTREAM

Academic achievement begins well before competitive examinations. A child's ability to question, experiment, solve problems, and communicate develops during the formative years, shaping how they learn long before they face high-stakes tests.

Established in 2020, Deeksha STEM Schools brings this understanding to school education across four Bengaluru campuses: Kengeri, Judicial Layout, Bannerghatta Road, and Vidyanagar. Its STEM-focused CBSE approach centres on enquiry-based learning, experiential science, learning by design, and communicative English supported by AI-powered modules.

Deeksha STEM School

These pillars develop capabilities increasingly vital in an AI-driven world: critical thinking, creativity, problem-solving, and communication. Students learn to question, apply knowledge, and design solutions, building the adaptability to navigate technologies and careers that may not yet exist.

Together, Deeksha Vedantu and Deeksha STEM Schools make a case that has taken 28 years to build: that preparing students well means beginning early, staying rigorous, and never losing sight of the child behind the result.

For more details, contact: Deeksha Vedantu: https://deekshalearning.com/ Call: 1800-102-4109
Deeksha STEM Schools: https://deekshastemschools.com/ Call: 8095334567

The Changing Blueprint Of Urban Homes

The modern real estate landscape is undergoing a quiet but significant transformation. Today, urban homebuyers are no longer satisfied with standard concrete boxes. They demand dynamic living spaces prioritising thoughtful design, everyday functionality and long-term environmental relevance. In this rapidly evolving market, the primary focus is shifting from rapid construction to deliberate craftsmanship.

Embodying this crucial shift is a Bengaluru-based development firm, ESD (Evantha Sri Durga). Formed in 2022, the company emerged from the strategic merger of two distinct entities - Evantha and Sri Durga that had operated independently in real estate since 2012. Led by managing partners Sanath V Babu, Tejas H S and Abhishek Mudram, this combined enterprise was established on one shared conviction that the property industry must place the human experience at the forefront.

Shaping Communities through Deep Contextual Understanding

At the core of the ESD philosophy is a fundamental belief that residential real estate should be meticulously crafted rather than quickly assembled. "We realised early on that a home is more than just a physical structure, it is the vital backdrop to people's daily lives. Our goal is to deeply understand the unique character of the land and the specific aspirations of the residents before a single brick is even laid," explains Sanath V Babu.

This analytical approach actively dictates the creative blueprint for their diverse portfolio. Whether developing intimate boutique residences, expansive luxury villa communities, carefully planned plotted developments and commercial properties across Bengaluru, Mysuru and Shoolagiri, the foundational approach remains resolutely consistent. ESD responds directly to the site, paying close attention to finer architectural details to shape vibrant places with distinct character.

Delivering Purposeful Design

What separates ESD from conventional builders is the deliberate connection it forges between artistic imagination and responsible execution. Thoughtful architectural design must function seamlessly in everyday reality.

"Design cannot just look good on a blueprint, it must effortlessly survive the complex, often demanding realities of physical construction. We prioritise abundant natural light, intelligent spatial utilization and organic community interaction because those specific elements ultimately define true living quality," notes Managing Partner Tejas H S. This dedication to professional transparency has earned ESD customer trust, reflecting high referral rates.

"For most families, buying a property is their most significant lifetime financial investment. We take that profound responsibility seriously. An ESD property is intentionally designed to be a robust asset inherently capable of holding and significantly growing its market value over time," adds Abhishek Mudram.

As urban populations inevitably expand and housing demands intensify, successful developers will undoubtedly be those who refuse to treat homes as disposable commodities. By effectively marrying creative imagination with disciplined structural execution, the modern industry builds stronger local communities for tomorrow. For ESD, this philosophy lies at the heart of every development it envisions and every home it creates.

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Sanath V Babu and Abhishek Mudram, received award from Shriya Saran

A Natural Expression of Luxury

Luxury is often associated with what is added to a home. At Earthen Ambience, ESD (Evantha Sri Durga) takes a different view. Here, luxury is found equally in what surrounds it including space, privacy, greenery, natural light and the quiet pleasure of feeling connected to nature.

Set off Sarjapur Road, Earthen Ambience is an intimate community of just 52 luxury garden villas, conceived for people who want the expansiveness of villa living without losing the warmth and connection of a planned neighbourhood. Spread across 2.45 acres with ample open space, the development brings architecture and landscape together to create a distinctly more natural way of living.

Inspired by the Earth

Earthen Ambience is an exclusive community of 52 luxury garden villas, designed around space, privacy, natural light and a deeper connection with nature. The project brings together warm, earthy architecture, private gardens, skylit interiors and generous landscaped spaces to create a distinctive living experience.

The name Earthen Ambience is reflected in the architecture itself. Clay-tile cladding, terracotta terrace flooring and individually varied façades give the villas a warm, tactile character, while private gardens, spill-out decks and dense peripheral greens soften the boundaries between built and natural spaces.

Inside, the same philosophy continues. Double-height volumes create a sense of openness, skylit internal gardens draw nature deeper into the home, and terraces and flexible spaces allow everyday life to flow comfortably between indoors and outdoors. Premium specifications and contemporary conveniences including home automation, biometric locks and video door phones, ensure that the natural character of the development is complemented by modern comfort.

Landscape Designed to be Experienced

At Earthen Ambience, landscaping is an integral to the experience of the community. Around 20,000 sq ft of landscaped spaces weave through the development, with thoughtfully created environments introducing different textures into the landscape. A children's play area, senior citizens' corner and community spaces create opportunities to pause, interact or simply enjoy being outdoors.

The lifestyle offering extends to the clubhouse, an 8,000 sq ft space with an infinity-edge swimming pool, gymnasium, library and co-working space, indoor games, multipurpose hall, steam and sauna facilities, along with dedicated recreation spaces for children.

Connected to the City, Removed from its Rush

Situated on the Sarjapur-Attibele Road, the project offers access to Bengaluru's major technology corridors and is close to leading educational institutions, healthcare and everyday conveniences. It is also in close proximity to the upcoming STRR, positioning the development within one of Bengaluru's evolving growth corridors.

With Earthen Ambience, ESD demonstrates that luxury need not announce itself through excess. It can be quieter and more considered, expressed through space, material, light, landscape, privacy and the quality of everyday experience.

Perhaps that is the project's greatest luxury of all, a home that allows its residents to remain connected to the city, while feeling distinctly closer to the earth.

RERA NO- PRM/KA/RERA/1251/308/PR/210323/005811
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Trust Isn't Built in a Day. It's Built Over 20 Years

Satish Bathi, Managing Partner, along with Shama Sunder R J ,Executive Director, received award from Shriya Saran

Surya Developers wins the Trusted Developer Award at ET Achievers 2026 Bengaluru event organized by OMS, Times of India and research conducted by Avance Insights Pvt. Ltd.

In real estate, trust is more than a promise. It is built through every decision, every commitment and every space created for people to call their own.

Surya Developers won the Trusted Developer Award — a recognition that celebrates their commitment to quality, transparency, thoughtful design and lasting relationships.

Since 2006, Surya Developers journey has been driven by a simple belief: a home is more than walls and windows. It is where families grow, memories are created and dreams find a foundation. With over two decades of real estate experience, they have continued to shape residential, commercial and industrial spaces with a focus on quality, functionality and long-term value along with their core values of sunlight, space & sustainability.

From the established communities of Surya Paradise1 & 2, Siri Enclave, Surya Hermitage, Surya Prism & Surya Heights to the contemporary elegance of Surya Valencia, every development reflects our philosophy of building with heart, crafting with care and honouring our promises.

Surya Developers commitment extends beyond homes. It's commercial and industrial developments are designed to support businesses, enable growth and create homes that deliver lasting value. Across every project, they remain guided by the principles that define them: integrity, sustainability, innovation and customer-first thinking.

This award is not just a milestone for Surya Developers. It is a tribute to it's homeowners who placed their trust in them, their partners who share their vision and the team whose dedication brings that vision to life.

Because a trusted developer doesn't just build properties. One of the trusted developer builds confidence, creates communities and delivers a legacy that stands the test of time.

As Surya Developers look ahead, their promise remains unchanged: to create thoughtfully designed homes where every moment finds its light, every family finds its place and every commitment is backed by action.

Surya Developers - Built on values.
Built on trust. Built for tomorrow.

RERA No. PHASE1 – PRM/KA/RERA/1251/472/PR/171224/007305
RERE NO. PHASE2- PRM/KA/RERA/1251/472/PR/020125/007343
For more details, visit:
SuryaDevelopers.in /
Call : 90712 88484

Leadership that Builds More than Properties. It Builds Trust

Vishwanath Bathi, Founder & Managing Director of Surya Developers, wins the Real Estate Entrepreneur – Excellence in Business Leadership Award.

> Our vision is to construct homes for everyone, from affordable, basic housing to luxury homes. We aspire to make Surya Developers a contributor to the nation's growth while creating meaningful employment opportunities. By 2032, our goal is to become a recognised name in the real estate industry, with a development portfolio spanning 10 million square feet.
>
> **Vishwanath Bathi**

Great businesses are built on strong foundations. Exceptional leaders build them on vision, values, and trust.

Under his leadership, Surya Developers has established a strong presence in Bengaluru's real estate market, guided by integrity, quality and customer trust.

The company's portfolio spans premium residential communities, villas, commercial spaces, and mixed-use developments. His approach extends beyond constructing buildings to creating thoughtfully designed homes that fulfil customer aspirations and contribute to the city's evolving landscape.

A defining aspect of his leadership is balancing business growth with lasting relationships. By prioritising customer satisfaction and honouring commitments to investors and landowners, he continues to strengthen the trust that underpins Surya Developers' growth. His focus on innovation, responsible development and enduring value reflects a commitment to building a sustainable business.

Vishwanath Bathi received award from Shriya Saran

This recognition celebrates not just entrepreneurial achievement but a leadership journey driven by conviction, consistency and purpose.

As Surya Developers looks ahead, its ambition remains clear: creating homes that inspire confidence, communities that stand the test of time and a legacy built on enduring values.

Surya Developers. Built on Values. Led by Vision. Trusted for Generations.

For more details, log on to:
SuryaDevelopers.in
Call : 90712 88484

Indicative image representation only

Assetz's Life Reimagined: Where Design Comes First

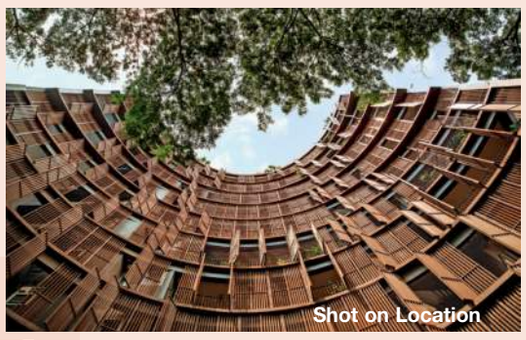
What if the real achievement of architecture isn't what it builds, but what it makes possible?

The relief of coming home after a long day. The quiet pleasure of stepping into a garden. The simple joy of watching the sunset from your favourite corner. These experiences may never appear on a blueprint, yet they are often what make a house feel like home.

At Assetz, this understanding has shaped over a decade of residential development, finding its clearest expression yet in Life Reimagined.

BEYOND THE BROCHURE

At its core, Life Reimagined is about questioning convention. It looks beyond the standard checklist of amenities to ask how each design decision can serve a larger purpose. Architecture, functionality, aesthetics and sustainability are considered as a whole, shaping homes and neighbourhoods that respond to the many dimensions of life.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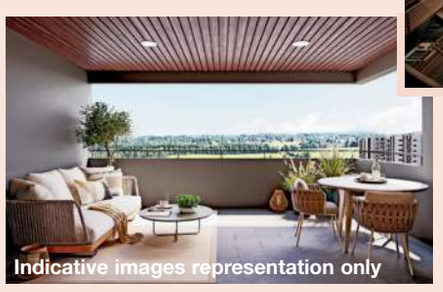

Indicative images representation only

This thinking finds expression in details that go beyond the expected. Luxury terrace balconies create opportunities to extend life outdoors. Double-height lobbies create a distinctive sense of arrival, while intuitively planned landscapes bring nature into everyday routines. Age-designated children's play areas recognise the different needs of growing children, while pet parks and thoughtfully planned communal spaces foster a sense of belonging.

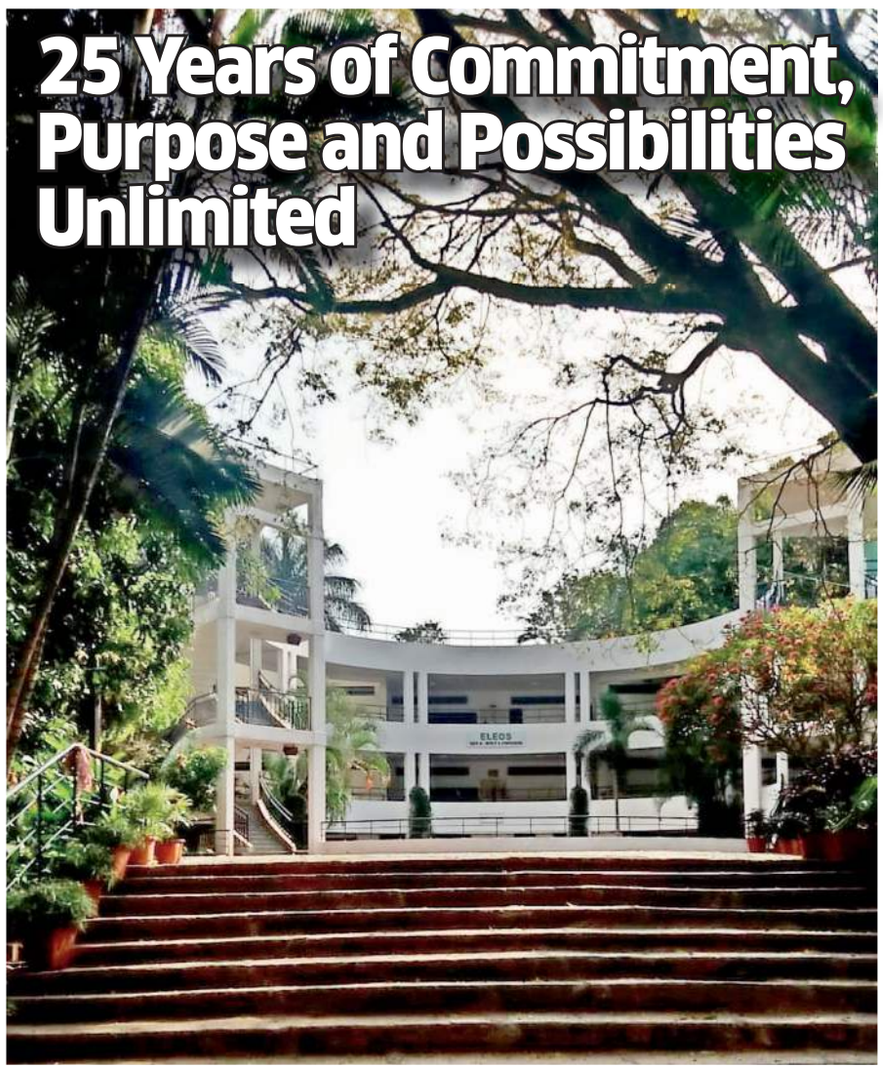
Assetz Life Reimagined in Practice

50+ projects
50+ million sq. ft.
22,000+ units
*as of August 2026

Each element carries the Assetz signature, making design work harder, not by adding more, but by careful deletion. Just as important is ensuring that the original intent survives beyond the blueprint, with a commitment to quality and delivering on every promise made.

Life Reimagined brings these principles together under one platform, expressing a distinctive point of view on residential design. For Assetz, reimagining life begins with rethinking the spaces that shape it, creating homes that are not simply places to live, but places that make life feel fuller.

25 Years of Commitment, Purpose and Possibilities Unlimited



Delhi Public School, Bangalore South - Celebrating a Legacy, Inspiring a Future

A school is never merely a collection of classrooms, corridors, and buildings. It is a living tapestry of dreams, relationships, discoveries, and memories. For twenty - five remarkable years, Delhi Public School, Bengaluru South, has been weaving this tapestry with dedication, vision, and an unwavering belief in the limitless potential of every child.

What began as a commitment to quality education has blossomed into a vibrant institution where academic learning walks hand in hand with compassion, creativity, and character. Across generations, the school has nurtured inquisitive minds, encouraged courageous aspirations, and empowered young people to discover not only what they can achieve, but also who they can become.

At the heart of this journey lies a simple yet profound conviction - every child matters. Every question deserves encouragement, every talent deserves an opportunity, and every individual deserves to feel seen, valued, and included. Here, learning extends beyond textbooks and examinations into sports fields, laboratories, performing arts, community initiatives, and everyday moments of kindness. Achievements are celebrated not only through accolades, but also through resilience, integrity, empathy, and the courage to try again.

Rooted in enduring values yet responsive to an ever - changing world, DPS Bengaluru South continually reimagines education. Innovation, critical thinking, collaboration, and responsible citizenship are woven into its learning culture, equipping students to navigate uncertainty with confidence and approach challenges with imagination. Equally significant is its commitment to emotional well - being, ensuring that children grow in spaces where they feel safe to express themselves, build meaningful connections, and flourish.

This silver jubilee is also a celebration of people. Of teachers whose quiet dedication has ignited countless possibilities. Of parents whose trust has strengthened the school's foundations. Of alumni who carry its values into the wider world. And, above all, of children whose laughter, questions, achievements, and dreams give the institution its true identity.

Twenty - five years invite them to look back with gratitude, stand in the present with pride, and look ahead with renewed purpose. The milestones achieved are meaningful, but the lives touched and the values carried forward are the most enduring measures of our legacy.

As Delhi Public School, Bengaluru South, steps into its next chapter, its promise remains steadfast - to inspire learners, nurture humanity, embrace possibilities, and prepare young minds not merely for the future, but to shape it with wisdom and heart.

For the traditions of a school is never simply what it builds, but what it awakens within every child.

Team DPS Bangalore South received the award from Shriya Saran

Building From the Heart: A Legacy of Trust

For over 25 years, Vaishnavi Group has built more than homes and workplaces. It has built trust.

Across Bengaluru and beyond, the Group has earned a reputation for developments that combine quality, innovation and timely delivery with an understanding of how people aspire to live and work. With more than 40 completed projects, over 6,500 happy families and numerous global awards, Vaishnavi Group aims to shape communities guided by its philosophy: Building from the heart.

The Group's approach reflects four core pillars: Impeccable Service, Trust, Timeliness and Uncompromising Quality. Its projects span more than 19 million square feet of residential, commercial and retail developments, with a further 8 million square feet under development. These principles inform the Group's work across its portfolio and its focus on lasting value.

VAISHNAVI®

VAISHNAVI AT-ONE KRISHNA BRINDAVAN: A HOME AT THE HEART OF SOUTH BENGALURU

Vaishnavi AT-One Krishna Brindavan brings this philosophy to residential real estate in Banashankari, South Bengaluru. Spread across 4.95 acres, the development comprises 359 three- and four-bedroom residences across two towers. Inspired by traditional courtyard homes, its central Brindavan is the focal point around which living spaces are arranged, bringing nature and community into everyday life.

Located in one of Bengaluru's established neighbourhoods, the development offers access to schools, hospitals, shopping destinations and recreational options. It brings together contemporary living and green spaces in a location that balances urban convenience with the area's distinctive character.

Designed to blend architecture with nature, the project combines open spaces, landscaped gardens and contemporary residential planning. Features include independent living, Vaastu-compliant design and ceiling heights of over 10 feet. Homes are planned to support privacy, openness and natural light, with imported marble flooring in living and dining areas and wooden flooring in bedrooms.

Indicative images representation only
Grand Entrance

A 25,745 sq.ft. clubhouse brings together indoor and outdoor facilities for residents. Amenities include an infinity pool, children's pool, mini theatre, gymnasium, indoor games, multipurpose hall & yoga deck. Outdoor spaces include a walking and jogging track, children's play area, cricket net, pickleball and padel courts, a half basketball court and a pet park.

Sustainability measures include solar power, rainwater harvesting, energy-efficient systems, recycled water and water-conservation practices. Native plants and landscaped spaces reinforce the development's connection with nature.

At the heart of the project is the belief that a home extends beyond its physical structure. The central courtyard is envisioned as a place where neighbours come together and everyday moments become lasting memories. From spaces for recreation to quieter corners for relaxation, the development is planned around the varied rhythms of family life.

A COMMITMENT TO QUALITY AND EXECUTION

Vaishnavi Group's people-first philosophy is matched by a commitment to execution. The Group emphasises transparent business practices, quality standards and attention to detail. Its developments bring together architects, structural engineers, landscape consultants and construction specialists, supported by advanced construction technologies and rigorous quality control.

LEADERSHIP AND THE ROAD AHEAD

C. N. Govindaraju, Founder, Chairman and Managing Director of Vaishnavi Group, has shaped the company's vision of creating thoughtfully designed homes and efficient commercial spaces. His leadership has helped establish the Group's emphasis on construction practices, customer experience, consistent delivery and long-standing client relationships.

Darshan Govindaraju, Executive Director, plays a key role in residential development, sales, marketing and customer experience, while also expanding the commercial portfolio. A graduate from Boston, he brings global exposure and a strategic perspective to the Group's development initiatives. His focus includes strengthening investor confidence, advancing Brand Vaishnavi, integrating technology and building organisational capability.

Kishan Govindaraju, Executive Director, leads initiatives focused on technology integration, operational efficiency and sustainable development. He has helped modernise operations through the strategic adoption of technology across the real estate value chain. He is also spearheading sustainability initiatives, including resource-efficient design and construction practices aligned with global environmental best practices.

Clubhouse

Aerial View - Day Shot

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- 25+ years of experience
- Over 40 completed projects
- Numerous prestigious global awards
- 19 Million Sq. Ft. developed across sectors

Together, the leadership brings a focus on customer experience, operational capability, technology and sustainability, while continuing to build on the Group's founding philosophy.

As Bengaluru evolves as an economic and innovation hub, expectations from real estate continue to rise. Homebuyers increasingly seek developments that combine sustainability, connectivity, community and long-term value. Vaishnavi Group continues to create spaces that respond to these aspirations.

Every home, every workplace and every community reflects one enduring promise: to build from the heart.

Scan for more details

RERA: PRM/KA/RERA/1251/310/PR/081025/008140

For more detals, contact:
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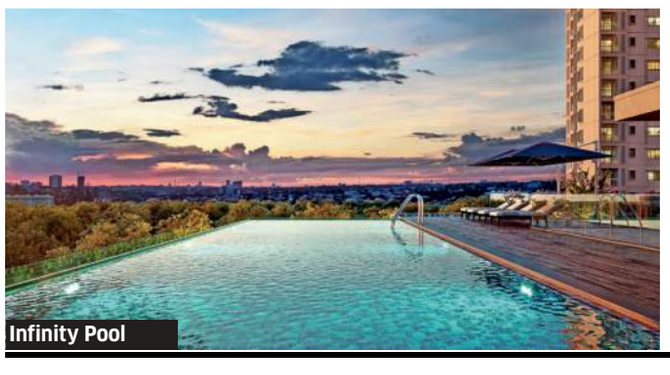
Call: +91 7996 111 030


Infinity Pool

Canopy Court

Clubhouse - Aerial View

From healing to education- Dr. Anuradha Venkatesh's vision for AECS

Dr. Anuradha Venkatesh, Chief Operating Officer of the AECS Group of Institutions, brings together a background in medicine, a record of community service and a strong commitment to education. Her leadership is guided by the belief that schools should help children grow into capable, resilient and socially responsible individuals.

Dr. Venkatesh completed her MBBS at Kempegowda Institute of Medical Sciences, Bengaluru, in 1995, followed by an MS in General Surgery from M. S. Ramaiah Medical College in 1998.

Her commitment to service has extended beyond clinical practice. For seven years, she and her team conducted free medical, counselling and awareness camps across Bengaluru Rural, Koppal district and remote areas of Tamil Nadu. The camps addressed concerns including the effects of tobacco, gutka and pan chewing, personal hygiene and the prevention of diseases associated with poor sanitation. During this period, the team examined, treated and counselled more than 35,000 people.

Dr. Venkatesh is also involved in environmental initiatives, including riverbed rejuvenation and tree-planting drives along the Palar and Koundinya rivers in Kolar district. The work brings together a multidisciplinary team of geologists, civil engineers, satellite-mapping experts and doctors.

Her approach to education is shaped in part by her family's long-standing commitment to supporting young people from economically and socially disadvantaged rural communities through education, empowerment and employment opportunities. At AECS, she promotes collaboration among faculty, parents and counsellors, with each playing a role in supporting children's development.

She believes schools should nurture scientific curiosity and help children build resilience, communication skills and confidence in facing challenges. In a country as diverse as India, she sees education as an opportunity to encourage friendships across age groups and backgrounds, while helping students develop respect for different cultures and perspectives.

Team projects, she believes, can help children practise cooperation, patience, tolerance and understanding. These qualities matter not only in school but also in personal and professional life. Her vision is for each child to develop at their own pace and grow beyond academic achievement, becoming a thoughtful and adaptable person.

In recognition of her work, Dr. Venkatesh received an award at the ET Achievers event in the Excellence in Transformative Leadership in Education category. Seema Goel, Director of the AECS Group of Institutions, received the award on her behalf.

Through her work in medicine, community service, environmental initiatives and education, Dr. Venkatesh continues to bring a broad perspective to her role at AECS. Her focus remains on creating learning environments that support children's growth as scholars and as empathetic, resilient and socially responsible citizens.

Dr. Anuradha Venkatesh

The New Green Premium: A Growing Trend Among Urban Investors

The New Green Premium: How Urban Investors are Building Worry-Free Generational Wealth

Prabhjoth Singh, Managing Director

Raghavendra Sundaram, Director

For urban professionals and business leaders, the dream of owning a countryside retreat while generating steady, hands-free passive income is no longer out of reach. Since 2018, Myfra Group has been quietly revolutionizing farmland ownership across North Bengaluru, turning raw land into a corporate-managed, high-value asset class.

Founded by banking and land-banking veterans Prabhjoth Singh, Managing Director and Raghavendra, Director, Myfra India Pvt. Ltd. draws on over two decades of collective leadership expertise. By eliminating traditional entry barriers—such as legal clearances, water management, boundary security, and daily upkeep—Myfra allows families to enjoy the rewards of land ownership without any of the hassle.

Today, Myfra's footprint spans over 150 acres of premium managed parcels, serving a growing community of more than 250 co-owners. The group's growth is anchored by five interconnected pillars: Myfra India (Managed Farm lands), Myfra Estates (Complete real estate solutions), Hospitality (Themed restaurants, experiential farmstays monetized via platforms like Airbnb), Agro-Farming (farm-fresh produce delivery), and Distribution (Electronic security solutions for home and office).

Farmland has long served as a resilient hedge against inflation. Unlike volatile equities or stagnating urban apartments, Myfra's model unlocks dual income streams: long term agro-forestry timber yield alongside recurring hospitality revenues, all managed within a professional corporate framework.

However, Myfra's philosophy extends beyond financial returns to environmental responsibility. Moving far past token green gestures, the group has scaled its afforestation footprint from an initial 300 saplings to over 17,000 thriving trees, with a bold roadmap to nurture 100,000 trees. Crucially, Myfra addresses regional water scarcity through dedicated rainwater harvesting ponds, water restoration programs, and groundwater recharge systems that elevate water tables across neighboring farming villages.

This balanced model recently earned national recognition, with Myfra Group receiving the prestigious ET Excellence in Community Based Farmland Project award.

"This award highlights a model of development that balances financial opportunity with environmental responsibility," states Managing Director Prabhjoth Singh. Director Raghavendra concludes, "As urban aspirations evolve, Myfra stands ready to deliver land that serves as a hedge, a retreat, and a sustainable legacy for generations."

Discover how Myfra Group is transforming farmland into effortless wealth, community upliftment, soil enrichment and nature-led living.

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www. myfraindia.com

Dhruvija Properties LLP: Sculpting Legacies of Timeless Worth

Dhruvija Properties LLP has emerged as a distinguished name in real estate, synonymous with legacies that embody refinement, inspire belonging, and stand resilient through time. The company has been honoured at ET Achievers 2026 for "Excellence in Luxury Lifestyle Oriented Farm Development" for its Dhrumini Vatika project, and for "Excellence in Luxury Apartment" for its Dhruvija Gopura project. These awards celebrate a philosophy rooted in the steadfastness of Dhruva, the pole star: a guiding light that keeps the company's vision focused on permanence, quality, and community value.

FOUNDATION AND ETHOS

At Dhruvija Properties, the ethos is defined by the integration of modern design with eco-conscious development. We believe a home is more than a structure; it is an environment that nurtures lives and fosters connection. Our organisation is built on deep professional experience, spanning legal and financial acumen to large-scale construction management. This multidisciplinary strength allows them to navigate complex project lifecycles, from initial blueprinting to final execution, delivering every development with precision, transparency, and an unwavering commitment to quality. Their focus remains on shaping environments where modern aspirations meet timeless balance, creating spaces that stand as hallmarks of trust and innovation.

Dhruva, the pole star, taught us that true value lies in steadfastness. These awards belong to every family that trusted us and every team member who built with integrity.

— M R Narasimhamurthy,
Founder & Director,
Dhruvija Properties LLP

SIGNATURE PROJECTS

Dhruvija Properties flagship Dhrumini Vatika is a 77-acre luxury farm estate in North Bengaluru, designed for those who wish to unplug from the urban hustle. It offers an immersive lifestyle of resort-style amenities and the wholesome rewards of private living. The project exemplifies their ability to blend large-scale land development with the intimacy of a private sanctuary, a harmonious retreat from the demands of modern life.

Complementing it is Dhruvija Gopura, their luxury residential enclave at the KIADB Aerospace Park in Bagalur. A gopura is the towering gateway of Indian temples, an apt image for a project that rises as a marvel of glass and steel and redefines luxury living in North Bengaluru. It caters to a sophisticated clientele with thoughtfully designed residences that prioritise daylight, ventilation, and advanced modern amenities. The project reflects their capability in vertical residential development, offering high-end comfort and structural resilience in a rapidly growing commercial and industrial hub.

Dhruvija Properties: Key Highlights

- Award-Winning Excellence
  - Excellence in Luxury Lifestyle Oriented Farm Development: Dhrumini Vatika
  - Excellence in Luxury Apartment: Dhruvija Gopura
- Core Philosophy
  - Spaces that embody refinement, inspire belonging, and stand resilient
  - Modern urban aspirations blended with sustainable, eco-conscious development
- Signature Developments
  - Dhrumini Vatika: A 77-acre luxury farm sanctuary in North Bangalore
  - Dhruvija Gopura: An exclusive luxury residential enclave at KIADB Aerospace Park, Bagalur
- Professional Foundation
  - Deep expertise in finance, law, and multi-site construction management
  - Dedication to integrity, transparency, and long-term value creation.

A VISION FOR THE FUTURE

The leadership team is driven by a vision to cultivate spaces that act as benchmarks of quality and craftsmanship. By balancing the rigours of corporate governance with a creative passion for real estate, we ensure that every Dhruvija project is a strategic investment in the future. They believe in creating value that endures, building trust with every stakeholder, and contributing to the built landscape of Bengaluru with integrity and innovation. As the company expand, their promise remains the same: to create legacies that endure, inspire, and belong.

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DHRUVIJA GOPURA - PRM/KA/

Shaping Future-Ready Graduates through Innovation and Critical Thinking

As higher education undergoes rapid transformation, institutions must prepare students for a complex and unpredictable world. While Artificial Intelligence (AI) reshapes industries, climate change influences policy and business decisions, and entrepreneurship emerges as a mainstream career path, employers are increasingly looking for graduates who demonstrate adaptability, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills, rather than rote learning.

Akash Nagpal, executive chairman of Krupanidhi Group of Institutions (KGI) and Asia Pacific World School, says the changing landscape calls for a broader approach to education. "Education should not end with knowledge acquisition. Its true purpose is to develop people who can think independently, solve meaningful problems, and contribute positively to society," says Akash. This approach has shaped Krupanidhi's focus on learning beyond classrooms, examinations, and placements.

STRONG ACADEMIC FOUNDATION

The education sector continues to evolve; automation, AI, and academic quality must always remain the foundation of every institution. However, strong academic focus alone is not sufficient.

Graduates need industry-relevant skills, practical exposure, and the ability to apply knowledge to real-world situations. Krupanidhi uses an application-based learning methodology, in which concepts taught in classrooms are reinforced through experiential learning, industry engagement, and problem-solving exercises. "Skill-based learning is essential. Institutions must ensure that students do not just learn concepts but also know how to apply them in the real world," says Akash.

GLOBAL OUTLOOK

Akash adds that his post-graduate studies at Monash University in Australia influenced his perspective on higher education. The experience reinforced the importance of complementing technical expertise with ethical judgement, environmental awareness, and the ability to navigate uncertainty. These principles continue to be the decisive factors in the academic approach of Krupanidhi, he says.

DEVELOPING CRITICAL THINKING

It is important to create an ecosystem where classroom learning is strengthened through industry engagement, interdisciplinary collaboration and experiential learning. Equally important is nurturing critical thinkers. "One of the primary responsibilities of an educational institution is to create an environment in which students are encouraged to question, analyse, collaborate, and solve complex problems rather than simply memorise information. Asia Pacific World School also focuses on cultivating curiosity, creativity, and critical thinking from the earliest years of education," he says.

INNOVATION AND RESEARCH

Recognising the gap between academic learning and real-world application, Krupanidhi established the Krupanidhi Research and Incubation Centre (KRIC) to promote research, startup incubation, patent support and interdisciplinary collaboration. The institution facilitates research, encouraging students to investigate real-world challenges, explore new ideas and develop analytical thinking from an early stage. By embedding research into the academic journey, KRIC plays a pivotal role in fostering curiosity, innovation, and critical thinking.

The objective is to encourage students to innovate while still on campus and build solutions that address real-world challenges. "If students leave campus believing someone else will create opportunities for them, we have only completed half the job. Education must inspire them to become creators of opportunity," says Akash.

SOCIAL PURPOSE

Education should also foster empathy and social responsibility alongside academic and professional development. As part of this approach, Krupanidhi operates the Krupanidhi Health Clinic and Krupanidhi Physiotherapy Clinic, a not-for-profit initiative that provides free healthcare services to economically disadvantaged communities. The initiative allows students to understand the link between professional expertise and community service, Akash says.

Akash Nagpal, Executive Chairman of Krupanidhi Group of Institutions (KGI) and Asia Pacific World School

"The future of higher education will not be defined solely by infrastructure, rankings or placement statistics. It will be shaped by institutions that nurture academic excellence, skill development, critical thinking, innovation, and a commitment to societal progress," says Akash.

"The institutions that will matter tomorrow are those that encourage students to ask better questions, embrace lifelong learning and create solutions that improve lives," he adds.

Trust Written in Concrete

When real prestige is defined not by accolades alone, but by the trust of over 40,000 families, recognition naturally follows. In a landmark achievement for South India's real estate landscape, DS MAX Properties has officially been crowned the "Prestigious Brand 2026" at the acclaimed ET Achievers Awards.

BUILDING DREAMS, EARNING FAITH

For decades, DS MAX Group has perfected a multi-domain approach to quality across Bengaluru and beyond. With hundreds of luxury residential projects redefining the cityscape, the developer has turned the aspirations of thousands of homebuyers into enduring realities.

At the heart of the group's philosophy is a simple conviction: true prestige is built on customer-centricity and unwavering commitment. DS MAX does not merely erect concrete structures; it crafts vibrant communities and raises modern living standards under its core promise—a Lifetime of Assurance.

WORDS FROM THE LEADERSHIP

Reflecting on this major milestone, the visionary leadership behind the brand attributes the accomplishments directly to their growing family of homeowners.

"To me, 'Prestigious' is measured by one thing—it is the reflection of the trust of 40,000+ customers who chose us to build their dreams. This recognition is a result of a relentless DS MAX attitude—a spirit driven by humility, commitment to excel, and delivering value without compromise," says K. V. Satish, Founder & Chairman, DS MAX Group.

"'Prestigious' isn't just an award on the wall—it is the faith built across 40,000+ happy homeowners. True prestige is earned when families place their dreams in our hands, and we deliver on every single promise. This milestone is a tribute to our valued customers and their happiness above all else."

PILLARS OF THE DS MAX PROMISE

- **Unwavering Trust:** Built on the faith of over 40,000 happy homeowners
- **Delivering Value:** Some of the premium luxury living crafted without compromise
- **Relentless Spirit:** Driven by humility and an enduring commitment to Perform well
- **Lifetime Assurance:** Comprehensive quality and support far beyond handover

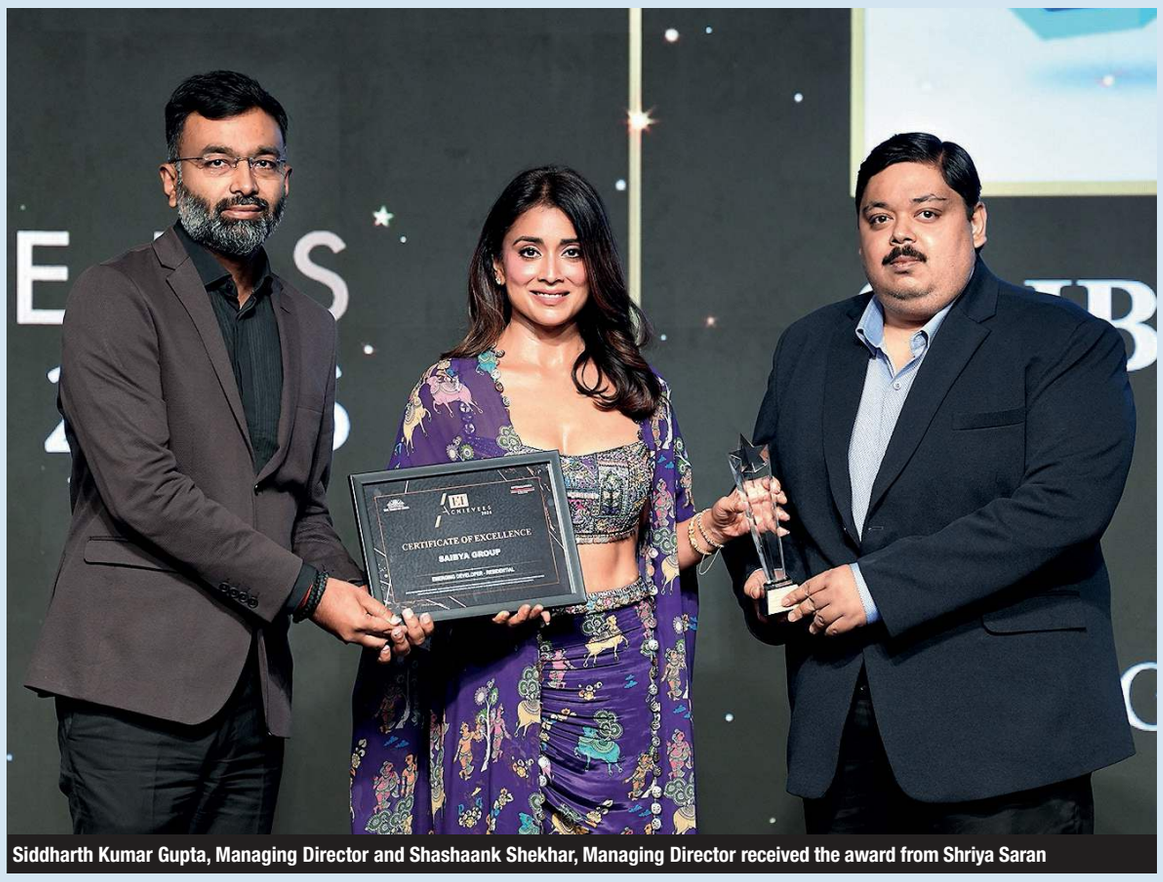
As DS MAX Properties looks toward the future, the ET Achievers Award stands as both a testament to past accomplishments and a driving force to set standards in the real estate industry.

For more details, contact:
PRO - Dinesh Singh
Call: 8050515669

K. V. Satish, Founder & Chairman, DS MAX Group

Pankaj Shah, General Manager and Ravi Kumar, AGM received the award from Shriya Saran

Saibya Group's 14-Year Legacy Aims at Redefining Urban Living in Bengaluru



Siddharth Kumar Gupta, Managing Director and Shashaank Shekhar, Managing Director received the award from Shriya Saran

With a 14-year legacy in Bengaluru's real estate landscape, Saibya Group has built its reputation on four pillars: timely delivery, quality construction, innovation, and transparent processes. What began as a commitment to doing business the right way has grown into one of the trusted names among homebuyers across the city.

Over the years, the group has delivered 5,00,939 sq. ft. of projects, serving more than 1,200 happy customers. Each handover reflects a simple belief that a home is not just a transaction but a long-term relationship built on trust. By keeping its processes open and its timelines honest, Saibya Group has earned the confidence of families who chose to invest in their futures with the brand.

The journey is far from over. Currently, 1.2 million sq. ft. is under development, with another 1.2 million sq. ft. in the pipeline. This ambitious growth reflects both the demand for thoughtfully designed urban homes and the group's readiness to meet it without compromising on quality.

Innovation remains central to Saibya Group's approach. From smart layouts and efficient use of space to modern construction practices, every project is planned to match the evolving lifestyle of Bengaluru's residents.

The group's focus on transparency, from clear documentation to regular communication with buyers, ensures that customers stay informed at every stage, from booking to possession.

As Bengaluru continues to expand and evolve, Saibya Group is positioned to shape its next chapter of urban living, creating communities that blend comfort, convenience, and lasting value.

With a strong foundation built over 14 years and a forward-looking vision, Saibya Group aims to create spaces that bring together thoughtful design, enduring value, and better urban living.

For more information,contact:
Saibya Group
Call +91 80 2206 8111,
Visit www.saibya.com.

Every Hospital Has a Story, Architecture Helps Tell It

"I don't approach a hospital as a building. I approach it as a story waiting to be told. My job is to understand its purpose, its aspirations and its identity — and then express that through architecture."

That conviction defines the work of Prashanth Raj, co-founder of Archventure, a practice that has carved out a distinct niche in healthcare architecture. Together with co-founder Shilpa Patel, he sees healthcare design as a rare chance to marry storytelling with problem-solving — giving each hospital a character of its own while making sure it works seamlessly for everyone inside it.

Hospitals are complex by nature. Behind every corridor lie intricate clinical workflows, stringent regulations, sophisticated medical infrastructure and an unrelenting demand for operational efficiency. Operating theatres, intensive care units and diagnostic suites each carry their own technical demands, yet all must connect without friction. For Archventure, these constraints are not obstacles — they are precisely what make healthcare architecture compelling.

Every project begins with understanding how a hospital actually functions: how patients arrive, how clinicians move between departments, and how supplies and services flow out of sight. Only once those patterns are clear does the architecture take shape.

Over the years, the practice has built a reputation for turning highly service-intensive environments into spaces that feel calm, intuitive and restorative. Natural light, biophilic principles, considered circulation and contextual planning come together to support both clinical performance and human wellbeing. Clear wayfinding eases the anxiety of patients and families, while daylight and glimpses of greenery offer respite to doctors and nurses on long shifts.

Aster RV Hospital, Bengaluru

Prashanth Raj & Shilpa Patel, Founders

Even Hospital, Bengaluru

Even Hospital, Bengaluru

For Shilpa, the process is deeply personal.

"I'm a little obsessed with solving design problems. Once a challenge comes my way, I take it home with me — I'm thinking about it over dinner, before I sleep, sometimes in the middle of the night. I don't really switch off until I've cracked it."

It is this blend of storytelling and problem-solving that sets the firm apart. Rather than treating function and aesthetics as competing priorities, its architects see them as inseparable. A well-planned department is also a more humane one, and a space that feels welcoming is one that patients, visitors and staff navigate with greater ease.

That approach recently earned Archventure the Economic Times Achievers Excellence in Healthcare Architecture & Design innovation Award — recognition that a hospital can be both a precise instrument of care and a place with a story worth telling.

For more details, contact :
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Call - 9945781010

Brick by Brick, a Bengaluru Legacy

Vijaya Aquagreen Somashetti Halli, Chikkabanavara

Vijaya Shankar Metro Centre, Magadi Road (next to Magadi Road Metro Station)

From building a single house in 1973 to completing more than 500 projects and delivering over one million sq. ft of built space, Vijaya Enterprises has turned a modest beginning into a remarkable construction legacy. The Bengaluru-based company has now added another accomplishments to that journey, winning the Excellence in Construction and Development of Urban Standards Projects - Residential & Commercial award at ET Achievers 2026. The honour recognises a business built over five decades on construction expertise, customer relationships and a commitment to quality across residential and commercial developments.

VIJAYA ENTERPRISES Since 1973

FIVE DECADES OF BUILDING TRUST

Founded by H B Shivakumar, Vijaya Enterprises began with a house built for a colleague. That first assignment laid the foundation for a company that has since served more than 1,500 clients across residential, commercial and institutional projects.

Its portfolio includes Vijaya Aquagreen in Abbigere and Vijaya Kousalya in Jayanagar. The company's institutional project experience also extends to assignments associated with HAL Airport in Bengaluru and facilities for ISRO, BARC and Bharat Electronics.

LEADERSHIP WITH A LONG-TERM VISION

Managing Partner Mahantesh B. Nelavagi leads the company today. Holding an MBA in Management Consulting and Multinational Finance from Cardiff University, he is guiding Vijaya Enterprises as it builds on its founder's legacy and pursues new development opportunities.

Reflecting on the award, Nelavagi says, "This recognition is a proud moment for everyone who has been part of our journey. Our founder began with one house and a commitment to doing things right. More than five decades later, that principle continues to guide us. We remain focused on quality, timely delivery and earning the trust of every customer who chooses us."

The group also supports education in Lakshmeshwar, Gadag district, through the BCN Education Trust. Its institutions include schools, a pre-university college, a degree college and a polytechnic, extending its contribution beyond construction.

A key element of its approach is integrated project execution. From architecture and planning to civil construction, interiors and landscaping, the company manages these functions in-house. This model helps coordinate work more closely, maintain quality oversight and manage costs, while timely completion remains a priority.

PROJECTS SHAPING BENGALURU'S SKYLINE

Vijaya Enterprises continues to strengthen its presence in Bengaluru with a mix of completed and upcoming developments. Vijaya Aquagreen (RERA No-PRM/KA/RERA/1251/309/PR/160623/005997), a recently completed residential project of 196 flats, is seeing strong demand and selling fast among homebuyers.

The company is also planning Vijaya Shankar Metro Centre, a commercial building located next to Magadi Road Metro Station.

As Vijaya Enterprises looks ahead, the award marks both recognition of its achievements and an opportunity to build on its legacy. Its founding principle remains unchanged: to deliver quality, honour commitments and remain worthy of customers' trust.

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(L to R) V. N. Subramanya Gupta, Senior Engineer; K. S. Ganapathi Hegde, Head – Administration; actress Shriya Saran; Mahantesh B. Nelavigi, Managing Partner

Where Every Home Holds a Story

A house may be built with bricks and wood, but a home takes shape through the memories, dreams and little details that make it personal. For Gruhanza, this distinction lies at the heart of interior design. The architectural and interior design studio believes that luxury is not simply about expensive materials or impressive spaces but about creating surroundings that feel unmistakably like the people who live in.

Recently recognised with the Premium and Luxury Interior Designers award at ET Achievers, the company is building its identity around interiors that hold stories.

GRUHANZA • INTERIORS THAT HOLD STORIES •

DESIGNING BEYOND APPEARANCES

"At Gruhanza, every project begins with understanding the people behind the home. Their experiences, aspirations, routines and relationships become the foundation for spaces that are personal rather than predictable. The intention is to move beyond standardised interiors and create homes that reflect individual journeys with customisation," says Sham Sunder, Director.

From first-time homeowners seeking thoughtful design to clients looking for uncompromising bespoke luxury, the studio approaches each project with an emphasis on personalisation, functionality and customization. Its tagline, 'Interiors that hold stories' places human experiences at the centre of every design decision.

"A home should be a reflection of the people living in it, not simply a beautiful space that follows a trend, is the philosophy that guides this approach at our firm," he adds.

Sham Sunder T, Nataraja Narayanappa and Navya Ashwath Directors of Gruhanza Private Limited received the award from Shriya Saran

CRAFTSMANSHIP THAT MAKES A DIFFERENCE

Their expertise in diverse materials, combined with skilled in-house artisans specialising in intricate wood carving and bespoke detailing, gives every home its own unique identity. Backed by a 32,000-square-foot manufacturing facility equipped with German machinery, automation, specialised solid wood crafting equipment and dedicated paint booths, they blend traditional artistry with modern technology. "This enables complete customization, precision, and uncompromising quality under one roof. True luxury lies in the thought behind every detail, from material to craftsmanship that makes every element belong beautifully within the home," informs Nataraj.

BUILDING HOMES, BUILDING TRUST

What sets Gruhanza apart is its commitment to transparency throughout the design and execution journey. "With our own manufacturing facility and in-house team, Gruhanza gives homeowners the opportunity to witness their interiors taking shape firsthand. Clients are actively encouraged to visit the production facility, inspect the materials, and personally verify the quality of their products at various stages of manufacturing. We strive to make luxury interiors more transparent and accessible," states Nataraj.

He further adds that this approach eliminates uncertainty, builds confidence, and gives homeowners the reassurance that every detail of their home is being crafted with care and accountability. By bringing clients closer to the manufacturing process, Gruhanza transforms transparency into trust and trust into lasting relationships.

The recent award marks an encouraging milestone in this journey. Yet, their larger ambition extends beyond recognition, which is to create homes that feel authentic, function beautifully and preserve the stories of the families within them.

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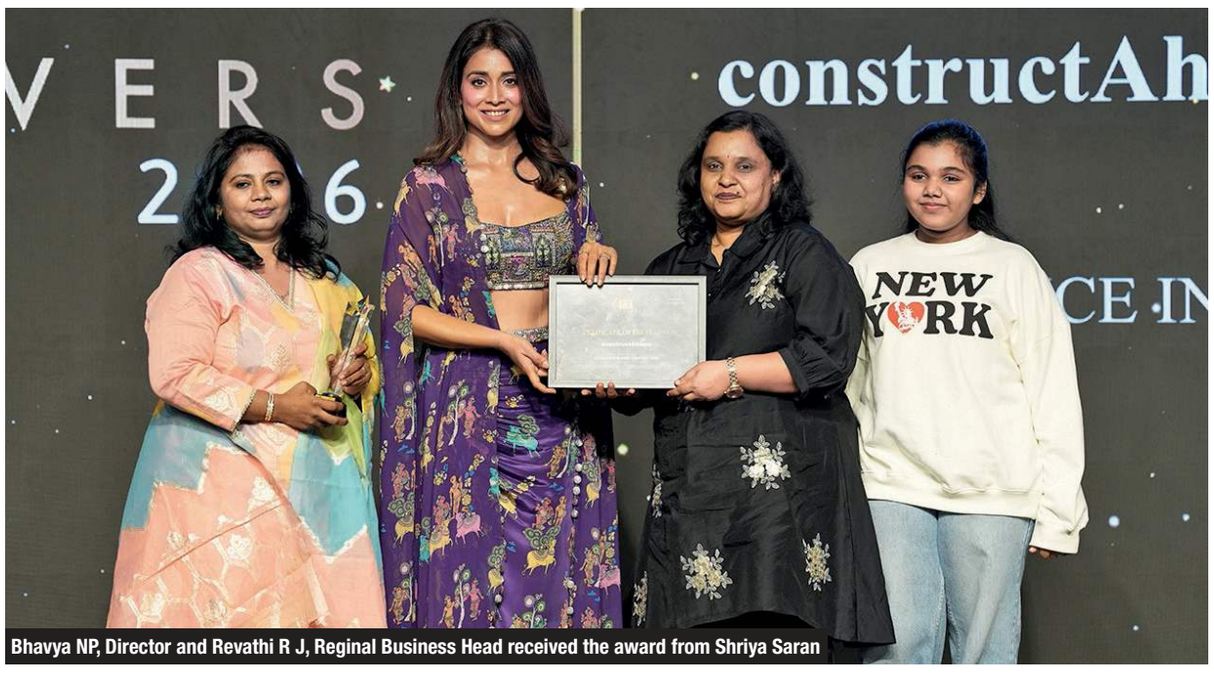
constructAhome: Building Homes with Quality, Clarity and Confidence


Bhavya NP, Director and Revathi R J, Reginal Business Head received the award from Shriya Saran

Building a home is among a family's most significant milestones. From choosing the right design to managing construction, every decision shapes the spaces where life unfolds. ConstructAhome brings these stages together through turnkey residential construction solutions, helping homeowners move from an initial idea to a completed home.

Established in 2013, ConstructAhome is a unit of ADVP Business Ventures Private Limited. The company focuses on homes, villas and customised living spaces, combining professional project management with an emphasis on workmanship, transparency and customer satisfaction. Its approach centres on understanding each client's requirements, lifestyle and budget before translating those expectations into practical designs.

The company's services cover architectural design, structural engineering, project management, residential construction and interior design. By coordinating planning, approvals, construction and finishing, ConstructAhome aims to simplify the building journey and provide homeowners with a consistent point of coordination throughout their projects.

Indicative image representation only

Planning begins with consultations, site surveys and discussions about individual preferences. Customised floor plans, soil testing, structural drawings and three-dimensional designs help establish a foundation for execution. Assistance with government approvals and necessary documentation forms another part of the process.

constructAhome™ CONSTRUCTION IS OUR WORSHIP

Quality remains a stated priority across construction stages. ConstructAhome highlights a system of more than 150 quality checkpoints, alongside careful material selection and structural planning. Detailed quotations and transparent cost management are intended to help customers understand project expenses and make informed decisions.

The company also incorporates technology into its approach, including architectural visualisation and project tracking. These tools support communication and help homeowners follow the progress of their homes.

With offices listed in Bengaluru, Mysuru and Chennai, ConstructAhome seeks to combine design, engineering and coordinated execution under one roof. Its vision is to make homebuilding a reassuring experience, creating functional living environments that reflect the people who call them home.

For more details, contact:
ConstructAhome
Call 6366660070,
www.constructahome.in

Celebrating every occasion with Lalithaa jewellery

Lalithaa Jewellery follows an integrated promotional strategy that combines strong personal branding of the owner , multilingual digital communication, traditional media, and hyperlocal activations to build brand awareness, trust, and customer loyalty across its markets.

At the centre of its promotional strategy is the personal brand of its owner, Kiran Kumar, whose public presence, direct communication, and relatable personality help humanise the brand. By making the owner a central figure in its marketing, Lalithaa Jewellery builds a stronger connection with consumers, reinforces credibility, and creates a recognisable identity beyond its products and showrooms.

The brand maintains a strong social media presence across multiple languages, including Tamil, Telugu, and Kannada, enabling it to connect with diverse audiences across Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Karnataka, and Puducherry. Its vernacular communication ensures that promotional messages, offers, and brand narratives resonate with local cultures, consumer preferences, and regional sensibilities.

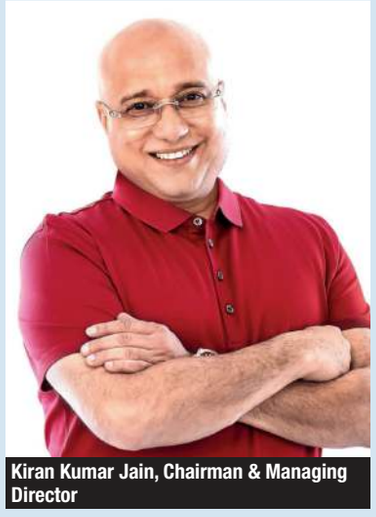
Beyond digital platforms, Lalithaa Jewellery adopts an integrated marketing approach through Above-The-Line (ATL) and Below-The-Line (BTL) promotions. By combining digital campaigns with traditional media and on-ground activities, the brand creates multiple consumer touchpoints and strengthens its visibility across markets.

A defining USP of its promotional strategy is its commitment to offering the best prices in the market. Rather than treating affordability as a temporary campaign message, Lalithaa consistently reinforces competitive pricing through its offers and communication. This unwavering positioning helps differentiate the brand in a highly competitive jewellery market.

The brand also prioritises top of mind awareness through consistent media presence across platforms. Regular campaigns, seasonal promotions, festive offers, and showroom specific advertising ensure that Lalithaa Jewellery remains visible when consumers consider purchasing jewellery.

Complementing its large-scale promotions is a strong focus on community engagement and hyperlocal BTL activities around individual showrooms. These initiatives help connect the brand with local audiences, strengthen neighbourhood relationships, and drive footfall.

Overall, Lalithaa Jewellery's promotional strategy combines personal branding, regional relevance, consistent visibility, competitive pricing, and local engagement to create a unified brand presence and maintain a strong connection with consumers across its markets.


Kiran Kumar Jain, Chairman & Managing Director

Giniiris: AI-Driven Customer Experience Innovation

Sonu Bandhan, CEO and Rajeev Sachdev, Co Founder received award from Shriya Saran

In an era where customer experience defines market leadership, Giniiris.ai is spearheading the shift from legacy contact centers to autonomous, AI-native enterprises. Headquartered with delivery and R&D hubs in Gurugram and Bengaluru, the company provides an enterprise-grade AI platform that powers human-like conversational agents, deep process automation, and intelligent workforce orchestration across voice and digital channels.

The company's recent industry recognition underscores its distinct operating philosophy: moving enterprises beyond superficial "technology theatre" to deliver grounded, measurable business outcomes. While conventional customer service relies on fragmented telephony and scripted bots that merely deflect issues, Giniiris.ai deploys Digital Humans and autonomous agents capable of true reasoning and end-to-end workflow execution. Powered by low-latency neural processing—clocking voice responses under 300 milliseconds—and multi-LLM orchestration across frontier models like GPT, Claude, and Gemini, the platform dynamically evaluates complexity, latency, and cost to resolve inquiries instantly. Across critical, high-volume sectors—including BFSI, Healthcare, Telecom, Retail, and Utilities—Giniiris.ai serves as a real-time operational fabric.

The platform connects seamlessly with core systems like Salesforce, SAP, and Zendesk via 20+ CRM and 15+ knowledge-base connectors. Rather than handling isolated chats, its AI workforce coordinates complex journeys end to end—from automated Video KYC and liveness detection under RBI/SEBI norms to real-time claims processing and billing dispute resolution.

Deployed across multiple global regions, client implementations consistently demonstrate transformative metrics: an average 35% reduction in operating costs, a +40-point lift in CSAT, and a 94% first-contact resolution (FCR) rate. Crucially, Giniiris.ai balances autonomous intelligence with uncompromising governance. Built with a zero-trust architecture, the platform enforces strict tenant isolation, completely automated interaction QA, live PII masking, and full data sovereignty aligned with SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001, GDPR, and India's DPDP regulations. As global enterprises seek resilient AI strategies that compound value rather than add technical debt, this award highlights Giniiris.ai's growing stature as an indispensable digital partner—augmenting human talent, automating mission-critical workflows, and engineering the real-time enterprise of tomorrow.

Giniminds: Data Foundation for AI Transformation

Ranganath Shenoy, CEO and Venkatesh Sagare, CTO received award from Shriya Saran

In an era where artificial intelligence is aiming at redefining business possibilities, the true competitive advantage lies not merely in adopting AI, but in building the right technology foundation to unlock its potential. As enterprises navigate increasingly complex digital landscapes, Giniminds Solutions a Bengaluru-based enterprise technology solutions company is helping organizations bridge the gap between existing infrastructure and the demands of an AI-driven future.

At the core of Giniminds' approach is a comprehensive technology portfolio structured around five strategic pillars: Store, Integrate, Stream, Security and Intelligence. Together, these capabilities address critical enterprise needs from modernizing IT infrastructure and connecting disparate applications to enabling real-time data movement, strengthening cybersecurity and transforming information into actionable business insights.

A key focus area is Data Foundation for AI Transformation an approach built on the belief that meaningful AI adoption begins with reliable, accessible, and well-governed enterprise data. Giniminds helps organizations address fragmented data landscapes, legacy integration complexities and information silos by designing modern data architectures that bring together data engineering, real-time streaming, scalable analytics platforms and governance.

What distinguishes Giniminds is its architecture-led, consultative approach. Rather than viewing technology modernization as a series of isolated implementations, the company emphasizes understanding customers' existing ecosystems, identifying opportunities for improvement and designing integrated solutions that align technology investments with business objectives.

Backed by strategic partnerships with leading global technology providers, Giniminds combines specialized technical expertise with enterprise-grade solutions to address evolving requirements across banking, financial services, manufacturing and other data-intensive industries. Its capabilities across on-premises, hybrid and cloud environments enable organizations to pursue modernization while maintaining security, scalability and operational resilience.

As enterprises move beyond AI experimentation toward practical, enterprise-wide adoption, the need for strong data foundations and connected technology ecosystems becomes increasingly important. Giniminds is focused on enabling this transition by bringing together modern infrastructure, intelligent integration, real-time data capabilities and advanced analytics.

With a commitment to continuous innovation, technical qualityand customer-centric solution design, Giniminds aims to empower organizations to become more agile, data-driven and resilient.

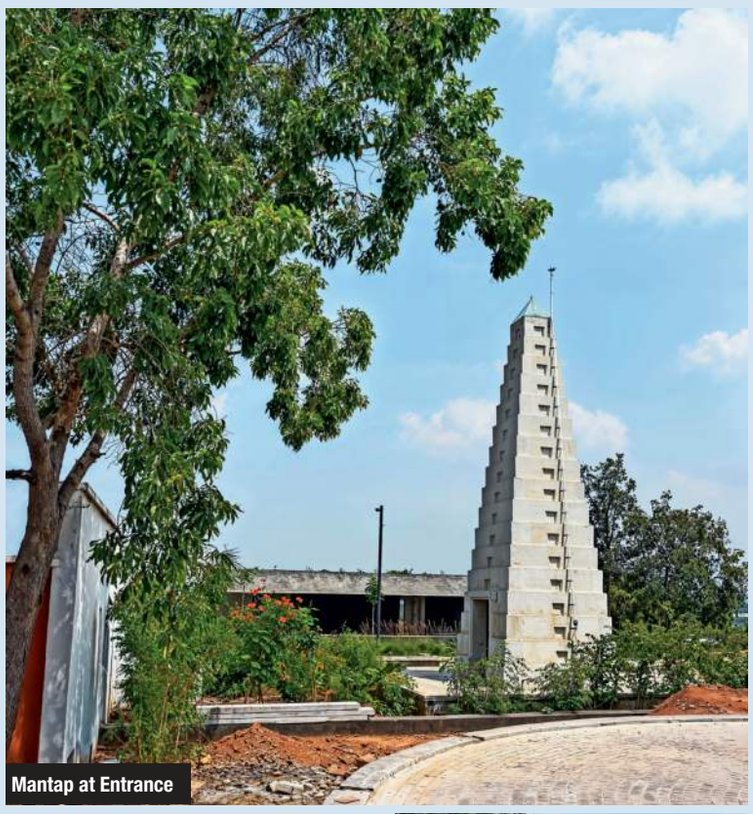
For Giniminds, the journey toward AI transformation begins with a simple principle: build the right foundation today to unlock the intelligence of tomorrow.

Svamitva Group: Where Innovation Meets Nature

Known for its distinctive approach to real estate, Svamitva Group continues to bring fresh thinking to the way communities are designed and experienced. From Svamitva Terravana, with its emphasis on luxury and wellness-led living, to Svamitva SR Water & Woods, the Group's journey reflects a consistent commitment to creating developments that go beyond conventional real estate.

Located near Jangamkote Cross, Svamitva SR Water & Woods is a contemporary development that brings together thoughtful planning, nature and infrastructure. Its location offers an opportunity to experience a more open, nature-oriented environment while remaining connected to the broader Bengaluru region.

What truly distinguishes the project is its innovative planning concept: a dedicated six-metre green buffer behind every plot. This distinctive feature creates a private connection to greenery and makes nature an integral part of the development rather than an afterthought. Complemented by water elements, green corridors and nature-inspired spaces, the project demonstrates how thoughtful design can contribute to a more sustainable and enriching living environment.


Mantap at Entrance

Cafe and Experience Centre

SVAMITVA
ENGINEERING TRUST, CRAFTING SATISFACTION

At the heart of this approach is Mahaveer Mehta, Managing Director of Svamitva Group, whose vision is to redefine real estate through innovation, infrastructure quality and wellness-oriented living. His philosophy extends beyond developing land and buildings to creating communities that respond to the evolving aspirations of homebuyers. By placing greater emphasis on the relationship between people and their surroundings, he is steering the Group towards a more considered and differentiated approach to development.

The recognition of Svamitva SR Water & Woods by ET Times as "Most Innovative Project" marks an important milestone in this journey. It acknowledges a development that brings a distinctive design idea to the forefront and reinforces Svamitva Group's ambition to challenge conventional approaches to community planning.

For Svamitva Group, innovation is not a one-time achievement but an ongoing philosophy. With every new development, the Group continues to explore how design, nature and infrastructure can work together to create more thoughtful places to live. Svamitva SR Water & Woods is the latest expression of that vision.
RERA No. - PRM/KA/ RERA/1254/465/PR/281026/009043

Scan for more

Project Entrance

For more details, contact: Svamitva Call: 8880748748

Embassy Eden Marks its Finest Expression of Villa Luxury Yet

Is the Garden of Eden a place on Earth, or a state of mind? At Embassy Eden, it is both. Set within a private 32-acre estate in North Bengaluru, this limited collection of ultra-luxury villas brings together architectural distinction, expansive landscapes and a rare sense of seclusion. Conceived for those who value understated refinement and a closer connection with nature, Embassy Eden offers a way of life shaped by space, tranquillity and individual choice.

Designed around a low-density masterplan, the estate places privacy and openness at the heart of its planning. Spanning 7,140 to 8,984 sq. ft., the villas are separated by 40 feet, with carefully oriented openings and landscaped buffers that ensure natural light and ventilation. Private lawns, expansive decks and shaded sit-outs extend living outdoors, while biophilic design and smart-home technology integrate contemporary comforts. Thomas Associates has led the architectural design, with interiors by LW Architecture.

The landscape, designed by Coopers Hill, draws inspiration from Bengaluru's Garden City legacy. Native trees, seasonal flowering groves, rain gardens and shaded pathways create a setting that evolves through the year. The Tree of Life anchors the landscape, while the Community Farm offers residents an opportunity to engage more closely with nature.

Club Eden brings fitness, wellness and leisure into the heart of the community. Dedicated fitness facilities, a therapeutic saltwater pool, an amphitheatre, nature trails, family parks, reflexology paths and pet-friendly spaces cater to a range of interests, from individual pursuits to shared experiences.

For Aditya Virwani, Managing Director, Embassy Developments Ltd., Embassy Eden is the realisation of a deeply personal vision. "True luxury is understood, not advertised. At Embassy, decades of experience have shaped our understanding of exceptional living. Embassy Eden brings this philosophy to life through an enduring connection with nature and the freedom to enjoy life at your own pace. It is a place deeply close to my heart, created to offer families the opportunity to pause, reconnect and experience a great reset from the pace of everyday life."

Embassy Eden Mansion

Embassy Eden Clubhouse

EMBASSY

The Tree of Life

Embassy Eden offers seamless access to key business and lifestyle destinations, as well as being located 20 minutes from Kempegowda International Airport – allowing residents to move effortlessly between world-class connectivity and quiet retreat.

Embassy's signature luxury hospitality offering will provide residence management, home maintenance, concierge assistance and personalised lifestyle services.

With its expansive villas, carefully planned landscape and hospitality-led approach, Embassy Eden offers a private world for a select few. Here, luxury is found in the freedom to slow down, reconnect and experience the everyday differently.

RERA Number - PRM/KA/ RERA/1251/472/PR/311225/008368

The Patio at 24/1: The Convergence of Food, Drinks and Play

The way people engage with dining spaces is evolving, with food and drink increasingly becoming part of a broader social experience. At The Patio at 24/1, JW Marriott Hotel Bengaluru, this finds expression in a Modern European restaurant that brings together a globally inspired menu, a considered beverage programme and pickleball within a relaxed, contemporary setting.

Conceptualised as a fun dining space, The Patio evolves through the day, accommodating breakfast catch-ups, easy lunches and long dinners, while lending itself to experiences that go beyond the conventional restaurant format. From bar takeovers that put the spotlight on drinks and mixology to evenings built around friends and a good game, the space has the flexibility to host different expressions of food, beverage and social culture.

The menu follows this changing rhythm, moving from breakfast favourites to small plates, mains and desserts suited to different occasions. Its European sensibility is expressed with refinement and restraint, in dishes such as Michel's Burrata Devanhalli Citrus Salad, the Fungi Terzet of crispy king oyster mushroom, stuffed morels ricotta and parmesan cream, and A Must Eat Risotto, a finale of white chocolate gelato and almond crumble. The beverage programme complements this breadth, allowing the offering to shift naturally from daytime gatherings to evening drinks.

A defining feature of the place is its pickleball court, set within JW Marriott Hotel Bengaluru and bringing an unexpected sporting element to the dining experience. Located in the heart of the city, the hotel lends the space its scenic views, making a friendly match the starting point for an afternoon with friends, followed by food and drinks, while the pool table adds to the spirit of play that runs through the space. It is this combination of European dining, recreation and socialising, in one of Bengaluru's most central addresses, that gives The Patio at 24/1 a distinct identity.

MYFRA INDIA PVT LTD - MYFRA GROUP OF COMPANIES

EXCELLENCE IN COMMUNITY-BASED FARMLAND PROJECTS

SURVEY - METHODOLOGY

The objective of this research was to conduct a survey, assess and evaluate the probable nominations and recommend the final list of recipients for the coveted ET - Achievers Karnataka 2026.

Avance Insights has developed a nominee assessment form and an objective analytical framework to assess the nominees for ET - Achievers Karnataka 2026 in various categories.

The survey had these modules i.e. Desk Secondary Research, Approach for sharing fact file, Factual survey (Participatory Survey) to identify the excellent performers and contributors in different fields.

A comprehensive list of business entities, brand leaders and performers and certain affiliates businesses was generated with the help of the internet, social media, print -magazines, and other publications.

The business entities, brand leaders and performers, Individuals and certain affiliates were sent the factual data questionnaire and then rigorously followed up through telephone, email, and personal visits.

The kind of work done by the nominees with focus on innovation and value propositions, contribute to the business world, society, and nation at large, vision for the further addition of value to business world, society, and nation in future,

In addition, feedback of each nominee was assessed through multiple tools such as social media profile scan and customers/ colleagues or public feedback. All data was objectively analyzed to assess the eligibility and suitability of the nominee for the award.

All data was objectively analyzed to assess the eligibility and suitability of the nominee for the award. The final score for each entity was weighted to an average Factual Score. Based on the final score, results were drawn in respective leaders.

The study was conducted in Karnataka and started from the 2nd week of August 2026.

Some caveats/assumptions:

- Best efforts were made to reach the maximum business entities, brand leaders and performers, Individuals in the respective categories.
- If the nomination for any specific category was not received, those categories were dropped and categories with single nominations were given unanimously. For some category, there were multiple nominations, The most suitable and eligible are awarded as best/most in their category.
- Only those entities were considered who have submitted their participatory factual sheet.

About Avance Insights Pvt Ltd (Avance Insights)

Avance is a new age strategic research and consulting firm founded by Industry experts from diverse academic and Industry background. Avance leverages advanced technologies to provide actionable insights to power client's businesses in real-time. Avance has an ecosystem where clients' interests are aligned with the best-in-class tailored made solutions.

Avance has executed assignments spanning large scale surveys in Healthcare, Agriculture, Livelihood, Education, Water and Sanitation, Rural Development Sector, Financial Inclusion, Air Pollution, Climate Change, FMCG, IT & ITes, Automobile, Retail, Fashion, Food & Beverages, Tourism etc.

The team behind the company's success is a mix of experts, experienced Industry veterans and dynamic young professionals which makes a perfect combination of knowledge, experience, and cutting-edge technology.

Avance has PAN INDIA Network and covered entire part of country successfully.

Avance Insights is a corporate member of MRSI and follows the MRSI code of conduct while conducting all its research projects. For more information about the company please visit www.avanceinsights.in and contact us on manoj@avanceinsights.in

Note: Present survey has been exclusively conducted by an independent Research Agency named Avance Insights Pvt Ltd using stated methodology for arriving at given results. The publication house and its affiliates/ employees/ authorized representatives/ group companies are not responsible/ liable for the said results. Readers are advised to take an informed decision before acting upon the survey results.

9 in 10 Indians want to be their own bosses: Is entrepreneurship becoming a necessity rather than a choice

The corner office is losing its charm. For generations, Indians were taught to chase stability, a government position, a corporate career, a predictable salary deposited at the end of every month. Success was measured by permanence. Risk was something to be avoided. But a new global study suggests that the country's professional imagination is undergoing a profound shift.

According to a survey conducted by Remitly Business across 28 countries, India ranks fourth globally in the desire for self-employment, with 90 percent of respondents saying they would rather be their own boss than work for someone else. Only Kenya, South Africa, and Morocco reported a stronger preference for entrepreneurship.

The finding is more than a statistic. It offers a glimpse into a changing India, one where millions are questioning the traditional relationship between work, security, and success.

THE GREAT REIMAGINING OF WORK

The rise of entrepreneurship in India is not happening in isolation. Over the past decade, the country has witnessed the emergence of start-up founders as household names, influencers turning hobbies into businesses, freelancers serving clients across continents, and small enterprises reaching global markets through digital platforms.

The smartphone has become an office. Social media has become a marketplace. Geography has become less relevant.

As a result, self-employment is no longer viewed as a fallback option for those unable to find jobs. Increasingly, it is being seen as a deliberate career choice.

The Remitly study found that the strongest motivations behind this shift are not financial. Across the surveyed countries, respondents cited independence and control over how they work as the primary attraction of self-employment, followed by flexibility and better work-life balance. In other words, people are not merely seeking higher incomes. They are seeking greater control over their lives.

BEYOND THE PAYCHEQUE: THE SEARCH FOR FREEDOM

This finding arrives at a moment when conversations around workplace burnout, long commutes, and rigid corporate structures are becoming increasingly common. Many professionals today are questioning whether career success should come at the cost of personal freedom.

For younger workers especially, flexibility has become a currency in its own right. The ability to choose projects, manage schedules, and work from anywhere is often viewed as valuable as a salary increment.

The survey suggests that India's entrepreneurial ambitions are being driven as much by lifestyle aspirations as by economic considerations.

That represents a significant cultural shift. A generation ago, stability defined ambition. Today, autonomy increasingly does.

THE REALITY CHECK: DREAMS MEET FINANCIAL ANXIETY

Yet the survey reveals a striking contradiction. While nearly three-fourths of respondents globally expressed a preference for self-employment, only one-third said they were likely to take concrete steps towards it in the next 12 months.

The reason is simple: uncertainty. More than half of respondents cited the lack of stable income as their biggest concern. Others worried about securing enough clients, sustaining demand or simply failing.

These concerns carry particular weight in India, where salaried employment often provides access to benefits that independent workers must arrange themselves, healthcare coverage, retirement savings, and financial predictability.

The entrepreneurial dream may be growing stronger, but so are the risks associated with pursuing it. Many people want freedom. Far fewer are prepared to sacrifice security to obtain it.

SOCIAL MEDIA'S ENTREPRENEURIAL MIRAGE

Perhaps the most revealing aspect of the survey concerns the influence of social media. An overwhelming 84 per cent of respondents worldwide believe that social media makes self-employment appear more attractive than it actually is. Meanwhile, 81 percent feel that hustle culture places excessive pressure on people to constantly work, earn, and achieve.

The modern internet is saturated with stories of overnight success. Videos promise financial independence. Influencers showcase lifestyles built around flexibility and freedom. Entrepreneurship is often presented as a shortcut to wealth and personal fulfilment.

What receives far less attention are the setbacks, the inconsistent income, failed ventures, financial stress, and years of uncertainty that often accompany business ownership.

The result is a growing gap between perception and reality. Entrepreneurship is increasingly celebrated. Its challenges are frequently underreported.

THINKING BEYOND BORDERS

Another noteworthy trend emerging from the survey is the global mindset of aspiring entrepreneurs. More than half of respondents expressed interest in working internationally, whether by serving overseas clients or building businesses that operate across multiple countries.

For India, this is particularly significant. Digital infrastructure, online marketplaces, and cross-border payment systems have dramatically lowered barriers to global commerce. A designer in Jaipur, a software developer in Bengaluru, or a consultant in Delhi can now compete for opportunities far beyond India's borders.

The entrepreneur of the future may not be building a local shop on a neighbourhood street. They may be building a global business from a laptop.

THE BIGGER QUESTION FOR INDIA

The findings raise an important question for policymakers and employers alike. Is India's entrepreneurial surge being driven by opportunity or by dissatisfaction with traditional employment?

The answer may lie somewhere in between.

People are clearly attracted to the flexibility, independence and sense of ownership that self-employment can offer. At the same time, many continue to view entrepreneurship as financially risky and emotionally demanding.

The challenge for India is not simply inspiring more entrepreneurs. It is creating an ecosystem where entrepreneurial ambition can be converted into sustainable livelihoods.

Access to capital, digital infrastructure, financial literacy and social security protections will play a critical role in determining whether this aspiration becomes an economic transformation.

The study reveals a country eager to redefine work on its own terms. The desire to be one's own boss is no longer confined to start-up founders and business owners.

It is becoming a mainstream aspiration. Whether that aspiration evolves into a lasting entrepreneurial revolution—or remains an unfulfilled dream, may be one of the most consequential workforce stories India faces in the years ahead.

Audience at the event

How Engineering is shaping the Spaces we Inhabit

Abdul Khader Niyaz, Chairman and Dr. Prasanth M. A, Director of AK ApplePly received the award from Shriya Saran

Anil Kumar, Abdul Khader Niyaz and Dr. Prasanth M A

We rarely consider what stops fire from consuming a transit vehicle or what keeps hotel air free from emissions. People admire upholstery and lighting but ignore the framework holding it together. For most, plywood is just a board used in construction. Strip away the surface of infrastructure, however, and you uncover a system of robotics, chemical control and structural integrity.

For over 40 years, one South Indian manufacturing enterprise has driven this architectural shift. Moving beyond timber processing, this operation has transformed structural panels into assets built to withstand modern demands. AK Apple Ply stands at the center of this change, providing materials for commercial spaces.

A GENERATIONAL BLUEPRINT FOR PRECISION

Aiming at Transforming a raw material into a structural component requires a clear mandate. Over 40 years ago, the late M Ahmed AK founded a manufacturing enterprise focused on quality, laying a blueprint that outlasted earlier methods. Today, this operation has scaled into an industrial network with facilities across Karnataka, Kerala and Goa.

This expansion is directed by Chairman AK Niyaz, backed by a board of directors including Dr Prasanth MA, Anil Kumar, Naushad Abdul Khader, Nazim Abdul Khader, Shajeed Abdul Khader and Shaz Ahmed Abdul Khader. Together, they navigate environmental regulations and structural engineering, guiding the company through industrial growth.

FIRE, TRANSIT AND MOBILITY

When mobility experts design transit interiors, they require lightweight, fire safe materials rather than standard wood. To meet this demand, the enterprise launched an automotive division. In vehicular design, safety acts as a baseline.

The panels engineered for this sector undergo testing by the Automotive Research Association of India to ensure they conform to IS 15061:2002 flammability standards. By engineering fire retardant boards that meet safety benchmarks, the company has embedded its materials into the infrastructure of automobile manufacturers, protecting passengers.

WASTE REDUCTION AND CLEAN AIR

The true cost of construction lies in its environmental footprint. To ensure air inside hospitals remains untainted, the enterprise utilises adhesives that cut formaldehyde emissions. This control earned them CARB and EPA TSCA Title VI certifications from the United States, alongside a CVI Green Product status maintained since 2010 for LEED buildings.

Taking control of their supply chain, the board launched a formaldehyde manufacturing unit last year, ensuring consistent raw materials. They also tackle construction waste through a cut size service. By employing CNC routers, they deliver custom trimmed panels that eliminate on site material wastage.

This fusion of chemical safety and precision robotics makes their panels the backbone for major hospitality brands proving leadership can reinvent materials.

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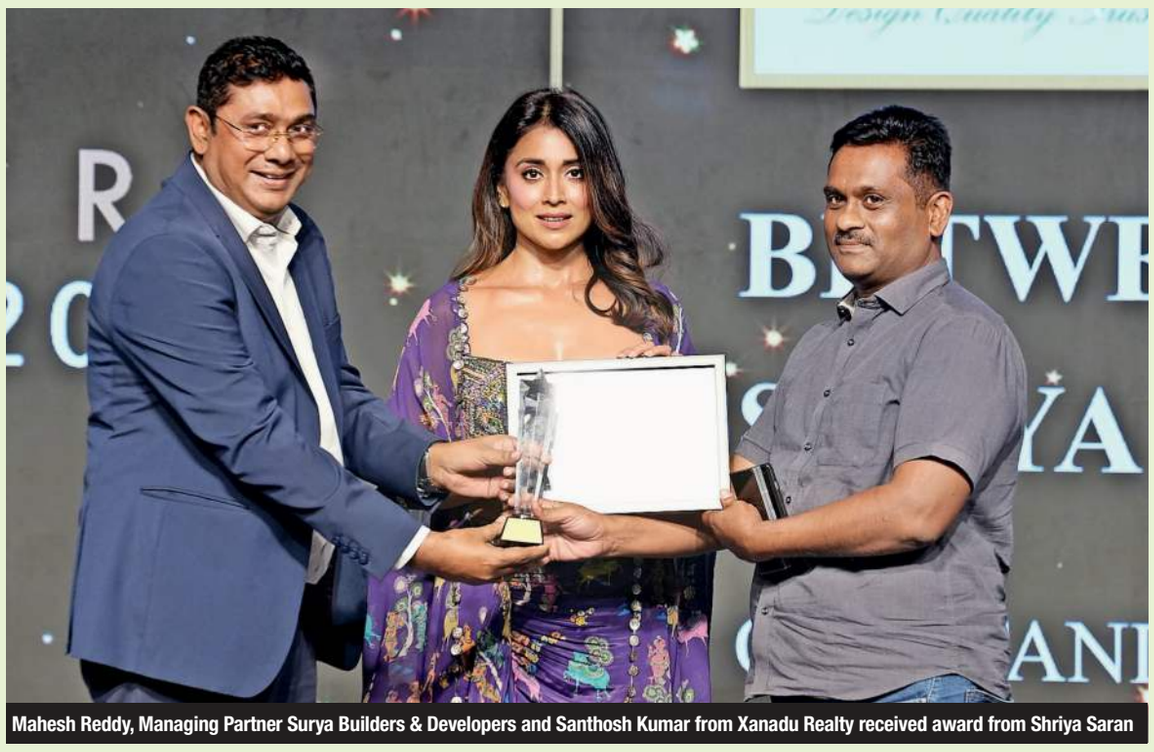
Redefining Villa Living through Space, Nature and Design



Mahesh Reddy, Managing Partner Surya Builders & Developers and Santhosh Kumar from Xanadu Realty received award from Shriya Saran

Nestled in the prime and rapidly expanding locality of Varthur, right at the thriving heart of East Bengaluru's prominent tech corridor, This award winning project, Between the Greens aims to set benchmark of ultra-luxury residential design.

Spread thoughtfully across an expansive 9.3-acre biophilic master plan, this low-density gated enclave offers an exclusive and private community of just 137 ultra-premium villas.

Designed to provide residents with complete everyday independence, the development completely eliminates shared walls and elevator queues, offering instead a serene retreat that balances modern urban convenience with a deep connection to the natural environment.

The centerpiece of the community's natural charm is its prime placement right beside the expansive Chikkanekkundi Lake basin. This strategic location along the southeast lakefront provides residents with picturesque, unblocked views, natural microclimate cooling, and superior groundwater recharge. Within this idyllic setting, the project features a curated collection of 4 BHK villas planned with tri-level living space. Every villa is structured with a distinct vertical hierarchy, incorporating ground-floor elder suites, upper-level master floors, and dedicated executive dens.

The architectural quality of these homes shines through a seamless integration of indoor and outdoor living spaces. Every villa features dynamic central courtyards that act as atmospheric spines for natural light and ventilation, complemented by private backyards, dedicated decks, and roof skylights that frame the sky. Furthermore, every single villa comes equipped with dedicated dressing areas and spacious walk-in wardrobes to cater to contemporary luxury standards.

For leisure and wellness, the community boasts dual-clubhouse villa enclave, divided into a dedicated social clubhouse and a comprehensive sports clubhouse. The social clubhouse contains premier amenities focused on hospitality, hosting guests, and social gatherings, while the sports clubhouse contains all the state-of-the-art sports and fitness amenities.

ABOUT THE DEVELOPER

SPD | Surya Builders and Developers brings a solid, trusted track record spanning over 12 years within the regional real estate market of East Bengaluru. Having delivered more than 1,500 residential units across notable landmark projects such as Purvi Symphony, Sai Purvi Sapphire, and Sai Purvi Arvindam, the developer has established a great reputation for quality. SPD | Surya Builders and Developers consistently create organized, future-ready communities that deliver remarkable institutional-grade capital appreciation and superior living standards.

Building a future defined by vision, integrity and distinctive living

NVG Group Wins Promising Developer Award at ET Achievers 2026

In real estate, true progress is measured not merely by the structures created, but by the trust earned, the experiences delivered and the legacy built over time. For Noble Vision Group (NVG Group), Bengaluru, this belief lies at the heart of its journey. The group's recognition with the Promising Developer Award at ET Achievers 2026 marks an important milestone in its pursuit of quality in contemporary residential development.

Guided by its philosophy of "Integrity First," NVG Group places transparency, quality and customer satisfaction at the centre of its approach. Its vision extends beyond conventional homebuilding to creating thoughtfully designed residences that combine sophisticated design, functionality and enduring value. The group aspires to bring together superior craftsmanship and a customer-first mindset to meet the evolving expectations of modern homebuyers.

N Venkate Gowda, Managing Director and founder of NVG group received award from Shriya Saran

At the helm of this vision is N Venkate Gowda, Managing Director of NVG Group, whose leadership reflects the organisation's ambition to create a distinctive identity in Bengaluru's evolving real estate landscape. With a forward-looking outlook, NVG is focused on developing residential experiences that are differentiated in character, considered in detail and rooted in trust.

A key expression of this ambition is World Residences by NVG, a collection conceived around the idea of bringing some of the world's finest lifestyles to Bengaluru. Drawing inspiration from remarkable global cities, the collection seeks to combine international lifestyle influences with the aspirations of local homebuyers. With an emphasis on impeccable craftsmanship, curated services and superior conveniences, World Residences reflects NVG's commitment to a more considered way of living.

NVG Group's focus on North Bengaluru, particularly Greater Yelahanka, reflects its understanding of the region's growing residential potential and evolving urban character. With improving connectivity, an established social infrastructure and new avenues for development, the region offers significant opportunities for sustainable residential growth. NVG aims to build on this momentum by creating homes that combine thoughtful planning, contemporary design and everyday functionality to meet the evolving aspirations of modern homebuyers.

The Promising Developer Award at ET Achievers 2026 marks an important milestone in NVG Group's growth journey. Beyond recognition, the honour aspires NVG's commitment to quality-led development, customer trust and a long-term vision for responsible growth. As the group continues to strengthen its presence in the real estate sector, it remains focused on creating lasting value through purposeful development and a consistent commitment to homebuyer expectations.

For NVG Group, this recognition is not simply a milestone to celebrate; it is motivation to pursue an even more ambitious future.

NVG Group — Designed for success. Built with trust.

NVG Seattle

A Fine Blend of Architectural Distinction & Elevated Sky Villa Living: Melange One

Melange One - Premium Residential Sky Villas

Bengaluru's 33-storey sky villa development brings a fresh perspective to high-rise living, placing privacy, space and nature at the heart of its architectural design.

RR Nagar, Bengaluru: Melange One, one of the premium residential development by Vaishnodevi Group, has received the ET Award 2026 for Excellence in Architectural Design – Premium Residential Sky Villas of the Year. The recognition highlights its approach to bringing the experience of villa living into a high-rise setting.

This 33-storey development reimagines urban living through thoughtfully planned sky villas. With expansive interiors, panoramic views and a focus on privacy, Melange One offers a residential experience shaped around space and exclusivity.

A defining feature of the project is its emphasis on privacy. The residences are designed without common walls between homes, offering a greater sense of separation. The development also features 270-degree panoramic views and Vastu-compliant homes, bringing contemporary architectural planning together with the preferences of Indian homebuyers.

Nature is an integral part of the design, with ample open spaces, an emphasis on natural light and the preservation of existing trees. Together, these elements aim to create a more open and considered living environment within Bengaluru's evolving urban landscape.

The project's location adds to its appeal, with the RR Nagar Metro Station in close proximity, connecting residents to Bengaluru's wider public transport network.

The ET Award 2026 marks an important milestone for Vaishnodevi Group, recognising the architectural vision behind Melange One. It also reflects the growing importance of residential design that looks beyond scale to consider privacy, space and the everyday experience of living.

Scan for more:

Through Melange One, Vaishnodevi Group brings together the scale of high-rise development and the defining qualities of villa living, offering a distinctive approach to premium residential design in Bengaluru.

PRM/KA/RERA/1251/310/PR/230126/008425

Chirag Jain, Vimal Jain, Madhusudan Baheti & Aslam Principle Architect received award from Shriya Saran

Avinash Books & Stationery: Three Decades of Trust, Service and Quality in Education

A legacy of over 30 years built on trust, service, and a commitment to education

Avinash Books & Stationery has been honoured with the prestigious ET Achievers 2026 Award for Excellence in School Book Distribution, recognizing its contribution to the education sector and its commitment to providing schools with quality products and reliable services.

Established in 1996 by Radhey Shyam Ramdayal Pareek, the company has grown into a trusted educational book distribution partner in Karnataka. With a legacy of over 30 years, Avinash Books & Stationery serves more than 100 schools and collaborates with over 100 publishers, offering a wide range of textbooks and educational resources to meet the diverse academic needs of educational institutions.

Guided by its vision of providing excellent book distribution services to schools, the company has established itself as an Elite Distributor in Karnataka. It also manages book supply and distribution requirements for group schools across the state, supporting institutions through organised operations and dependable service.

Radhey Shyam Ramdayal Pareek, Founder

Beyond book distribution, Avinash Books & Stationery is also a manufacturer of customised notebooks, offering tailored solutions featuring school names, logos, and branding. These products help schools meet their stationery requirements while maintaining consistency in their academic materials.

Embracing digital innovation, the company offers a technology-enabled online platform that allows parents to purchase schoolbooks conveniently. This initiative simplifies the book-buying process, improves accessibility, and provides parents with a seamless purchasing experience while supporting schools through efficient distribution arrangements.

Expressing gratitude for this prestigious recognition, the company extends its heartfelt thanks to all the schools, parents, publishers, and employees who have been integral to its journey. The trust of school managements, the continued support of parents and publishing partners, and the dedication of its employees have played a vital role in the company's growth and success.

The ET Achievers 2026 Award marks an important achievement in the company's journey and inspires it to achieve greater heights. Built on a strong foundation of trust, service, and innovation, Avinash Books & Stationery remains committed to strengthening partnerships, expanding its reach, and contributing to the educational ecosystem across Karnataka.

Looking ahead, the company will continue to combine its experience with technology-driven solutions and customised products to deliver excellence in school book distribution.

For more details, contact:
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Shaping Future Leaders through Innovation and Experiential Learning

As education evolves to meet the demands of a rapidly changing world, Dhermesh Manghnani, President of New Horizon Educational Institution, Bengaluru, is focused on creating learning environments that prepare students for life beyond the classroom.

Coming from a family with a longstanding legacy in education, Manghnani brings an understanding of institution-building and the transformative role education plays in society. He holds a Diploma in International Perspectives in Education from Newcastle University, United Kingdom, reflecting his interest in global approaches to learning and educational development.

Under his leadership, New Horizon emphasises a progressive approach that combines strong institutional values with innovation, experiential learning and real-world exposure. His vision extends beyond academic achievement to nurturing curiosity, creativity, critical thinking and problem-solving abilities among students.

A strong advocate of student empowerment, Manghnani believes educational institutions must provide young people with opportunities to discover their strengths, pursue their interests and translate knowledge into meaningful outcomes. By encouraging exploration across the arts, sciences and commerce, New Horizon seeks to help students develop skills that remain relevant in an increasingly dynamic global environment.

Innovation and entrepreneurship form important pillars of his educational philosophy. He champions learning experiences that encourage students to think independently, collaborate effectively and approach challenges with confidence.

For Manghnani, the purpose of education is not merely to impart knowledge but to empower the next generation to lead, innovate and create opportunities. Through a forward-looking vision grounded in institutional values, he continues to contribute to New Horizon's endeavour to nurture confident thinkers, responsible citizens and future-ready leaders.

Dhermesh Manghnani, President, New Horizon Educational Institution, Bengaluru

DRIVING INNOVATION: 70 YEARS OF IMPACT ACROSS SECTORS

The Shakti Group, a name synonymous with strength, courage, and dignity, has evolved into a powerhouse in the automotive, consumer lifestyle, and hospitality sectors. With a rich legacy spanning over 70 years, the group has continuously adapted to changing market dynamics while upholding its core values of transparency, excellence, and customer satisfaction.

STEADY EVOLUTION

The foundation of the Shakti Group was laid in 1950 with the establishment of a garments manufacturing and retail business. In 1985, under the visionary leadership of Chairman Narayanrao B. Tatuskar, the business diversified into cattle feed manufacturing under the name "Shakti Feeds". This transition marked the beginning of a legacy where all subsequent businesses carried the name 'Shakti', symbolising strength and resilience.

SHIFTING GEARS: ENTERING THE AUTOMOTIVE INDUSTRY

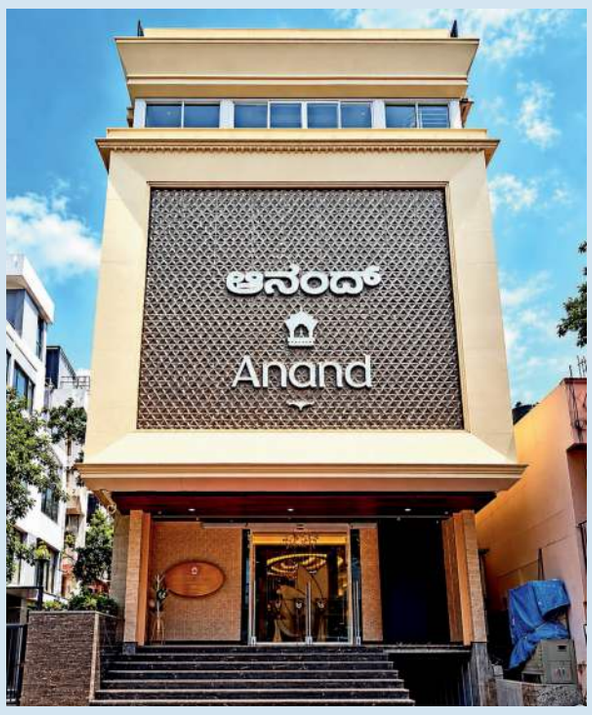
A major breakthrough came in 2006 when the group transitioned entirely into the automotive sector, dissolving its cattle feed business to focus on the distribution of Maruti Suzuki Genuine Spare Parts. Since then, the Shakti Group has grown exponentially, establishing a strong presence in retail, dealerships, and services for Some of the leading multinational automotive brands.

Venkatesh Tatuskar, CMD

VISIONARY LEADERSHIP

Today, under the leadership of Chairman and Managing Director Venkatesh Tatuskar, along with Executive Directors Aditya Tatuskar and Pratik Tatuskar, Director Geetha Tatuskar, and Brand Director Nidhi Tatuskar, the Shakti Group aims to expand, while remaining committed to its vision of growth, innovation, and customer satisfaction.

Anand Swarnn: Where Heritage Meets Contemporary Elegance



Jewellery holds a special place in Indian life, marking celebrations, expressing affection and carrying memories across generations. Embracing this enduring connection, Bengaluruw Anand Swarnn brings together traditional craftsmanship and contemporary design, offering creations that celebrate both cultural heritage and individual expression.

Rooted in a family jewellery business, Anand Swarnn has evolved with a commitment to artistry, purity and lasting value. Its approach reflects an understanding that jewellery is more than an accessory: it can become a treasured keepsake, a meaningful gift or an heirloom connecting one generation with the next. Skilled artisans combine established techniques with modern sensibilities, creating pieces that honour tradition while appealing to changing tastes.

The brand's three-storey flagship showroom on Magadi Main Road brings this vision into a dedicated retail setting. Its collections encompass gold, diamonds, precious gemstones and silver, with designs ranging from intricate traditional ornaments to lighter, contemporary pieces. Whether chosen for a wedding, a festive occasion or everyday elegance, the jewellery reflects different styles and personal preferences.

Each collection presents a distinct design language. Divine Heritage draws inspiration from India's sacred artistry, celebrating devotion and cultural motifs through intricate workmanship. Timeless Elegance focuses on graceful designs with enduring appeal, while Royal Opulence introduces grand creations associated with regal splendour. Regal Romance explores ornate detailing and romantic expression. Modern Radiance embraces sleek lines and contemporary brilliance, while The Art of Silver combines heritage influences with modern styling.

Personalisation adds another dimension to the Anand Swarnn experience. Customers can collaborate with its team to develop bespoke jewellery that reflects their stories, milestones and aspirations. The process extends from initial concepts and sketches to final polishing. Services also include reimagining existing heirlooms, allowing cherished pieces to acquire a fresh expression while retaining their emotional significance.

Alongside design, the brand places emphasis on purity, authenticity and transparency. Its stated commitments include hallmarked gold, certified diamonds, clear pricing and careful attention to craftsmanship. These principles underpin its effort to build relationships with customers seeking jewellery for important occasions and lasting enjoyment.

Guided by the thought, "Designed for Today, Inspired Forever," Anand Swarnn presents jewellery as a meeting point between memory and modern life. Its collections invite customers to celebrate their roots, express their individuality and choose pieces they can continue to cherish.

For more details, contact:
Anand Swarnn at No. 32, Magadi Main Road, Jai Muni Rao Circle, A. Dasarahalli, Bengaluru–560079.
For enquiries, call +91 98444 46064 or explore the collections online at anandswarnn.in.
Follow at Instagram
https://www.instagram.com/anandswarnn

Sourabh Jain

CELEBRATE ACCOMPLISHMENTS

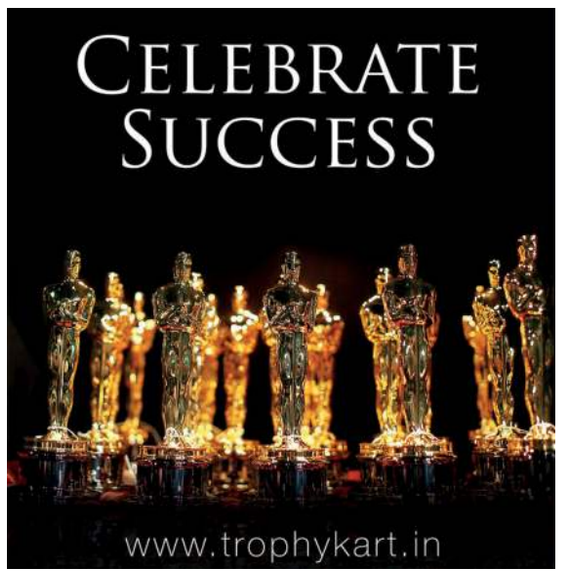
TrophyKart, one of the first exclusive online store which provides end-to end solutions for all your awards and gifting requirements. The website showcases a wide range of products in all varieties in awards, medals and corporate gifts items {T shirts, bags (backpack / laptop / sling), pens, table organizers, utilities, gadgets, tech products & Home appliance, etc}.

TROPHYKART AND ITS OFFERINGS

The website www.trophykart.in provides the comfort to access all types of trophies, medals, shields, awards, etc. under one umbrella, order and get them delivered at your doorstep with free personalization without having to deal with multiple vendors.

It offers a huge collection of metal, wooden, acrylic, glass and crystal trophies, premium awards, plaques, salvers, sports specific trophies, medals & corporate gifts. They have collaborated with the some of the largest manufacturers across India and China for offering the same.

Trophykart are specialists in making custom awards and medals. They can manufacture awards as per your requirements. Whatever your imagination says, if technically possible then they can do it for you.



Enjoy the unique shopping experience at the comfort of your home or office, while browsing through thousands of options to choose from with exceptional gifting concepts with free custom branding and free delivery at your doorstep.

Trophykart has a team of professional and passionate people who work 24/7 to cater to all your requirements. They ensure that the products are delivered on time with flawless quality. They provide end to end solutions with superior and sophisticated quality products which are crafted by professional craftsman to ensure that you get your products on time with highest level of service commitment.

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Trophykart
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or mail at order@trophykart.in
Visit: www.trophykart.in

Audience at the event

Building Beyond Boundaries: Terrain Estates' Journey Across Real Estate, Hospitality and Warehousing

From plotted developments in Bengaluru to a resort in Madikeri and Terrain Estates is carving its own path across real estate, hospitality and warehousing

What if development was not just about building more, but about creating spaces people genuinely value? This idea lies at the heart of Terrain Estates, established in 2019. With interests spanning real estate, hospitality and warehousing, the company is building its presence around quality, functionality and a connection with nature.

Led by Managing Directors Janardhan Gowda and Ranjitha, Terrain Estates is steadily expanding its footprint while focusing on practical development and customer aspirations.

THREE BUSINESSES, ONE GROWTH VISION

Terrain Estates has built a diversified portfolio that reflects the changing needs of individuals and businesses. Its A+ category warehouse facility caters to demand for quality commercial infrastructure, with an emphasis on functionality and operational efficiency.

"Our focus is on developing spaces that serve a clear purpose, whether it is supporting business operations or creating better lifestyle opportunities," says Janardhan Gowda.

While warehousing addresses commercial needs, the company's real estate and hospitality ventures bring a different dimension to its business, centred on lifestyle, comfort and the experience of a place.

A DIFFERENT TAKE ON LIVING AND LEISURE

In Bengaluru, Terrain Estates offers villa plots and farm villa plots for buyers seeking more than a conventional urban address. Open spaces, greenery and privacy are central to the appeal, offering people the opportunity to shape a lifestyle around their own aspirations.

The company's nature-inspired approach also extends to its resort in Madikeri, Karnataka. Set amid the scenic beauty of the Western Ghats, the resort offers guests a chance to step away from everyday routines and enjoy a more relaxed setting.

"We believe the surroundings are as important as the space itself. Our aim is to create experiences that bring people closer to nature, whether they are planning a home or taking time to unwind," says Ranjitha.

Together, these ventures reflect the company's belief that development should respond to people's needs while respecting the character of its surroundings.

RECOGNITION AND THE ROAD AHEAD

The company recently received the Luxury Lifestyle Plotted Development 2026 award at ET Achievers Bengaluru, marking an important milestone in its real estate journey. The recognition adds to the company's efforts to establish its presence in the plotted development segment.

Terrain Estates plans to strengthen its existing ventures and explore opportunities across all three sectors. Its focus remains on quality, customer satisfaction and steady growth. "Our ambition is not simply to expand but to create spaces that balance modern aspirations with nature and lasting value," concludes Gowda

For more information, contact:
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enquiry@terrainestates.com
www. terrainestates.com

Ranjitha , Director and Janardhan Gowda Founder and Managing Director of Terrain Estates Pvt Ltd received the award from Shriya Saran

Building Beyond Plots, Celebrating Space

What if buying a plot meant investing in more than just land? What if it meant discovering the freedom to build a home on your own terms, surrounded by greenery, thoughtful design and a community that values quality of life?

This vision drives Terra Blue Projects, a design-led real estate developer founded by Koshy Abraham, bringing a distinctive perspective to residential development in North Bengaluru.

"Terra Blue Projects is focused on creating residential enclaves shaped by architecture, landscape and enduring value. Our approach brings together architects, landscape designers, engineering consultants and specialist contractors, with an emphasis on design, meticulous execution and environmental sustainability. We believe a plotted development should be more than a collection of individual sites. It should be a thoughtfully designed living environment," says Koshy.

That philosophy finds expression in Terra Blue LEAF Villa Enclave (PRM/KA/RERA/1251/472/PR/231222/005554), the company's flagship development in Boyilahalli, North Bengaluru. Spanning approximately nine acres, the enclave features just 58 exclusive bungalow and villa plots, ranging from 3,100 to 4,400 square feet.

SPACE TO BUILD, ROOM TO BREATHE

Conceptualized around the belief that luxury begins with space, Leaf Villa Enclave is an exclusive large-format plotted development that offers a refreshing alternative to increasingly dense residential environments.

Designed as a low-density residential enclave, Leaf brings together expansive plots, Balinese-inspired landscaping and generous green spaces. Approximately 45 per cent of the development is dedicated to open spaces, while most plots enjoy north-facing, east-facing or park-facing orientations.

The concept offers homeowners the freedom to design and build individual residences that reflect their aspirations, while becoming part of a neighbourhood defined by greenery, privacy and thoughtful planning.

At the heart of the enclave lies The Loop of Joy (PRM/KA/RERA/1251/472/PR/231222), a 33,000-square-foot landscaped central plaza envisioned as a vibrant space for recreation, relaxation and community interaction.

For more information contact :
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Website: www.terrablueprojects.in

Koshy Abraham, Founder of Terra Blue Projects received the award from Shriya Saran

Xanadu Realty Completes a Decade Long Journey in Redefining Real Estate Consulting

Santosh Kumar, Regional CEO, Xanadu Bengaluru and Nitin, Sr. VP Business Development, Xanadu Bengaluru received the award from Shriya Saran

Xanadu recognition as the Best Real Estate Mandate Company at the ET Achievers Award 2026 marks a significant milestone in its decade-long journey to institutionalise a unique product-to-market business model for real estate in India. Since 2016, the company has reshaped how large-scale real estate projects are strategised, positioned and brought to market.

With a presence across Pune, Bengaluru and Mumbai, Xanadu has carved a distinctive place in the real estate ecosystem by bringing the rigour of strategic consulting to a traditionally fragmented market. Its unique value proposition lies in its ability to assemble and orchestrate a specialised, multi-partner ecosystem for each client, addressing the entire commercial value chain. It brings together specialised talent, proprietary technology, institutional processes and end-to-end execution capabilities under a unified strategy and operating framework, giving clients a single point of accountability for commercial outcomes.

At the core of Xanadu's philosophy is the belief that real estate solutions must be designed at the project level, because every project is unique. Its approach begins with a deep understanding of consumer behaviour, which informs the product concept, a compelling proposition and precise market positioning. Xanadu has pioneered this approach in India, connecting market insight with commercial strategy and on-ground execution. Over the past decade, this has translated into successful launches and projects that have achieved sell-out milestones.

Bengaluru offers a compelling view of this journey, with Xanadu's portfolio spanning multiple micro-markets across the city. Its noteworthy launches include The Presidential Tower, Bengaluru's tallest residential tower, alongside Tata New Haven, Tata Promont, Ajmera Marina and Ajmera Lakeside Paradise. Alongside this project portfolio, Xanadu has built long-standing partnerships with several listed real estate companies. These enduring collaborations extend across projects, with the company working alongside its clients to shape propositions, navigate markets and pursue sustained business growth.

The ET Achievers recognition acknowledges Xanadu's contribution towards giving birth to a new category in real estate. Today, the real estate mandate business is valued at approximately ₹6 lakh crore across India's ten largest real estate markets. As Xanadu strengthens its presence across India and explores opportunities in international markets, its ambition is to carry this model forward, helping more clients build stronger brands and enduring businesses.

Delivering Urban Certainty in Bengaluru Realty

For the average Indian family, purchasing a house is not merely a financial transaction, it is a defining life milestone that represents years of disciplined savings and shared aspirations.

While the Bengaluru property market is undeniably booming, navigating it requires finding a construction partner capable of delivering on time and on paper. Stepping into this environment in 2009, real estate developer Rainbow Properties recognised that builders are ultimately the custodians of these significant family investments. By prioritising corporate governance and a robust construction track record, the developer is bringing institutional reliability to the home-buying journey.

FROM CORPORATE GOVERNANCE TO CONSTRUCTION

The company is founded by Supreetth Vimala Suresh, an MBA graduate from Australia and has worked with multinational corporations. Transitioning into real estate development, his primary objective was to integrate strict multinational compliance into local property construction. This approach mandates absolute clarity on land titles, securing municipal permits and ensuring that all projects are strictly RERA-registered before any public launch.

"When a family commits their life savings to a property, they are fundamentally investing in trust. Our corporate background ensures that we protect that major milestone through absolute transparency. Buyers should be spending their time planning their home interiors, not worrying about the validity of regulatory approvals," says Suresh.

A MULTI-FORMAT DELIVERY TRACK RECORD

To capture different market segments, the developer has executed a diversified pipeline of residential, commercial and plotted properties. The company established its early execution capabilities with Rainbow Waterfront, a mid-segment residential project comprising 170 flats across a 2,10,000 square-foot built-up area. For those seeking premium living spaces, the 45-unit Rainbow Glendale offered boutique architecture, earning recognition.

The builder has also delivered mid-budget and thoughtfully planned communities like the 94-flat Rainbow Oaks and the 63-flat Rainbow Haven. Catering to the traditional Indian aspiration of building an independent home, the firm has developed expansive plotted layouts including the 93-plot Rainbow Misty Green spread across over five acres, the 76-plot Rainbow Park and the 145-plot Rainbow Vistas spanning nine acres. To balance this residential exposure, the company has constructed commercial properties such as the four-story Rainbow Lake Square and the three-story Rainbow Centrum.

Supreetth Vimala Suresh and Ravikumar S, Founders and Managing Partners of Rainbow Properties received the award from Shriya Saran

SCALING UP WITH HIGH-DENSITY DEVELOPMENTS

The company is currently executing two major high-density projects. Rainbow Mayfair is an ambitious project which caters to the premium segment by offering 62 luxury row villas over a 2,63,245 square-foot area. Rainbow Uno is a residential high-rise featuring 240 apartments spread across 4,90,800 square feet. "Scaling our project footprint is a natural progression but our core focus remains fixed on executing safe, vibrant and sustainable communities," he adds.

With Rainbow Mayfair and Rainbow Uno adding to its development portfolio, the company is looking to further its presence in Bengaluru's evolving residential market. The projects reflect its approach to catering to diverse homebuyer segments while focussing on quality, safety and sustainable community development.

Rainbow Mayfair-PRM/KA/RERA/1251/308/PR/190325/007593
Rainbow Uno-PRM/KA/RERA/1251/310/PR/180326/008540
Rainbow Haven-PRM/KA/RERA/1251/310/PR/191130/003049
Rainbow Park-PRM/KA/RERA/1251/310/PR/190305/002477
Rainbow Vistas-PRM/KA/RERA/1251/310/PR/071123/006377

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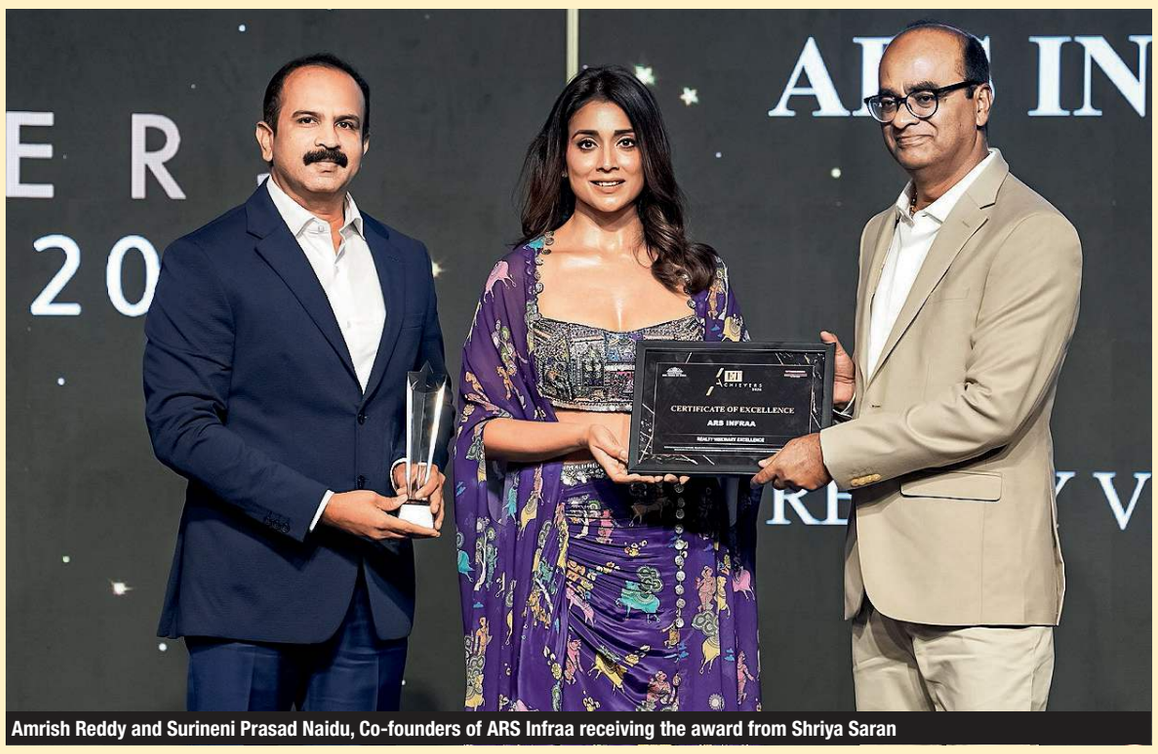
ARS Infraa: Building a Vision for Tomorrow's Sarjapur



Amrish Reddy and Surineni Prasad Naidu, Co-founders of ARS Infraa receiving the award from Shriya Saran

A vision becomes meaningful when it changes how people experience everyday life. For ARS Infraa, residential development begins with that belief: homes should offer more than a location or an address. They should provide spaces where comfort, connection and future aspirations can grow together. This outlook has earned the company the Realty Visionary Excellence award from Optimal Media Solution, a division of Times Internet Limited (The Times of India).

At the centre of its journey are founders Surineni Prasad Naidu and Amrish Reddy, whose shared focus on purposeful development continues to guide the company's direction. Their approach combines an understanding of evolving homebuyer expectations with a commitment to considered planning, quality and the long-term value of a home.

Sarjapur holds a special place in that vision. Once viewed primarily through the lens of its growth potential, the area has become a sought-after residential corridor where families look for the right balance of accessibility, comfort and community. ARS Infraa's developments aim to respond to these expectations while

THE VISION OF
ARS INFRAA

contributing to the area's emerging residential identity.

Zurich Phase 1 (Svaasa) and Zurich Phase 2 (Riva and Ziva) reflect this commitment. Designed around contemporary lifestyles, they bring together residential spaces and shared amenities intended to make daily routines more convenient and enriching. They also underline a central principle of the company's work: a successful development considers not just the individual apartment, but the larger environment in which residents live, interact and belong.

That philosophy shapes the way ARS Infraa looks at innovation. Visionary thinking does not always require dramatic gestures. Often, it is expressed through sensible layouts, well considered facilities, a clear understanding of family needs and careful attention to how spaces will be used over time. These choices create value that extends beyond appearance.

The Realty Visionary Excellence award recognises this emphasis on looking ahead while remaining grounded in real needs. It is a moment of pride for the founders and the team, and a reflection of their commitment to pursuing higher standards in residential development.

As Bengaluru continues to change, ARS Infraa aims to carry its vision forward through thoughtfully planned communities in Sarjapur. Its focus remains on building places that can adapt to changing lifestyles without losing the qualities that make a house feel like home.

The recognition marks an important milestone, but the purpose behind it remains ongoing: to imagine better possibilities for residential living and bring them closer to reality, with care, conviction and consistency, one community at a time.

For more details, contact:
ARS Infraa
Call: 8884000765

Bhavisha Homes adds Another Milestone to its Growth Journey

Sheela Surineni, Co-founder of Bhavisha Homes, and Chetan Surineni, Project Head receiving the award from Shriya Saran

For over 15 years, Bhavisha Homes has contributed to Sarjapur's transformation into one of Bengaluru's sought-after residential destinations. Founded by Surineni Prasad Naidu and Sheela Surineni, the company has built its reputation on thoughtful design, dependable quality and an understanding of modern living. This commitment has been recognised with the Excellence in Luxury Housing Developer award from Optimal Media Solutions a division of Times Internet Limited, marking a significant milestone in its journey.

With deep roots in Sarjapur, Bhavisha Homes has witnessed the neighbourhood's evolution into a thriving residential hub. As infrastructure, connectivity and lifestyle aspirations have progressed, the company has continued creating homes that combine everyday comfort, practicality and lasting appeal.

This philosophy is reflected in two distinctive residential offerings, Bilva II and Casa Life. Bilva II brings together generous living spaces, contemporary planning and lifestyle amenities to create a balanced urban experience. Casa Life presents a different expression of luxury through villa living centred on privacy, personal space and the freedom to enjoy life at one's own pace. Though different in character, both developments share a commitment to thoughtful living.

For Bhavisha Homes, luxury extends beyond premium finishes, impressive features or visual grandeur. It lies equally in the details shaping everyday experiences: functional layouts, welcoming common spaces, reliable execution and communities that foster a genuine sense of belonging. Years of working closely with homebuyers have established these priorities at the heart of its development philosophy.

THE SYMPHONY OF
BHAVISHA HOMES

The Excellence in Luxury Housing Developer recognition celebrates more than individual projects. It acknowledges the company's pursuit of quality, understanding of evolving lifestyle needs and the trust it has built through years of serving homebuyers in Sarjapur. It also recognises the dedication of the teams contributing to every stage of the development journey.

For founders Surineni Prasad Naidu and Sheela Surineni, this honour represents an important milestone in the company's continued growth and commitment to the region. Their vision continues to guide Bhavisha Homes as it raises expectations for residential living while remaining grounded in quality, transparency, attention to detail and customer confidence.

With over 15 years of experience in Sarjapur, Bhavisha Homes continues strengthening its connection with the neighbourhood and the families who call it home. This recognition reinforces an enduring belief: true luxury is not defined merely by the spaces a developer creates, but by the everyday experiences those spaces enable and the confidence with which families choose to make them their own. The award inspires the company to keep evolving alongside Bengaluru, creating thoughtfully designed residences that reflect changing aspirations while preserving the values that have shaped its journey and earned homebuyers' trust over the years.

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For more details, contact:
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The Changing Aspirations of Bengaluru's Homebuyers

Praveen C, VP, Sales and Marketing and Varun Singh, AGM Sales received award from Shriya Saran

Homebuying today is about more than location, size, or investment potential. It is about choosing a place that aligns with one's aspirations, offers a better quality of life, and inspires confidence in the developer. For many homebuyers in Bengaluru, this shift is aiming to redefine what makes a residential destination desirable.

As the city expands beyond its traditional urban centres, emerging neighbourhoods are attracting attention for their connectivity, evolving infrastructure, and potential to offer a more balanced way of life. Among these, Devanahalli in North Bengaluru is steadily gaining prominence, bringing a new dimension to the city's residential landscape.

Goyal &Co. | Hariyana Group
creating landmarks since 1971

WHERE CONNECTIVITY MEETS CHANGING ASPIRATIONS

Situated in North Bengaluru, near Kempegowda International Airport, Devanahalli is emerging as a location of interest for homebuyers looking beyond established residential corridors. Its strategic positioning and evolving infrastructure have brought it into the conversation for those considering long-term residential choices.

However, a promising location is only one part of the homebuying equation. Today's buyers are also evaluating the environment they will live in, the experiences a community can offer, and the confidence they can place in the developer behind it.

Green spaces, thoughtfully planned residential environments, dedicated recreational areas, and access to essential infrastructure are becoming important considerations. The emphasis is gradually shifting from simply purchasing a property to choosing a lifestyle that supports family life, personal well-being, and future aspirations.

A DECISION FOR THE FUTURE

Riviera Glade by Goyal & Co. | Hariyana Group is among the premium villa development in Devanahalli, North Bengaluru, offering a combination of strategic location, contemporary living, and thoughtfully planned community spaces. Located approximately 15 minutes from Kempegowda International Airport. The development features landscaped green spaces and dedicated zones for senior citizens and pets, catering to the evolving needs of modern families. Backed by the developer's residential development experience, Riviera Glade offers homebuyers an opportunity to explore a lifestyle that brings together connectivity, comfort, and long-term residential aspirations.

A HOME THAT REFLECTS YOUR ASPIRATIONS

As Bengaluru continues to grow, the meaning of a desirable home is evolving. Buyers are increasingly looking for a combination of connectivity, thoughtfully designed living spaces, community amenities, and confidence in their investment decision. A home that emphasis on the experience of the living within a thoughtfully planned community.

For homebuyers seeking a premium villa in North Bengaluru, Riviera Glade offers an opportunity to explore a lifestyle shaped by these priorities. Its proximity to Kempegowda International Airport, landscaped surroundings, and amenities designed for different members of the family make it a development worth discovering.

If you are considering a villa that brings together location, lifestyle, and long-term residential aspirations, explore Riviera Glade by Goyal & Co. | Hariyana Group and discover whether it is the right fit for your family's next chapter.

RERA - PRM/KA/RERA/1251/472/PR/040326/008503

For more details, contact:
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Email: mkt.bng@goyalco.com
Call: 80888 66000

BENGALURU'S TECH CORRIDOR, BUILT BIGGER

A Grade A Technology Campus on Bengaluru's Outer Ring Road

Gopalan Fortune City is a premium Grade A, campus-style technology park on the Outer Ring Road in Mahadevapura, Bengaluru. Built for technology enterprises, R&D centres, engineering firms and global business operations, it brings together large-scale commercial infrastructure, integrated amenities and a metro station at its doorstep.

METRO AT THE DOORSTEP

One of Gopalan Fortune City's biggest advantages is the Mahadevapura / DRDO Metro station on the Namma Metro Blue Line, right at the campus gates. It brings a major convenience to the daily commute of every professional working at the tech park. Situated on Bengaluru's established ORR technology corridor, the campus is also well connected to Whitefield, KR Puram and central Bengaluru, supported by nearby bus services and major arterial roads.

INFRASTRUCTURE BUILT FOR ENTERPRISE

Spread across approximately 50 acres, Gopalan Fortune City is planned as six office blocks and a dedicated amenities block. Each office block rises to three basements, a ground floor and 11 upper floors (3B + G + 11), with average floor plates of approximately 94,000 sq. ft. Double- and triple-height atriums run across all floors, while large structural grids and generous clearance heights make every client workspace more efficient.

Block 2, spanning 1.1 million sq. ft., is complete. A further 3.9 million sq. ft. across three office blocks and the amenities block is under execution, with an additional 2.5 million sq. ft. planned for future expansion, giving organisations room to scale on a single campus.

AN INTEGRATED WORKPLACE ECOSYSTEM

Beyond the office floor, the campus offers multi-cuisine food courts, a sports club, an amphitheatre, indoor recreation, rooftop restaurants, open gyms and fitness centres, yoga and meditation rooms, a crèche, a medical room and convenience stores.

GOPALAN FORTUNE CITY
A CAMPUS-CENTRIC TECHPARK

Indicative image representation only

RECOGNISED AND RESPONSIBLE

Gopalan Fortune City was named IT Park of the Year 2026 at the Times Real Estate Awards. Its commitment to sustainability is reflected in its USGBC LEED Gold certification, a recognised benchmark for green commercial real estate.

ENABLING THE NEXT GENERATION OF ENTERPRISE

With its scale, enterprise-grade infrastructure, integrated amenities and seamless metro connectivity, Gopalan Fortune City is a destination for organisations seeking a future-ready business address in Bengaluru.

Scan for more:

For more information on ET Achievers, write to:info.oms@timesofindia.com

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